NPTEL Soft Skills — Complete Notes

All 12 weeks, 60 lectures

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Week 1: Foundations of Soft Skills and Communication

1. Lecture 1: Introduction to Soft Skills
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Lecture 1: Introduction to Soft Skills

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 5–23 (printed pages 4–22)

Learning objectives

- Understand what soft skills are and why the term is called an umbrella term.
- Distinguish soft skills from hard skills.
- Explain why soft skills matter for employability and career growth.
- Recall the working definition and the key skills named in the lecture (self-awareness, flexibility, persistence).

Important definitions

SOFT SKILLS

An umbrella term for people skills, life skills and behavioural skills. Working definition: soft skills comprise personality traits, social graces, facility with language, personal habits, friendliness and optimism that mark people to varying degrees.

HARD SKILLS

Subject knowledge and technical expertise gained through college or university study; part of the formal curriculum.

EMPLOYABILITY

The ability to get and keep a job; the lecturer calls it the “keyword”, since degrees alone do not make a person employable.

Core concepts

Soft skills are more than communication skills

Many people think soft skills = communication skills. Communication is only **one part**. Others include interpersonal skills, management skills, leadership skills and team dynamics. Soft skills cannot be

learned in a day: they are a **lifelong, continuous learning process**.

The lecturer's two illustrations

- **Gift-shop manager:** a young manager with no degree won the customer by helping, analysing the need, being friendly and reassuring. Another salesman who also spoke did not have the "extra edge", so communication alone is not the answer.
- **Two doctors on one road:** both had foreign degrees and were toppers, yet one clinic was crowded. The difference lay in how they talked to patients, their use of simple language (the doctor who said "hypochondria" confused the patient) and how friendly the staff were.

Behavioural skills the lecture names

- **Self-awareness** – awareness of present-day needs of the world and of one's own abilities.
- **Flexibility**.
- **Persistence and perseverance**.
- Self-confidence, optimism, cultural sensitivity, being accommodating and a good listener.

Why soft skills matter

- They help us come out of difficult situations and give **reassurance and reliability**.
- Two equally qualified people can get different packages because of soft skills.
- Job requirements are changing: employers want people who take initiative, make decisions, negotiate and innovate.
- There is a **gap between academia and industry**; organisations often train new recruits in soft skills.
- Soft skills make an employee more cordial, accountable and able to take decisions without the boss's direction.
- Needed in meetings, group discussions, drafting business documents, telephone deals, electronic writing and representing the organisation.
- In a globalised "global village", cultural sensitivity and listening are essential.

Evidence cited (employability gap)

- Census 2011 data reported by *The Hindu*: unemployment is high among the better qualified.
- Report: 23 lakh people applied for a peon's job in U.P., including engineers and doctors.
- Survey in *Aspiring Minds*: many professionals are unemployable because of poor communication skills.
- Kiran Karnik (former NASSCOM president): we must groom qualified students to make them employable.
- ILO report: India faces "jobless growth"; Rituparna Chakraborty (Vice President, Indian Staffing Federation): "We need to invest in and build skills among the youth."
- Government initiatives mentioned: Skill India, Start-up India, Make in India; NPTEL itself aims to bridge the gap.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Hard skills versus soft skills (as described in the lecture)

Basis	Hard skills	Soft skills
Nature	Subject knowledge, technical expertise	Personality traits, people skills, life skills, behavioural skills
Source	Taught in college curriculum	Not taught as a college subject; learned through exposure, practice and training programmes
Role	Get you the job (technical competence)	Make you excel and shine in the job; "performance skills"
Relationship	Need soft skills to be effective	Complement hard skills: "drive your hard skills through the engine of soft skills"

Theories, principles, models and contributors

SWAMI VIVEKANANDA'S MANTRA — QUOTED IN THE LECTURE

"Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached." Arise = become **self-aware**; awake = become **self-confident**; do not stop = become **dynamic** through soft skills.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Gift-shop manager who lacked an MBA yet persuaded the customer through helpfulness and need analysis.

EXAMPLE

Two doctors with identical foreign degrees: the crowded clinic is the one with better patient dealing and friendlier staff.

EXAMPLE

A recruiter's remark: "I would love to hire a girl with a pleasant smile and better communication skills than one having a very good CGPA and doing nothing."

Comparison tables

Soft skills versus communication skills

Point	Soft skills	Communication skills
Scope	Umbrella term covering many skills	One component of soft skills
Includes	Interpersonal, management, leadership, team dynamics, self-awareness, flexibility, persistence	Speaking, listening, writing, non-verbal communication

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Soft skills is an **umbrella term**; they are also called life skills, people skills and behavioural skills.
- Estimates of the number of soft skills vary (28, 60 or 10) because the skills overlap.
- Working definition: personality traits, social graces, facility with language, personal habits, friendliness and optimism.
- Behavioural skills named first: self-awareness, then flexibility, then persistence and perseverance.
- Soft skills are performance skills and a process of continuous learning.
- Hard skills are part of the college curriculum; soft skills are not taught as a college subject.
- Recruiter quote: pleasant smile and communication skills preferred over a very good CGPA by someone doing nothing.
- Swami Vivekananda's mantra is "Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached."

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q6	p.4	Importance of soft skills in hiring	MCQ
W1 Q11	p.5	Behavioural soft skills	MSQ
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Soft skills are an umbrella term for people, life and behavioural skills such as self-awareness, flexibility, persistence, friendliness and optimism. They complement hard (technical) skills, make people employable and are learned continuously. Communication is only one part of soft skills. The widening gap between academia and industry, and rising unemployment among qualified people, show why employers value them.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which statement best describes soft skills?

A. Technical expertise gained in college

B. An umbrella term for people, life and behavioural skills

C. Only communication skills

D. Skills taught in every university syllabus

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** The lecture calls soft skills an umbrella term and cautions that they are not merely communication skills.

Q2 (MCQ) Which of these is a hard skill?

A. Persistence

B. Friendliness

C. Technical expertise in a subject

D. Optimism

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Hard skills are subject knowledge and technical expertise.

Q3 (MSQ) Select the behavioural skills named in the lecture.

A. Self-awareness

B. Flexibility

C. Typing speed

D. Persistence and perseverance

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** These are the personal charms listed; typing speed is not mentioned.

Q4 (T/F) Communication skills and soft skills mean exactly the same thing.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Communication is only a part of the wider set of soft skills.

Q5 (Fill) Soft skills are performance skills, while hard skills are part of the _____.

> **Answer:** college curriculum
> **Why:** Soft skills are not taught in colleges the way subject knowledge is.

Q6 (Short) Why were the two doctors in the lecture's example differently successful?

> **Answer:** Their soft skills differed.
> **Why:** One used simple language, took the case history and had friendly staff; the other confused patients with jargon.

Revision checklist

☐ I can state the working definition of soft skills.
☐ I can list three differences between hard and soft skills.
☐ I know why communication skills alone are not soft skills.
☐ I can quote Vivekananda’s mantra and explain its three parts.
☐ I remember the employability evidence (Census 2011, 23 lakh peon applicants, NASSCOM remark).

Lecture 2: Aspects of Soft Skills

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 24–40 (printed pages 23–39)

Learning objectives

- List the main aspects (components) of soft skills: communication, attitude, adaptability, teamwork, conflict management, leadership, time and space skills, mannerism and cultural sensitivity.
- Explain the four communication skills (listening, speaking, reading, writing) and why listening comes first.
- Apply De Bono's Six Thinking Hats to problem solving.
- Recall the quotations and thinkers used in the lecture.

Important definitions

EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Communication that serves the requisite purpose (e.g. you order a book and receive it in time). It needs more than words: structure, sentence construction, non-verbal cues and the receiver's point of view.

COMMUNICATION

From the Latin *communicare*, meaning **to share** an idea or experience through a medium.

ATTITUDE

A tendency or willingness displayed to get work done in the right direction and in the right way.

ADAPTABILITY

Ability to adjust to differing situations, tools, versions and ways of working.

HOMOPHILY

Common experiences or familiarity between sender and receiver, which make communication faster and more vital.

CONFLICT MANAGEMENT

Using soft skills to resolve a conflict so that it does not turn into a quarrel; healthy conflict is functional and promotes creative thinking and team decisions.

Core concepts

Aspects of soft skills

1. **Effective communication** – listening, speaking, reading, writing.
2. **Attitude**.
3. **Adaptability**.
4. **Teamwork** and conflict management.
5. **Leadership** – a trait developed over time; leaders emerge from critical situations (e.g. rescue a group discussion from being sidetracked).
6. **Time and space skills** – everyone has only 24 hours; effective managers manage time.
7. **Mannerism** – learnable; organisations look for well-mannered people.
8. **Cultural sensitivity** – respect others' culture, faith and beliefs.
9. **Problem solving** (e.g. Six Thinking Hats).

The four communication skills

- **Listening** – first and most neglected; 60–75 per cent of working time is spent listening. All hearing is not listening: hearing needs no conscious effort, listening is a mental activity (active/perceptive listening).
- **Speaking** – needed in interviews, group discussions, data collection, product launches, negotiations, presentations. A communication starts with a message and ends in a response.
- **Reading** – on the decline because of screens; "Reading maketh a full man".
- **Writing** – the most challenging; business writing is meant **to express and not to impress**; avoid pompous words; follow the organisation's structure.

Attitude: the five Cs to avoid

Organisations suffer from "emotional cancers": **criticizing, complaining, comparing, competing and contending** instead of concentrating on one's own work. ("My shirt is whiter than yours.")

Teamwork and conflict

- Projects come as team projects; a leader should bind, cohere and accommodate different natures.
- Own both defeat and victory: no blame game; say "team's victory".
- Suzanne Bidlake: "In most models of future organization, teams, not individuals function as the primary performance unit."
- David Hume: "Truth springs from argument amongst friends" – let there be argument, not quarrel. Emotions should not enter conflict resolution.
- Advantages of conflict management: functional, healthy, ensures creative thinking and promotes team decisions.

Culture

The lecture quotes "Culture is a code we learn and share" (the transcript says Adam Smith; the quiz attributes the definition to **Alfred G. Smith**, *Communication and Culture*). Accept, accommodate and assimilate; communication should be a binding, not a dividing, force. Not everything in your culture is good, nor everything in another's bad.

Leadership

Not all can be leaders. A leader emerges because of merit and constructive suggestions, builds support logically, and saves the group from deviating. Leadership is developed through awareness and interaction.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Six Thinking Hats (Edward De Bono)

Hat	Thinking mode
White	Objective, facts and information
Red	Emotions and feelings
Yellow	Positive mindset, optimism
Green	Generating ideas, creativity
Blue	Controlling and organising the thinking process
Black	Caution, fighting against and preventing mistakes (not detailed in this lecture's text)

Theories, principles, models and contributors

SIX THINKING HATS — EDWARD DE BONO

A technique for problem solving: when all members take turns wearing different coloured hats, different kinds of ideas emerge, giving more creative and conclusive solutions.

QUOTATIONS TO REMEMBER

- David Hume – "Truth springs from argument amongst friends."
- Suzanne Bidlake – teams, not individuals, are the primary performance unit.
- "Reading maketh a full man."
- Culture is "a code we learn and share" (Alfred G. Smith).

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Missed calls used by youngsters as a code: repeated missed calls lead to confusion, showing communication can fail.

EXAMPLE

Cricket: the captain says "it is the team's victory", not the individual's.

EXAMPLE

In a group discussion a person with no points at first can contribute later if he keeps listening patiently.

Comparison tables

Hearing versus listening

Hearing	Listening
Physiological (physical) activity	Mental activity
Needs no conscious effort	Needs conscious participation and extra effort
Passive	Active/perceptive

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Latin *communicare* = to share.
- 60–75 per cent of one's time in any job is spent in listening.
- Four communication skills: listening, speaking, reading, writing; writing is the most challenging.
- Business writing: express, do not impress.
- Five negative Cs: criticizing, complaining, comparing, competing, contending.
- Green hat = generating ideas; white = objective; red = emotion; yellow = positive; blue = control.
- Hume: truth springs from argument amongst friends.
- Culture is a code we learn and share (Alfred G. Smith in the quiz).
- Homophily = common experience between communicators.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q1	p.3	Hearing vs listening	MCQ
W1 Q3	p.3	De Bono's Six Thinking Hats	MCQ
W1 Q9	p.4	Time spent listening	MCQ
W1 Q13	p.5	De Bono's Six Thinking Hats	MSQ
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Soft skills have several aspects: effective communication (listening, speaking, reading, writing), attitude, adaptability, teamwork, conflict management, leadership, time and space skills, mannerism and cultural sensitivity. Listening is the foundation; business writing aims to express, not impress. Teams, not individuals, are the performance unit, and constructive conflict helps. De Bono's hats support creative problem solving.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which hat is associated with generating ideas?

A. White

B. Red

C. Green

D. Blue

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Green hat = idea generation.

Q2 (MCQ) The word 'communication' comes from *communicare*, meaning:

A. To speak

B. To share

C. To write

D. To command

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Communication is sharing ideas or experiences.

Q3 (MSQ) Select the four communication skills discussed.

A. Listening

B. Speaking

C. Reading

D. Writing

E. Painting

> **Answer:** A, B, C, D
> **Why:** LSRW are the four skills.

Q4 (T/F) Hearing and listening require the same amount of conscious effort.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Hearing is physical and needs no conscious effort; listening is mental and conscious.

Q5 (Fill) Business writing is meant to express and not to _____.

> **Answer:** impress
> **Why:** Avoid pompous words; be clear.

Q6 (Short) Name the five negative Cs that harm attitude in organisations.

> **Answer:** Criticizing, complaining, comparing, competing and contending.
> **Why:** They replace concentration on one's own work.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list the aspects of soft skills.
☐ I know the four communication skills and why listening comes first.
☐ I can match each Six Thinking Hat to its function.
☐ I remember Hume, Bidlake and the culture quotation.
☐ I can state the 60–75 per cent listening fact.

Lecture 3: Effective Communication Skills

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 41–54 (printed pages 40–53)

Learning objectives

- Define communication and explain why it is called a process.
- Describe the elements of the communication process: sender, encoding, message, channel, receiver, decoding, feedback, frame of reference, noise.
- State the qualities of effective communication (the 7 Cs as presented).
- Differentiate general-purpose and organisational communication, and internal and external communication, including the grapevine.

Important definitions

COMMUNICATION

To express an idea, desire, expectation or experience; from Latin *communicare* (to share). It is effective only when it meets its desired goal.

COMMON FRAME OF REFERENCE

Shared background (age, experience, knowledge, tastes) between sender and receiver that makes communication successful.

ENCODING

The sender’s act of putting an idea into a message (words, symbols, language) before sending.

DECODING

The receiver’s act of extracting the meaning from the received message.

FEEDBACK

The receiver’s response; only feedback shows that the communication process is complete.

GRAPEVINE

An informal channel of organisational communication, often a rumour mill; information may be unauthentic or inadequate, though it may also forewarn management.

HOMOPHILY

Common experiences between communicators.

Core concepts

Illusion of communication

George Bernard Shaw: “The greatest problem in communication is the illusion that it has been accomplished.” The real test is whether the message sent has been **received properly**.

Communication as a process

1. The **sender/source** has an idea, experience, desire or fact.
2. The sender considers the receiver’s background, **encodes** the idea in a message and selects a **channel**.
3. The message is transmitted; obstruction (noise, wrong medium, difficult language) may change it.
4. The **receiver decodes** the message.
5. The receiver gives **feedback**, which completes the process.

Absence of a response does not always mean failure; there may be an obstruction.

Factors that affect success

- **Perception** differs between sender and receiver.
- **Environment** (e.g. a noisy marketplace spoils a phone call).
- **Medium** (the teacher who did not have email access); choose a medium the receiver is accustomed to.
- **Language and vocabulary** (Marathi to a Tamil speaker fails; difficult English words fail because nobody sits with a thesaurus).
- Receiver’s attention and background.

Qualities of effective communication (the 7 Cs as presented)

- **Clarity** – be clear and avoid difficult words.
- **Completeness** – no half sentences; written messages cannot be clarified on the spot.
- **Conciseness** – use short sentences yet be specific; the “hallmark of communication”.
- **Correctness** – grammatical and accurate.
- **Courtesy** – consideration and sympathy for the receiver, especially seniors and elders.
- **Candidness** – integrity, honesty and fairness.
- **Consideration** of the receiver’s background and knowledge (the text names the seven but spells out these six plus consideration; the exact seventh appears only in the original slide).

Organisational communication

Differs from casual communication; words must be specific because people of different faiths, beliefs and positions work together. Think of collective responsibility.

- **Internal** – within the organisation: formal (meetings, policies) and informal. Flow: **upward, downward, horizontal (lateral), vertical, diagonal/across departments**.
- **External** – with clients, customers, government agencies and the public; builds a positive image (promotion, website, pamphlets, letters, internet).

The grapevine

Formal communication is to the point, so employees seek an informal channel. Grapevine information is often unauthentic and can create factionalism; managers sometimes use it carefully for early warnings. Use it not to discard or discredit, and stay away from rumour.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Direction of internal communication

Direction	Meaning / example
Downward	From management to employees (new policy, DA hike)
Upward	From employees to superiors (feedback, requests)
Horizontal / lateral	Between people of the same status or post
Diagonal / across departments	Between different departments and levels

Theories, principles, models and contributors

PROCESS MODEL OF COMMUNICATION

Sender (idea) → encode → channel → receiver → decode → feedback. A common frame of reference and absence of noise help it succeed.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A child who cries when hungry communicates without words; only the mother knows the cause.

EXAMPLE

Sharing a book or movie is easiest with a friend of similar age, experience and knowledge.

EXAMPLE

An email sent to a teacher who has no email access never gets a response; a phone call fixes it.

Comparison tables

General-purpose versus organisational communication

Point	General-purpose (casual)	Organisational
Participants	Friends and relatives	Employees at different positions, clients, public
Language	Casual, loose word control	Specific, careful, considers beliefs and positions
Aim	Social sharing	Specific organisational goal

Internal versus external communication

Internal	External
Within the organisation and with employees	With clients, customers, government agencies, the public
Formal and informal (incl. grapevine)	Product promotion, website, letters; builds image

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Bernard Shaw: the greatest problem in communication is the illusion that it has been accomplished.
- Communication is a process; feedback completes it.
- A common frame of reference is essential for success.
- Conciseness is the hallmark of communication.
- Grapevine = informal channel, often rumour-based and not always authentic; it may be used carefully.
- Internal flow: upward, downward, horizontal, vertical, diagonal.
- Extracting meaning from a message is decoding; forming it is encoding.
- Latin *communicare* = to share.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q5	p.3	Frame of reference in communication	MCQ
W1 Q7	p.4	Meaning of communication	MCQ
W1 Q10	p.4	Encoding and decoding	MCQ
W1 Q12	p.5	Seven Cs of communication	MSQ
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Communication is a process in which a sender encodes an idea, sends it through a channel, the receiver decodes it, and feedback completes the cycle. A shared frame of reference, a suitable medium and environment, and a message that is clear, complete, concise, correct, courteous and candid improve effectiveness. Organisational communication may be internal (upward, downward, horizontal, diagonal, including the grapevine) or external.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The receiver's task of extracting meaning from a message is called:

A. Encoding

B. Decoding

C. Feedback

D. Channelling

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Receivers decode; senders encode.

Q2 (MCQ) Shared background of experience between sender and receiver is the:

A. Common frame of reference

B. Grapevine

C. Channel

D. Feedback loop

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** It makes communication successful and effective.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are directions of internal communication?

A. Upward

B. Downward

C. Horizontal

D. Subterranean

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Diagonal is also mentioned; 'subterranean' is not.

Q4 (T/F) The grapevine always gives authentic information.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It is informal and may be rumour-based and inadequate.

Q5 (Fill) Communication is complete only when _____ is received.

> **Answer:** feedback
> **Why:** Feedback shows the process has been completed.

Q6 (Short) Name two factors that can obstruct a message.

> **Answer:** Noise in the environment and an unsuitable medium or language.
> **Why:** Perception differences also matter.

Revision checklist

☐ I can draw and explain the communication process.
☐ I can explain the Shaw quotation.
☐ I know the qualities of effective communication.
☐ I can distinguish internal, external and grapevine communication.
☐ I know the directions of internal communication.

Lecture 4: Classification of Communication

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 55–69 (printed pages 54–68)

Learning objectives

- Compare oral and written communication.
- Classify communication by number of participants: intrapersonal, interpersonal, extra-personal, group and mass/media.
- Explain verbal, non-verbal and meta-communication, and print vs electronic media.
- Understand cross-cultural, ethical and legal aspects (plagiarism, libel, slander).

Important definitions

INTRAPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Communication within oneself: you talk to yourself; the eyes act as transmitter, the central nervous system as medium and the brain as receiver, with feedback in bodily reactions. Helps self-discovery and recovery.

INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Communication between two individuals (or two groups), usually conversation or dialogue; also called **dyadic** communication and 'relationship communication'.

EXTRA-PERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Communication between humans and animals (or animals among themselves) without language; responses come through movements and sounds.

GROUP COMMUNICATION

Communication among members of a group (classroom lecture, group discussion, meeting).

MASS AND MEDIA COMMUNICATION

Communication to large audiences through electrical and mechanical devices (newspaper, television); receivers are largely passive.

META-COMMUNICATION

Communication beyond words, including unintentional meanings that listeners find in what is said.

LIBEL AND SLANDER

Criticism of an organisation or person in writing is **libel**; in speech it is **slander**. Both are unethical and may be illegal.

PLAGIARISM

Using someone's words or ideas without acknowledgment; to be avoided with misquoting.

Core concepts

Oral and written communication

- **Oral:** spontaneous, warm, immediate feedback and clarification, uses voice to carry emotion, can be informal or formal, reaches small or large groups; forms include briefing, talk, speech, group discussion, paper presentation, meetings, interviews and telephone.
- **Written:** organised, formal, a record; feedback is delayed; follows standards of grammar and structure; cannot be easily changed once sent; can reach a very large audience across the world. Business writing includes letters, reports, memos, notices, newsletters, circulars, brochures and research papers.

Four forms by number of participants

Humans communicate in four (five) ways depending on the number of participants: **intrapersonal, interpersonal, extra-personal, group** and **mass/media**.

- Intrapersonal examples: soliloquy and aside in plays (Hamlet's "To be or not to be").
- Interpersonal depends on the relationship with the other party (e.g. boss). Interviews are interpersonal.
- Group: silence in a meeting also communicates.
- Mass/media: less chance of clarification and less personal rapport; sender cannot control a wide audience.

Verbal, non-verbal and meta-communication

- All spoken or written communication is **verbal** (uses words). Meaning lies with the **sender**, not the word.
- **Non-verbal** cues supplement words (body movements, face); the lecture says there are more than **6 lakh** non-verbal cues. "Whatever you say is written on your face."
- **Meta-communication** is beyond words and may carry unintended meaning.

Print and electronic media

Written words keep their importance in print and electronic form (email, chat). Think before writing: messages can be interpreted differently and may have impact in a crisis.

Cross-cultural communication

- Respect religious sentiments, etiquette, tastes, habits and the concept of time.
- In Latin America meetings may start late because people first discuss and eat.
- Gifts: giving a Chinese person a clock may suggest inviting evil.
- Do not assume your culture's understanding is universal; allow room to receivers; mind status patterns.

Ethical and legal aspects

- Every organisation has an ethical code and policy statements; employees must respect them (e.g. using organisational funds to travel for a personal interview is unethical).
- Avoid misquoting, plagiarism and inaccurate information; acknowledge sources.
- Do not criticise your organisation to get another job; remember you are its ambassador.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Classification of human communication by participants

Type	Parties	Key features / examples
Intrapersonal	One person (self)	Self-talk, soliloquy; self-discovery; brain gives feedback
Interpersonal (dyadic)	Two persons or two groups	Conversation, dialogue, interview; depends on relationship
Extra-personal	Humans and animals	Sounds, movements, wagging tails; no language
Group	Members of a group	Lecture, GD, meeting; formalities; silence also communicates
Mass and media	One source to a large audience	Newspaper, TV; passive receiver; little personal rapport

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A student who missed a good grade talks to himself and realises the lapses: intrapersonal communication.

EXAMPLE

Hamlet's soliloquy "To be or not to be, that is the question."

EXAMPLE

Presenting a clock to a Chinese colleague may be read as inviting evil.

EXAMPLE

Latin American meetings begin after discussion and food.

Comparison tables

Oral versus written communication

Point	Oral	Written
Feedback	Immediate, spontaneous	Delayed
Nature	Informal or formal; emotional through voice	Formal, organised, record
Clarification	Possible on the spot	Difficult
Revision	Can improvise	Hard to change once sent
Reach	Small or large group present	Wide audience across the world

Libel versus slander

Libel	Slander
Defamatory statement in writing	Defamatory statement in speech

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Interpersonal communication is also called dyadic communication.
- Intrapersonal: brain acts as receiver; soliloquy and aside are examples.
- Mass/media receivers are passive; media include newspapers and television.
- More than 6 lakh non-verbal cues exist.
- Meaning lies with the sender, not in words.
- Written criticism = libel; spoken = slander.
- A clock as a gift may be considered bad omen in Chinese culture.
- Latin American meetings often start late after discussion and food.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Communication may be oral or written and, by participants, intrapersonal, interpersonal, extra-personal, group or mass/media. It is also verbal, non-verbal or meta-communication, carried in print or electronic media, and shaped by culture, ethics and law. Effective communicators avoid plagiarism, libel and slander and communicate ‘to bind, not to divide’.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which form of communication is also called dyadic?

A. Intrapersonal

B. Interpersonal

C. Mass

D. Group

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It involves two parties.

Q2 (MCQ) A defamatory spoken remark is called:

A. Libel

B. Slander

C. Plagiarism

D. Soliloquy

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Written = libel; spoken = slander.

Q3 (MSQ) Select the examples of mass communication.

A. Newspaper

B. Television programme

C. A conversation between two friends

D. Talking to oneself

> **Answer:** A, B
> **Why:** They reach large audiences through devices.

Q4 (T/F) In written communication, feedback is usually immediate.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Feedback in writing is delayed.

Q5 (Fill) Soliloquies and asides are examples of _____ communication.

> **Answer:** intrapersonal
> **Why:** The speaker talks to himself.

Q6 (Short) Give two advantages of oral over written communication.

> **Answer:** Spontaneity and immediate feedback and clarification.
> **Why:** Voice also conveys emotion.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list the five forms by number of participants.
☐ I can compare oral and written communication.
☐ I know what meta-communication means.
☐ I can distinguish libel, slander and plagiarism.
☐ I can give cross-cultural examples from the lecture.

Lecture 5: Personality Development

Week 1 · Course book PDF pages 70–83 (printed pages 69–82)

Learning objectives

- Explain the origin and meaning of ‘personality’ and why outward appearance does not define it.
- Describe Freud’s three systems of personality: id, ego and superego, and their principles.
- Explain Alfred Adler’s ideas: social interest, fictional finalism, striving for superiority, inferiority complex and creative self.
- Compare Freud and Adler and relate personality to workplace behaviour.

Important definitions

PERSONALITY

From Latin *persona*, meaning **mask**. A set of qualities that make an individual distinct: emotional qualities, attitudes, values, beliefs, motivations, communication skills, ways of thinking and behaviour. Personality is an ‘inside thing’.

ID

The reservoir of instinctive energy; the true psychic reality and matrix of the ego and superego; a world of subjective experience that operates on the **pleasure principle** and cannot tolerate tension.

EGO

The executive of the personality and the organised portion of the id; follows the **reality principle**, differentiates memory and image and mediates between instincts and the environment.

SUPEREGO

The moral guardian or moral agency; the internal representative of good and evil; strives for **perfection rather than pleasure** and opposes both id and ego.

FICTIONAL FINALISM

Adler’s idea that humans are guided by hypotheses or ‘fictions’ that cannot be tested (e.g. ‘honesty is the best policy’, ‘the end justifies the means’) but help them deal with reality.

INFERIORITY COMPLEX / STRIVING FOR SUPERIORITY

Every human feels some inferiority and compensates by striving for superiority, i.e. perfection.

Core concepts

What personality is not

Good looks, dress or fluency are only **outward features**. Shakespeare: “One may smile and smile and be a villain.” Two people who look identical may think very differently.

Why personality matters at work

- Helps understand the mindset of people from different backgrounds and faiths.
- Develops flexibility, persuasion, compassion and diplomacy.
- Builds competence and career success; explains why people react the way they do.

Freud’s three systems

- **Id** – pleasure principle; does not distinguish right from wrong; relieves tension through **reflex action** (sneezing, blinking) and **primary process / wish fulfilment** (e.g. a hungry person imagines food; repressed wishes appear in dreams – *Interpretation of Dreams*).
- **Ego** – reality principle; asks whether an experience is true or false; finds realistic ways (how to get food); mediates between id and environment.
- **Superego** – moral guardian; ideal rather than real; persuades the ego to substitute **moralistic goals for realistic goals**; inhibits impulses.

Every action passes through these three layers. “The child is the father of the man”: childhood habits and social influences continue; thwarted psychological growth can lead to introversion, pessimism or depression.

Alfred Adler’s theory (opposed Freud)

- Humans are primarily **social** creatures, not sexual ones; **social interest** motivates behaviour.
- Personality is shaped by **expectations of the future**, not only past experience.
- **Fictional finalism** guides conduct.
- **Striving for superiority** = striving for perfection; the inferiority complex drives compensation.
- Humans **identify** with others (Freud’s term for imitation).
- Each person has a unique **style of life**; “Le style, c’est l’homme” – the style is the man.
- **Masculine protest**: both men and women seek power.
- People can become a **creative self** and socially useful.
- Example: Mariyappan Thangavelu, Paralympic gold medallist, compensated for a damaged leg. Adler himself was a sickly child who became a doctor.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Freud's three systems of personality

System	Principle	Nature	Function
Id	Pleasure principle	Psychological (psychic) force; subjective	Wants immediate satisfaction; reflex and wish fulfilment
Ego	Reality principle	Biological; executive of personality	Realistic thinking; mediates between id and surroundings
Superego	Perfection / morality	Moralistic force; moral guardian	Opposes id and ego; seeks ideal and right

Theories, principles, models and contributors

FREUD'S PSYCHOANALYTIC STRUCTURE OF PERSONALITY — SIGMUND FREUD

Personality = id + ego + superego. Behaviour results from their interaction, often at an unconscious level.

INDIVIDUAL PSYCHOLOGY — ALFRED ADLER

Social interest, fictional finalism, striving for superiority, creative self.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A hungry person imagines food (id, wish fulfilment); the ego plans how to get food; the superego checks whether it is morally right.

EXAMPLE

A gruff person may hide great kindness; a smiling person may be cruel.

EXAMPLE

Mariyappan Thangavelu turned a physical weakness into Paralympic success.

Comparison tables

Freud versus Adler

Point	Freud	Adler
Human nature	Driven by instincts (sexual); id, ego, superego	Social creature; social interest
Time orientation	Past experience and childhood	Expectations of the future
Goal	Pleasure and relief of tension	Perfection / superiority
Key terms	Id, ego, superego, wish fulfilment, identification	Fictional finalism, inferiority complex, creative self

Id, ego and superego

Id	Ego	Superego
Pleasure principle	Reality principle	Perfection (moral) principle
Pleasurable or painful?	True or false?	Right or wrong?

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- *Persona* = mask.
- Id: pleasure principle, true psychic reality, matrix of ego and superego.
- Ego: executive of the personality and organised portion of the id; reality principle.
- Superego: strives for perfection rather than pleasure; opposes both id and ego; moral guardian.
- Id relieves tension by reflex action and wish fulfilment.
- Freud's book: *Interpretation of Dreams*.
- Adler: fictional finalism, striving for superiority, creative self, social interest.
- "The child is the father of the man"; "Le style, c'est l'homme."
- Shakespeare: one may smile and smile and be a villain.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q2	p.3	Freud's theory of personality	MCQ
W1 Q4	p.3	Meaning of personality	MCQ
W1 Q14	p.5	Freud's id, ego and superego	MSQ
W1 Q15	p.5	Thinkers and theories of personality	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Personality (from *persona*, mask) is the inner set of qualities, attitudes, values and behaviours that make people distinct. Freud explained it through the id (pleasure), ego (reality) and superego (perfection). Adler, opposing Freud, stressed social interest, fictional finalism and striving for superiority, with the possibility of becoming a creative self.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The id operates on the:

A. Reality principle

B. Pleasure principle

C. Moral principle

D. Social principle

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** The ego follows reality; the superego follows perfection.

Q2 (MCQ) Who proposed ‘fictional finalism’?

A. Freud

B. Hume

C. Adler

D. Shakespeare

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Alfred Adler.

Q3 (MSQ) Select the correct statements about the superego.

A. It is the moral guardian

B. It strives for perfection rather than pleasure

C. It supports only the id

D. It opposes both id and ego

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** It does not support the id.

Q4 (T/F) Personality is derived from the Latin word meaning ‘mind’.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It comes from *persona*, meaning mask.

Q5 (Fill) The executive of the personality is the _____.

> **Answer:** ego
> **Why:** It is also the organised portion of the id.

Q6 Short State two differences between Freud and Adler.

> **Answer:** Freud stresses instincts and the past; Adler stresses social interest and future expectations.
> **Why:** Adler also introduced the creative self.

Revision checklist

☐ I can explain the origin of the word personality.
☐ I can describe id, ego and superego with their principles.
☐ I can state Adler’s key ideas.
☐ I can contrast Freud and Adler.
☐ I remember the quotations and the Thangavelu example.

Week 2: Positivity, Telephone and Non-verbal Communication

1. Lecture 6: Positive Thinking
2. Lecture 7: Telephonic Communication Skills Part I
3. Lecture 8: Telephonic Communication Skills Part II
4. Lecture 9: Communicating Without Words
5. Lecture 10: Paralanguage

Lecture 6: Positive Thinking

Week 2 · Course book PDF pages 84–99 (printed pages 83–98)

Learning objectives

- Define positive thinking and distinguish optimists from pessimists.
- Explain Eric Berne's four life positions (I'm OK, you're OK, etc.).
- Describe the Johari Window and its four areas, and how each area can be expanded.
- State ways of developing positivism using examples from the lecture.

Important definitions

POSITIVE THINKING

Norman Vincent Peale (*The Power of Positive Thinking*): a positive mental attitude that firmly believes things will soon be better and so overcomes difficulty.

OPTIMIST / PESSIMIST

An optimist looks at the bright side (glass half full) and creates opportunities; a pessimist looks at the dark side (glass half empty) and finds negativity in every opportunity.

JOHARI WINDOW

A model devised by American psychologists **Joseph Luft and Harry Ingham in 1955** to illustrate and improve self-awareness and mutual understanding in a group through disclosure and feedback.

OPEN AREA

Known to the person and known to others; it can be expanded through open, positive communication, feedback and interaction.

BLIND AREA

Not known to the person but known to others; reduced through non-judgmental feedback.

HIDDEN AREA

Known to the person but kept hidden from others; reduced through self-disclosure, which builds trust.

UNKNOWN AREA

Unknown to the person and unknown to others (latent talents); uncovered through mutual or collective discovery.

Core concepts

Why positive thinking helps

- A positive person believes 'I can do it' and so makes a good leader, entrepreneur and risk-taker.
- One who never takes risks never gains.
- William James: "We are only half awake" – we use only a small part of our physical and mental resources; discover your limits and hidden powers.
- A new player who faces the game positively can win.

Eric Berne's attitudes (life positions)

- **I'm not OK, you're not OK** – introvert; cannot proceed.
- **I'm not OK, you're OK** – negative.
- **I'm OK, you're not OK** – imposing (only he matters).
- **I'm OK, you're OK** – positive and co-operative; ideal for teamwork.

How to develop positivism

- **Believe in your abilities** and be yourself; you have immense untapped potential.
- **Do not blindly imitate** others; imitate only qualities that help you, without losing your own identity (story of the singer who hid her teeth).
- **Concentrate on your goals** and follow the right action; Gita: "Karmanye vadhikaraste ma phaleshu kadachana".
- People change: Roosevelt was physically weak; Demosthenes stuttered yet became a great orator.
- Dhammapada: "All that we are is the result of what we have thought."

Johari Window in groups

When a new person enters a group, not all of his skills are known to others or to himself. Group members should help him expose them. The window has four quadrants (areas). Feedback and self-disclosure move information into the open area; the open area grows both horizontally and vertically. Managers can promote honest, non-judgmental feedback. Better self-awareness improves communication, relationships and productivity.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Johari Window quadrants

Quadrant	Known to self?	Known to others?	How to expand / reduce
1. Open (arena)	Yes	Yes	Open positive communication, feedback, solicitation
2. Blind	No	Yes	Non-judgmental feedback from managers/members
3. Hidden	Yes	No	Self-disclosure; reduce hidden area to build trust
4. Unknown	No	No	Mutual discovery, new experiences

Berne's life positions

Attitude	Type of person
I'm not OK, you're not OK	Introvert
I'm not OK, you're OK	Negative
I'm OK, you're not OK	Imposing
I'm OK, you're OK	Positive and co-operative

Theories, principles, models and contributors

TRANSACTIONAL ANALYSIS ATTITUDES — DR. ERIC BERNE

Four conclusions about human attitudes, ranging from 'I'm not OK, you're not OK' to the healthy 'I'm OK, you're OK'.

JOHARI WINDOW — JOSEPH LUFT AND HARRY INGHAM (1955)

The name combines the first names Joe and Harry. Four areas: open, blind, hidden, unknown.

POSITIVE MENTAL ATTITUDE — NORMAN VINCENT PEALE

Author of *The Power of Positive Thinking*.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Half-full versus half-empty glass of water.

EXAMPLE

A singer who hid her teeth was told to rely on her voice and talent.

EXAMPLE

Demosthenes' stutter and Roosevelt's weakness were overcome through practice.

EXAMPLE

Latent talent: someone discovers a good singing voice only when a situation draws it out (unknown area).

Comparison tables

Optimist versus pessimist

Point	Optimist	Pessimist
Glass of water	Half full	Half empty
View	Bright side; creates opportunity	Dark side; negativity in every opportunity

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Glass half empty = pessimist; half full = optimist.
- Peale wrote *The Power of Positive Thinking*.
- William James: we are only half awake.
- 'I'm OK, you're OK' = positive and co-operative; 'I'm OK, you're not OK' = imposing; 'I'm not OK, you're not OK' = introvert; 'I'm not OK, you're OK' = negative.
- Johari Window: Luft and Ingham, 1955; four areas: open, blind, hidden, unknown.
- Blind area = unknown to self but known by others.
- Ways to develop positivism: believe in your abilities; concentrate on your goals.
- Gita quotation: Karmanye vadhikaraste ma phaleshu kadachana.
- Dhammapada: All that we are is the result of what we have thought.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W2 Q1	p.7	Positive thinking	MCQ
W2 Q2	p.7	Berne's life positions (transactional analysis)	MCQ
W2 Q5	p.7	Johari Window	MCQ
W2 Q10	p.8	Developing positive thinking	MSQ
W6 Q9	p.23	Berne's life positions	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Positive thinking is the belief that one can succeed; optimists create opportunities while pessimists see obstacles. Eric Berne's four attitudes show why 'I'm OK, you're OK' suits teamwork. The Johari Window (Luft and Ingham, 1955) uses four areas – open, blind, hidden, unknown – to show how feedback and disclosure increase self-awareness. Positivism is built by believing in one's abilities, not imitating blindly and pursuing one's goals.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) In the Johari Window, the area unknown to the person but known to others is the:

A. Open area

B. Blind area

C. Hidden area

D. Unknown area

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Others see it; the person does not.

Q2 (MCQ) 'I'm OK, you're not OK' describes a person who is:

A. Positive

B. Negative

C. Imposing

D. Introvert

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Only he matters; others are disregarded.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are ways to develop positivism?

A. Believe in your abilities

B. Concentrate on your goals

C. Imitate others completely

D. Hide your weaknesses permanently

> **Answer:** A, B
> **Why:** The lecture warns against losing your own identity.

Q4 (T/F) The Johari Window was proposed by Eric Berne.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It was proposed by Joseph Luft and Harry Ingham in 1955; Berne gave the OK attitudes.

Q5 (Fill) Reducing the _____ area through self-disclosure builds trust.

> **Answer:** hidden
> **Why:** It is known to oneself but concealed from others.

Q6 (Short) Why is 'I'm OK, you're OK' the ideal attitude at work?

> **Answer:** It is positive and co-operative, so it supports teamwork across different backgrounds.
> **Why:** Teams need co-operation.

Revision checklist

☐ I can distinguish optimist and pessimist.
☐ I can state all four life positions and their labels.
☐ I can define the four Johari areas with known/unknown to self and others.
☐ I know who proposed each theory and when.
☐ I can list ways to develop positivism.

Lecture 7: Telephonic Communication Skills Part I

Week 2 · Course book PDF pages 100–114 (printed pages 99–113)

Learning objectives

- Explain the importance of telephonic communication in life and business.
- List the special features of telephonic communication: clarity, courtesy, consideration, brevity.
- Apply the etiquette of making, receiving, transferring and closing calls.
- Handle complaints and voicemail professionally and avoid negative language.

Important definitions

TELEPHONIC COMMUNICATION

Sending and receiving messages through telephone instruments; the fastest and a low-cost means of contact across distance.

NETIQUETTE VERSUS ETIQUETTE

Netiquette is etiquette for internet communication; the lecturer notes that we forget basic etiquettes in the age of netiquettes.

VOICEMAIL

A recorded message left when the call cannot be completed; it should be complete.

Core concepts

Why telephones matter

- Bridge distance and time; fast, saves travel, cost-effective.
- Used to place orders, book tickets, give feedback, check quality, contact students, sellers and distributors.
- The reputation of an organisation depends on how its people communicate by phone.

Limitations

No face-to-face contact and no immediate visual feedback; the only cue is the voice. Video-calls are costly and not for everyone. Voice must carry assurance, sincerity, intimacy and enthusiasm.

Features of telephonic communication

1. **Clarity** – the first requirement.
2. **Courtesy** – right time, right address and tone; you cannot see the other person.
3. **Consideration** – empathy; the other party may be in a noisy or congested place; do not make them repeatedly ask “can you be loud?”.
4. **Brevity** – be brief and specific because someone is paying and time is limited.

While making a call

- Decide whether the call is necessary; if it can be avoided, avoid it.
- **Place your own call** instead of asking a secretary.
- **Plan an agenda** (purpose; keep pen and paper) to avoid repeated calls.
- **Identify yourself** and your affiliation (name, department, institute) and state the purpose.
- Address the person by name; avoid small talk such as “How is the weather?” in official calls.
- Speak clearly at a moderate volume; imagine you are speaking face to face.
- Close politely (“It was nice talking to you…”); never end abruptly.
- If the call is cut or you must stop, say you will call back, and call back when promised; leave a **complete voicemail** if needed.

While receiving a call

- Answer immediately, **not later than three rings**.
- Stop other conversation; identify yourself at once (“I am … from …, how may I help you?”).
- Respond positively, even if you dislike the caller; “good gestures always mean good business”.
- Take the message carefully: note caller’s name (verify spelling), number and message and pass it on.
- To transfer a call, explain why and ask consent (“May I put you on hold?”).
- For an angry complainant: stay calm, listen, note the concern, assure a response, and let the caller hang up first.

Language to use and avoid

- Avoid negatives such as “No, he is not here”, “I cannot do that”, “You have to…”, “Why did you not…?”.
- Use “Tell me what I can do for you”, “I would like you to…”, “Will/would you please…”.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Four features of telephonic communication

Feature	Meaning
Clarity	Clear message and speech, whether giving or seeking information
Courtesy	Right time, right address, proper orientation without seeing the person
Consideration	Empathy for the other party’s surroundings and state of mind
Brevity	Short and specific because of cost and the other person’s time

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Opening a call: “Binod Mishra, Department of HSS, IIT Roorkee. May I speak to Mr X? The purpose of this call is…”

EXAMPLE

Closing a call: “It was nice talking to you, Mrs D’Souza. I have got the required information.”

EXAMPLE

Receiving: “I am Jeethendra from NPTEL, how may I help you?”

Comparison tables

Making a call versus receiving a call

Making a call	Receiving a call
Plan an agenda, place own call	Answer within three rings
Identify yourself and purpose	Identify yourself immediately
Avoid small talk; be brief	Respond positively; take message accurately
Close courteously; call back if promised	Transfer only with consent; let the caller hang up

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Four features: clarity, courtesy, consideration, brevity.
- Clarity is the first requirement of telephonic communication.
- Answer a call within three rings.
- Place your own call and plan an agenda.
- Identify yourself with name and affiliation when calling and when receiving.
- Avoid small talk and negative words such as ‘No’ or ‘You have to’.
- Voice conveys reassurance, intimacy, sincerity; there is no immediate visual feedback.
- Telephone calls are fast and low cost, bridging distance.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W2 Q6	p.8	Features of telephonic communication	MCQ
W2 Q11	p.9	Telephone etiquette: making a call	MSQ
W2 Q13	p.9	Importance of telephonic communication	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Telephonic communication bridges time and distance quickly and at low cost but lacks visual feedback, so clarity, courtesy, consideration and brevity are essential. A caller should plan an agenda, place his own call, identify himself, state the purpose and close politely; a receiver should answer within three rings, identify himself, respond positively and take accurate messages. Negative language is avoided.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which is the first and foremost feature of telephonic communication?

A. Brevity

B. Clarity

C. Humour

D. Confrontation

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** The lecture lists clarity first.

Q2 (MCQ) A call should ideally be answered within:

A. One minute

B. Ten rings

C. Three rings

D. Whenever convenient

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Respond immediately, not more than after three rings.

Q3 (MSQ) Select the guidelines for sending a call.

A. Place your own call

B. Plan an agenda

C. Avoid identifying yourself

D. Recline in your chair

> **Answer:** A, B
> **Why:** Always identify yourself and prepare an agenda.

Q4 (T/F) In an official call it is good to begin with small talk about the weather.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Small talk wastes money and time; be professional.

Q5 (Fill) While transferring a call, ask the caller's _____ and explain why you are transferring.

> **Answer:** consent
> **Why:** For example, "May I put you on hold?"

Q6 (Short) How should one respond to an angry customer on the phone?

> **Answer:** Stay calm, listen, note the concern, assure a response and allow the caller to hang up first.
> **Why:** This gives the caller more room.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list the four features of telephonic communication.
☐ I know the steps for making and receiving a call.
☐ I can rephrase negative sentences positively.
☐ I know the three-ring rule.
☐ I can describe how to take messages and transfer calls.

Lecture 8: Telephonic Communication Skills Part II

Week 2 · Course book PDF pages 115–126 (printed pages 114–125)

Learning objectives

- Explain voice mail, its advantages and limits, and how to leave and answer a voice message.
- State mobile (cell phone) etiquette.
- Differentiate teleconferencing (audio) and video conferencing, including the three types of video conferencing.
- Know when teleconferencing is ineffective and the cautions for video conferencing.

Important definitions

VOICE MAIL

A recorded-message facility that acts as a substitute for short memos and short phone calls, solves time-zone difficulties and reduces paperwork; messages are digitised and stored.

AUTOMATED ATTENDANT

A menu system (e.g. “for account balance press 1”) through which callers get information or record messages.

TELECONFERENCING

A telephonic meeting with more than two people, requiring a leader or facilitator; an alternative to a face-to-face meeting. Can be audio or video.

VIDEO CONFERENCING

Audio plus video link so that communication appears face to face; a tool of business and management for people separated by time and distance.

Core concepts

Voice mail: use and etiquette

- **Advantages:** substitute for short memos and phone calls; solves **time-zone difficulties**; reduces interoffice paperwork (paperless office); easy and low cost; can be replayed; can carry goodwill messages.
- **Limitation:** no immediate feedback; automated responses are general, not specific.
- **When leaving a message:** state your name clearly, give the point of the message, your phone number and the time/date you are available; avoid interrupting.
- **When replying:** reply quickly; listen again and write your response before returning the call.

Cell phone etiquette

- Speak in a **low, modulated tone**; do not shout (the Delhi bus example).
- Switch off or use silent mode in meetings, conferences, theatres, cinemas, temples, churches and classrooms; send a short message if a call is urgent.
- Do not call at odd hours unless urgent.
- Avoid talking in poor signal; suspend and resume later.
- Do not multitask (laptop plus call plus instructions) at the cost of courtesy; dial correctly to avoid wrong numbers.
- Phones are sensitive, so privacy is limited; keep private calls separate from official ones.

Teleconferencing

- Needs a leader/facilitator; can be arranged at **short notice**; connects geographically dispersed people; saves travel cost.
- Audio conferences give good sound quality when conference rooms and microphones are used.
- **Ineffective for negotiations** and decision-making because facial expressions and gestures cannot be read; little scope for secondary conversation; poor signals can defeat the purpose.

Video conferencing

- Emerging major tool for business and management; cheaper than journeys; top executives use it for decisions.
- Three types: **one-way video and one-way audio; two-way audio with one-way video; two-way video and two-way audio** (e.g. Skype, news-channel discussions).
- **Cautions:** check microphones and camera; introduce yourself (name, post, affiliation); control body movements; avoid parallel whispers; look at the camera; avoid distracting clothes and excessive movement.

Man is the master

“Technology should not become the master; man should become the master.” Be sensitive to others’ reactions, culture, time and energy.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of video conferencing (as described)

Type	Description
One-way video and one-way audio	Audio and video flow from one side to the other
Two-way audio with video one side	Both sides talk; one side sees
Two-way video and two-way audio	Both sides see and hear each other (Skype-like)

Examples and applications

> **EXAMPLE**
>
> Automated bank menu: “Welcome to SBI Credit Card... for account balance press 1.”

EXAMPLE

A passenger shouting instructions on a bus journey to Delhi.

EXAMPLE

News channel anchors connecting people at several locations through video conferencing.

Comparison tables

Audio teleconferencing versus video conferencing

Point	Teleconferencing (audio)	Video conferencing
Medium	Voice only	Voice plus video
Cues	Cannot read facial reactions or gestures	Body language visible; must control movements
Arrangement	Can be arranged at very short notice	Needs equipment; costlier but cheaper than travel
Use	Weak for negotiations	Used for decisions by busy executives

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Voice mail substitutes for short memos and phone calls and solves time-zone difficulties.
- Voice mail lacks immediate, specific feedback.
- Teleconferencing is ineffective for negotiations.
- Teleconferencing can be arranged at short notice and connects dispersed people.
- Three types of video conferencing (one-way, mixed, two-way).
- Speak in a low, modulated tone on cell phones; silent mode in meetings and worship places.
- Do not call at odd hours unless urgent.
- Teleconferencing needs a leader or facilitator.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W2 Q7	p.8	Teleconferencing	MCQ
W2 Q9	p.8	Voice mail	Fill-in-the-blank
W2 Q12	p.9	Voice mail	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Voice mail replaces short memos, overcomes time zones and cuts paperwork but gives no immediate feedback. Mobile phone etiquette stresses low voice, silence in public places and no odd-hour calls. Teleconferencing connects dispersed people at short notice but is poor for negotiation, while video conferencing adds visuals and has three types; users must manage equipment, speech and body language.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Teleconferencing is generally ineffective for:

A. Saving travel costs

B. Negotiations

C. Arranging meetings at short notice

D. Connecting dispersed people

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Facial reactions and non-verbal cues cannot be read.

Q2 (MCQ) Voice mail helps solve _____ difficulties.

A. Spelling

B. Time zone

C. Language

D. Dress code

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Messages can be left when the person cannot be reached.

Q3 (MSQ) Select correct statements about voice mail.

A. It substitutes short memos and calls

B. It solves time-zone problems

C. It increases paperwork

D. It gives immediate specific feedback

> **Answer:** A, B
> **Why:** It reduces paperwork and lacks immediate feedback.

Q4 (T/F) In a video conference you should look at the camera and avoid parallel whispers.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** These are listed cautions.

Q5 (Fill) On a cell phone one should speak in a _____ modulated voice.

> **Answer:** low
> **Why:** Loud calls disturb others.

Q6 Short What should a voice mail message include?

> **Answer:** Name, point of the message, phone number and time/date of availability.
> **Why:** Keep it focused on the essentials.

Revision checklist

☐ I can state advantages and limits of voice mail.
☐ I know cell phone etiquette.
☐ I can contrast teleconferencing and video conferencing.
☐ I know the three types of video conferencing.
☐ I remember why teleconferencing fails for negotiation.

Lecture 9: Communicating Without Words

Week 2 · Course book PDF pages 127–147 (printed pages 126–146)

Learning objectives

- Define non-verbal communication and explain why it matters.
- Quote the Birdwhistell and Mehrabian percentages.
- List the types of non-verbal communication: kinesics, proxemics, chronemics, paralanguage, haptics, meta-communication.
- Describe the forms of kinesics: personal appearance, facial expression, eye contact, movement, posture and gesture, with cultural differences.

Important definitions

NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION

Communication without words, through symbols and cues such as expression, gesture, posture and eye behaviour. It is spontaneous and unintentional, and it supplements and complements verbal communication.

KINESICS

The study of body movement or body language; includes personal appearance, facial expression, eye contact, movement, posture and gesture.

PROXEMICS

Use of space and distance in communication (from *proximity*).

CHRONEMICS

The role of time in communication.

PARALANGUAGE

How words are spoken, beyond the words themselves (voice qualities).

HAPTICS

Communication through touch.

POSTURE

Positioning: how you sit, stand and hold your arms and shoulders.

Core concepts

Verbal and non-verbal proportions

- **Ray Birdwhistell:** 35% of communication is verbal and 65% non-verbal.
- **Mehrabian:** 7% verbal (words), 38% vocal, and the remaining (55%) non-verbal.
- One study counts more than **6 lakh** non-verbal cues, so they are categorised.

Nature of non-verbal cues

- Cannot substitute words (e.g. 'happiness', 'silence') but have **more impact because they are spontaneous**.
- They are **unintentional and unstructured**; posed expressions become stereotyped (as with actors).
- Work at two levels: the verbal level (words) and the non-verbal level.
- People are communicating all the time; even silence has meaning (differs across cultures).
- Symbols and emoticons in chat and email are non-verbal cues.

Types of non-verbal communication

1. **Kinesics** – body language
2. **Proxemics** – space
3. **Chronemics** – time
4. **Paralanguage** – voice
5. **Haptics** – touch
6. **Meta-communication**

Kinesics: sign language (posed, stereotyped), action language (body behaviour) and object language.

Personal appearance and face

- The face is a junction of emotions; 'face is the index of the mind', but 'a false face must have a false heart' when one manipulates.
- Liars find it hard to hide body language (child with clamped hands in pockets).
- Dress should be clean, ironed and suitable; it creates the **first impression**. It need not be expensive.
- Freud: "He who has eyes to see and ears to hear can convince himself that no mortal can keep a secret."
- Chesterton: "There are no uninteresting topics, there are uninteresting people."

Eye contact

- Eyes are 'the mirror of the heart and windows of the soul'; they show sincerity, honesty and conviction and establish rapport and credibility.
- Culture-specific: Arabs, Latin Americans and southern Europeans gaze at the face; Asians, Indians, Pakistanis and northern Europeans prefer peripheral gaze or none (Harper, Wiens and Matarazzo).
- Eye contact should be neither a gaze nor a stare.
- Herodotus: "Men trust their ears less than their eyes."
- Glowering looks and checking watches show the audience is bored.

Movement and posture

- Do not rush; avoid excessive or distracting movement; move gracefully.

- Dale Carnegie: people form an impression from how you dress, walk, sit and stand.
- Posture: do not recline; avoid hands in pockets, clamped hands, playing with key rings, shuffling.

Gestures

- Gestures back up language; do not repeat the same gesture (e.g. thumping the desk).
- Types: enumerative and symbolic gestures.
- **Limp hands** – boredom; **flat hands** – silent questions; **open hands** – welcome; **clenched hands** – tension/frustration; **fist** – determination; **crossed arms** – negative; **crossed legs** – insulting to the audience.
- Handshakes: glove handshake (politician); dead-fish handshake (formal/unwilling).
- Gestures differ by culture: 'come here' in the US may mean 'go away' in Italy.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of non-verbal communication

Type	Concerned with
Kinesics	Body movement
Proxemics	Space and distance
Chronemics	Time
Paralanguage	How words are spoken
Haptics	Touch
Meta-communication	Meaning beyond words

Forms of kinesics

Form	Notes
Personal appearance	Dress, grooming; first impression
Facial expression	Junction of emotions
Eye contact	Rapport, credibility; culture-specific
Movement / posture	Graceful, not excessive; alert positioning
Gesture	Supports speech; meanings vary across cultures

Theories, principles, models and contributors

VERBAL VERSUS NON-VERBAL SHARE — RAY BIRDWHISTELL

35% verbal, 65% non-verbal.

7-38-55 SPLIT — MEHRABIAN

7% verbal, 38% vocal, remainder non-verbal.

THREE LANGUAGES OF KINESICS — AUTHOR CITED IN LECTURE

Sign language, action language and object language.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A mute beggar’s face conveyed happiness on receiving a coin.

EXAMPLE

A child who lies hides clamped hands in his pockets.

EXAMPLE

‘Come here’ gesture in the US means ‘go away’ in Italy.

EXAMPLE

A speaker whose audience keeps checking watches should change delivery.

Comparison tables

Birdwhistell versus Mehrabian

Point	Birdwhistell	Mehrabian
Verbal	35%	7%
Vocal	Not separated	38%
Non-verbal	65%	Remaining (55%)

Hand gestures and meanings

Gesture	Usual meaning
Limp hands	Boredom
Flat hands	Silent questions
Open hands	Welcome
Clenched hands	Tension, frustration
Fist	Determination
Crossed arms	Negative attitude

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Birdwhistell: 35% verbal, 65% non-verbal.
- Mehrabian: 7% verbal, 38% vocal, rest non-verbal.
- More than 6 lakh non-verbal cues.
- Non-verbal communication is spontaneous and unintentional.
- Kinesics = body language; proxemics = space; chronemics = time; haptics = touch.
- Kinesics forms: appearance, facial expression, eye contact, posture, gesture, movement.
- Eye contact: Arabs, Latin Americans and southern Europeans gaze; Asians prefer peripheral gaze.
- Herodotus: men trust their ears less than their eyes.
- Dale Carnegie: people judge how you dress, walk, sit and stand.
- Glove handshake: politician; dead-fish handshake: formal or unwilling.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W0 Q2	p.1	Non-verbal communication	MCQ
W0 Q4	p.1	Positive body language	MCQ
W2 Q3	p.7	Mehrabian's 7-38-55 rule	MCQ
W2 Q15	p.9	Hand gestures (kinesics)	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Non-verbal communication complements words and is spontaneous and unintentional. Birdwhistell put it at 65% and Mehrabian at 55% with 38% vocal. Its categories are kinesics, proxemics, chronemics, paralanguage, haptics and meta-communication. Kinesics covers appearance, face, eyes, movement, posture and gestures, all of which vary by culture and must be controlled to create a favourable impression.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) According to Mehrabian, the vocal element accounts for:

A. 7%

B. 38%

C. 55%

D. 65%

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** 7% verbal, 38% vocal, 55% non-verbal.

Q2 (MCQ) The study of space in communication is:

A. Kinesics

B. Haptics

C. Proxemics

D. Chronemics

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Derived from proximity.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are forms of kinesics?

A. Eye contact

B. Posture

C. Touch

D. Gesture

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Touch belongs to haptics.

Q4 (T/F) Non-verbal cues can completely substitute for words.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** They supplement, not substitute.

Q5 (Fill) Clenched hands indicate _____ and frustration.

> **Answer:** tension
> **Why:** A fist signals determination.

Q6 (Short) Why is eye contact culture-specific?

> **Answer:** Some cultures gaze at the face; others, e.g. Asian, prefer peripheral gaze and treat direct gaze as impolite.
> **Why:** Avoid both gaze and stare.

Revision checklist

☐ I know both percentage splits.

☐ I can list the six types of non-verbal communication.

☐ I can list the forms of kinesics.

☐ I know hand-gesture meanings.

☐ I remember the cultural differences in eye contact.

Lecture 10: Paralanguage

Week 2 · Course book PDF pages 148–167 (printed pages 147–166)

Learning objectives

- Define paralanguage and list the features of voice: quality, volume, rate, pitch, pronunciation, pauses and silence.
- Identify voice faults: throatiness, breathiness, nasalisation, harshness, muffling and hoarseness.
- State the ideal speaking rate and how to improve articulation.
- Explain intonation, stress, pauses, silence and the quotations of Mark Twain and Pythagoras.

Important definitions

PARALANGUAGE

The study of how words are spoken: the vocal characteristics (quality, volume, rate, pitch, pronunciation, pauses) that add meaning beyond the words.

ARTICULATION

Producing speech sounds clearly through the speech organs; clarity is the hallmark of communication.

AUDIBILITY

The ability of the listener to hear the speaker; related to volume.

INTONATION

The rises and falls in the voice.

INFLECTION

Changes in pitch produced by vibration of the vocal cords while speaking; they convey feelings.

PAUSE

A short silence in speech that separates units of thought; a longer pause becomes silence.

RECEIVED PRONUNCIATION (RP)

The standard pronunciation recommended for clear, intelligible speech instead of imitating Americans or Britons.

Core concepts

Why voice matters

- Everyone's voice is unique and carries intentional and unintentional emotions.
- The **quality** of voice can be improved by training (Lincoln and Churchill had voice problems).
- Speech production passes through stages starting with the **articulatory–respiratory** process using lips, teeth, nasal passage, windpipe.
- English as a second or third language causes translation lapses and pronunciation problems.

Features of voice

1. **Quality** – check audibility; neither too loud nor too slow.
2. **Volume** – degree of loudness; adjust to audience size and room acoustics (no shouting for 20–30 people).
3. **Rate** – adjust to the audience's background.
4. **Pitch** – variations and inflections.
5. **Pronunciation**.
6. **Pauses and silence**.

Rate of speech

- Ideal average: **140–150 words per minute** (the lecturer also advises at least 130–150).
- Too fast: you forget and run out of material; too slow: boredom. Follow the **'madhyam marga'** (middle path).
- Imagine an audience of ordinary, moderately educated people.

Faults of voice

- **Throatiness** – deep resonance in the throat.
- **Breathiness** – too much air through the vocal cords.
- **Nasalisation** – air released through the nose.
- **Harshness** – uninhibited flow of air.
- **Muffling** – lazy lip and jaw movement.
- **Hoarseness** – inflammation of the larynx; a medical problem, consult a speech therapist.

Improving the voice

- Speak distinctly; avoid chopping, slurring and mumbling ('gonna', 'wanna', 'dunno', 'otta', 'dint') and fillers (ah, um).
- Record yourself on a mobile phone and rehearse.
- Use a dictionary, thesaurus and phonetic notation for difficult words.
- Follow Received Pronunciation; learn from good news anchors; listen actively.
- Vary pitch to avoid monotony; use intonation.

Stress and intonation

- Content words (nouns, adjectives, verbs, adverbs) take stress; **articles, prepositions, conjunctions, auxiliary verbs and personal pronouns usually do not**.
- Stress the correct syllable (use a dictionary).

- **Falling tone** for commands and wh-questions ('Bring me a cup of tea', 'Where had you been?').
- **Rising tone** for requests and yes/no questions and question tags.
- Modulate voice to express intended meaning (the late student seeking permission).

Pauses and silence

- Pauses separate units of thought; begin and end a speech with a pause.
- **Mark Twain:** "The right word may be effective, but no word was ever as effective as a rightly timed pause."
- A longer pause becomes silence; silence is a non-verbal cue with different meanings across cultures (approval, disapproval, disagreement).
- Silence helps thinking, introspection and decision-making for both speaker and listener.
- **Pythagoras:** "Silence is better than unmeaning words."

Types, classifications and characteristics

Voice faults

Fault	Cause
Throatiness	Deep resonance in the throat
Breathiness	Too much air through vocal cords
Nasalisation	Air released through the nose
Harshness	Uninhibited air flow
Muffling	Lazy lips and jaw
Hoarseness	Inflammation of the larynx (medical)

Features of voice

Feature	Meaning
Quality	Overall character and audibility
Volume	Loudness or softness
Rate	Speed (140–150 wpm)
Pitch	Rise and fall; inflection
Pronunciation	Clear sounds; correct stress
Pauses	Short silences between thought units

Theories, principles, models and contributors

> **MARK TWAIN ON THE PAUSE — MARK TWAIN**
>
> "The right word may be effective, but no word was ever as effective as a rightly timed pause."

SILENCE IS BETTER THAN UNMEANING WORDS — PYTHAGORAS

Quoted at the close of the lecture.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Lincoln and Churchill overcame voice problems through training.

EXAMPLE

Late student: “May I come in, sir, though I am late, sir?” shows intended meaning through voice.

EXAMPLE

BBC English, Hindi and Bangla services as models of pleasant voices.

EXAMPLE

Falling tone: “Where had you been?”; rising tone: “Is it time to wind up, isn’t it?”

Comparison tables

Falling versus rising tone

Falling tone	Rising tone
Commands: Bring me a cup of tea	Requests: Would you like tea with me?
Wh-questions: Where had you been?	Yes/no questions and tags: Isn’t it?

Pause versus silence

Pause	Silence
Short gap between units of thought	Longer gap that adds meaning or lets listeners reflect
Used within speech	Interpreted differently across cultures

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Ideal rate is about 140–150 words per minute.
- Pitch changes are called inflections; rises and falls in the voice are intonation.
- Voice faults: throatiness, breathiness, nasalisation, harshness, muffling, hoarseness.
- Hoarseness results from inflammation of the larynx; consult a speech therapist.
- Articles, prepositions, conjunctions, auxiliaries and personal pronouns do not take stress.
- Mark Twain on the rightly timed pause.
- Pythagoras: Silence is better than unmeaning words.
- Clarity is the hallmark of communication.
- Follow Received Pronunciation rather than imitating Americans or British.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W2 Q4	p.7	Voice faults	MCQ
W2 Q8	p.8	Paralanguage: pitch and inflection	Fill-in-the-blank
W2 Q14	p.9	Characteristics of voice	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Paralanguage covers voice quality, volume, rate, pitch, pronunciation and pauses. Speakers should speak at about 140–150 words per minute, vary pitch to avoid monotony, articulate each sound distinctly, follow Received Pronunciation, stress content words and use pauses and silence intentionally. Voice faults such as throatiness, breathiness, nasalisation, harshness, muffling and hoarseness can be reduced by training, except hoarseness, which is medical.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Hoarseness results from:

A. Lazy lips

B. Inflammation of the larynx

C. Too much nasal air

D. Fast speech

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It is a medical problem needing a speech therapist.

Q2 (MCQ) The ideal speaking rate suggested is:

A. 80–100 wpm

B. 140–150 wpm

C. 200–220 wpm

D. Any speed

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** This is the balanced rate.

Q3 (MSQ) Which words usually do NOT take stress?

A. Articles

B. Prepositions

C. Nouns

D. Conjunctions

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Nouns, adjectives, verbs and adverbs take stress.

Q4 (T/F) Changes in pitch while speaking are called inflections.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** They convey feelings.

Q5 (Fill) The ‘middle path’ in speech rate is called _____.

> **Answer:** madhyam marga
> **Why:** Neither too fast nor too slow.

Q6 (Short) Why should a speaker use pauses?

> **Answer:** They separate units of thought, give emphasis, let listeners absorb the message and help the speaker think.
> **Why:** Mark Twain valued a rightly timed pause.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list the features of voice.

☐ I know the voice faults and causes.

☐ I remember 140–150 wpm.

☐ I know which words take stress and which tones fall or rise.

☐ I can quote Mark Twain and Pythagoras.

Week 3: Space, Touch, Meta-communication and Listening

1. Lecture 11: Proxemics
2. Lecture 12: Haptics: The Language of Touch
3. Lecture 13: Meta-communication
4. Lecture 14: Listening Skills
5. Lecture 15: Types of Listening

Lecture 11: Proxemics

Week 3 · Course book PDF pages 168–179 (printed pages 167–178)

Learning objectives

- Define proxemics and chronemics.
- State the four space zones with distances and who may enter each.
- Relate space and time to status, power and culture; distinguish high-context and low-context cultures.
- Recall examples and quotations from the lecture.

Important definitions

PROXEMICS

The study of physical space in communication; from *proximity* (nearness). It is called relationship communication because it reflects behavioural norms.

CHRONEMICS

The study of time in communication: how time is perceived, used and valued across cultures and professions.

AIR BUBBLE

The personal space every human (and animal) needs around the body.

LOW-CONTEXT CULTURE

A culture that relies on written, explicit messages and attaches less importance to non-verbal cues.

HIGH-CONTEXT CULTURE

A culture that derives meaning from non-verbal cues and context and prefers short written messages.

Core concepts

Why space matters

- Space shows warmth, need for freedom, friendliness and power.
- Freed animals feel relaxed; humans too need breathing space.
- Violation of space makes people feel threatened.
- Mehrabian: “Status manifests itself by relaxed posture and ways of interacting.”

Four space zones

1. **Intimate zone** – up to **18 inches**; family, close relatives, intimate people. Touch is allowed.
2. **Personal zone** – **18 inches to 4 feet**; friends, colleagues, peers.
3. **Social zone** – **4 to 12 feet**; strangers and occasional visitors such as plumbers, electricians, milkmen.
4. **Public zone** – **12 to 30 feet or more**; public speakers and leaders addressing audiences; feedback is hard to read.

Many Europeans keep 15–25 cm in the intimate zone. A person allowed one zone must not enter an inner zone.

Space, status and power

- Bosses have large rooms or corner offices; employees have smaller cabins; furniture signals status.
- In the US non-verbal communication at work reinforces power; space denotes control and dominance.
- Going very close to a boss makes him feel threatened.

Cultural examples

- **Japanese hosts** gave a US guest space by sitting with the driver in the front seat; the guest felt lonely and embarrassed. Later British students sat away from him: “you and I are close friends”.
- Arabs of the same sex stand closer than North Americans; Indians often stand close.
- A Danish couple violated American space at an American club.
- An American and a Japanese adjusted distances like dancing: the Japanese moved close and the American stepped back.
- A violation of space at a political rally led to a tragic incident.

Low- versus high-context cultures

- **Low context:** North America, Germany, England, France, Italy, Scandinavia – put things in writing; ignore non-verbal cues; Americans write long emails.
- **High context:** Japan, China, Arab countries, Greece, Mexico, Spain – read non-verbal cues; write short messages.
- Americans may find the French withholding; the French may find Americans dominant.

Chronemics

- Time is a **commodity**; punctuality earns respect and reveals personality and attitude.
- Missing deadlines suggests insincerity.
- Latin American and Mexican meetings may start late; the UK expects punctuality; India talks about time but is often late.
- **Robert E. Hall:** “Time talks and space speaks.”
- Plan a presentation by time: do not let the introduction be long; give beginning, development and end proper time.
- Leaders decide how much time to give to whom; this shows the importance they give.
- Gather facts about the other culture’s view of space and time to avoid miscommunication.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Space zones

Zone	Distance	Who is allowed
Intimate	Up to 18 inches	Family, close relatives, intimates
Personal	18 inches – 4 feet	Friends, colleagues, peers
Social	4 – 12 feet	Strangers, occasional visitors, service people
Public	12 – 30 feet or more	Public speakers, leaders, audiences

Theories, principles, models and contributors

TIME TALKS AND SPACE SPEAKS — ROBERT E. HALL

Time and space are non-verbal cues that communicate.

STATUS AND POSTURE — MEHRABIAN

"Status manifests itself by relaxed posture and ways of interacting."

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Japanese escorts seated in front with the driver, leaving the US guest alone in the back.

EXAMPLE

Danish couple at an American club violating American space.

EXAMPLE

Latin American meetings starting late after chat; British punctuality.

Comparison tables

Low-context versus high-context cultures

Point	Low context	High context
Examples	North America, Germany, England, France, Italy, Scandinavia	Japan, China, Arab countries, Greece, Mexico, Spain
Messages	Written, long, explicit	Short; rely on non-verbal cues
Non-verbal cues	Less importance	Great importance

Proxemics versus chronemics

Proxemics	Chronemics
Space and distance	Time and punctuality
Four zones	Time as a commodity; timing of talk
‘Space speaks’	‘Time talks’

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Four zones: intimate (up to 18 in), personal (18 in–4 ft), social (4–12 ft), public (12–30 ft+).
- Proxemics derives from proximity.
- Robert E. Hall: Time talks and space speaks.
- Low-context: North America, Germany, England, France, Italy, Scandinavia.
- High-context: Japan, China, Arab countries, Greece, Mexico, Spain.
- Bosses occupy larger or corner spaces.
- Plumbers, electricians and milkmen belong in the social zone.
- Arabs stand closer than North Americans.
- Meetings in Latin America often begin late.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W3 Q1	p.11	Proxemics	MCQ
W3 Q4	p.11	Chronemics	MCQ
W3 Q6	p.12	Hall's proxemic zones	MCQ
W3 Q10	p.12	High-context and low-context cultures	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Proxemics studies how space communicates. Four zones – intimate (to 18 in), personal (to 4 ft), social (4–12 ft), public (12–30 ft+) – are linked to relationship and status, and vary with culture. High-context cultures read non-verbal cues while low-context cultures rely on written words. Chronemics treats time as a commodity; punctuality and timing show professionalism, and ‘time talks and space speaks’.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The social zone extends from:

A. 0–18 inches

B. 18 inches–4 feet

C. 4–12 feet

D. 12–30 feet

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Strangers and visitors are kept here.

Q2 (MCQ) Who said ‘Time talks and space speaks’?

A. Mehrabian

B. Robert E. Hall

C. Birdwhistell

D. Freud

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Hall is cited in the lecture.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are high-context cultures?

A. Japan

B. China

C. Germany

D. Spain

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Germany is low context.

Q4 (T/F) Colleagues and peers belong to the personal zone.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** Friends, colleagues and peers enter the personal zone.

Q5 (Fill) The word proxemics comes from _____.

> **Answer:** proximity
> **Why:** Meaning nearness.

Q6 (Short) How does office space show status?

> **Answer:** Bosses have larger, corner rooms; lower employees have smaller cabins.
> **Why:** Space denotes power and control.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the four zones and distances.
☐ I can say who enters each zone.
☐ I can classify cultures by context.
☐ I can explain chronemics and cite Hall.
☐ I remember the Japanese car example.

Lecture 12: Haptics: The Language of Touch

Week 3 · Course book PDF pages 180–192 (printed pages 179–191)

Learning objectives

- Define haptics and its Greek origin.
- Explain meanings of touch: reassurance, warmth, regard, blessing, and how they vary by culture and setting.
- Describe types of handshakes (dominant, submissive, equal, dead fish, glove) and palm/finger gestures.
- Use cultural examples: Thailand, Spain, New Zealand hongi, India, Japan.

Important definitions

HAPTICS

The systematic study of touch behaviour in communication; from a Greek word meaning ‘I touch’.

DEAD FISH HANDSHAKE

A limp, lifeless handshake showing lack of enthusiasm or encouragement; it may signal that a deal or negotiation will not go well.

DOMINANT HANDSHAKE

A handshake where one party takes control by pressing the other’s hand (palm on top) or gripping only the fingers; shows power.

SUBMISSIVE HANDSHAKE

A handshake in which one offers an open hand with the palm up, giving control to the other.

HONGI

A New Zealand greeting in which two people touch noses, treated as sharing breath.

ENUMERATIVE AND LOCATIVE GESTURES

Gestures that count points or point to locate an object.

Core concepts

Meanings of touch

- Touch generates feelings: warmth, friendliness, regard, togetherness, affection, reassurance (mother and child).

- In professional settings it may have a negative impact; a pat on the back may encourage a younger person but may be unwelcome from a stranger.
- Touching elders' feet in India shows regard and brings blessings.
- Greetings: hugging, folding hands (*namaste*), kissing the forehead (Latin America), handshakes.
- Mulk Raj Anand's *Untouchable*: the protagonist Bakha announces "an untouchable is coming" — touch once reflected class and caste.

Cultural differences

- **India:** handshake or folded hands; restrictions between men and women.
- **US and UK:** handshake is the commonest form; it troubles Indian women unused to shaking hands with the opposite sex.
- **Spain:** a handshake should last at least **seven strokes**; withdrawing may be seen as rejection.
- **Arab and Asian countries:** handshakes restricted.
- **Thailand and Laos:** touching a child on the head is rude because the head is sacred and holds the spirit.
- **Japan:** a woman covers her mouth while smiling; public display of feelings is impolite. Germans smile less.
- **New Zealand:** hongi.
- A senior's pat on a female junior's back and a forehead kiss led to debates and a court case.
- Advice: when unsure of local culture, **restrict touch**.

Handshake types

- **Dominant:** hand on top, palm down, or gripping only the fingers; used by those in higher positions.
- **Submissive:** palm up, giving control.
- **Equal:** hands meet in a shake of equality between peers.
- **Dead fish:** lifeless, discouraging.
- **Glove / politician's:** clasping with both hands; friendly show with a hidden meaning.
- Timing (beginning or end) also carries meaning.

Palms and fingers

- Flat hands may show depression or nothingness.
- Open palm = submission; palm on top of another's hand = dominance.
- Pointing or raising a finger = aggression and is often unwelcome.
- Finger-thumb circle = 'OK' but may be insulting in some cultures.

Verbal and non-verbal congruence

If a positive verbal message is accompanied by a negative non-verbal cue, there is conflict and the deal may fail. When verbal and non-verbal behaviour blend, the message is positive. Give others more room and respect their cultures.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Handshake types

Type	Features	Message
Dominant	Hand on top; palm down; fingers only	Control and power
Submissive	Palm up; open hand	Giving control
Equal	Hands meet equally	Equality between peers
Dead fish	Limp and lifeless	Lack of interest; poor deal
Glove (politician)	Both hands clasp	Cheerful, friendly show

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Bakha in Mulk Raj Anand's *Untouchable* warns others of his approach.

EXAMPLE

Thailand: touching a child's head is rude.

EXAMPLE

Spain: seven-stroke handshake.

EXAMPLE

New Zealand: hongi, touching noses.

EXAMPLE

Japanese woman covers her mouth when smiling.

Comparison tables

Touch customs across cultures

Place	Practice / meaning
India	Folded hands; touching elders' feet gives respect and brings blessings
US/UK	Handshake is the common greeting
Spain	Handshake lasts about seven strokes
Thailand/Laos	Do not touch a child's head
New Zealand	Hongi nose greeting
Latin America	Kissing forehead

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Haptics comes from a Greek word meaning 'I touch'.
- Mulk Raj Anand wrote *Untouchable*; the protagonist is Bakha.
- In Spain a handshake should last at least seven strokes.
- In Thailand and Laos touching a child's head is rude because the head is sacred.
- Hongi is the New Zealand nose-touching greeting.
- Three handshake types: dominant, submissive and equal; also dead fish and glove.
- Raised or pointed fingers are aggressive.
- If verbal and non-verbal cues conflict, trust the non-verbal.
- Restrict touch when unfamiliar with the local culture.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W3 Q2	p.11	Haptics	MCQ
W3 Q8	p.12	Cultural meanings of touch	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Haptics is the language of touch and it varies by culture, gender and setting. Handshakes may express dominance, submission or equality; a dead-fish shake signals disinterest. Gestures with palms and fingers also carry meaning. Because touch can be misread (Thailand's head taboo, Spanish seven-stroke handshakes), professionals should learn local norms, restrict touch when unsure and ensure verbal and non-verbal messages agree.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The word haptics comes from a Greek word meaning:

A. I see

B. I touch

C. I speak

D. I move

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Haptics studies touch.

Q2 (MCQ) Touching a child's head is considered rude in:

A. Spain

B. New Zealand

C. Thailand and Laos

D. Japan

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** The head is regarded as the seat of the spirit.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are handshake types discussed?

A. Dominant

B. Submissive

C. Equal

D. Dead fish

> **Answer:** A, B, C, D
> **Why:** All appear in the lecture.

Q4 (T/F) In Spain a handshake should last about seven strokes.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** Pulling away earlier may signal rejection.

Q5 (Fill) The New Zealand nose-touching greeting is _____.

> **Answer:** hongi
> **Why:** It symbolises sharing breath.

Q6 (Short) What should a person do when unsure of another culture's touch norms?

> **Answer:** Restrict touch behaviour and respect local customs.
> **Why:** Good intentions can be misread.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the origin of haptics.
☐ I can describe each handshake type.
☐ I recall cultural examples (Thailand, Spain, NZ, India, Japan).
☐ I know Anand's *Untouchable* and Bakha.
☐ I can explain verbal–non-verbal conflict.

Lecture 13: Meta-communication

Week 3 · Course book PDF pages 193–208 (printed pages 192–207)

Learning objectives

- Define meta-communication (meta = beyond) and explain implied meaning.
- Show how word choice, tone and positioning change meaning.
- Explain the uses and advantages of silence and pauses and the disadvantages of non-words (vocalised pauses).
- Distinguish pauses from silence and recall the quotations (Adrienne Rich, Kennedy).

Important definitions

META-COMMUNICATION

Communication beyond words (meta = beyond): the implied meaning carried by choice of words, tone, hesitation, silence and context. It may be intentional or unintentional.

NON-WORDS

Fumbling for words and vocalised pauses (I mean, O.K., ah, um) that mar the flow of speech and suggest doubt or ambiguity.

VOCALISED PAUSE

A filler sound or phrase used when one lacks words.

PAUSE

A short break in speech that separates units of thought; a longer pause becomes silence.

SHARED ASSUMPTIONS

Common understanding on which successful communication depends, together with unspoken arguments.

Core concepts

What meta-communication includes

- Choice of words and why a speaker chooses them in a context.
- Tone of voice, temper and pitch.
- Hesitation, fumbling, breaks and silence.
- Implied meaning: ‘You are looking smart today’ may be praise or sarcasm depending on tone.
- It may be **unintentional**.

Positioning of words

- The same words, differently broken, change meaning: **“Leave him, not kill him”** versus **“Leave him not, kill him”**.
- “Try to reach the venue well in time” may be advice, anxiety or good wishes.
- A question like “Would you mind having a cup of coffee with me?” is a polite request.

Silence in meta-communication

- Silence can mean neutrality, impartiality, hiding feelings, non-participation, disagreement, dissonance or disinterest.
- A boss’s silence can be positive or negative: you must read non-verbal cues.
- Meaning varies across cultures. Silence can be loud, frightening or rewarding.
- Success in communication comes from shared assumptions and unspoken arguments.
- **Adrienne Rich:** “Lying is done with words and also with silence.”

Advantages of silence

- Relieves monotony and gives the audience time to digest and revise.
- Gives the speaker time to think; **ignites thoughts**.
- Draws back an inattentive listener.
- Shows consideration; listeners love speakers who place silence among words.
- Helps coherence and connection.

Non-words and their harm

- Fast speakers use vocalised pauses (I mean, O.K., ah, um) which mar the flow and signal doubt, ambiguity or lack of preparation.
- Fast delivery removes space between clauses and phrases; respect for the speaker falls.
- Better to be silent than to produce confused noises. Distinguish **providing silence** from **becoming silent**.
- Lengthy silence is disliked; keep it regulated.
- Written speeches use punctuation to place pauses (comma, semicolon, full stop, dash).
- The lecture mentions a delivery rate of 125–130 words per minute (earlier, 140–150).

Pauses

- Brief breaks that divide thoughts, build rapport and goodwill, gain control and feedback.
- Listeners’ minds move faster than words; pauses let them analyse and digest.
- Only a confident, well-prepared speaker uses pauses well; actors are trained in them.
- Opening: assert presence by looking at the audience in silence — a mutual, unspoken agreement.
- Example: Kennedy’s “Ask not what your country can do for you — ask what you can do for your country” is effective because of the pause.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Uses of silence

Use	Effect
Neutrality / hiding reaction	Avoids revealing opinion
Non-participation / disagreement	Signals dissonance
Relief from monotony	Audience digests ideas
Time to think	Speaker generates new ideas
Attention	Draws in distracted listeners

Theories, principles, models and contributors

LYING WITH SILENCE — ADRIENNE RICH

“Lying is done with words and also with silence.”

PAUSE IN SPEECH — JOHN F. KENNEDY (QUOTED)

The famous line gains force from a pause.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

“Leave him, not kill him” versus “Leave him not, kill him”.

EXAMPLE

A friend saying “You are looking damn smart today” may imply you earlier dressed badly.

EXAMPLE

A boss who stays silent on your request.

EXAMPLE

A meeting member silent to remain neutral.

Comparison tables

Pause versus silence versus non-words

Pause	Silence	Non-words
Short break dividing thoughts	Longer break with meaning	Fumbling, ah/um, I mean
Confident and planned	Intentional or obligatory	Signals doubt and poor preparation
Improves clarity	Can relieve, reflect or hide	Mars flow of speech

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Meta means beyond.
- Meta-communication may be unintentional.
- ‘Leave him, not kill him’ example shows the effect of word positioning.
- Silence can hide meaning or show disagreement.
- Non-words include ah, um, ‘I mean’, O.K.
- Adrienne Rich: lying is done with words and also with silence.
- Pauses are short breaks; longer breaks become silence.
- Silence ignites thoughts and relieves monotony.
- Kennedy’s sentence works because of its pause.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W3 Q3	p.11	Meta-communication	MCQ
W3 Q9	p.12	Silence as communication	MCQ
W3 Q13	p.13	Silence and pauses in speech	MSQ
W3 Q14	p.13	Non-words and vocalised pauses	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Meta-communication is communication beyond words: choice of words, tone, positioning, hesitation and silence. Silence and pauses relieve monotony, give time to think, build rapport and add emphasis, while non-words (ah, um, I mean) harm clarity and show poor preparation. Speakers should provide silence deliberately, keep it short and read others’ silences in context and culture.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) ‘Meta’ in meta-communication means:

A. Before

B. Beyond

C. Below

D. Between

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It is communication beyond words.

Q2 (MCQ) ‘Lying is done with words and also with silence’ was said by:

A. Mark Twain

B. Pythagoras

C. Adrienne Rich

D. Dale Carnegie

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Quoted in the lecture.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are non-words?

A. Ah

B. Um

C. I mean

D. A planned pause

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** A planned pause is useful.

Q4 (T/F) Meta-communication is always intentional.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It may be unintentional.

Q5 (Fill) A longer pause becomes _____.

> **Answer:** silence
> **Why:** Pauses are small breaks.

Q6 (Short) State two advantages of silence for a speaker.

> **Answer:** It gives time to think and ignites new thoughts; it relieves monotony and wins attention.
> **Why:** It also helps coherence.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define meta-communication.
☐ I can show how word positioning changes meaning.
☐ I can list advantages of silence.
☐ I know why non-words harm a speech.
☐ I can distinguish pause and silence.

Lecture 14: Listening Skills

Week 3 · Course book PDF pages 209–225 (printed pages 208–224)

Learning objectives

- Distinguish hearing from listening.
- List the stages of the listening process: hearing, filtering, interpreting, responding, remembering.
- Explain perceptive listening (Ernest D. Nathan) and the advantages of listening.
- Identify barriers: prejudging, ambiguity, bias/illusion, rigidity, premature evaluation.

Important definitions

LISTENING

A conscious, mental skill and art of paying attention, understanding and remembering what is said; involves ears and brain together.

HEARING

A physiological activity requiring no extra effort; sound reaches the ear without conscious attention.

PERCEPTIVE LISTENING

Ernest D. Nathan: a conscious cognitive effort involving primarily the sense of hearing reinforced by other senses, leading to understanding and inspired by a sincere desire to understand.

PREJUDGING

Forming an opinion before listening completely; a barrier to listening.

RIGIDITY

Unwillingness to change one’s view, which blocks listening (e.g. old-timers resisting the paperless office).

Core concepts

Listening versus hearing

- Hearing is physiological; listening is mental and needs conscious participation.
- Examples: radio playing while solving sums (hearing); remembering grandparents’ stories (listening).
- Researchers: **60 to 75 percent** of time is spent in listening, yet we are not trained to listen.
- People listen to what interests them.
- Listening and hearing: “You never listen” means you do not pay attention.

Process of listening

Hearing → Filtering → Interpreting → Responding → Remembering.

- Hearing: physical; make it mental.
- Filtering: words, expressions, idioms; unknown words block listening.
- Interpreting: understanding the message (e.g. a GM's instruction passed through channels).
- Responding: decision or reply; impossible without interpreting.
- Remembering: retaining data and quotations.

Advantages of listening

- **Knowledge:** a means of gathering information; saves time and money (lectures instead of buying books).
- **Learning new things** and inspiring creativity and sharing.
- **Sound relationships** (parents, friends, colleagues).
- **Better performance:** follow the boss's instructions and colleagues' ideas; helps solve problems.
- **Vocabulary and pronunciation:** hearing words in context with tone and pronunciation.
- Avoids miscommunication; helps in exams through remembered lectures.
- Supports a paperless office.

Barriers to listening

1. **Prejudging** – drawing conclusions early.
2. **Ambiguity** – unclear speaker or content.
3. **Bias or illusion** – 'I already know this subject'.
4. **Rigidity** – refusing change (demonetisation and paperless office examples).
5. **Premature evaluation** – judging the speaker by appearance.
6. Unfamiliar words; lack of interest; distractions (music while driving).

How to listen well

- Follow "**SLANT**": Sit up, Listen, interpret and then think (as phrased in the lecture).
- Hear adequately; filter, interpret, respond, remember.
- Solve the problems affecting your listening.
- Respect the speaker's experience; judge thoughts, not appearance.
- Be patient: "patience not only pays, patience prevails."

Types, classifications and characteristics

Stages of the listening process

Stage	Meaning
Hearing	Physiological reception of sound
Filtering	Sorting words and expressions mentally
Interpreting	Understanding and relating meaning
Responding	Reacting, deciding or replying
Remembering	Retaining the information

Theories, principles, models and contributors

PERCEPTIVE LISTENING — ERNEST D. NATHAN

A conscious cognitive effort, involving mainly hearing reinforced by other senses, leading to understanding and inspired by a sincere desire to understand.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Radio plays while a student solves sums: hearing, not listening.

EXAMPLE

Remembering grandparents' stories because of intent listening.

EXAMPLE

A train-journey friendship built through listening.

EXAMPLE

Listening to music while driving can cause accidents.

EXAMPLE

Demonetisation and the paperless office as instances of rigidity.

Comparison tables

Hearing versus listening

Point	Hearing	Listening
Nature	Physiological	Mental, conscious
Effort	No extra effort	Needs attention and purpose
Involvement	Only ears	Ears and brain
Retention	Often forgotten	Remembered

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Listening process: hearing, filtering, interpreting, responding, remembering.
- 60–75% of time is spent in listening.
- Hearing is physiological; listening is mental.
- Ernest D. Nathan defined perceptive listening.
- Barriers: prejudging, ambiguity, bias, rigidity, premature evaluation.
- Listening builds knowledge, relationships and vocabulary.
- Perceptive listening is inspired by a sincere desire to understand.
- SLANT: sit up, listen, interpret, think (as given in lecture).

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q1	p.3	Hearing vs listening	MCQ
W3 Q5	p.11	Hearing vs listening	Fill-in-the-blank

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Listening is a conscious mental skill, unlike hearing. It passes through hearing, filtering, interpreting, responding and remembering. Perceptive listening, as defined by Ernest D. Nathan, needs a sincere desire to understand. Listening brings knowledge, relationships, better performance and vocabulary, but prejudging, ambiguity, bias, rigidity and premature evaluation block it.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which stage comes immediately after filtering in listening?

A. Hearing

B. Interpreting

C. Responding

D. Remembering

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Order: hearing, filtering, interpreting, responding, remembering.

Q2 (MCQ) Perceptive listening was defined by:

A. Freud

B. Ernest D. Nathan

C. Adler

D. Mehrabian

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It requires a sincere desire to understand.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are barriers to listening?

A. Prejudging

B. Ambiguity

C. Rigidity

D. Sincere desire to understand

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** A sincere desire promotes listening.

Q4 (T/F) Hearing requires conscious effort just like listening.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Hearing is physiological and needs no extra effort.

Q5 (Fill) Researchers say _____ to 75 percent of time is spent listening.

> **Answer:** 60
> **Why:** Yet we are not trained to listen.

Q6 (Short) Give two advantages of listening.

> **Answer:** It is a means of gaining knowledge and it builds sound relationships; also improves vocabulary and performance.
> **Why:** Listening saves time and money compared with reading alone.

Revision checklist

☐ I can distinguish hearing and listening.
☐ I can list the five stages in order.
☐ I can define perceptive listening.
☐ I know the advantages and barriers.
☐ I remember 60–75% and SLANT.

Lecture 15: Types of Listening

Week 3 · Course book PDF pages 226–239 (printed pages 225–238)

Learning objectives

- Name and explain the three basic types of listening: combative, attentive, reflective.
- Explain content, empathetic, appreciative and analytical listening with uses.
- Identify external and internal factors affecting listening and prejudiced listening.
- Apply tips for effective listening and recall Hemingway’s quotation.

Important definitions

COMBATIVE LISTENING

Listening with protest or opposition in mind; the element of protest damages the listening process.

ATTENTIVE LISTENING

Paying equal attention to every word throughout, without analysing or interpreting in the process.

REFLECTIVE LISTENING

The most important form: listening and analysing in order to relate and gain knowledge.

CONTENT LISTENING

Listening carefully to bosses, leaders or chairpersons, often to take notes, so that instructions can be passed on or acted on.

EMPATHETIC LISTENING

Listening to a person’s problem to share feelings, relieve stress and perhaps advise, so that the person feels motivated.

APPRECIATIVE LISTENING

Listening to ideas, performance or achievements and appreciating them.

ANALYTICAL LISTENING

Listening to all parties (e.g. in a dispute) and analysing before deciding.

Core concepts

Three basic types

1. **Combative** – listen to protest.

2. **Attentive** – listen to every word.
3. **Reflective** – listen and analyse; the most important.

Types in the workplace

- **Content** – meetings, new policies, instructions (upward and downward flow).
- **Empathetic** – employees with stress or personal crisis; boss listens, shares and advises.
- **Appreciative** – new ideas, papers, songs, policies need an appreciative audience.
- **Analytical** – listen to both parties in a dispute or while negotiating or inviting bids.

Use the right type for the purpose; analysing a person who only wants to unburden is wrong.

Prejudiced listening

- When something opposes our deeply rooted prejudices, the brain becomes over-stimulated and stops listening.
- We mentally plan a rebuttal or a question designed to embarrass the speaker.
- Criticism about colour, dress or a 'hasty argument' may block the listener.

Situations needing listening

- **Conversation** — good conversation needs patience in listening.
- **Group discussion** — listening makes a leader; even an idea-less member can contribute by listening.
- **Organisational activities** — coordination depends on listening.
- **Negotiation** — weigh pros and cons.
- **Interview** — do not jump to answer before the question is complete.
- **Meetings** — avoid whispering and parallel talk.

Factors affecting listening

- **External:** noise, venue, time, culture (hence schools in isolated places).
- **Internal:** state of mind (preoccupation), **ego** ("incurable disease"), language barriers/unknown words, different perceptions, ego clashes, rigid categories, ambiguity.

Tips for effective listening

- Be generous and go with an open mind.
- Concentrate on the speaker; judge thoughts, not appearance.
- Take brief notes while listening and summarise mentally.
- Do not interrupt; note doubts and ask politely afterwards.
- Show interest non-verbally; keep critical thinking to yourself.
- Avoid parallel talk; read the speaker's non-verbal cues, pauses and silences.
- Use gaps to relate ideas. Listen to learn and to unlearn.
- **Hemingway:** "I like to listen. I have learned a great deal from listening carefully. Most people never listen."

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of listening by purpose

Type	Purpose	Typical situation
Content	Gather information / instructions	Boss's announcement, meeting
Empathetic	Share feeling; relieve stress	Employee with personal problem
Appreciative	Acknowledge and enjoy	New idea, paper, song
Analytical	Evaluate and decide	Dispute, negotiation, bids

Basic three types

Type	Key feature
Combative	Listening with protest
Attentive	Attention to every word
Reflective	Listening plus analysis; most important

Theories, principles, models and contributors

LISTENING QUOTATION — ERNEST HEMINGWAY

"I like to listen. I have learned a great deal from listening carefully. Most people never listen."

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A boss criticises a project as 'hasty' and the author stops listening.

EXAMPLE

An over-excited interviewee answers before the question ends.

EXAMPLE

Educational institutions are located away from noise.

EXAMPLE

A manager listens empathetically to an employee's crisis.

Comparison tables

External versus internal factors

External	Internal
Noise	State of mind
Venue	Ego
Time	Language and perceptions
Culture	Ambiguity, rigidity, clashes

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Three basic types: combative, attentive, reflective.
- Reflective listening is the most important.
- Types by purpose: content, empathetic, appreciative, analytical.
- External factors: noise, venue, time, culture.
- Internal factors: state of mind, ego, language, perception.
- Do not interrupt, whisper or hold parallel talks in meetings.
- Take notes while listening.
- Hemingway quote: most people never listen.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W3 Q7	p.12	Types of listening	MCQ
W3 Q11	p.13	Factors affecting listening	MSQ
W3 Q12	p.13	Barriers to listening	MSQ
W3 Q15	p.13	Types of listening	Match the columns
W5 Q7	p.20	Combative listening	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Listening may be combative, attentive or reflective, with reflective listening the most valuable. In organisations content, empathetic, appreciative and analytical listening serve different purposes. Prejudice, noise, ego, preoccupation and language hamper listening, whereas an open mind, concentration, note-taking, patience and attention to non-verbal cues improve it.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The most important of the three basic types of listening is:

A. Combative

B. Attentive

C. Reflective

D. Appreciative

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** It involves analysis and relating.

Q2 (MCQ) Listening to both parties in a dispute is:

A. Empathetic

B. Analytical

C. Appreciative

D. Content

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Analysis is needed before deciding.

Q3 (MSQ) Select internal factors affecting listening.

A. Ego

B. State of mind

C. Noise

D. Language

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Noise is external.

Q4 (T/F) In a meeting, parallel conversations help listening.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** They destroy the atmosphere of listening.

Q5 (Fill) Listening to an employee's personal problem to relieve stress is _____ listening.

> **Answer:** empathetic
> **Why:** It may include advice.

Q6 (Short) Suggest two tips for effective listening.

> **Answer:** Concentrate on the speaker with an open mind and take notes without interrupting.
> **Why:** Avoid prejudging and parallel talk.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the three basic types.
☐ I can match the four purpose-based types to situations.
☐ I can list external and internal barriers.
☐ I know tips and the Hemingway quote.
☐ I understand prejudiced listening.

Week 4: Negotiation, Culture and Organisational Communication

1. Lecture 16: Negotiation Skills I
2. Lecture 17: Negotiation Skills II
3. Lecture 18: Culture as Communication
4. Lecture 19: Communicating across Cultures
5. Lecture 20: Organizational Communication

Lecture 16: Negotiation Skills I

Week 4 · Course book PDF pages 240–254 (printed pages 239–253)

Learning objectives

- Define negotiation and list its ingredients.
- Differentiate formal and informal negotiation.
- Explain factors affecting negotiation: place, time, atmosphere, subjective factors, fear, influence.
- State the qualities of a negotiator and the stages of negotiation; define BATNA, WATNA and ZOPA.

Important definitions

NEGOTIATION (ALAN FOWLER)

A form of meeting or discussion in which the parties use argument and persuasion to reach an agreed decision or action. (The transcript spells the name ‘Alan Flower’.)

NEGOTIATION (PROCESS VIEW)

A process of combining conflicting positions into a common position, turning conflict into agreement.

BATNA

Best Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement: your fallback if the negotiation fails.

WATNA

Worst Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement: the worst result that you must avoid accepting out of fear or influence.

ZOPA

Zone Of Possible Agreement: the range in which the parties’ interests overlap and agreement is possible.

WIN-WIN SITUATION

An agreement that benefits both parties.

Core concepts

Nature of negotiation

- Arises when there is a **conflict or deadlock** or difference of opinion.
- Needs **two parties** with interests; discussion must not be one-sided.

- Works through **persuasion and instruction, not authority**.
- Outcome should benefit both parties; sometimes lose-win, ideally win-win.
- Examples: buying a car; employee seeking a raise from the boss.

Formal versus informal negotiation

- **Formal:** pre-announced date, venue, time and agenda; parties know the subject; usually **three people**: two parties and a negotiator/observer.
- **Informal:** not announced; casual, friendly; two persons; little preparation; position and familiarity can create pressure or deadlock; need extra restraint.

Factors affecting negotiation

- **Place:** own place gives comfort, confidence and access to documents.
- **Time:** mutually suitable; not imposed.
- **Atmosphere:** free exchange; no threat; seek common ground.
- **Subjective factors:** personal relationships, bias of observer, **fear**, influence and mutual obligation, personal ambition.
- Past negotiations may help.
- **Kennedy:** "Let us never negotiate out of fear, but let us never fear to negotiate."

Qualities of a negotiator

- **Confidence** from preparation; have a plan B.
- **Appearance** – dress with dignity.
- **Outlook** – flexible, ready to concede but never agree unless you have gained.
- **Honesty and reliability** – know your subject and both sides' strengths and weaknesses.
- **Competence** – communication and reading meta-communication and facial reactions.
- Flexibility and positivity; no agreement can be totally fair.

Stages and tactics

- **Preparation** (study the issue, gather facts, know upper and lower limits) → **Negotiation/interaction** (simple language, stay cool, conducive atmosphere) → agreement.
- Use polite language: "I think we need some more clarity in this regard"; "Can you repeat what you said earlier?"
- Facts must be factual and consistent; many negotiations fail because of poor control of vocabulary.
- **Upper limit** = how much you concede; **lower limit** = loss you can accept.
- Prepare BATNA; avoid WATNA; aim for ZOPA and a win-win outcome.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Formal versus informal negotiation

Point	Formal	Informal
Announcement	Date, venue, time and agenda announced	Not announced
Preparation	Prepared in advance	Little or no time
Persons	Two parties plus negotiator/observer	Two persons
Atmosphere	Official	Friendly, may be influenced by position

Key acronyms

Acronym	Expansion
BATNA	Best Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement
WATNA	Worst Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement
ZOPA	Zone Of Possible Agreement

Theories, principles, models and contributors

DEFINITION OF NEGOTIATION — ALAN FOWLER (‘FLOWER’ IN TRANSCRIPT)

A meeting or discussion where argument and persuasion lead to an agreed decision.

FEAR AND NEGOTIATION — JOHN F. KENNEDY

“Let us never negotiate out of fear, but let us never fear to negotiate.”

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Haggling over the price of a car; the seller must also benefit.

EXAMPLE

An employee negotiating a raise with the boss.

EXAMPLE

Students negotiating marks with a faculty member (fear factor).

EXAMPLE

Using ‘Can you repeat what you said earlier?’ to buy time.

Comparison tables

BATNA versus WATNA

BATNA	WATNA
Best fallback if talks fail	Worst outcome to avoid
Gives confidence and strength	Accepted only under fear or influence
Prepare in advance	Never accept

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Negotiation arises from conflict and needs two parties.
- Formal negotiation announces date, venue, time and agenda; three persons involved.
- Informal negotiation is not pre-announced.
- Negotiation works by persuasion, not authority.
- BATNA, WATNA, ZOPA acronyms.
- Qualities: confidence, appearance, outlook, honesty, competence, flexibility.
- Kennedy’s fear quotation.
- Facts must be consistent; know upper and lower limits.
- Ideal outcome is win-win.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W4 Q1	p.15	BATNA, WATNA and negotiation terms	MCQ
W4 Q2	p.15	Negotiation: quotations	MCQ
W4 Q3	p.15	Definition of negotiation	MCQ
W4 Q4	p.15	Nature of negotiation	MCQ
W4 Q9	p.16	ZOPA	Fill-in-the-blank
W4 Q10	p.16	Qualities of a negotiator	MSQ
W4 Q11	p.17	Formal negotiation	MSQ
W4 Q12	p.17	Subjective factors in negotiation	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Negotiation turns conflict into agreement through argument and persuasion. Formal negotiations are pre-announced with an agenda; informal ones are casual. Place, time, atmosphere, personal relations

and fear affect results. A negotiator needs confidence, dignity, flexibility, honesty and competence, must prepare facts and limits, secure a BATNA, avoid WATNA and seek a ZOPA that yields a win-win outcome.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) ZOPA stands for:

A. Zone Of Possible Agreement

B. Zero Option Plan Agreement

C. Zone Of Prior Action

D. Zone Of Peaceful Argument

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** It is the range of possible agreement.

Q2 (MCQ) WATNA is:

A. Best alternative

B. Worst alternative to a negotiated agreement

C. A kind of authority

D. A meeting type

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It must be avoided.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are true for formal negotiation?

A. Agenda announced

B. Venue announced

C. Always unplanned

D. Often involves an observer

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Informal is unplanned.

Q4 (T/F) Negotiation should be conducted through authority rather than persuasion.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It works through persuasion.

Q5 (Fill) BATNA stands for Best _____ To a Negotiated Agreement.

> **Answer:** Alternative
> **Why:** It is the fallback option.

Q6 Short State three qualities of a good negotiator.

> **Answer:** Confidence, honesty and flexibility (also appearance, outlook, competence).
> **Why:** Preparation builds confidence.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define negotiation.
☐ I can compare formal and informal negotiation.
☐ I can list factors and qualities.
☐ I can expand BATNA, WATNA, ZOPA.
☐ I remember Kennedy’s fear quote.

Lecture 17: Negotiation Skills II

Week 4 · Course book PDF pages 255–269 (printed pages 254–268)

Learning objectives

- Explain persuasion factors in negotiation: style, you-attitude, body language, summarising.
- Describe the three phases: preparation, interaction (negotiation), implementation.
- Distinguish red, blue and purple negotiation styles.
- List negotiation approaches (collaborate, accommodate, compromise, control, avoid) and dos and don’ts.

Important definitions

YOU-ATTITUDE

Convincing the other party that they will benefit; telling them the ‘sunny side’ of the deal and letting them talk while you listen.

SUNNY SIDE OF THE DEAL

The advantages to the other party that you highlight to persuade them.

RED STYLE

Self-centred, competitive negotiation style.

BLUE STYLE

Cooperative, less competitive style.

PURPLE STYLE

A mix of red and blue; the recommended style.

WIN-WIN / WIN-LOSE / LOSE-WIN

Possible outcomes of a negotiation; no negotiation gives a total win to one party.

Core concepts

Persuasion factors

- **Style:** language, convincing approach, presenting strengths and weaknesses; each party presents its case first.
- **You-attitude:** highlight the benefit to the other; combine talking and listening.
- **Body language:** glances, eyes and face complement words.

- **Summarising:** "I have said this, you have said this... something still needs discussion."

Agreement is the culmination ("sum and substance") of exchanged views.

Three phases of negotiation

1. **Preparation** – plan, study pros and cons, know your strength and the other's weakness, upper and lower limits, anticipate (plan B), discover the real issue, be realistic. **Tim Hindle:** it is almost impossible for a negotiator to do too much preparation.
2. **Interaction / negotiation** – introductions (often by the observer), exchange initial views, test the initial position, look for common ground (ZOPA), small sacrifices, watch time, note down the points of agreement, control vocabulary.
3. **Implementation** – decide roles after agreement and ensure the agreement sustains.

Negotiation styles by colour

- **Red:** self-centred, competitive.
- **Blue:** cooperative.
- **Purple:** blend; best choice.

Approaches / qualities

- **Collaborate** – avoid confrontation.
- **Accommodate** – polite, allow more room, especially with other cultures.
- **Compromise** – do not remain rigid.
- **Control** – be forgiving, conceding, convincing; ask for clarification advantageously.
- **Avoid** – keep emotion out of sight, avoid confrontational tone.

Dos and don'ts

- Keep some key points in reserve; do not say everything at once.
- Do not get personal; read the tone, not only the words.
- Do not prolong discussion after agreement; sign at the right time and record points.
- Acknowledge the other party's cooperation.
- Be ready for deadlock, defeat and lose-win outcomes; hide signs of loss and stay optimistic.
- Allow other cultures more time and space.
- "In business you do not get what you deserve, you get what you negotiate."
- Negotiation is cooperation, not competition.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Three phases of negotiation

Phase	Key tasks
Preparation	Study issue, strengths/weaknesses, limits, plan B
Interaction	Exchange views, test positions, find common ground, agree, note points
Implementation	Assign roles, carry out the agreement

Negotiation styles

Style	Nature
Red	Competitive, self-centred
Blue	Cooperative
Purple	Blend of red and blue (preferred)

Theories, principles, models and contributors

PREPARATION — TIM HINDLE (‘HANDLE’ IN TRANSCRIPT)

It is almost impossible for a negotiator to do too much preparation.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A schoolboy negotiates a bike with parents: bike for a 9-point CGPA.

EXAMPLE

Companies selling skill-based labs show the sunny side.

EXAMPLE

Cross-cultural delay: patient negotiators can win more concessions.

Comparison tables

Red, blue and purple styles

Style	Orientation	Result
Red	Self-centred	Deadlock risk
Blue	Cooperative	Smooth but may concede too much
Purple	Mixed	Balanced and recommended

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Three phases: preparation, interaction, implementation.
- Red = competitive; blue = cooperative; purple = mix.
- You-attitude means telling the sunny side.
- Tim Hindle: almost impossible to over-prepare.
- Agree and write down the points; decide roles.
- No negotiation gives a total win to only one party.
- Get what you negotiate, not what you deserve.
- Be patient with cultures that delay; allow concessions.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W4 Q7	p.16	Colour-based negotiation styles	MCQ
W4 Q9	p.16	ZOPA	Fill-in-the-blank

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Negotiation strategy depends on persuasion: style, you-attitude, body language and summarising. It runs through preparation, interaction and implementation. The purple style, blending cooperation and competition, is preferred, supported by collaboration, accommodation, compromise, control and emotional avoidance. Negotiators keep some points in reserve, record agreements, acknowledge cooperation and accept that outcomes can be win-win, win-lose or lose-win.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The recommended negotiation style is:

A. Red

B. Blue

C. Purple

D. Green

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** It mixes cooperation and competition.

Q2 (MCQ) ‘You-attitude’ means:

A. Talking only about yourself

B. Showing the other party their benefit

C. Remaining silent

D. Using authority

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Tell them the sunny side.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are phases of negotiation?

A. Preparation

B. Interaction

C. Implementation

D. Elimination

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Elimination is not a phase.

Q4 (T/F) A negotiator should reveal all key points at the start.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Keep some in reserve for concessions.

Q5 (Fill) A style that is self-centred and competitive is the _____ style.

> **Answer:** red
> **Why:** Blue is cooperative.

Q6 (Short) Why should points of agreement be written down?

> **Answer:** So that the agreement is clear and sustains in implementation.
> **Why:** Vocabulary affects meaning.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the three phases.

☐ I can contrast red, blue and purple.

☐ I can list approaches and dos and don’ts.

☐ I understand you-attitude.

☐ I remember outcome types.

Lecture 18: Culture as Communication

Week 4 · Course book PDF pages 270–288 (printed pages 269–287)

Learning objectives

- Define culture and explain how it affects communication.
- Explain cultural shock, diaspora and globalisation (GATT, NAFTA).
- List the dimensions of culture: context, individualism, formality, communication style, time orientation.
- Compare communication styles of Americans, Japanese, Arabs, Mexicans, Germans, Europeans and others, and cite translation blunders.

Important definitions

CULTURE

A combination of traits, behaviours, values, myths and traditions of a group; the totality of a group's thoughts, experiences and patterns of behaviour and their contact with other cultures. It is learnt and dynamic.

CULTURAL SHOCK

The feeling of isolation or being a loner that arises when one is unfamiliar with a different culture's way of living and responding.

GLOBAL VILLAGE

The world seen as interconnected through technology, trade and travel.

DIASPORA

People of one country settled in another country.

CULTURAL SENSITIVITY

Awareness and respect for differences between cultures when communicating.

DEFERENCE VS DIFFERENCE

The lecture advises showing deference (respect) rather than difference.

Core concepts

Why culture matters

- We assume the world behaves as we do; exposure to other cultures shows differences.

- Culture shapes eating, dress, vocabulary, festivals, thinking and identity; it gives a sense of belonging.
- Globalisation: GATT (General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade) and NAFTA (North American Free Trade Agreement), IT and transport exchange cultures; workplaces are multicultural. Example: idli–dosa in the north.
- Cultures are logical (a cat crossing the road is an omen to Indians) and dynamic; learn symbols, rituals, values, heroes and worships.
- Components to understand: language, gestures, appearance, religion, philosophy, values, family customs, communication systems.
- Example of cultural shock: the film/novel *The Namesake* (childbirth abroad alone).
- Gandhi: different ways to reach God, but the aim is one.

Major dimensions of culture

1. **Context** (high versus low)
2. **Individualism**
3. **Formality**
4. **Communication style**
5. **Time orientation**

Formality and style

- **Americans:** casual, direct, first names or titles, uncomfortable with silence and delay, take words literally; 'hamburger style' criticism (praise bun, criticism meat, praise bun).
- **Europeans:** formal; do not use first names without invitation.
- **Japan/China:** use titles; Japanese treat card exchange and signing as ritual.
- **Mexicans:** value courtesies and food before business; hurt if pushed to business.
- **Arabs, South Americans and Asians:** friendship first; poetic and indirect language.
- **Germans:** direct but understated; **Nigerians:** quiet and clear; **Japanese:** subtle.
- Asians use silence to gain concessions.

Contracts and context

- **Americans** (low context): contracts are specific and word-based.
- **Greeks:** a formal statement.
- **Japanese:** a statement of intention that can improve.
- **Mexicans:** an artistic exercise achievable in an ideal world.
- **Arabs** (high context): contract is insulting; stress non-verbal cues.

Space and time

- US and Canada keep about five feet; this is too close or too far for others.
- Boss in the corner (US) versus middle (Mexico).
- North Americans treat time as a commodity; Asians deliberate long; some cultures are relaxed (an American waited two hours for a purchase).

Translation blunders

- Swiss restaurant: "Our wines will make you forget everything / leave you nowhere."

- “Women are not allowed to have their children at the bar.”
- “Our water has been passed by the manager himself.”

Understand the essence, not the literal words.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Dimensions of culture

Dimension	Contrast
Context	High versus low
Individualism	Individual versus group
Formality	Tradition, titles, rituals
Communication style	Direct versus indirect
Time orientation	Time as commodity versus flexible

Theories, principles, models and contributors

HAMBURGER STYLE OF MANAGEMENT — OBSERVATION ON AMERICANS

Open with warm talk, deliver criticism in the middle, close with reassurance (the buns).

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Breakfast in Kuala Lumpur and dinner in Delhi.

EXAMPLE

Brother returns from abroad with changed behaviour.

EXAMPLE

Cat crossing the road as an omen in India.

EXAMPLE

The Namesake and cultural shock.

EXAMPLE

Hotel advertisement translation blunders.

Comparison tables

Communication styles by culture

Culture	Style
American	Direct, literal, casual, impatient with silence
German	Direct but understated, formal
Japanese	Subtle, ritual cards, statement of intention
Arab/South American	Poetic, friendship first, high context
Mexican	Courtesy first; contract is artistic ideal
Nigerian	Quiet, clear

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Culture is learnt and dynamic.
- GATT and NAFTA promote trade across cultures.
- Dimensions: context, individualism, formality, communication style, time orientation.
- Americans: hamburger style; low context; time is money.
- Mexicans prefer courtesies before business.
- Arabs consider contracts insulting (high context).
- US/Canada keep about five feet of space.
- Cultural shock causes isolation (The Namesake).
- Europeans do not use first names without invitation.

Summary

Culture is the learnt set of traits, values and behaviours of a group and strongly shapes communication. Globalisation brings cultural contact and, sometimes, cultural shock. Cultures differ in context, individualism, formality, communication style and time orientation; low-context Americans and Germans are direct and word-based, while high-context Arabs, Japanese and Asians stress relationship, silence and non-verbal cues. Respect, deference and learning are the keys to cross-cultural success.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which is a dimension of culture mentioned?

A. Climate

B. Time orientation

C. Latitude

D. Currency

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Context, individualism, formality, style, time orientation.

Q2 (MCQ) The ‘hamburger style’ is associated with:

A. Japanese

B. Americans

C. Arabs

D. Mexicans

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Praise, criticism, praise.

Q3 (MSQ) Select high-context cultures from the lecture’s discussion.

A. Arab

B. Japanese

C. American

D. German

> **Answer:** A, B
> **Why:** Americans and Germans rely on words.

Q4 (T/F) GATT and NAFTA are trade agreements.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** They helped goods and cultures move.

Q5 (Fill) Feeling isolated in an unfamiliar culture is called cultural _____.

> **Answer:** shock
> **Why:** As in The Namesake.

Q6 (Short) Why should translations of advertisements be checked?

> **Answer:** Literal translation can produce absurd meanings, e.g. ‘our wines will leave you nowhere’.
> **Why:** Convey the essence.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define culture.
☐ I know the five dimensions.
☐ I can contrast American, Japanese, Arab and Mexican styles.
☐ I can explain cultural shock.
☐ I remember translation blunders.

Lecture 19: Communicating across Cultures

Week 4 · Course book PDF pages 289–304 (printed pages 288–303)

Learning objectives

- Define communicating across cultures and Alfred G. Smith's definition of culture.
- Contrast low-context and high-context cultures.
- Distinguish intercultural, cross-cultural and global communication contexts.
- Explain ethnocentrism, stereotyping and the movement toward ethno-relativism; recall cultural examples.

Important definitions

CULTURE (ALFRED G. SMITH)

"Culture is a code we learn and share, and learning and sharing require communication." Communication requires coding and symbols that must be learned and shared. (From *Communication and Culture*.)

INTERCULTURAL COMMUNICATION

Face-to-face interaction among people of diverse cultures (also between subcultures of one country).

GLOBAL CONTEXT

Trans-border transfer of information by institutions and groups.

CROSS-CULTURAL COMMUNICATION

Comparing a phenomenon across cultures; problems arise when meanings differ.

ETHNOCENTRISM

The belief that one's own culture is the best.

ETHNO-RELATIVISM

Accepting that cultures differ and adapting to them; reached through stages from denial to acceptance and adaptation.

STEREOTYPING

An oversimplified view of a culture or community, judging individuals by their group.

Core concepts

Low versus high context

- **Low context** (North America, Scandinavia, France, Germany): logic, written contracts, words, analytical and action-oriented language, individualism, little role for silence and non-words.
- **High context** (Japan, China, Arab countries): meaning from context, intuition, silence and non-verbal cues; contemplative; social harmony and saving face; prefer friendship to contract.
- Example: a Japanese buyer paused, folded arms and closed eyes while the American seller grew impatient.

Communication contexts

- **International:** face-to-face among diverse cultures.
- **Global:** information across borders.
- **Cross-cultural:** comparing across cultures.
- **Intercultural:** interaction between people of different cultures, including subcultures (Indian Bengali versus Bangladeshi Bengali; American versus Indian English).

Cultural variations

- **Superstition:** a worm in pulque is fortunate in Mexico; the Japanese *Maneki neko* (beckoning cat) attracts customers.
- **Numbers:** 8 is lucky in China and Hong Kong; 4 sounds like death (shi) so no room 4 in hospitals.
- **Space:** Arabs of the same sex stand closer; North Americans keep five feet.
- **Silence:** Americans cannot bear long silence.
- **Colour, greeting and touch** differ.
- **Saying no:** USA/Canada shake head; Bulgaria nods up and down; Japan moves the right hand; Sicily raises the chin.
- An Indian politely refusing food saying ‘no’ went hungry among Americans.
- HP: French engineers wrote shorter e-mails, which Americans read as withholding information.
- Mazda: casual baseball caps hurt Americans’ feelings.
- Gifts: a clock in China invites evil; do not gift an Arab’s wife; a rose to a German lady may signal romance. ‘How was your weekend?’ may seem intrusive.
- Gestures: Thatcher’s victory sign and the thumbs-up may be negative elsewhere; Asian men holding hands is friendly.

Variables to watch

Ethnocentrism, education, religious faith, country laws, language and use of space are variables in cross-cultural communication.

Bridging cultural gaps

- Tolerance, empathy, patience; do not judge; give others space and time.
- Avoid stereotypes (a basket of mangoes: not all are rotten).
- Move from ethnocentrism to ethno-relativism through **six stages** (denial, defence, minimisation, acceptance, adaptation, integration), seeking commonalities.
- Indians care about image; Mexicans and Asians about harmony and saving face.

- *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* (“Ayam nijah paro veti…”): the world is one family.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Low versus high context cultures

Feature	Low context	High context
Countries	North America, Scandinavia, France, Germany	Japan, China, Arab countries
Meaning in	Words	Context, silence, non-verbal cues
Contracts	Written and specific	Relationship, trust
Orientation	Individualism, action	Harmony, contemplation

Ways to say ‘no’

Place	Gesture
USA/Canada	Shake head side to side
Bulgaria	Nod up and down
Japan	Move right hand
Sicily	Raise chin

Theories, principles, models and contributors

CULTURE AS A CODE — ALFRED G. SMITH

Culture is a code we learn and share; sharing requires communication. (The Lecture 2 note records the transcript’s ‘Adam Smith’ attribution as a discrepancy.)

ETHNOCENTRISM TO ETHNO-RELATIVISM — CROSS-CULTURAL MODEL (SIX STAGES)

Denial → defence → minimisation → acceptance → adaptation → integration.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Japanese buyer’s silence versus an American seller’s impatience.

EXAMPLE

Worm in the drink: lucky in Mexico, unlucky elsewhere.

EXAMPLE

Indian politely says ‘no’ to second helpings and is not offered more.

EXAMPLE

HP’s French and US engineers; Mazda baseball caps.

Comparison tables

Ethnocentrism versus ethno-relativism

Ethnocentrism	Ethno-relativism
My culture is the best	Cultures are different but equal
Denial and defence	Acceptance and adaptation
Judges by own standards	Understands others’ viewpoint

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Low context: North America, Scandinavia, France, Germany.
- High context: Japan, China, Arab countries.
- Number 8 is lucky; 4 sounds like death in Hong Kong/China.
- Maneki neko is the Japanese beckoning cat.
- North Americans keep about 5 feet of space.
- Sicily raises the chin to say no; Bulgaria nods for no.
- A clock as a gift is bad in China.
- Ethno-relativism has six stages.
- Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam shows the Asian ideal.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W4 Q5	p.15	Culture and numbers	MCQ
W4 Q6	p.16	Definition of culture	MCQ
W4 Q13	p.17	Low-context cultures	MSQ
W4 Q15	p.17	Cultural differences in gestures and style	Match the columns

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Communication across cultures requires understanding that culture is a shared code. Low-context cultures trust words and contracts, while high-context cultures read silence, context and relationships. Differences in gestures, numbers, gifts, space, colour and ways of saying no cause misunderstanding.

Avoid ethnocentrism and stereotypes; practise tolerance, empathy and adaptation, moving towards ethno-relativism.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which culture is low context?

A. Japan

B. China

C. Germany

D. Arab countries

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** North America, Scandinavia, France and Germany are low context.

Q2 (MCQ) The belief that one's own culture is best is:

A. Ethno-relativism

B. Ethnocentrism

C. Stereotype

D. Diaspora

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It must be avoided.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are correctly matched ways of saying no?

A. Bulgaria – nod up and down

B. Sicily – raise chin

C. USA – nod up and down

D. Japan – move right hand

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** In the USA people shake the head.

Q4 (T/F) In Hong Kong the number 4 is lucky.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It resembles the word for death; 8 is lucky.

Q5 (Fill) A Japanese cat figure that attracts customers is _____.

> **Answer:** Maneki neko
> **Why:** The beckoning cat.

Q6 Short How can cultural gaps be bridged?

> **Answer:** By tolerance, empathy, patience, avoiding judgments and stereotypes, and adapting to others' norms.
> **Why:** Move to ethno-relativism.

Revision checklist

☐ I can quote Smith's definition.
☐ I can compare low and high context.
☐ I know the ways of saying no.
☐ I can explain ethnocentrism and ethno-relativism.
☐ I remember gift and number examples.

Lecture 20: Organizational Communication

Week 4 · Course book PDF pages 305–321 (printed pages 304–320)

Learning objectives

- Define organisation and organisational communication (William Scott).
- State functions and objectives of organisational communication.
- Explain managerial roles (interpersonal, informational, decisional) and Maslow's hierarchy at work.
- Describe McGregor's management styles, line and staff management, formal and informal channels, and types of workplace communication.

Important definitions

ORGANISATION

A social unit of people structured and managed to meet a need or pursue collective goals.

ORGANISATIONAL COMMUNICATION (WILLIAM SCOTT)

A process involving transmission and accurate replication of ideas, their dissemination, promotion and distribution, ensured by feedback, to elicit actions that accomplish the goals of the organisation.

INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (IMS)

The core system by which information entering an organisation is managed and used.

LINE MANAGEMENT

People responsible for basic company activities such as manufacturing and sales.

STAFF MANAGEMENT

People who support line management with services such as accounting, distribution and personnel.

GRAPEVINE

An informal channel of casual talk, whispers and rumours.

CRISIS COMMUNICATION

Urgent communication among core managers when something goes wrong; combines persuasion with caution.

Core concepts

Why communication matters in an organisation

- Carry out management, allocate jobs, disseminate information and clarify roles.
- The communication environment shows a person's calibre and is an asset.
- Employees come from different backgrounds, ages, genders and faiths; communication must suit everyone.
- Communication flows to bosses, groups and other departments.

Functions of communication

1. **Forecasting** – what we want to do and where we want to be.
2. **Organising** – distributing work and responsibilities among divisions (quality control, HR, accounts, inventory).
3. **Instructing / persuading** – leader instructs, persuades or orders.
4. **Coordinating** – across divisions.
5. **Controlling** – the leader controls and is a role model.

Objectives

- Improve job performance and update knowledge (workshops, conferences).
- Create belonging; make employees feel heard and appreciated.
- Convince employees about decisions; set daily, monthly and annual aims jointly.
- Assign roles and empower employees with information.

Managerial roles

- **Interpersonal** – talking with individuals and groups.
- **Informational** – receiving and giving information; be like an ambassador who knows everything.
- **Decisional** – listen to problems, interpret information and decide.

Maslow's hierarchy at work

Physiological (food, shelter, salary) → safety/security → social (belonging, love, appreciation) → esteem/ego → **self-actualisation** (morality, creativity, spontaneity, purpose). "Ambition is everyone's slave."

McGregor's two styles

- **Traditional (Theory X):** workers need only basic needs; treated as labour; language of control.
- **Modern (Theory Y):** balance of control and freedom; workers treated as humans with higher needs; language of persuasion; manager must understand their needs.

Communication flow and channels

- **Vertical** (downward from top, upward), **horizontal**, **crosswise** (diagonal), and **spiral** for policy announcements (hike, bonus).
- **Line and staff** management coordinate; staff support line.
- **Formal** and **informal** channels (casual chat, grapevine). Managers may use the grapevine for warnings or to caution disgruntled employees; filter its information.

- **Koontz and O'Donnell:** "The most effective communication results when managers utilise the informal organisational channels to supplement the formal organisational channels."

Types of communication at workplace

- **Statutory** – norms, terms and conditions, policies, bulletins.
- **Crisis management** – urgent meetings of core members; persuasion and caution.

A satisfied employee is more productive than a dissatisfied one.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Functions of organisational communication

Function	Meaning
Forecasting	Planning goals and future position
Organising	Distributing tasks and divisions
Instructing / persuading	Directing employees
Coordinating	Linking divisions
Controlling	Monitoring performance; leader as role model

Managerial roles

Role	Description
Interpersonal	Dealing with people
Informational	Receiving and sharing information
Decisional	Interpreting and deciding

Theories, principles, models and contributors

ORGANISATIONAL COMMUNICATION — WILLIAM SCOTT

Transmission and replication of ideas ensured by feedback to accomplish organisational goals.

HIERARCHY OF NEEDS — ABRAHAM MASLOW

Needs move from physiological to self-actualisation.

TRADITIONAL VERSUS MODERN MANAGEMENT — DOUGLAS MCGREGOR

Control-oriented versus freedom and persuasion-oriented styles.

INFORMAL CHANNELS — KOONTZ AND O'DONNELL

Use informal channels to supplement formal ones.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Bank staff gather before opening to hear the day’s plan.

EXAMPLE

Workshops for electricity workers to update knowledge.

EXAMPLE

A manager plants messages on the grapevine to caution disgruntled staff.

Comparison tables

Traditional versus modern management (McGregor)

Point	Traditional	Modern
View of workers	Labour or resources with basic needs	Humans with higher needs
Language	Control	Persuasion
Freedom	Little	Balance of control and freedom

Line versus staff management

Line	Staff
Manufacturing, sales	Accounting, distribution, personnel
Core activities	Support services

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Scott’s definition emphasises feedback and action.
- Functions: forecasting, organising, instructing, coordinating, controlling.
- Roles: interpersonal, informational, decisional.
- Maslow’s hierarchy applies to employees.
- McGregor: traditional versus modern.
- Flows: vertical, horizontal, crosswise, spiral.
- Types: statutory and crisis communication.
- IMS means information management system.
- Satisfied employees are more productive.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W1 Q8	p.4	Grapevine (informal channel)	MCQ
W4 Q8	p.16	McGregor's management styles	MCQ
W4 Q14	p.17	Maslow's hierarchy of needs	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Organisational communication carries ideas through formal and informal channels so that goals are achieved. Its functions include forecasting, organising, instructing, coordinating and controlling; managers play interpersonal, informational and decisional roles. Understanding Maslow's needs and McGregor's styles helps leaders persuade rather than only control. Statutory and crisis communication, line–staff coordination and a careful use of the grapevine complete the picture.

Practice questions

Q1 MCQ Who defined organisational communication as ensured by feedback to elicit actions?

A. William Scott
B. Maslow
C. McGregor
D. Mehrabian

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Scott's definition.

Q2 MCQ Which management style uses the language of persuasion?

A. Traditional
B. Modern
C. Authoritarian
D. Rigid

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** McGregor's modern style.

Q3 (MSQ) Select managerial roles.

A. Interpersonal

B. Informational

C. Decisional

D. Combative

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** These are the three roles.

Q4 (T/F) Grapevine information must always be rejected.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It can warn managers but needs filtering.

Q5 (Fill) Support services like accounting belong to _____ management.

> **Answer:** staff
> **Why:** Line handles manufacturing and sales.

Q6 (Short) Name two functions of communication in an organisation.

> **Answer:** Forecasting and controlling (also organising, instructing, coordinating).
> **Why:** Leaders also act as role models.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define organisation and Scott's definition.

☐ I know the functions and roles.

☐ I can link Maslow and McGregor to employees.

☐ I know the flow types and channels.

☐ I can explain statutory and crisis communication.

Week 5: Communication Breakdown and Business Writing

1. Lecture 21: Communication Breakdown Part I
2. Lecture 22: Communication Breakdown Part II
3. Lecture 23: Advanced Writing Skills
4. Lecture 24: Principles of Business Writing
5. Lecture 25: Types of Business Writing Part I

Lecture 21: Communication Breakdown Part I

Week 5 · Course book PDF pages 322–339 (printed pages 321–338)

Learning objectives

- Define communication barrier or breakdown with the lecture's examples.
- Classify barriers: at the source, between people, and in the organisation.
- Explain source barriers: faltering with words, uncertain content, background, wrong inference, perception, rigid categories, frozen evaluation, allness.
- Explain interpersonal barriers: limited vocabulary, emotions, distraction, poor listening, selectivity, noise, verbal–non-verbal imbalance, semantic gap.

Important definitions

COMMUNICATION BARRIER / BREAKDOWN

Anything that blocks, restricts or interferes with the smooth flow of a message so that it fails to achieve its purpose.

HOMOPHILY

A common frame of reference between sender and receiver (two doctors, two engineers).

WRONG INFERENCE

Drawing a mistaken conclusion, like mistaking a rope for a snake at dusk.

FROZEN EVALUATION

Believing a past situation will repeat unchanged.

ALLNESS (CATEGORICAL THINKING)

Using 'all' and 'every'; believing one knows everything or that everyone is against one.

COMMUNICATION SELECTIVITY

Picking out only the part of a message that interests you and ignoring the rest.

SEMANTIC GAP

A language or meaning gap caused by different uses of words.

Core concepts

Illustrative cases

- A. G. Gardiner's *On Saying Please*: the lift man throws out a passenger who says 'top' without 'please'.
- Crying baby: bottle offered, but the bed was wet.
- Train ticket: date changes after 12 midnight; passenger missed the train.
- Doctor's 'SOS' misread: it means take as needed.
- E-mail to a foreign friend: too long or too short, no reply.

Three kinds of breakdown

1. At the **source** (sender).
2. **Between people** (interpersonal).
3. **In the organisation** (discussed in later lectures).

Remedy: find the cause, choose the best solution, get feedback.

Breakdown at the source

- **Faltering for words** (leave applications, in an age of channels).
- **Uncertain content** about why you are writing or speaking.
- **Different backgrounds** (a book unread by the listener); lack of homophily.
- **Wrong inferences** (rope or snake).
- **Different perceptions.**
- **Rigid categories** ('I know nanotechnology; nothing new').
- **Frozen evaluation** (reaching early because you missed the train once).
- **Categorical thinking / allness** ('everyone is against me').

"Change is the law of nature."

Breakdown between people

- **Different perceptions of reality.**
- **Limited vocabulary** and multiple meanings ('you are very fast').
- **Emotional outbursts** and tiredness.
- **Distraction** from gadgets (laptop, phone, colleagues).
- **Poor listening**; noise from adjacent rooms.
- **Communication selectivity** (answering only a phrase in an interview).
- **Noise** (also used as an excuse).
- **Imbalance between verbal and non-verbal messages.**
- **Cultural differences** (Kenya: son-in-law and mother-in-law do not face each other; silence).
- **Language as code:** Mark Twain – the difference between the right word and the almost right word is that between lightning and a lightning bug.
- **Semantic gap:** 'loyal' misused for 'kind'; *sidewalk* (US), *pavement* (UK), *platform* (India); 'table a motion' – UK: bring up for discussion; US: postpone.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Barriers by origin

Level	Examples
Source	Faltering for words, unclear content, background, wrong inference, rigid categories, frozen evaluation, allness
Between people	Perception, vocabulary, emotions, distraction, poor listening, selectivity, noise, semantic gap, cultural differences
Organisation	Discussed in the next lectures (information overload and others)

Theories, principles, models and contributors

RIGHT WORD VERSUS ALMOST RIGHT WORD — MARK TWAIN

The difference is like lightning and a lightning bug.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

The lift man and ‘top please’.

EXAMPLE

Rope mistaken for a snake.

EXAMPLE

Doctor’s SOS tablet taken regularly.

EXAMPLE

‘Table a motion’ means bring it up in Britain but postpone in the US.

EXAMPLE

‘Sidewalk’ versus ‘pavement’ versus ‘platform’.

Comparison tables

British versus American usage

Word	British / Indian	American
Footpath	Pavement / platform	Sidewalk
Table a motion	Take up for discussion	Postpone

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- A. G. Gardiner's 'On Saying Please'.
- Three types: at the source, between people, in the organisation.
- Homophily means a common frame of reference.
- Allness uses words like all and every.
- SOS in a prescription means 'if required'.
- Mark Twain's lightning and lightning bug.
- 'Table a motion' differs in UK and US.
- Communication selectivity: hearing only what interests you.
- Rope-and-snake example of wrong inference.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W5 Q5	p.19	Semantic gap	Fill-in-the-blank
W5 Q6	p.19	Definition of communication breakdown	MCQ
W5 Q8	p.20	Sources of communication breakdown	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Communication breakdown occurs when something blocks the flow of a message. Barriers arise at the source (poor word choice, uncertain content, background, inference, perception, rigid thinking, frozen evaluation, allness), between people (vocabulary, emotion, distraction, poor listening, selectivity, noise, imbalance of verbal and non-verbal cues, semantic and cultural gaps) and in organisations. Awareness, feedback and careful choice of words reduce them.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) A common frame of reference between communicators is called:

A. Homophily
B. Selectivity
C. Allness
D. Noise

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Two doctors talk smoothly.

Q2 (MCQ) ‘Allness’ is characterised by the use of:

A. Few words

B. ‘All’ and ‘every’

C. Silence

D. Jargon

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It is categorical thinking.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are barriers between people?

A. Communication selectivity

B. Noise

C. Poor listening

D. Clear content

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Clear content helps.

Q4 (T/F) ‘Table a motion’ means the same in Britain and the US.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** UK: discuss; US: postpone.

Q5 (Fill) Mistaking a rope for a snake is a wrong _____.

> **Answer:** inference
> **Why:** It is an illusion at dusk.

Q6 (Short) What is frozen evaluation?

> **Answer:** Assuming a past event will repeat in the same way regardless of changed circumstances.
> **Why:** Change is the law of nature.

Revision checklist

☐ I know three types of breakdown.

☐ I can list source barriers.

☐ I can list interpersonal barriers.

☐ I remember Gardiner and Twain.

☐ I can give semantic gap examples.

Lecture 22: Communication Breakdown Part II

Week 5 · Course book PDF pages 340–353 (printed pages 339–352)

Learning objectives

- List the barriers to communication in organisations.
- Explain transfer stations, media richness, jargon, physical distractions, ethics and misquoting.
- Apply the remedies: non-judgmental language, empathy, listening, audience-centred messages, open climate, fewer levels, feedback.
- Recall the lecture's examples and Whitman's quotation.

Important definitions

TRANSFER STATION

An intermediate level through which a message passes in a hierarchy; at each station the message may be reframed and distorted.

MEDIA RICHNESS

The variety of channels available; the lecture stresses choosing the channel suited to the receiver's background and facilities.

LEAN MEDIA

Channels or messages for technical and objective information, which people often attend to least.

PROPER CHANNEL

Following the prescribed route of reporting rather than approaching the top directly.

MISQUOTING

Reporting what another said inaccurately; an ethical lapse.

AUDIENCE-CENTRED APPROACH

Viewing the message from the receiver's point of view ('you' attitude).

Core concepts

Organisational barriers

- **Organisational structure:** tall hierarchy, many units; 'proper channel' restricts upward communication.
- **Fear of superior's perception** – juniors withhold information.

- **Negative attitudes** of employees and managers destroy candour.
- **Status gap** between senior and junior; lack of trust; grapevine functions as a ‘purgatory force’ (release).
- **Poor communication skills** make peers avoid talking.
- **Groups and subgroups** based on religion, faith, interest threaten channels.
- **Too many transfer stations** distort messages: ‘the message sent is not always the message received’ (example: ‘a friend is passing away’ became ‘he is no more’).
- **Wrong choice of media**, ignoring the receiver’s facilities; **information overload**.
- **Technical jargon** used with non-experts.
- **Physical distractions:** noise, poor acoustics, lighting, climate, power cuts, venue.
- **Ethical issues:** misquotes, far-fetched predictions, rumours that go viral.

Overcoming the barriers

- Be **non-judgmental**; select words carefully so they are not open to another meaning.
- **Put yourself in the other’s shoes**; be empathetic; avoid unnecessary assumptions.
- Be a **good listener**.
- Avoid jargon; keep sentences and paragraphs short; consider cultural bias.
- Keep non-verbal behaviour consistent with words.
- Adopt an **audience-centred** approach.
- Create an **open communication climate**.
- **Reduce the number of levels**; use direct communication when important.
- Seek **immediate feedback**.
- Commit to ethical communication; avoid extreme statements; create lean, efficient messages.
- Select the most suitable medium for the audience background.

The assumption story

A woman waiting at a bus stop smiled at a man's baby; he asked “Are you waiting for me?” — a wrong assumption. She replied that she had a baby at home. People misconstrue messages because they do not understand others’ assumptions and perceptions.

Walt Whitman (“Song of Myself”): “I celebrate myself, and sing myself, and what I assume you shall assume, for every atom belonging to me as good belongs to you.”

Types, classifications and characteristics

Organisational barriers and remedies

Barrier	Remedy
Fear of superior	Open communication climate
Negative attitude	Empathy, non-judgmental language
Transfer stations	Reduce levels; direct communication
Wrong media / overload	Choose suitable medium; lean messages
Jargon	Plain language; short sentences
Physical noise	Suitable venue, acoustics, lighting
Misquoting / rumours	Ethical communication

Theories, principles, models and contributors

SONG OF MYSELF — WALT WHITMAN (AMERICAN POET QUOTED)

“What I assume you shall assume” — think of how the message would affect you as receiver.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

‘A friend is passing away’ transmitted as ‘he is no more’.

EXAMPLE

A woman and a man with a baby at the bus stop.

EXAMPLE

Tall hierarchy forces use of proper channel.

EXAMPLE

Newly recruited managers require plain words; senior peers may use jargon.

Comparison tables

Closed versus open communication climate

Closed / restrictive	Open
Fear of superiors	Candid exchange
Many transfer stations	Direct and fewer levels
Distrust, grapevine	Trust and business thrives

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- The message sent is not always the message received.
- Too many transfer stations distort messages.
- Media richness: choose the channel suited to the receiver.
- Reduce levels and encourage direct communication.
- Take immediate feedback.
- Whitman: what I assume you shall assume.
- Grapevine acts as a purgatory force.
- Use of jargon with non-experts is a barrier.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W5 Q1	p.19	Causes of communication breakdown	Fill-in-the-blank
W5 Q3	p.19	Ethical breakdown	Fill-in-the-blank
W5 Q8	p.20	Sources of communication breakdown	MCQ
W5 Q11	p.20	Organisational barriers	MSQ
W5 Q14	p.21	Ethics in communication	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Organisational barriers include tall hierarchies, fear of superiors, negative attitudes, mistrust, subgroups, many transfer stations, wrong media, information overload, jargon, physical distractions and unethical practices such as misquoting. They are overcome by empathy, careful words, active listening, audience-centred messages, an open climate, fewer levels, suitable media and prompt feedback.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) A message passing through many levels may be distorted because of:

A. Transfer stations

B. Homophily

C. Feedback

D. Media richness

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Each station reframes the message.

Q2 (MCQ) 'Proper channel' in an organisation refers to:

A. Following the prescribed reporting route

B. Using social media

C. Anonymous letters

D. Grapevine

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** You cannot approach the top directly.

Q3 (MSQ) Which help overcome organisational barriers?

A. Immediate feedback

B. Fewer levels

C. Heavy jargon

D. Audience-centred messages

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Jargon is a barrier.

Q4 (T/F) Grapevine is always harmful, according to the lecture.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It can act as a purgatory (releasing) force.

Q5 (Fill) A message sent is not always the message _____.

> **Answer:** received
> **Why:** Because of distortion.

Q6 (Short) Why does fear of the superior hinder communication?

> **Answer:** Juniors hold back ideas and information under the weight of the superior's post, so candour is lost.
> **Why:** An open climate is the remedy.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list organisational barriers.
☐ I understand transfer stations.
☐ I can list remedies.
☐ I remember the passing-away story.
☐ I can quote Whitman.

Lecture 23: Advanced Writing Skills

Week 5 · Course book PDF pages 354–375 (printed pages 353–374)

Learning objectives

- Explain why writing matters and the features of advanced writing (conceptualise, research, draft, revise, reader-centred).
- Differentiate informative and persuasive writing.
- Apply directness, simple words and short sentences, and outlining.
- List the nine writing patterns with examples.

Important definitions

ADVANCED WRITING

Professional, technical and scientific writing (proposals, reports, technical descriptions, business letters) based on a concept, research, drafting and revision, and centred on the reader.

READER-CENTRED WRITING

Writing planned from the reader's point of view; it uses the 'you' tone.

INFORMATIVE WRITING

Writing that conveys information as it is (e.g. stock verification form).

PERSUASIVE / ARGUMENTATIVE WRITING

Writing that explains, contradicts, counters arguments and convinces, with an assertive tone (thesis, dissertation).

OUTLINE

A tentative plan with main topics, sub-topics and supporting points, like the tailor's cutting plan.

DIRECTNESS

Expressing the point plainly, without circumlocution.

Core concepts

Why writing matters

- Francis Bacon: **"Reading maketh a full man, conference a ready man, and writing an exact man."**
- Reveals personality, grasp of language and reasoning in your absence.
- Serves as a **record** (now through word processing and databases).

- Professional work needs proposals, reports, manuals, technical descriptions and letters (credit, collection, complaint, adjustment).

Stages of advanced writing

1. **Conceptualise** – have an idea; testify with truth and objectivity.
2. **Research** – books and papers to support the concept.
3. **Draft** – structure suited to report, letter, proposal or description.
4. **Revise** – add, delete, check against the audience.
5. Check that the writing is **reader-centric**.

Ask first: **Why** am I writing and for **whom**? Aims: express, inform, convince, persuade.

Style rules

- **Directness** – plain, candid language, no circumlocution.
- Short sentences (6–8 words are simple; 20–30 words are hard).
- Familiar words; avoid jargon with lay readers; avoid pompous or wordy language; do not sacrifice meaning for brevity.
- Make an outline; ensure unity, coherence and logic.
- Put the verb early: "Please submit the report to me no later than 5 p.m. tomorrow" (better than "You will do me a personal favour…").
- Keep SVA (subject–verb agreement) and active voice; use 'you' tone.
- **Alexander Pope:** "True ease in writing comes from art, not chance, as those move easiest who have learned to dance."

Nine writing patterns

1. **Direct plan** – good or routine news first: "Congratulations! Your proposal…".
2. **Indirect plan** – bad news: buffer, reasons, negative in the middle, positive ending (job-rejection example).
3. **Order of importance** – most important reason first (recommendation letter).
4. **Chronology** – time sequence (resume, incident report).
5. **Problem–solution.**
6. **Causal** – cause to effect or the reverse (Pali losing speakers).
7. **Spatial** – by geography (sales north, south, east, west).
8. **Structural** – by parts or structure (bonus, hike, compensation; course objective).
9. **Topical** – breaks topics into subtopics.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Nine patterns of writing

Pattern	Use
Direct plan	Good or routine news
Indirect plan	Bad or unpleasant news
Order of importance	Recommendations; ranked reasons
Chronology	Resume, incident report
Problem–solution	Proposals
Causal	Cause–effect analysis
Spatial	Geographical description
Structural	Parts of a plan or course
Topical	Subtopics

Theories, principles, models and contributors

WRITING MAKES AN EXACT MAN — FRANCIS BACON

Called the father of the essay; his essays are aphoristic.

EASE IN WRITING — ALEXANDER POPE

Art, not chance, produces ease.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

“Congratulations! Your proposal for the workshop has evoked interest.” (direct)

EXAMPLE

“Thank you for your application... Because of our size and reputation we review...” (indirect rejection)

EXAMPLE

Resume year by year (chronology).

EXAMPLE

“Pali is losing 60% significance because of fewer users.” (causal)

Comparison tables

Informative versus persuasive writing

Point	Informative	Persuasive
Purpose	Convey facts as they are	Convince, counter arguments
Tone	Neutral	Assertive, argumentative
Example	Stock verification form	Thesis, dissertation

Direct versus indirect plan

Direct	Indirect
Main point first	Buffer first, bad news later
Good/routine news	Unpleasant news
Pleasant tone	Guarded with positive ending

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Bacon: writing maketh an exact man.
- Stages: conceptualise, research, draft, revise.
- Ask why and for whom.
- Nine patterns: direct, indirect, order of importance, chronology, problem–solution, causal, spatial, structural, topical.
- Bad news goes in the indirect plan with a positive ending.
- Short sentences of 6–8 words are simple.
- Pope: true ease in writing comes from art, not chance.
- Writing serves as a record.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W5 Q2	p.19	Goal of business writing	Fill-in-the-blank
W5 Q4	p.19	Direct and indirect plans in writing	Fill-in-the-blank
W5 Q9	p.20	Patterns of organising writing	MCQ
W5 Q12	p.21	Features of effective writing	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Advanced writing is concept-based, researched, drafted, revised and reader-centred. It should be direct, simple and short-sentenced, planned with an outline. Informative writing reports facts; persuasive writing argues. Choose among nine patterns – direct, indirect, order of importance, chronology, problem–solution, causal, spatial, structural, topical – and put bad news in the indirect plan with a positive close.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) 'Writing maketh an exact man' is by:

A. Alexander Pope

B. Francis Bacon

C. Mark Twain

D. Freud

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** From Bacon's essay on studies.

Q2 (MCQ) Which plan is suited to unpleasant news?

A. Direct

B. Indirect

C. Chronological

D. Spatial

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Buffer, explain, close positively.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are among the nine patterns?

A. Causal

B. Spatial

C. Topical

D. Emotional

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Emotional is not a pattern.

Q4 (T/F) A resume is best organised chronologically.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** Year-wise listing.

Q5 (Fill) Before writing, ask why you are writing and for _____.

> **Answer:** whom
> **Why:** Reader-centred writing.

Q6 Short List the stages of advanced writing.

> **Answer:** Conceptualise, research, draft, revise and check for reader-centricity.
> **Why:** Make an outline too.

Revision checklist

☐ I can recall Bacon and Pope.
☐ I know the stages of writing.
☐ I can distinguish informative and persuasive writing.
☐ I can list the nine patterns.
☐ I can rewrite sentences with the verb first.

Lecture 24: Principles of Business Writing

Week 5 · Course book PDF pages 376–392 (printed pages 375–391)

Learning objectives

- List the 5 Cs of business writing: clarity, courtesy, consideration, conciseness, cordiality.
- Explain how to achieve clarity, conciseness, courtesy and consideration with before-and-after examples.
- Recall the quotations of T. S. Eliot and Oscar Wilde and the maxim ‘express, not impress’.
- Rewrite negative and wordy sentences using the you-attitude.

Important definitions

CLARITY

Writing that is unambiguous, plain and easily understood so that action can follow.

COURTESY

Respect shown to the reader in tone and word choice, even when information is dry.

CONSIDERATION

Writing from the reader’s viewpoint (the ‘you’ approach), so no one is hurt.

CONCISENESS

Being brief without sacrificing meaning; removing redundant words and flabby phrases.

CORDIALITY

Warmth and goodwill sustained in writing, since business is dealing with people.

FOGGY WRITING

Unclear, cloudy messages produced by unskilled writers who have not learnt to communicate clearly.

Core concepts

The 5 Cs

1. **Clarity** – ambiguity is an unwelcome guest in business.
2. **Courtesy**
3. **Consideration**
4. **Conciseness**

5. **Cordiality**

Goal: **express, not impress**; impress through simplicity and clarity.

Clarity

- Unskilled writers produce foggy messages; use familiar words.
- Example: "Employees have not been made sufficiently aware of the potentially adverse consequences..." → **"Warn your employees about these chemicals."**
- It is better to use a few more words than fewer words that are difficult.
- **T. S. Eliot:** "Do not use big words too big for the subject; do not say 'infinitely' when you mean 'very'."

Conciseness: shorter expressions

- a number of → **many**
- at your earliest possible convenience → **soon**
- fullest possible extent → **fully**
- it would be unreasonable to assume → **I assume**
- "There are three things I want you to do" → "I want you to do three things."
- Remove needless repetitions and redundant phrases; avoid excessive noun habit and pompous words; revise last. "Brevity is the soul of wit."

Courtesy and consideration: rewriting

- "You cannot meet the director; don't you know he is out of station?" → "Thanks for your interest; today he is out of station. We will call you when he returns."
- "Will you send me 125 geysers at the official rate?" → "We require 125 geysers and expect to buy at the official rate."
- "The executive meeting is postponed." → "We regret the inconvenience; the meeting has been postponed for unavoidable reasons."
- "You must know that PAN alone can make online tax procedure easy." → "We would appreciate your PAN number; it will make tax procedure smoother."
- "Your project is returned; no more funds this year." → "Thanks for submitting; we regret we lack funds this year, but will let you know once funds are available."
- Complaint about ACs: "We have received several complaints about the ACs supplied by us; we look forward to knowing what can be done." (you-attitude)
- Put the negative in the middle and end positively; give hope.

Cordiality

- Avoid negative starts: "You are not a member, we cannot entertain you" → "We entertain our members; we expect you to join."
- "Your report is unsatisfactory" → "We appreciate a detailed report."
- "You should not ignore the official instructions" → "All of us follow the official timing: reports are due Friday."
- **Oscar Wilde:** "If you pretend to be good, the world takes you very seriously." Keep hope alive, since a bad deal with a customer can cost an organisation heavily.

Types, classifications and characteristics

The 5 Cs

C	Meaning	Tip
Clarity	Unambiguous message	Use familiar words
Courtesy	Respect for reader	Polite tone
Consideration	Reader's viewpoint	You-attitude
Conciseness	Brief but complete	Cut redundancy
Cordiality	Warm goodwill	Positive framing

Theories, principles, models and contributors

BIG WORDS — T. S. ELIOT

"Do not use big words too big for the subject."

PRETENDING TO BE GOOD — OSCAR WILDE

Quoted to encourage optimism in writing.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

"Warn your employees about these chemicals."

EXAMPLE

"We grew hot and cold" (flowery) → "We have received complaints about the ACs."

EXAMPLE

Rejecting a project politely with hope.

EXAMPLE

"Many" replaces "a number of".

Comparison tables

Wordy versus concise

Wordy	Concise
A number of	Many
At your earliest possible convenience	Soon
Fullest possible extent	Fully
It would be unreasonable to assume	I assume
There are three things I want you to do	I want you to do three things

Express versus impress

Express	Impress
Make the reader understand	Show off difficult words
Goal of business writing	Not the goal

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- 5 Cs: clarity, courtesy, consideration, conciseness, cordiality.
- Goal of business writing: to express, not to impress.
- Eliot: do not use big words; do not say infinitely for very.
- Put negative news in the middle and end positively.
- Brevity is the soul of wit.
- Revision is the last task in writing.
- Wilde quote on pretending to be good.
- ‘Warn your employees about these chemicals’ example.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W5 Q10	p.20	Stages of the writing process	Ordering (MCQ)
W5 Q15	p.21	Principles of business writing	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Good business writing follows the 5 Cs. Express rather than impress: use plain, familiar words, cut redundant phrases and avoid foggy sentences. Show courtesy and consideration by taking the reader’s

viewpoint, soften negatives, put bad news in the middle and end with hope, and keep cordiality so that relationships and business continue.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The goal of business writing is to:

A. Impress

B. Express

C. Confuse

D. Entertain

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Clarity over show.

Q2 (MCQ) 'At your earliest possible convenience' can be replaced by:

A. Soon

B. Never

C. Someday

D. Quickly please

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Shorter and clear.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are among the 5 Cs?

A. Clarity

B. Courtesy

C. Criticism

D. Cordiality

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Criticism is not a C.

Q4 (T/F) Eliot advised using the biggest words available.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** He advised against big words.

Q5 (Fill) Put negative news in the _____ and end positively.

> **Answer:** middle
> **Why:** Indirect plan.

Q6 Short How do you make a complaint letter considerate?

> **Answer:** State the facts politely from the receiver's viewpoint and ask what can be done, avoiding anger.
> **Why:** Use the you-attitude.

Revision checklist

- ☐ I can list the 5 Cs.
- ☐ I know the concise replacements.
- ☐ I can rewrite rude sentences politely.
- ☐ I remember Eliot and Wilde.
- ☐ I know express vs impress.

Lecture 25: Types of Business Writing Part I

Week 5 · Course book PDF pages 393–410 (printed pages 392–409)

Learning objectives

- List the types of business writing: letters, reports, memos, letter reports, circulars, e-mails, technical proposals, research papers.
- Define a memo, state its purposes, tone and format.
- Differentiate memo, memo report, letter report and circular.
- Describe the types of circulars.

Important definitions

MEMO (INTER-OFFICE MEMORANDUM)

A short, informal piece of business writing circulated within an organisation to confirm, suggest, inform, explain, announce, report or warn.

MEMO REPORT

A memo written in report form for a longer explanation.

LETTER REPORT

A report written in business-letter format; less informal than a memo, longer (about 2–3 pages), may go inside or outside the organisation, with an inside address, salutation and complimentary close.

CIRCULAR

A document circulated within (or sometimes outside) an organisation to inform, create awareness or announce policy, products or programmes.

CC (CARBON COPY)

A line at the end on the left, listing persons who receive a copy.

Core concepts

Types of business writing

- Business letters (sell, buy, order, remind)
- Reports
- Memos
- Letter reports
- Circulars

- Electronic mails
- Technical proposals
- Research papers

Follow the standards and practices of your organisation.

Purposes of a memo

- **Confirm** (meeting outcomes)
- **Suggest** action
- **Inform / explain** (why something went wrong)
- **Announce** policies, hikes, DA, products
- **Request / report** information
- **Warn** (late coming, misuse of photocopier) without offending, because the tone is informal

A memo is not always a threat.

Format of a memo

- **Letterhead** (organisation name) at the top centre.
- **To** and **From** on the left; From shows the **designation**, not the name.
- **Reference number and date** on the right.
- **Subject line** in the middle, explicit.
- **No salutation and no complimentary close**; direct, short, specific, conversational, informal.
- Body: problem → explanation → action required.
- Writer's name at the end (right); **cc** on the left.

Sample memo: from Dean (Admission) to all heads about dissatisfactory campus placement; proposes faculty development training and meeting heads; cc Dean Academics.

Letter report

- Letterhead, date, inside address, subject, formal salutation ('Dear Sir'), introduction, findings, complimentary close, signature, enclosures (with number of pages).
- Longer than a memo (1 page memo, 2–3 pages letter report); includes discussion and illustrations; less formal than a full formal report.
- Example: report on a faculty development programme.

Circular

- Purpose: inform, create awareness, matters of general interest.
- Use a memo for people within the organisation; use a circular for larger audiences including outside.
- Structure: introduction, details, relevant information; short unless required.
- Letterhead on top centre, 'Circular', content, signature.
- Revise carefully for spelling and grammar because reputation is at stake.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of circulars

Type	Audience / purpose
Informative circular	Factual; introduction, details, relevant information
Public circular	General awareness to large, spread-out audiences (e.g. child labour policy)
Partnership / company circular	Partners, shareholders and stakeholders
Official circular	Wide audience in organisations; longer and carefully worded

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Dean (Admission) memo on placements and faculty development.

EXAMPLE

Letter report on faculty development training.

EXAMPLE

Warning memo about misuse of the photocopier.

Comparison tables

Memo versus letter report versus circular

Point	Memo	Letter report	Circular
Audience	Within organisation	Inside or outside	Within; sometimes public
Tone	Informal	Less informal	Informal yet formal
Length	Short (about one page)	2–3 pages	Short unless needed
Salutation / close	None	Yes	None
Address	To / From	Inside address	Letterhead

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Memo = inter-office memorandum.
- A memo has no salutation or complimentary close.
- From line shows designation.
- Reference number and date on the right.
- cc line at the end left.
- Letter report may have 2–3 pages and enclosures.
- Four circular types: informative, public, partnership/company, official.
- Memo purposes: confirm, suggest, inform, explain, announce, report, warn.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W5 Q2	p.19	Goal of business writing	Fill-in-the-blank
W5 Q13	p.21	Internal business documents	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Business writing includes letters, reports, memos, letter reports, circulars, e-mails, proposals and research papers. A memo is a short, informal intra-office document with letterhead, To/From (designation), reference and date, subject line and body but no salutation or close. A letter report is a longer, letter-format report that may go outside; a circular informs larger audiences and has four types.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) A memo does NOT contain:

A. Subject line

B. Salutation

C. Date

D. Reference number

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** No salutation or complimentary close.

Q2 (MCQ) In a memo, the ‘From’ line shows:

A. Name only

B. Designation

C. Address

D. Phone number

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Designation is written, not name.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are types of circulars?

A. Informative

B. Public

C. Official

D. Private diary

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Partnership/company is also a type.

Q4 (T/F) A letter report is always shorter than a memo.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It is longer (2–3 pages).

Q5 (Fill) A memo is also called an _____ memorandum.

> **Answer:** inter-office
> **Why:** It circulates within the organisation.

Q6 (Short) State two purposes of a memo.

> **Answer:** To confirm a meeting outcome and to announce a policy (also suggest, explain, report, warn).
> **Why:** Tone remains informal.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list types of business writing.

☐ I know memo format.

☐ I can compare memo, letter report and circular.

☐ I know four circular types.

☐ I know memo purposes.

Week 6: Business Writing and Business Letters

1. Lecture 26: Types of Business Writing Part II
2. Lecture 27: Business Letters
3. Lecture 28: Business Letters: Format & Style
4. Lecture 29: Types of Business Letters Part I
5. Lecture 30: Types of Business Letters Part II

Lecture 26: Types of Business Writing Part II

Week 6 · Course book PDF pages 411–428 (printed pages 410–427)

Learning objectives

- Draft a notice, agenda and minutes of a meeting with correct format and language.
- Write professional e-mails following netiquette.
- Differentiate research paper types: journal paper, conference paper, review article, thesis, term paper, technical paper.
- Plan a research paper: title, literature review, outline, statement of purpose, revision, references.

Important definitions

NOTICE

Pre-information about a meeting stating the issuer, venue, date, time and agenda; sent several days in advance.

AGENDA

From *agendum*: the list of items to be discussed in a meeting, prepared with the chairman; usually attached to the notice.

MINUTES

A sequential written record of the happenings in a meeting, prepared by the secretary in consultation with the chairman, in the past tense.

NOTE OF DISSENT

A written disagreement a member may submit when he does not agree with the minutes or decisions.

RESEARCH PAPER

A document presenting a new finding or analysis, supported by evidence and references.

REVIEW ARTICLE

An article that examines and evaluates a new book, film or development in a field.

Core concepts

Notice of a meeting

- Organisation name at top centre; heading **NOTICE**.

- State the number of the meeting (e.g. 10th meeting), body (board of directors / executive committee), date, day, time, venue and mention that the agenda is attached.
- Issue **well in advance (4–5 days)** unless urgent.
- Signed by the secretary (hard copy).

Agenda

- Items numbered as 5.1, 5.2 (meeting number.item number).
- **First item:** confirmation of the minutes of the previous meeting.
- **Last item:** any other matter with the permission of the chair.
- Prepared with the chairman; not attached for urgent or secret meetings.

Minutes

- Written by the secretary after the meeting (a day or two later), finalised with the chairman and circulated.
- Heading: organisation, **Minutes of the Nth meeting**, date and venue; chairman first, then members present; absentees listed after the secretary.
- Language: simple, specific, **past tense**, often passive (“was discussed”).
- Items follow the agenda sequence: 10.1 confirmation of minutes, 10.2 chairman’s report, 10.3 provision of laptops for office staff, … any other matter (canteen) … “The meeting ended with a vote of thanks to the chair.”
- Secretary signs, chairman signs on the left, with date.
- Not everything is recorded (off-the-record remarks); minutes serve as a record for future reference.
- An e-mail is only a medium; minutes are authentic when signed.

E-mail etiquette

- Use proper salutation for official mail; keep it short and specific; no sarcasm.
- **Avoid capital letters** (they are like shouting); use correct punctuation.
- Limit cc to those concerned (information load).
- Keep the signature line brief; check that the attachment is really attached.
- Avoid long emotional e-mails; remember that e-mails can be official records.

Research papers

- Organisations use R&D and incubation centres.
- Types: **technical paper**, **conference paper** (presented to peers), **journal paper** (for publication), **review article**, thesis, term paper.
- Steps: select a **specific title** → literature review in libraries → **outline** → **statement of purpose** → analysis and findings → conclusion → **revision** (language, grammar, addition, deletion) → bibliography/references.
- Title capitalisation: main words only, not prepositions or connectives.
- Examples: “Importance of soft skills at workplace”; “Role of media in women empowerment”.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of research writing

Type	Purpose
Technical paper	Detailed technical content, jargon allowed
Conference paper	Presented to peers for feedback
Journal paper	Submitted for publication per journal style
Review article	Evaluate a new book, film or work
Thesis / term paper	Academic requirement

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Notice of the 10th meeting of the board with agenda attached.

EXAMPLE

Minutes 10.1 – confirmation of previous minutes; 10.2 chairman’s report; any other matter – canteen arrangement.

EXAMPLE

E-mail sent with the attachment missing.

Comparison tables

Notice versus agenda versus minutes

Document	Time	Content
Notice	Before meeting	Date, time, venue, issuer
Agenda	Before meeting	List of items to discuss
Minutes	After meeting	Record of what happened (past tense)

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Notice is pre-information of a meeting.
- First agenda item: confirmation of previous minutes.
- Last agenda item: any other matter with the permission of the chair.
- Minutes are written in the past tense by the secretary.
- Item numbering such as 5.1 means meeting 5, item 1.
- Capitals in e-mail are like shouting.
- Agenda comes from agendum.
- Revision is the best antidote before sending a paper.
- Absentees are listed in minutes.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W5 Q13	p.21	Internal business documents	MSQ
W6 Q6	p.22	Research paper	MCQ
W6 Q8	p.23	Minutes of a meeting	MCQ
W6 Q13	p.24	E-mail etiquette	MSQ
W6 Q14	p.24	Meeting documentation	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

A meeting is documented through a notice (issued days ahead with date, time, venue and agenda), an agenda (numbered items beginning with confirmation of previous minutes and ending with any other matter) and minutes (a signed, past-tense, sequential record). E-mails need brevity, courtesy and care with cc, capitals and attachments. Research papers require a specific title, literature review, outline, statement of purpose, revision and references.

Practice questions

Q1 MCQ The first item in the agenda is:

A. Any other matter

B. Confirmation of the minutes of the previous meeting

C. Vote of thanks

D. Chairman’s speech

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It is always the first item.

Q2 (MCQ) Minutes are written in the:

A. Future tense

B. Past tense

C. Present tense

D. Imperative

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** They record what happened.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are e-mail do's?

A. Avoid capitals

B. Check attachments

C. Send to everyone through cc

D. Keep it brief

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Limit cc.

Q4 (T/F) A notice should be issued only a day before a routine meeting.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Give 4–5 days unless urgent.

Q5 (Fill) Item '10.3' means the _____ item of the 10th meeting.

> **Answer:** third
> **Why:** Meeting number then item number.

Q6 (Short) What is a note of dissent?

> **Answer:** A written statement by a member who disagrees with a decision or the minutes.
> **Why:** It is recorded with the minutes.

Revision checklist

☐ I can draft a notice.

☐ I know agenda rules.

☐ I can write minutes in the right tense.

☐ I know e-mail etiquette.

☐ I know research paper steps.

Lecture 27: Business Letters

Week 6 · Course book PDF pages 429–449 (printed pages 428–448)

Learning objectives

- Explain the functions of business letters and how they differ from personal letters.
- List the ten parts of a business letter and the rules for each.
- State the correct salutation, closing and signature conventions.
- Recall Lord Chesterfield's advice on politeness.

Important definitions

BUSINESS LETTER

A formal written communication between an organisation and a customer, firm or individual for business purposes: direct, neutral in tone, simple in language, kept as record.

LETTERHEAD

The printed heading with organisation name, logo, address, telephone, fax and website.

INSIDE ADDRESS

The address of the recipient, written accurately with title and full name.

SUBJECT LINE

A clear one-line statement of what the letter is about.

COMPLIMENTARY CLOSE

The polite closing phrase such as 'Yours faithfully' or 'Yours sincerely'.

IDENTIFICATION MARKS

Initials of the dictator and the typist, e.g. BM/LKI.

ENCLOSURES

Attached documents; the number of pages is stated in brackets.

Core concepts

Why business letters still matter

- Maintain rapport with customers, clients and shareholders; speed up business.

- Serve as **record** for future reference and quasi-MOU (memorandum of understanding) of the dealings.
- Promote products, get feedback, expand business beyond a region.
- The writer represents the organisation; reveals personality and ability; employers want written skills.
- Horace Walpole's lady: "I write to you because I have nothing to do; I finish my letter because I have nothing to say."

Business versus personal letters

- **Tone:** business letters are neutral, formal, direct, cordial; no sarcasm or emotion.
- **Content:** only business; personal letters (Charles Lamb, Thomas Gray, Carlyle, Robert Lynd, A. G. Gardiner, Lord Chesterfield) can talk about weather and family.
- **Language:** simple; no sesquipedalian (long) words or long sentences.
- Time is a commodity; come to the point at once.

Ten parts of a business letter

1. **Letterhead** – follow your organisation's style (centre, left or right).
2. **Date line** – month first (March 10, 2017) or numeric; follow organisation practice.
3. **Reference** – both 'Our ref.' and 'Your ref.'.
4. **Inside address** – full, accurate; use Shri/Dr/Mr/Ms; if name unknown write designation.
5. **Subject line**
6. **Salutation** – 'Dear Sir/Madam' (do not drop 'Dear'); comma optional in full block.
7. **Body** – usually 3 paragraphs: opening (direct), discussion/details, closing.
8. **Complimentary close** – Yours faithfully/sincerely (no apostrophe in 'Yours').
9. **Signature line** – typed name in brackets; leave two lines gap for signature; 'for' when writing on behalf.
10. **Enclosures** (and identification marks) – state number of pages; e.g. cheque, receipt, order copy.

Closing lines

- Avoid participial endings such as "Waiting to see you" or "Hoping to get your response".
- Use complete sentences: "I look forward to receiving your answer soon.", "I hope to hear from you soon."
- Yours truly / yours cordially are less common; a student may write 'yours obediently'. Yours faithfully (unknown name) or yours sincerely are safest.

Politeness

Lord Chesterfield: politeness is as much concerned in answering letters within a reasonable time as in returning a bow immediately. Letters are an exchange of goodwill and build relationships.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Ten parts of a business letter

No.	Part	Key point
1	Letterhead	Name, logo, address, phone, fax, website
2	Date	Month first or numeric per organisation
3	Reference	Our and your reference
4	Inside address	Accurate name and address
5	Subject line	Clear topic
6	Salutation	Dear Sir/Madam
7	Body	Three paragraphs
8	Complimentary close	Yours faithfully/sincerely
9	Signature line	Name typed, space for signature
10	Enclosures	List, with number of pages

Theories, principles, models and contributors

POLITENESS IN LETTERS — LORD CHESTERFIELD

Answer letters within a reasonable time.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Subject lines: “Regarding replacement of solar panel batteries”; “Transfer of my savings account”; “Regarding the status of my article”.

EXAMPLE

Inside address: Shri Rajkumar Bhatt, 25 Winter Mayor Cottage, Summer Hills, Shimla, Himachal Pradesh.

EXAMPLE

Identification marks BM/LKI.

Comparison tables

Business versus personal letter

Point	Business	Personal
Tone	Formal, neutral, cordial	Informal, emotional
Content	Only business	Family, weather, feelings
Format	Fixed ten parts	Free
Record value	High	Low

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- A business letter has at least ten parts.
- Use ‘Dear Sir/Madam’.
- Yours faithfully / sincerely; no apostrophe after ‘Yours’.
- Reference includes ‘our reference’ and ‘your reference’.
- Body usually has three paragraphs.
- Identification marks: dictator’s and typist’s initials.
- Enclosures with number of pages.
- Lord Chesterfield on prompt reply.
- Follow the organisation’s letterhead and date style.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W6 Q2	p.22	Closing of business letters	Fill-in-the-blank
W6 Q4	p.22	Tone of business letters	Fill-in-the-blank

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Business letters keep organisations and customers in touch, serve as records and reveal the writer’s skill. They are formal, neutral and direct, unlike personal letters. The standard structure has ten parts – letterhead, date, reference, inside address, subject, salutation, body, complimentary close, signature and enclosures – and requires accuracy, courtesy and prompt replies.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) A business letter has at least how many parts?

A. 5

B. 8

C. 10

D. 15

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Ten parts.

Q2 (MCQ) The safest complimentary close for a letter to an unnamed person is:

A. Yours faithfully

B. Love

C. Cheers

D. Bye

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Yours faithfully / sincerely.

Q3 (MSQ) Which belong to the structure of a business letter?

A. Subject line

B. Enclosures

C. Poem

D. Inside address

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** There is no poem.

Q4 (T/F) A business letter may include weather and family news.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It deals only with business.

Q5 (Fill) Both ‘our’ and ‘your’ _____ are written in a business letter.

> **Answer:** reference
> **Why:** To trace correspondence.

Q6 (Short) How should a business letter be closed?

> **Answer:** With a complete sentence such as ‘I look forward to hearing from you soon’, then ‘Yours faithfully/sincerely’.
> **Why:** Avoid ‘hoping to…’ endings.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list the ten parts.
☐ I know the date and reference conventions.
☐ I know the correct complimentary close.
☐ I can explain business vs personal letters.
☐ I recall Chesterfield.

Lecture 28: Business Letters: Format & Style

Week 6 · Course book PDF pages 450–466 (printed pages 449–465)

Learning objectives

- Describe the four letter formats: full block, modified block, semi-block (indented), simplified.
- State the punctuation rules (open punctuation) and placement of date, close and signature for each.
- Apply style rules: reader-friendly, you-approach, thank-you opening, positive language, active/passive voice, I versus we.
- Rewrite negative letter sentences positively.

Important definitions

FULL BLOCK FORMAT

All parts (date, address, salutation, subject, body, close, signature, enclosures) are aligned to the left margin; open punctuation; the most common format in organisations.

MODIFIED BLOCK FORMAT

Address, subject, salutation and body paragraphs on the left; date, complimentary close and signature between the centre and the right margin.

SEMI-BLOCK (INDENTED) FORMAT

Like modified block but paragraphs are indented.

SIMPLIFIED FORMAT

Used when the recipient’s name or gender is unknown: no salutation, no complimentary close; subject line and attention line; date and writer's name aligned on the right.

OPEN PUNCTUATION

No punctuation in the inside address, salutation and complimentary close; punctuation only in the body.

ATTENTION LINE

A line (in capitals) directing the letter to a particular person or post, e.g. ATTENTION: Finance Officer.

Core concepts

Four formats

1. **Full block** – everything on the left; no commas after date or address; double space between salutation and subject; typed name in brackets with gap for signature; designation below.
2. **Modified block** – date, close and signature between right margin and centre; body blocked; sometimes a colon after 'Dear Sir'.
3. **Semi-block** – same as modified, but **paragraphs indented**; date in the middle or right; inside address at left.
4. **Simplified** – no salutation or close; use subject and attention line; writer's name on right; like a memo; easy to type.

Always follow the practice of your organisation.

Salutation when gender is unknown

Write 'Dear' plus the first name (Dear Rahil, Dear Stella, Dear Stephanie).

Opening and closing

- Reply letters begin with **thanks** ("Thank you for your letter dated ..." / mention reference no.).
- Come straight to the point: "Please find enclosed...".
- Last line should be cordial, reinforcing goodwill (you-approach); mention enclosures.

Style of business letters

- **Reader-friendly, you-approach** – imagine receiving your own letter.
- **Courtesy** – thank-you note connects with earlier correspondence.
- **Consideration** – short, to the point; do not write in anger; **do not blame the reader**; avoid many negatives.
- **Be specific** – mention model, colour, design in orders; specific letters get quicker replies.
- **Simple and precise** words, natural tone.
- **I versus we:** use 'we' when representing the organisation; 'I' for personal informal tone.
- **Voice:** active for good news; passive for indirect or defensive messages.

Positive rewriting

- "If you do not pay on time, we will lose you as a customer" → "We appreciate timely payment to continue a relationship with our customers."
- "Your refrigerator's warranty has expired; service on payment" → "We welcome you as a valued customer; for goods out of warranty, service is available on payment."
- "We are glad we can now send your Xerox machine" → "Please find your new Xerox machine; we look forward to receiving orders from our valued customers."
- "Your application cannot be entertained; try next year" → "May we request you to submit a detailed resume with full educational details?"
- "We are not responsible for damages in transportation" → "Though we take care in quality control, things can go wrong in transit; we are always ready to serve you."

Types, classifications and characteristics

Letter formats compared

Feature	Full block	Modified block	Semi-block	Simplified
Date	Left	Right/centre-right	Right/middle	Right
Paragraphs	Blocked	Blocked	Indented	Blocked
Salutation	Yes	Yes (colon optional)	Yes	None
Close	Left	Right/centre-right	Right/centre-right	None
Subject line	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes (plus attention line)

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

“Dear Rahil” when the gender is unknown.

EXAMPLE

Attention: Finance Officer / Registrar.

EXAMPLE

Subject: Regarding excursion (simplified format letter to the Regional Tourist Officer).

Comparison tables

Negative versus positive phrasing

Negative	Positive
Your warranty has expired	Service is available on payment for out-of-warranty goods
We will lose you as a customer	We appreciate timely payment
Your application cannot be entertained	We request a detailed resume

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Four formats: full block, modified block, semi-block, simplified.
- Full block: all on the left margin.
- Open punctuation: none in address, salutation and close.
- Semi-block: indented paragraphs.
- Simplified: no salutation or close; attention line.
- When gender unknown: Dear + first name.
- Begin replies with thanks and reference.
- Do not blame the reader.
- Use ‘we’ for the organisation.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W6 Q1	p.22	Simplified letter format	Fill-in-the-blank

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Business letters are laid out in four formats – full block (all left), modified block (date, close and signature right of centre), semi-block (indented paragraphs) and simplified (no salutation or close, with subject and attention line). Whatever the format, style must be reader-friendly: thank, be specific and brief, avoid blame and negatives, use ‘we’ for the organisation and keep a positive, cordial tone.

Practice questions

Q1 MCQ In which format are paragraphs indented?

A. Full block
B. Semi-block
C. Simplified
D. None

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Semi-block has indented paragraphs.

Q2 (MCQ) Which format omits the salutation and complimentary close?

A. Full block

B. Modified block

C. Semi-block

D. Simplified

> **Answer:** D
> **Why:** It resembles a memo.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are features of full block?

A. All parts at left

B. Open punctuation

C. Indented paragraphs

D. Used widely

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Indentation belongs to semi-block.

Q4 (T/F) In style, one should blame the reader for the error.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Do not blame the reader.

Q5 (Fill) If the recipient's gender is unknown, write ‘Dear’ followed by the _____ name.

> **Answer:** first
> **Why:** E.g. Dear Stella.

Q6 (Short) Rewrite: ‘Your application cannot be entertained.’

> **Answer:** May we request you to submit a detailed resume with complete educational details?
> **Why:** Positive wording.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the four formats.

☐ I know open punctuation.

☐ I can rewrite negatives positively.

☐ I know I vs we.

☐ I know when to use the simplified format.

Lecture 29: Types of Business Letters Part I

Week 6 · Course book PDF pages 467–485 (printed pages 466–484)

Learning objectives

- List the types of business letters.
- Write a sales letter using the AIDA technique.
- Draft letters of enquiry, responses to enquiries, order letters, credit letters and refusal letters.
- Apply Sir Ernest Gowers' advice on courtesy.

Important definitions

SALES LETTER

A letter written like an advertisement to promote a product and convert the reader into a customer.

AIDA

Attention, Interest, Desire, Action: the pattern for sales letters.

LETTER OF ENQUIRY

A letter seeking information about a product or service; main idea first, polite command ending in a period.

ORDER LETTER

A letter placing an order; specific, direct, lists items vertically and states the payment procedure.

CREDIT LETTER

A request to purchase on credit, supported by valid credit references.

REFUSAL LETTER

A letter declining a request without breaking goodwill; gives reasons and keeps hope.

Core concepts

Types of business letters

Sales letters, letters of enquiry, placing orders, letters of credit, collection letters, refusal letters, claim letters, adjustment letters and letters of recognition. All business letters are goodwill letters.

Sir Ernest Gowers' rule

- If he is rude, be specially courteous.

- If he is muddle-headed, be specially lucid.
- If he is pig-headed, be patient.
- If he is helpful, be appreciative.
- If he convicts you of a mistake, acknowledge it (with gratitude).

Planning any letter

Three As: **Analysis, Anticipation, Adaptation** – determine your purpose, anticipate the reader's reaction, adapt and organise carefully; proofread.

Sales letter and AIDA

- **Introduction (Attention):** striking statement, significant point, quotation, question, special appeal, central selling point.
- **Body (Interest and Desire):** trial offers, guarantees, free samples, brochures.
- **Close (Action):** positive call to action, e.g. “Send your order today and be the first in town to own our new television.”
- Avoid exaggeration (ethical limit) and negatives (“Do not miss…”).

Letter of enquiry and its reply

- **Enquiry:** main idea first; polite command ending in a period; appreciation at the end (“I appreciate this information, which will enable me to decide on 45 ACs.”); subject line should be clear.
- **Reply:** good news first; avoid dull openings (“Lying before me is your letter…”); begin “Please find the information you requested…”; answer all queries sequentially; use lists or bullets; enclose brochures/coupons to promote other products.
- Mixed messages: give good news first, place bad news before the end, close positively (e.g. accept the talk but propose the last week of March because of a conference in Sweden).

Order, credit and refusal letters

- **Order letter:** first line “Please send me 45 Hitachi window ACs”; be specific; list items vertically; mention payment procedure (cheque, banking); cordial conclusion.
- **Credit letter:** give sufficient valid credit references and offer additional information.
- **Refusal of credit:** thank the applicant; explain (company is new); welcome cash purchases; promise future credit arrangements; keep the customer.

Types, classifications and characteristics

AIDA in a sales letter

Letter	Stage	Technique
A	Attention	Striking opening, quotation, question
I	Interest	Explain features and benefits
D	Desire	Samples, guarantees, trial offers
A	Action	Prompt the reader to order

Theories, principles, models and contributors

COURTESY TOWARD CORRESPONDENTS — SIR ERNEST GOWERS

Be courteous to the rude, lucid to the muddle-headed, patient to the pig-headed, appreciative of the helpful and gracious when proved wrong.

AIDA PROCESS — ADVERTISING MODEL

Attention → Interest → Desire → Action.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Insurance agent writes to promote another policy.

EXAMPLE

Enquiry about 25 geysers, 20 room heaters or 45 ACs.

EXAMPLE

Accepting a talk invitation while proposing the third week of March.

EXAMPLE

Credit refusal: company is new; pay cash now.

Comparison tables

Good news versus bad news placement

Position	Content
Beginning	Good news
Middle / before end	Bad news, softened
End	Positive, cordial close

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- AIDA = Attention, Interest, Desire, Action.
- Three As of planning: analysis, anticipation, adaptation.
- Gowers: if he is rude, be specially courteous.
- Enquiry: main idea first; polite command ends with a period.
- Reply: good news first, avoid dull openings.
- Order letter: specific, vertical list, payment procedure.
- Credit letter needs valid credit references.
- Refusal letters must retain goodwill.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W6 Q2	p.22	Closing of business letters	Fill-in-the-blank
W6 Q3	p.22	Subject line in business letters	Fill-in-the-blank
W6 Q7	p.23	Refusal letters	MCQ
W6 Q10	p.23	Parts of a business letter (sales letter)	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Business letters include sales, enquiry, reply, order, credit, refusal, collection, claim, adjustment and recognition letters. Sales letters follow AIDA and avoid exaggeration and negatives. Enquiries state the main idea first; replies lead with good news and answer all queries; order letters are specific and state payment; credit requests need references; refusals thank, explain and keep hope. Sir Ernest Gowers' advice guides tone.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) In AIDA, 'D' stands for:

A. Decision

B. Desire

C. Direction

D. Discount

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Attention, Interest, Desire, Action.

Q2 (MCQ) Where should good news be placed in a reply?

A. End

B. Middle

C. Beginning

D. Nowhere

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Announce good news first.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are ways to attract attention in a sales letter?

A. Striking statement

B. Quotation

C. Question

D. Threat

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Avoid threats and negatives.

Q4 (T/F) A refusal letter should close all ties with the customer.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It should preserve goodwill.

Q5 (Fill) Gowers advises: if he is rude, be specially _____.

> **Answer:** courteous
> **Why:** Keep courtesy.

Q6 (Short) What should an order letter contain?

> **Answer:** A specific order in the first line, itemised list, and the payment procedure with a cordial close.
> **Why:** No roundabout expressions.

Revision checklist

☐ I can expand AIDA.

☐ I know Gowers' advice.

☐ I can write enquiry and reply letters.

☐ I know order and credit letter rules.

☐ I can write a polite refusal.

Lecture 30: Types of Business Letters Part II

Week 6 · Course book PDF pages 486–503 (printed pages 485–502)

Learning objectives

- Write a collection letter series with a gradually firmer tone.
- Draft a claim (complaint) letter: state the problem, explain, state the adjustment wanted, close cordially.
- Draft an adjustment letter: good news first, active voice, explanation, empathy, appreciation.
- Write a recommendation letter honestly and quote the closing remark on simplicity.

Important definitions

COLLECTION LETTER

A letter, or series of letters, written to recover money owed; tone moves from gentle to firm.

CLAIM / COMPLAINT LETTER

A letter written to correct a wrong and obtain replacement, repair or compensation.

ADJUSTMENT LETTER

The organisation's reply to a claim; conveys the remedy while restoring goodwill.

RECOMMENDATION LETTER

A letter nominating and justifying a person for promotion, awards or recognition, written honestly and confidentially.

EMPATHETIC LANGUAGE

Language that places oneself in the customer's position ("You are right to be disappointed...").

Core concepts

Collection letters

- A **series** (often four) because one letter may be ignored.
- **1st:** gentle reminder; **2nd:** a bit harsh; **3rd:** harsher and indirect; **final:** strong, may be intimidating but still ends cordially.
- Sample final letter: "Despite three reminders we have not received the outstanding amount for 20 photocopiers... You are morally obliged to pay... further delay may force us to hand the matter to legal agencies... Please send the cheque and inform us by telephone by 5 p.m. tomorrow." (deadline set)
- Credit and collection go hand in hand; keep the customer if possible.

Claim letters

- Receiving complaints is good: an opportunity for dialogue, relationship and product improvement and feedback.
- Open with the **problem or the action wanted** (“Please send your service engineer to rectify the technical problems in 20 geysers…”).
- Explain what went wrong without alleging; **appeal to the company’s fair reputation** (“we have always enjoyed your prompt service”).
- State the inconvenience and the adjustment wanted (replacement or refund).
- **Do not blame or shout**; include copies of bills, receipts and documents; suggest remedy.
- Close cordially: “We realise mistakes in ordering and shipping sometimes occur; because we have enjoyed your prompt service, we hope you will send the ACs by …”.
- Example: two employees with confirmed reservations were refused rooms – “would you clarify your room reservation policy for late arrivals?”

Adjustment letters

- Complaints are more valuable than surveys.
- **Open with the good news** (action taken) in **active voice**: “We have sent the new photocopier to your address” – not “has been sent”.
- Explain why things went wrong; give additional information; emphasise the action wanted from the customer.
- **Address the claimant by name.**
- Avoid negative words (trouble, fault, regret, misunderstanding); do not blame the customer or staff; avoid unrealistic promises (“this will never happen again”).
- Use sensitive, empathetic language: “We are really sorry; you are right to be disappointed with the Lumia cell phone” (Gowers: if he convicts you of a mistake, admit it).
- Close with appreciation: “Thanks for writing. Your satisfaction is important to us… our goal is to earn your confidence.”
- Send appreciation notes when a wrong is righted.

Recommendation letters

- Purpose: nominate and justify the merits for promotion, awards or recognition.
- Be **honest**, confidential, not biased; do not exaggerate; avoid vague or ambiguous words.
- Mention if you are writing at someone's suggestion.
- Evaluate communication, organisational, leadership, team and behavioural skills and dynamism.
- Do not include negatives without evidence; keep a copy for your record.
- Closing quotation about letters: “The art of art, the glory of expression and the sunshine of the light of letters is simplicity” (attributed to a famous poet; the transcript gives no name).

Types, classifications and characteristics

Sequence of collection letters

Letter	Tone
First	Gentle, courteous reminder
Second	A little firmer
Third	Harsher, indirect
Final	Strong, deadline, mentions legal action; ends cordially

Claim, adjustment and recommendation letters

Letter	Opening	Key rules
Claim	State the problem / action wanted	No blame; attach documents; request remedy
Adjustment	Good news in active voice	Empathy; address by name; no negatives; thank
Recommendation	State relationship and recommendation	Honest, specific, confidential

Theories, principles, models and contributors

ADMIT MISTAKES — SIR ERNEST GOWERS (CITED AGAIN)

If he convicts you of a mistake, admit it.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Collection letter for 20 photocopiers.

EXAMPLE

Claim letter for 20 faulty geysers.

EXAMPLE

Hotel refused rooms to two employees with confirmed reservations.

EXAMPLE

Adjustment letter replacing a Lumia cell phone with a touch-screen defect.

Comparison tables

Claim versus adjustment letter

Point	Claim	Adjustment
Writer	Customer	Organisation
Opening	Problem or desired action	Good news / action taken
Tone	Polite, firm, not angry	Empathetic, appreciative
Close	Hope for prompt correction	Thanks for writing; promise of service

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Collection letters form a series with increasing firmness.
- Open claim letters with the problem or action wanted.
- Do not blame; include documents.
- Adjustment letters open with good news in active voice.
- Address the claimant by name.
- Avoid trouble, fault, regret, misunderstanding and unrealistic promises.
- Complaints are opportunities.
- Keep a copy of recommendation letters.
- Closing quote: simplicity is the glory of expression.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W6 Q5	p.22	Collection letters	Fill-in-the-blank
W6 Q11	p.23	Adjustment letters	MSQ
W6 Q12	p.24	Recommendation letters	MSQ
W6 Q15	p.24	Adjustment letters	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Collection letters grow firmer across a series but keep goodwill. Claim letters state the problem and desired remedy politely with documents; adjustment letters open with the good news in active voice, explain, show empathy, avoid blame and negative words and thank the customer. Recommendation letters must be honest, specific and confidential. Simplicity and cordiality underlie all letters.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) An adjustment letter should open with:

A. An apology for trouble

B. The good news or action taken

C. A threat

D. A query

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Good news first, in active voice.

Q2 (MCQ) How many letters typically make up the collection series in the lecture?

A. One

B. Two

C. Four

D. Ten

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** A final fourth letter is the strongest.

Q3 (MSQ) Which should be avoided in an adjustment letter?

A. Blaming the customer

B. Negative words like trouble

C. Unrealistic promises

D. Thanking the customer

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Thank and empathise.

Q4 (T/F) A claim letter should attach copies of bills and documents.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** They support the claim.

Q5 (Fill) Complaints give an organisation a chance to start a _____.

> **Answer:** dialogue
> **Why:** And to improve products.

Q6 (Short) What care is needed in a recommendation letter?

> **Answer:** Be honest, specific, confidential and unbiased; avoid exaggeration and unsupported negatives.
> **Why:** Retain a copy.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the tone progression in collection letters.
☐ I can write a claim letter.
☐ I can write an adjustment letter.
☐ I know recommendation letter rules.
☐ I can list words to avoid.

Week 7: Report Writing

1. Lecture 31: Report Writing
2. Lecture 32: Types of Reports
3. Lecture 33: Strategies for Report Writing Part I
4. Lecture 34: Strategies for Report Writing Part II
5. Lecture 35: Evaluation and Organization of Data

Lecture 31: Report Writing

Week 7 · Course book PDF pages 504–517 (printed pages 503–516)

Learning objectives

- State the origin and definition of a report.
- List the attributes of a report: formal, factual, specific purpose and audience, organised, unified, illustrated, bound.
- Explain the objectives of reports.
- Differentiate report writing from literary writing.

Important definitions

REPORT

A formal communication written for a specific purpose and audience; it describes the procedures followed for collecting and analysing data and gives conclusions and, if required, recommendations.

ETYMOLOGY OF REPORT

From Latin *reportare* = *re* (back) + *portare* (to carry): to carry information to a person who is not present. (The transcript glosses ‘re’ as ‘to send’.)

UNITY AND COHERENCE

Every sentence and paragraph links to the topic and to one another, giving a smooth flow of thought.

CROSS-FERTILISATION OF IDEAS

Exchange of ideas across people and departments through reports.

Core concepts

Why reports matter

- Decisions (promotion, product launch, new policy) rest on reports; a committee studies data and concludes.
- Doctor’s medical tests are an everyday analogy of procedure, data, interpretation and conclusion.
- A report is the “bread and butter” of an organisation; it can make or mar the fortune of both organisation and individual.

Attributes of a report

1. **Formal** piece of writing.
2. **Factual** – data-based, objective, no wrong data.

3. Written for a **specific audience** (language adapted; computer professional versus layman).
4. Written for a **specific purpose**; only when required (need-based).
5. **Systematic and well organised** (beginning, discussion, end).
6. **Unity and coherence**.
7. Uses **illustrations** (charts, graphs, pie charts, tables).
8. **Bound properly** with a cover page and title; sequence of parts.

Objectives of a report

- **Update progress** of the organisation.
- **Evaluate** performance (e.g. five-year data and trends).
- **Guide the organisation to a corrective path** when things go wrong (committee, data, conclusions).
- **Spread information** internally and externally to stakeholders and shareholders.
- **Cross-fertilise ideas** and reveal gaps in reasoning.
- **Record findings and recommend action.**
- **Create awareness** and self-awareness (compare yourself with a promoted colleague).

Professional's only tangible product

A report is "a professional's only tangible product": it often is the only contact between an engineer/professional and management, so it shows reasoning, scientific attitude, grasp, intelligence and initiative; clarity is the hallmark.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Attributes of a report

Attribute	Meaning
Formal	Official style and structure
Factual	Based on accurate data
Audience-specific	Language fits reader
Purpose-specific	Written on demand for a reason
Organised	Fixed structure and sequence
Unified and coherent	Smooth flow of ideas
Illustrated	Charts, tables, graphs
Bound	Cover page, title, order

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Medical test reports leading to diagnosis.

EXAMPLE

Committee investigating a fire loss.

EXAMPLE

Comparing yourself with a promoted colleague.

Comparison tables

Report writing versus literary writing

Point	Report	Literary
Initiative	Written on demand	Own initiative
Audience	Specific	General, not fixed
Structure	Fixed	No fixed structure
Approach	Objective	Subjective
Language	Plain, matter-of-fact	Figurative, ornamental
Aim of reader	Information	Pleasure
Formality	Formal	Spontaneous

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Report derives from Latin reportare (re + portare).
- A report is a formal communication for a specific purpose.
- Reports are need-based, not self-initiated.
- A report is a professional's only tangible product.
- Reports contain data, procedure, conclusions and recommendations.
- Illustrations include charts, graphs, pie charts and tables.
- Objectives: update, evaluate, guide, spread information, cross-fertilise ideas, record and recommend, create awareness.
- Clarity is the hallmark of business communication.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W7 Q5	p.25	Technical vs literary writing	True/False
W7 Q15	p.27	Technical reports vs literary writing	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

A report (from Latin *reportare*) is a formal, factual, systematic communication prepared on demand for a specific audience and purpose. It describes procedure and data, draws conclusions and may recommend action. Reports update, evaluate, correct, inform and create awareness. Unlike literary writing, reports are objective, structured, plain and audience-specific.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The word ‘report’ derives from the Latin:

A. Reportare

B. Reportum

C. Reporter

D. Rapere

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Re + portare.

Q2 (MCQ) Which is a feature of report language?

A. Ornamental

B. Plain and factual

C. Highly figurative

D. Exaggerated

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Objective and matter-of-fact.

Q3 (MSQ) Select attributes of a report.

A. Formal

B. Factual

C. Spontaneous

D. Well organised

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Spontaneity belongs to literary writing.

Q4 (T/F) A report is written whenever the writer feels like it.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It is written on demand.

Q5 (Fill) A report is a professional’s only _____ product.

> **Answer:** tangible
> **Why:** It shows his abilities.

Q6 Short State two objectives of a report.

> **Answer:** To update the progress of an organisation and to guide it to a corrective path (also evaluate, inform, recommend).
> **Why:** Reports support decisions.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the etymology and definition.
☐ I can list the attributes.
☐ I can list the objectives.
☐ I can differentiate report from literary writing.
☐ I recall ‘tangible product’.

Lecture 32: Types of Reports

Week 7 · Course book PDF pages 518–528 (printed pages 517–527)

Learning objectives

- Classify reports by length, form, nature, frequency and purpose.
- Differentiate short (informal) and technical (formal) reports.
- Differentiate informative and analytical (interpretive) reports.
- Explain routine, management and special reports.
- Recall the bathing-suit quotation by Sherring and Christian.

Important definitions

SHORT REPORT

An informal, brief report (one page to about 10 pages) with an authorisation, a problem, a conclusion and, only if asked, a recommendation; includes letter reports and memo reports.

TECHNICAL REPORT

A formal, documented report with prefatory material, deep and systematic discussion, data analysis, illustrations and back matter.

INFORMATIVE REPORT

A report that presents information as it is, without analysis or recommendation (e.g. inspection, lab, attendance reports).

ANALYTICAL (INTERPRETIVE) REPORT

A report that interprets, analyses and evaluates data, reaches conclusions and may recommend action.

ROUTINE REPORT

A report written regularly at fixed intervals on a fixed proforma, dealing with regular matters (finance, production, sales, inventory).

MANAGEMENT REPORT

A non-technical, short report for top managers, with restricted language, journalistic tone and more illustrations.

SPECIAL REPORT

A report written during a critical juncture or aberration, with no standard format and time pressure.

ACR

Annual Confidential Report: a routine report evaluating an employee's performance.

APPENDIX

Back matter where supporting material that would block the flow of the report is placed.

Core concepts

Ways of classifying reports

- By **length**: short and long.
- By **form**: written and oral.
- By **subject / nature**: management and technical.
- By **frequency**: routine and special.
- By **purpose / function**: informative and analytical (interpretive).

Short reports

- Informal; e.g. a school picnic report; one page to 5–6 or 8–10 pages.
- Needs a **letter of authorisation** and a statement of the problem; then conclusion.
- **Recommendation only if asked:** conclusions rest on data, recommendations bring in your own thoughts.
- Letter reports (salutation, complimentary close, informal tone) and memo reports (no salutation or close) are short reports.
- Be concise, plain, direct; ask 'why am I writing this?'; review before sending; move blocking material to the appendix.

Technical reports

- Proper documentation: beginning, prefatory material, discussion, analysis, illustrations, supporting material.
- Very detailed, logical, systematic discussion to analyse a problem and provide a solution.
- **Data must be factual and its sources authentic**: wrong data leads to wrong decisions that harm the institution.
- Data is collected, analysed, interpreted and sampled to reach a conclusion (and recommendation, if required).
- Analysis is divided into sections and subsections (e.g. pollution, garbage disposal) and must lead logically to the conclusion.
- Supporting material (sources, methods) goes to the back matter.
- Divided into **informative** and **analytical**.

Informative reports

- Simply convey information as it is, not as it should be; no analysis, usually shorter.
- Often a fixed proforma with ticks; little language use; the writer does not recommend action.
- Examples: market survey, laboratory report, inventory, inspection, traffic observation.

- Also: periodic (weekly attendance, monthly inspection), readership surveys, employee booklets, prospectus, website information, committee reports, policy statements, sales, credit and production reports.

Analytical (interpretive) reports

- Interpret, analyse and evaluate data; investigate a problem (e.g. a product with deficiencies) and may recommend action.
- Writer must be **unbiased** and keep personal bias out.
- Elaborate and descriptive: may run 30–35 pages.
- Example: a Pay Commission examines situations, recommends, and government decides.
- More objective and scientific; analysis must serve the common good.
- Busy readers read the illustrations (tables, charts, graphs), so use relevant visuals.

Routine reports

- Regular, at fixed intervals (fortnight, month, year); fixed proforma; little language.
- Deal with finance, production, sales, performance, inventory; keep internal people and outside agencies informed.
- Examples: annual reports, project progress proforma (every six months), lab report, stock verification, inspection reports (e.g. car makers withdrawing or adding features), ACR (annual confidential report).

Management reports

- **Non-technical**, short, for top people; more illustrations, little explanation.
- Language restricted, tone at times journalistic.
- Managers read the conclusion and may refer to the technical report for detail.
- Writer must know the readers' background, age, taste and preferences.

Special reports

- Written only in critical hours or after a mishap; low frequency; time limit.
- No standard format; writer relies on caution and felicity of language.
- Writer must be extra vigilant, diligent, intelligent and careful because action will follow.

Key quotation

Sherring and Christian: "A report is like a bathing suit; it covers everything that has to be covered, but nothing more." (No unnecessary or irrelevant material.)

Types, classifications and characteristics

Classification of reports

Basis	Types
Length	Short, long
Form	Written, oral
Subject	Management, technical
Frequency	Routine, special
Function	Informative, analytical (interpretive)

Examples of informative and routine reports

Category	Examples
Informative	Lab report, inventory, inspection, market survey, prospectus, committee report, sales, credit, production report
Routine	Annual report, progress proforma, stock verification, inspection report, ACR

Theories, principles, models and contributors

BATHING-SUIT QUOTATION — SHERRING AND CHRISTIAN

A report covers everything that has to be covered, but nothing more.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

School picnic report (short report).

EXAMPLE

Report on pollution or garbage disposal (technical).

EXAMPLE

Teacher’s attendance record deciding course continuation.

EXAMPLE

Pay Commission recommendations to the government.

EXAMPLE

Car companies withdrawing features after inspection reports.

Comparison tables

Informative versus analytical report

Point	Informative	Analytical (interpretive)
Content	Information as it is	Interpretation and evaluation
Recommendation	Usually none	Often given
Length	Shorter	Longer (30–35 pages)
Language	Little; proforma ticks	Elaborate, descriptive
Use	Record and trend	Solve problems, take decisions

Short versus technical report

Point	Short	Technical
Formality	Informal	Formal
Length	1–10 pages	Long
Illustrations	Few	Many
Structure	Authorisation, problem, conclusion	Prefatory, body, back matter
Examples	Letter and memo reports	Pollution report

Routine versus special report

Point	Routine	Special
Frequency	Regular intervals	Rare, on critical occasions
Format	Fixed proforma	No standard format
Language use	Little	Careful, meticulous
Time	Scheduled	Limited, urgent

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Reports are classified by length, form, subject, frequency and function.
- Letter and memo reports are short reports.
- Do not recommend unless asked; conclusion is fine.
- Technical report needs authentic data and sources.
- Technical reports are informative or analytical.
- Analytical reports can run 30–35 pages.
- Routine reports follow fixed proformas at fixed intervals.
- ACR = Annual Confidential Report.
- Management reports are non-technical, short, illustrated.
- Special reports have no standard format and are rare.
- Bathing-suit quote by Sherring and Christian.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W7 Q7	p.26	Types of reports	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Reports vary by length (short or long), form (written or oral), subject (management or technical), frequency (routine or special) and function (informative or analytical). Short reports are informal; technical reports are formal and documented and must rest on authentic data. Informative reports present facts; analytical reports interpret and may recommend. Routine reports are periodic and proforma-based, management reports are short and non-technical, and special reports arise in critical situations. A report should cover everything necessary, but nothing more.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) A letter report is a type of:

A. Long report

B. Short report

C. Special report

D. Oral report

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Letter and memo reports are short reports.

Q2 (MCQ) Which report simply presents information as it is?

A. Analytical

B. Informative

C. Special

D. Management

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** No analysis or recommendation.

Q3 (MCQ) The ACR is an example of a:

A. Special report

B. Routine report

C. Oral report

D. Management report

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Annual and periodic.

Q4 (MSQ) Which are features of management reports?

A. Non-technical

B. Short

C. Journalistic tone possible

D. Heavy documentation

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Heavy documentation is technical.

Q5 (T/F) A report writer should always give recommendations.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Only if asked.

Q6 (Fill) A report is like a _____ suit: it covers everything necessary but nothing more.

> **Answer:** bathing
> **Why:** Sherring and Christian.

Q7 (Short) Distinguish informative and analytical reports.

> **Answer:** Informative reports present facts as they are; analytical reports interpret and evaluate data and may recommend action.
> **Why:** Core classification.

Revision checklist

☐ I can classify reports by five bases.

☐ I know short vs technical.
☐ I know informative vs analytical.
☐ I can describe routine, management and special reports.
☐ I recall the bathing-suit quote.

Lecture 33: Strategies for Report Writing Part I

Week 7 · Course book PDF pages 529–545 (printed pages 528–544)

Learning objectives

- List the steps in preparing to write a report: purpose and scope, audience, data collection, organising material, outline.
- Explain terms of reference (TOR) and why knowing the reader matters.
- Distinguish primary and secondary sources of data.
- Evaluate personal observation: process, precautions, limitations.
- State the advantages and disadvantages of telephonic interviews.

Important definitions

TERMS OF REFERENCE (TOR)

Instructions from the person assigning the report stating the problem, scope, readers and what is to be done.

SCOPE

The extent of the problem the report covers and who will read it.

PRIMARY SOURCE

First-hand data from personal observation and investigation.

SECONDARY SOURCE

Existing data used to verify or supplement: library, Internet, internal records.

PERSONAL OBSERVATION

Seeing with a purpose; the word is explained in the lecture as ob + servation.

CONTROLLED OBSERVATION

Observation where the subject knows or is prepared in advance.

UNCONTROLLED OBSERVATION

Observation where the subject is unaware of being observed.

PRIMARY READER

The boss or person who assigned the report.

SECONDARY READER

Other readers, including those outside the organisation with relevant expertise.

TELEPHONIC INTERVIEW

Collecting data by planned telephone questioning.

Core concepts

Steps before writing a report

1. Identify **purpose and scope**.
2. Determine the **audience**.
3. Choose the right **method of data collection**.
4. **Organise** the material.
5. Make an **outline**.

Purpose, scope and TOR

- Ask: why am I writing, and who gave me the task?
- The assigner supplies the **terms of reference**: problem, scope, readers, what to cover.
- Example: Mess Secretary asked by the Chief Warden to report on mess functioning (timing, food quality, vegetarian meals, sweets).

Knowing the audience

- Readers: superior officers, colleagues, counterparts, subordinates, people of other organisations, shareholders, customers, the public. (In the example: Chief Warden, Dean Students' Welfare, Deputy Director, Director.)
- Know their background, your relationship with them and their **attitude** (favourable or hostile); this guides language and presentation.
- Primary reader = boss; secondary readers = others, including outsiders with expertise.
- Do not be influenced by the assigner's expectations: work on the data to stay unbiased.

Sources of data

- **Primary:** personal observation and investigation (verified later).
- **Secondary:** library, Internet, internal records.
- Ways of collection: personal observation, telephonic interviews, personal interviews, questionnaires.
- Use specific words in search engines; avoid straying to irrelevant sites; verify authenticity with other sources without wasting time.

Personal observation: how to do it

- Fix beforehand what data you want (a habit, trend, quality).
- Decide between **controlled** and **uncontrolled** observation; people change behaviour when they know they are watched.
- Do not display pen and paper; note afterwards from memory when observing people (open note-taking is fine for traffic counts).

- Ignore sudden irrelevant changes (posture, gesture); stay focused.
- Avoid prejudice and see with the 'mind's eye'; first impressions (e.g. a tired-looking speaker) may be wrong.
- Covert recording that is later disclosed creates problems; be specific, not general.

Limitations of observation

- Cannot be the only method; gives first-hand but not necessarily representative data.
- Can **report behaviour but not interpret it**.
- Biased by the observer; one day may not represent others (e.g. rainy Sunday traffic).
- Slow, costly, and subjects may be unavailable.

Telephonic interviews

Advantages: accessible anywhere, saves time and travel, wide geographic reach, low refusal rate.

Disadvantages: needs meticulous planning and specific questions; casual talk differs from data-collecting talk; detailed data is hard to get; no sight of non-verbal cues (video calls help only partly); cannot judge age or nationality or if the respondent hides information; limited time, so follow-up is hard; respondents may give wrong information or send someone else.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Sources of data

Source type	Examples
Primary	Personal observation, investigation
Secondary	Library, Internet, internal records

Methods of data collection (Part I)

Method	Key point
Personal observation	First-hand; cannot interpret; observer bias
Telephonic interview	Wide reach; limited depth
Personal interview	Discussed next lecture
Questionnaire	Discussed next lecture

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Mess Secretary's report for the Chief Warden.

EXAMPLE

Observing Sunday traffic flow.

EXAMPLE

Misjudging a tired-looking speaker.

EXAMPLE

Searching for air pollution data.

Comparison tables

Primary versus secondary sources

Point	Primary	Secondary
Nature	First-hand	Existing material
Methods	Observation, investigation	Library, Internet, records
Role	Starting data	Verification and support

Controlled versus uncontrolled observation

Point	Controlled	Uncontrolled
Subject aware?	Yes, in advance	No
Risk	Subject prepares or hides things	Less altered behaviour

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Preparation: purpose and scope, audience, data method, organisation, outline.
- TOR = terms of reference.
- Know the attitude of readers.
- Primary sources: observation and investigation.
- Secondary sources: library, Internet, internal records.
- Observation reports behaviour but cannot interpret it.
- Do not recommend or take sides under the boss’s influence.
- Telephonic interviews: low refusal, wide reach, limited detail.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W7 Q1	p.25	Primary and secondary sources	True/False
W7 Q2	p.25	Personal observation	True/False
W7 Q3	p.25	Interview as a data-collection method	True/False
W7 Q8	p.26	Secondary sources	MCQ
W7 Q10	p.26	Personal observation	MCQ
W7 Q11	p.26	Preparatory steps for report writing	MSQ
W7 Q12	p.27	Observation: advantages and disadvantages	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Preparing a report starts with the purpose and scope defined in the terms of reference, then analysis of the audience and its attitude, selection of data-collection methods, organisation of material and an outline. Data come from primary sources (personal observation, investigation) and secondary sources (library, Internet, internal records). Observation gives first-hand data but is biased, slow and cannot interpret behaviour; telephonic interviews reach many people cheaply but lack depth and non-verbal cues.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) TOR stands for:

A. Terms of Reference
B. Time of Report
C. Type of Research
D. Tone of Reader

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Instructions given by the assigner.

Q2 (MCQ) Which is a secondary source?

A. Personal observation
B. Investigation
C. Library
D. Eyewitness view

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Library, Internet and internal records.

Q3 (MSQ) Disadvantages of telephonic interviews include:

A. No non-verbal cues

B. Limited detail

C. Wide reach

D. Respondent may mislead

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Wide reach is an advantage.

Q4 (T/F) Observation can both report and interpret behaviour reliably.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It reports but cannot interpret.

Q5 (Fill) The boss who assigns the report is the _____ reader.

> **Answer:** primary
> **Why:** Others are secondary.

Q6 (Short) Why should note-taking be discreet during observation?

> **Answer:** People who know they are observed change behaviour, defeating the purpose.
> **Why:** Controlled versus uncontrolled observation.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the five preparation steps.

☐ I can define TOR.

☐ I can classify data sources.

☐ I know observation limits.

☐ I know telephone interview pros and cons.

Lecture 34: Strategies for Report Writing Part II

Week 7 · Course book PDF pages 546–560 (printed pages 545–559)

Learning objectives

- Define a personal interview and list its advantages and precautions.
- Explain questionnaires, their advantages and disadvantages.
- List the types of questions: closed, rating, open-ended, multiple choice.
- Apply guidelines for framing a questionnaire and covering letter.
- Recall Freud's and Ruskin's quotations.

Important definitions

PERSONAL INTERVIEW

A process of seeking information directly through a face-to-face conversation with a purpose.

QUESTIONNAIRE

A set of standardised questions sent to many respondents to collect data without travel.

CLOSED QUESTION

A question with a fixed answer such as yes/no (e.g. 'Do you smoke?').

RATING QUESTION

A question asking the respondent to rate on a scale such as 1 to 10.

OPEN-ENDED QUESTION

A question allowing respondents to express their own opinion in their own words.

MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTION

A question with (typically four) offered answers.

LEADING QUESTION

A question that suggests the expected answer or is embarrassing or tricky.

COVERING LETTER

A letter accompanying a questionnaire explaining its purpose and assuring confidentiality.

REPRESENTATIVE SAMPLE

A group of respondents whose answers reflect the whole population.

Core concepts

Why other methods are needed

Observation and telephonic interviews have limits and their data may not be representative, so data should be verified through personal interviews and questionnaires.

Personal interview: advantages

- Face-to-face communication is better because **non-words** (dress, bearing, gestures, postures, silence, pauses) are available.
- Gathers **attitudes and feelings**; faces reveal emotions.
- Learns from people with intimate knowledge of the problem; verifies and supplements observation, questionnaire or telephone data.
- The interviewer has **control** and can bring the interviewee back to the point.
- Questions can be interpreted and ambiguities cleared; replies are more representative (people may lie on the phone but less so in person).
- Gives first-hand impressions and immediate feedback.

Freud: "He who has eyes to see and ears to hear can convince himself that no mortal can keep a secret. If his lips are silent, he chatters with his fingertips; betrayal oozes out of him at every pore."

Personal interview: tips and disadvantages

- Costly and needs travel.
- Seek an **appointment in advance**, state the purpose; be courteous and tactful.
- Standardise questions; limit time (busy professionals).
- Jot notes if allowed; recording is possible.
- **Do not argue**; give the interviewee room; speak less, listen carefully; take a subordinate role.
- Avoid embarrassing questions that affect the interviewee's image; frame questions subtly.

Questionnaire: advantages

- Saves travel, time and money; reaches people in different locations with one set of questions.
- Convenient for respondents, who can **look up information** at leisure.
- No interviewer bias; respondents are fearless and may stay **anonymous**.
- Standardised questions; follow-up questions can follow closed ones.
- Return postage can be prepaid.

Questionnaire: disadvantages

- Low response; people decide on likes and dislikes, so the sample may not be representative.
- Uncertainty; questions left unanswered or answered inadequately or meaninglessly.
- Reluctance on confidential or complex matters.
- No control over the situation.
- Cost per mailing is low but cost per return is high.

Framing a questionnaire

- Keep it **short, specific and attractive**; too long means unanswered.
- Two parts: **personal information first**, then the main questions.
- Use simple wording; arrange logically with coherence.
- Place **tricky questions in the middle**, not at the beginning or the end.
- **Avoid leading and embarrassing questions** (e.g. about alcohol brand, newspaper read).
- Be free of grammatical errors.
- Include a **covering letter** stating purpose and assuring confidentiality.

Ask direct questions: 'Do you smoke?' rather than 'What is your reaction to smoking?'.

Closing quotation

John Ruskin: "To be able to ask a question clearly is two-thirds of the way to getting it answered."

After collection: analyse, organise, outline, then write.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of questions in a questionnaire

Type	Description	Example / use
Closed	Yes/no answers	Do you smoke?
Rating	Scale such as 1–10	Rate the service
Open-ended	Own opinion, space provided	Reveals attitudes and trends
Multiple choice	Choose from four options	Fixed alternatives

Methods of data collection

Method	Main strength	Main weakness
Observation	First-hand	Cannot interpret; biased
Telephonic interview	Wide reach, low refusal	Limited detail, no cues
Personal interview	Non-verbal cues, control	Costly, travel
Questionnaire	Cheap, wide, anonymous	Low and unrepresentative response

Theories, principles, models and contributors

FREUD ON BODY LANGUAGE — SIGMUND FREUD

No one can keep a secret; the body betrays emotions.

RUSKIN ON QUESTIONS — JOHN RUSKIN

A clearly asked question is two-thirds answered.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Smoking research: ‘Do you smoke?’

EXAMPLE

Tricky or leading: ‘Do you drink alcohol?’, ‘Which brand?’

EXAMPLE

Pre-paid return postage to improve response.

Comparison tables

Personal interview versus questionnaire

Point	Personal interview	Questionnaire
Control	With interviewer	None
Cost / travel	High	Low
Non-verbal cues	Available	Absent
Bias	Interviewer bias possible	Eliminated
Anonymity	None	Possible
Response	High	Often low

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Personal interview = conversation with a purpose.
- Non-verbal cues are available in personal interviews.
- Do not argue in an interview; listen more.
- Seek appointments in advance.
- Questionnaires save time and travel and allow anonymity.
- Types: closed, rating, open-ended, multiple choice.
- Put tricky questions in the middle.
- Avoid leading and embarrassing questions.
- A covering letter assures confidentiality.
- Ruskin: question asked clearly is two-thirds answered.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W7 Q4	p.25	Personal interview	True/False
W7 Q14	p.27	Questionnaires	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Personal interviews give reliable, verifiable, first-hand data with non-verbal cues and interviewer control but are costly; the interviewer should plan, listen, avoid arguments and embarrassing questions. Questionnaires reach many respondents cheaply and anonymously but risk low and unrepresentative responses. A good questionnaire is short, simple, logical, error-free, uses closed, rating, open-ended and multiple-choice questions, avoids leading questions, places tricky ones in the middle and carries a covering letter. Ruskin: a clearly asked question is two-thirds answered.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) A key advantage of a personal interview is:

A. Low cost
B. Access to non-verbal cues
C. Anonymity
D. No travel

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Face-to-face reveals non-words.

Q2 (MCQ) Where should tricky questions be placed?

A. First
B. Middle
C. Last
D. Nowhere

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Neither in the beginning nor at the end.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are question types for questionnaires?

A. Closed

B. Rating

C. Open-ended

D. Hostile

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Multiple choice is also a type.

Q4 (T/F) A questionnaire gives the researcher control over the respondent.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** There is no control; that is a limitation.

Q5 (Fill) A questionnaire should be accompanied by a _____ letter.

> **Answer:** covering
> **Why:** It explains purpose and assures secrecy.

Q6 (Short) Name two disadvantages of questionnaires.

> **Answer:** Low response rate and unrepresentative or inadequate answers (also unanswered questions, reluctance on confidential matters).
> **Why:** Cost per return is high.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define personal interview and questionnaire.
☐ I know tips for interviewing.
☐ I can list question types.
☐ I know questionnaire guidelines.
☐ I recall Freud and Ruskin.

Lecture 35: Evaluation and Organization of Data

Week 7 · Course book PDF pages 561–575 (printed pages 560–574)

Learning objectives

- Explain why collected data must be evaluated and organised.
- Describe probability and non-probability sampling and their types.
- Apply note-making techniques.
- State the principles of an outline: indenting, numbering, coordination, subordination, parallel construction, logical ordering.
- Prepare a decimal-numbered outline.

Important definitions

SAMPLING

Selecting a representative part of the data so that conclusions can be drawn for the whole.

PROBABILITY SAMPLING

Sampling in which every item has a known chance of selection: random, systematic or stratified.

RANDOM SAMPLING

Selecting items purely by chance so that every item has an equal chance; the ‘purest’ way.

SYSTEMATIC SAMPLING

Choosing records by a fixed system, e.g. every ninth record.

STRATIFIED SAMPLING

Dividing the data into strata (e.g. men/women, students/teachers, children/adults) and sampling from each.

NON-PROBABILITY SAMPLING

Sampling by convenience or judgment of the analyst.

OUTLINE

A rough, tentative, short structure of the whole report; a distribution table showing which information goes to which section.

COORDINATION

Main head and sub-heads of the same level are of equal importance and belong to the same subject.

SUBORDINATION

Sub-heads are less important than, and visibly lower than, the main head (indent and typeface).

PARALLEL GRAMMATICAL CONSTRUCTION

Headings of the same level use the same grammatical form (all nouns, all phrases).

NOTE CARDS

Cards with sections and sub-sections used to sort jumbled data.

Core concepts

From data to report

Collected data is huge and haphazard. Steps: **evaluate** (validate, sample) → **make notes** → **organise** → **outline** → write.

Sampling methods

- **Probability:** random, systematic (e.g. every ninth record), stratified (groups by criteria).
- **Non-probability:** convenience, judgment.
- Aim: representative data so the report can lead to a solution.

Making notes

- Notes later create the outline; report writing is a systematic process.
- Place quoted words in **quotation marks** and give credit.
- Add a small summary; use abbreviations (shorthand is abandoned now).
- Use **note cards** with sections and sub-sections.
- Write clearly so you can read your own notes.
- Record observations, facts and trends under suitable categories.

Principles of outline

1. **Indenting** – sub-topics shifted to the right, main topics at left.
2. **Numbering** – Roman, alphabetical or **decimal** (preferred: 1, 2, 3.1, 3.2.1); do not go **beyond the third level**.
3. **Coordination** – no new matter unrelated to the head.
4. **Subordination** – sub-heads visibly less important (bold head, normal sub-heads).
5. **Parallel grammatical construction** – all nouns/phrases/adjectives, not a mix.
6. **Logical ordering** – a sequence such as introduction, history, discussion, conclusion, recommendation, bibliography; stick to the pattern chosen.

7. **Phrasing** – use phrases, not full sentences.

Sample outlines

Advertising in India: 1 Introduction; 2 History; 3 Types → 3.1 Print, 3.2 Electronic → 3.2.1 (sub-type).

Modes of presentation: reading from manuscript, impromptu, memorisation (coordinated, no new matter).

Benefits of advertising: economic, political, moral, religious, cultural (all adjectives; not 'politics' or 'moralise').

Advantages of nationalisation: mobilisation of national resources, promotion of agricultural production… (nouns, not 'to promote').

Role of the outline

- A tailor's analogy: cut cloth into pieces, then stitch into one whole.
- Outline is a tentative guide that reminds you what is missing or misplaced; the writer may change it.
- "Once the outline is ready, half the job is done."
- Next: structure (anatomy) of the report.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Sampling methods

Category	Types
Probability	Random, systematic, stratified
Non-probability	Convenience, judgment

Principles of outline

Principle	Meaning
Indenting	Sub-topics to the right
Numbering	Decimal preferred; max three levels
Coordination	Same-level items belong together
Subordination	Lower items less prominent
Parallelism	Same grammatical form
Logical ordering	Systematic sequence

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Outline for 'Advertising in India' with decimal numbering 3.2.1.

EXAMPLE

Parallel list: economic, political, moral, religious, cultural.

EXAMPLE

Stratified groups: men/women, student/teacher, child/adult.

EXAMPLE

Tailor cutting and stitching cloth.

Comparison tables

Probability versus non-probability sampling

Point	Probability	Non-probability
Basis	Chance or system	Convenience or judgment
Types	Random, systematic, stratified	Convenience, judgment
Representativeness	Higher	Depends on analyst

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Evaluate data by sampling.
- Probability sampling: random, systematic, stratified.
- Systematic example: every ninth record.
- Non-probability: convenience, judgment.
- Quote with quotation marks.
- Decimal numbering preferred.
- Do not go beyond three levels.
- Parallel grammatical construction in headings.
- Outline uses phrases, not sentences.
- Outline is a tentative guide: half the job done.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W7 Q6	p.25	Sampling methods	MCQ
W7 Q11	p.26	Preparatory steps for report writing	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Collected data must be evaluated through sampling (probability: random, systematic, stratified; non-probability: convenience, judgment), noted carefully with quotation marks, abbreviations and note cards, and organised into an outline. The outline follows the principles of indenting, numbering (decimal, up to three levels), coordination, subordination, parallel grammatical construction and logical ordering, uses phrases rather than sentences and serves as a tentative guide; a good outline means half the report is done.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which is a probability sampling method?

A. Convenience

B. Judgment

C. Stratified

D. Casual

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Random, systematic and stratified.

Q2 (MCQ) The preferred numbering system for outlines is:

A. Roman

B. Alphabetical

C. Decimal

D. Mixed

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** It avoids confusion.

Q3 (MSQ) Principles of outline include:

A. Coordination

B. Subordination

C. Parallelism

D. Rhyme

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Rhyme is irrelevant.

Q4 (T/F) An outline should be written in full sentences.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Phrases are used.

Q5 Fill Divisions in an outline should not go beyond the _____ level.

> **Answer:** third
> **Why:** Else it becomes sketchy.

Q6 Short What is parallel grammatical construction? Give an example.

> **Answer:** Using the same grammatical form for headings of one level, e.g. economic, political, moral, religious, cultural (all adjectives).
> **Why:** Avoid mixing ‘politics’ or ‘moralise’.

Revision checklist

☐ I know sampling types.
☐ I can make notes properly.
☐ I can list outline principles.
☐ I can draft a decimal outline.
☐ I know parallelism.

Week 8: Report Structure, Style and Group Communication

1. Lecture 36: Structure of Reports: Part-I
2. Lecture 37: Structure of Reports: Part-II
3. Lecture 38: Report Style: Part I
4. Lecture 39: Report Style: Part II
5. Lecture 40: Group Communication

Lecture 36: Structure of Reports: Part-I

Week 8 · Course book PDF pages 576–592 (printed pages 575–591)

Learning objectives

- State the three structural divisions of a technical report.
- List the items of the prefatory material (front matter) in order.
- Describe the cover page, title page, frontispiece, copyright notice and forwarding letter.
- Differentiate preface and foreword; write an acknowledgement.
- Prepare a table of contents and list of illustrations; differentiate abstract, summary and executive summary.

Important definitions

PREFATORY MATERIAL (FRONT MATTER)

Items preceding the main text of a report: cover, frontispiece, title page, copyright notice, forwarding letter, preface, acknowledgement, table of contents, list of illustrations, abstract.

COVER PAGE

Outer page on thick paper bearing ‘Report on’, title, report number, writer, ‘prepared for’, organisation and month/year.

TITLE PAGE

Page after the cover with the title (and subtitle), prepared for/by, ‘approved by’ and organisation and date.

FRONTISPIECE

A thin protective page, or illustration, facing the title page, giving a window display of the report to create curiosity; used in bound reports.

COPYRIGHT NOTICE

A statement on the back of the title page such as ‘© Amit Jain 2017. All rights reserved. No part of this report may be reproduced…without written permission’.

FORWARDING LETTER / LETTER OF TRANSMITTAL

A letter by the controlling officer forwarding the report through proper channel; includes authorisation, subject, purpose, scope, limitations and acknowledgement.

PREFACE

The writer’s own first page introducing the subject, work done, significance and organisation; kept short.

FOREWORD

A recommendation written by an expert or celebrity, not the author.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

A separate page thanking those who helped, in simple polite language, in 2–3 paragraphs.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Division of the report into parts with page numbers.

LIST OF ILLUSTRATIONS

Separate list of tables, charts, graphs with numbers and pages.

ABSTRACT

A very short condensed statement of the focus of the report, with key words.

SUMMARY

A longer account (up to 1.5–2 pages) of the entire report.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The whole report in a nutshell for top managers: purpose, objectives, methodology, findings, recommendations.

Core concepts

Three parts of a technical report

Prefatory material (front matter) → Main body (text) → Back matter. Like a letter’s introduction, middle and end. Check the TOR for what the report needs; short reports need not follow the full structure. Analogy: a palatial building built brick by brick on a foundation.

Items of front matter (order)

1. Cover
2. Frontispiece
3. Title page
4. Copyright notice
5. Forwarding letter

6. Preface
7. Acknowledgement
8. Table of contents
9. List of illustrations
0. Abstract (or summary)

Cover page

- Thick paper, usually white (coloured allowed); many organisations have a proforma.
- Contents: 'Report on', **title** (key words; capitals or initial capitals except prepositions), **report number** (right), **writer's name** (employee or enrollment number), **'Prepared for'** (person), **organisation**, **month and year**.
- Number and date help later researchers.

Title page

- Gives title and **subtitle** (e.g. 'Quality Health Management in Hospitals: A Case Study').
- Prepared for / prepared by; **'Approved by' at lower left** with the controlling officer's name.
- Studies: descriptive (demand of two-wheelers), correlational, causal (effect of pollution on mankind) help in choosing titles.

Frontispiece, copyright, forwarding letter

- **Frontispiece:** only bound, thick reports; protects drawings and charts; now often dropped.
- **Copyright notice:** on the back of the title page with year and 'All rights reserved'.
- **Forwarding letter:** in business-letter format; certifies the report, states authorisation and scope; not mandatory.

Preface versus foreword; acknowledgement

- Preface: by the author; foreword: by an expert as recommendation.
- Keep preface short; put thanks on a separate page.
- Acknowledgement: 2–3 paragraphs, categorise helpers, vary phrases ("I am thankful to…", "I shall be failing in my duty if…"), avoid jargon and metaphor.

Table of contents and illustrations

- Differs from outline by **page numbers**; title in the centre/top.
- Order: Preface, Acknowledgement, Abstract (in *italics*, Roman numerals), then chapters from Introduction with Arabic numbering, then appendix and bibliography.
- Sub-divisions are not essential.
- List of illustrations gives number, title and page of tables and charts (graphs, pie charts) for readers who scan visuals.

Abstract, summary, executive summary

- **Abstract:** very short, key words, main focus; as at conferences.
- **Summary:** longer, covers the report; up to 1.5–2 pages.
- **Executive summary:** whole report in a nutshell: reason for writing, objectives, findings, methodology, recommendations; topic sentences in paragraphs.

- Language: neutral, scientific, detached, no flowery words or jargon; it prepares the reader for the report.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Structure of a technical report

Part	Alternative name	Contents
1	Prefatory material / front matter	Cover to abstract
2	Main body / text	Introduction to recommendation
3	Back matter	Appendix, bibliography, glossary, index

Front matter items

Item	Key point
Cover	Report on, title, number, writer, date
Frontispiece	Thin protective page; optional
Title page	Subtitle, approved by
Copyright	All rights reserved
Forwarding letter	Through channel; not mandatory
Preface	Author's note; short
Acknowledgement	Thanks; simple language
Table of contents	Page numbers
List of illustrations	Tables and charts
Abstract	Brief, key words

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Cover: 'Quality Management in Service Industries' with report number and month/year.

EXAMPLE

Title page with subtitle 'A Case Study'.

EXAMPLE

Copyright: Amit Jain © 2017 – All rights reserved.

EXAMPLE

Forwarding letter to Nilesh Mathur.

Comparison tables

Preface versus foreword

Point	Preface	Foreword
Written by	Author	Expert or celebrity
Content	Subject, work done, significance	Recommendation to readers

Abstract versus summary versus executive summary

Point	Abstract	Summary	Executive summary
Length	Very short	1.5–2 pages	Concise but complete
Purpose	Main focus, key words	Entire report	Report in a nutshell for managers
Contains	Focus	Overview	Objectives, methodology, findings, recommendations

Outline versus table of contents

Point	Outline	Table of contents
Page numbers	No	Yes
Stage	Planning	Finished report

Cover page versus title page

Point	Cover	Title page
Material	Thick paper	Ordinary page after cover
Extra items	Report number	Subtitle and ‘approved by’

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Report has three parts: front matter, main body, back matter.
- Front matter items in order: cover, frontispiece, title page, copyright, forwarding letter, preface, acknowledgement, contents, illustrations, abstract.
- 'Approved by' goes at lower left of the title page.
- Copyright notice on the back of the title page.
- Forwarding letter is also called letter of transmittal.
- Preface by author; foreword by expert.
- Table of contents has page numbers; outline does not.
- Preface, acknowledgement and abstract use Roman numerals/italics.
- Abstract is shorter than summary.
- Executive summary may go up to 1.5–2 pages.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W8 Q2	p.28	Introduction of a report	True/False
W8 Q6	p.28	Executive summary	MCQ
W8 Q13	p.30	Introduction of a report	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

A technical report has front matter, main body and back matter. The front matter contains the cover, frontispiece, title page, copyright notice, forwarding letter, preface, acknowledgement, table of contents, list of illustrations and abstract or summary. The cover carries the report number, title, writer, recipient, organisation and date; the title page adds the subtitle and 'approved by'. The preface is by the author, the foreword by an expert. The table of contents carries page numbers. Abstracts and summaries use neutral, concise language.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The three parts of a technical report are:

A. Front matter, body, back matter

B. Title, text, index

C. Cover, letter, bibliography

D. Preface, summary, appendix

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Prefatory material, main elements and back matter.

Q2 (MCQ) A foreword is written by:

A. The author

B. An expert

C. The printer

D. The publisher

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It recommends the work.

Q3 (MCQ) The ‘approved by’ line appears on the:

A. Cover top

B. Title page, lower left

C. Index

D. Appendix

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Controlling officer’s approval.

Q4 (MSQ) Which belong to the front matter?

A. Abstract

B. Acknowledgement

C. Bibliography

D. Copyright notice

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Bibliography is back matter.

Q5 (T/F) A table of contents contains page numbers while an outline does not.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** That is the difference.

Q6 (Fill) Another name for a forwarding letter is a letter of _____.

> **Answer:** transmittal
> **Why:** It sends the report through channel.

Q7 (Short) Differentiate abstract and executive summary.

> **Answer:** An abstract is a very brief statement of the report’s focus with key words; an executive summary is a fuller digest including objectives, methodology, findings and recommendations.
> **Why:** Executive summary suits busy managers.

Revision checklist

☐ I can name the three parts.

☐ I can list front matter in order.
☐ I know cover and title page contents.
☐ I can differentiate preface and foreword.
☐ I know abstract vs summary.

Lecture 37: Structure of Reports: Part-II

Week 8 · Course book PDF pages 593–608 (printed pages 592–607)

Learning objectives

- List the four parts of the main body: introduction, discussion, conclusion, recommendation.
- Describe the contents of an introduction.
- Explain how to write discussion, conclusions and recommendations.
- List the items of back matter: appendix, list of references, bibliography, glossary, index.
- Differentiate bibliography and list of references; APA and MLA styles.

Important definitions

INTRODUCTION

First part of the main body: background, problem, authorisation, scope, limitations, sources and methods, definitions of terms and report preview.

DISCUSSION

The part where data are analysed, interpreted and evaluated to lead logically to the conclusion.

CONCLUSION

Logical inferences and judgments based only on the analysis, with no new information.

RECOMMENDATION

Feasible action suggested on the basis of the conclusions, written only when asked.

BACK MATTER

Supporting material after the main text: appendices, references, bibliography, glossary, index.

APPENDIX

Supporting material (questionnaire, interview sheets, charts) placed at the end; labelled Appendix A, B, C.

LIST OF REFERENCES

Only the works cited in the text; mandatory.

BIBLIOGRAPHY

Complete alphabetical list of works consulted, including those not quoted, for further reading.

GLOSSARY

Alphabetical list of technical terms with meanings.

INDEX

Alphabetical list of topics and sub-topics with page numbers, for very long reports.

APA STYLE

Citation style common in sciences; year follows the author's name.

MLA STYLE

Citation style common in humanities/social sciences; year given near the end.

Core concepts

Four parts of the main body

1. Introduction
2. Discussion
3. Conclusion
4. Recommendation (if asked)

Use decimal numbering; Introduction is 1, Discussion 2 and so on.

Contents of the introduction

- **Historical background** and statement of the problem (about the organisation, sector, or issue).
- **Authorisation** and terms of reference; hypothesis or concept of the problem.
- **Scope** – who or what is affected.
- **Limitations** of the findings and methods.
- **Sources and methods** of data collection.
- **Definitions of terms** for non-expert readers (e.g. the boss).
- **Report preview** – division of the report into sections.

Discussion

- 'The entire drama takes place': analysis, interpretation and evaluation of data.
- Divide into sections and sub-sections with decimal numbers.
- Present findings in tables, graphs and charts that are in sync with the text; useful for busy readers.
- Example: absenteeism – the data may show personal problems, unsuitable unit or poor communication with bosses, not mere insincerity.
- Raise questions and answer them with data.

Conclusion

- Based entirely on the analysis; **no new information**.
- Brief (1–2 pages even for a 30-page report); may be numbered.

- Busy readers read only conclusions and illustrations.

Recommendation

- Give **only when asked**.
- Must be **feasible**, not aggressive or 'the only solution', no personality; maintain equilibrium between truth and feasibility.
- Infeasible or invented recommendations make the report fail.

Back matter items

- **Appendices** (A, B, C) – questionnaires, interview sheets, charts that would block the flow; only interested readers consult them.
- **List of references** – works cited; **bibliography** – all works consulted; **glossary**; **index**.
- Few references can be footnotes on the same page; many go to the end.

Documentation styles

- Order of entry: author (surname first in bibliography; full name in footnote), year (APA: after author), title (italic), edition, place, publisher, year (MLA: at end), pages.
- Types: one, two, three authors, corporate author, e-mail, newspaper article, essay in an edited book, abstract.
- Example MLA: Gibaldi, Joseph. *MLA Handbook for Writers of Research Papers*. New York: Prentice Hall, year.
- Entries are alphabetical; follow your organisation's style (italics or underline).

Glossary and index

- **Glossary:** alphabetical technical terms; essential when many terms (more than 10–20).
- **Index:** alphabetical; main topics and sub-topics; only for extremely long reports.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Main body of a report

Part	Function
Introduction	Background, problem, scope, limitations, methods, definitions, preview
Discussion	Analysis and interpretation of data
Conclusion	Inferences based on analysis
Recommendation	Feasible action; only if asked

Back matter

Item	Content
Appendix	Supporting material
List of references	Works cited
Bibliography	Works consulted
Glossary	Technical terms
Index	Topics with pages

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Absenteeism report: causes found through data.

EXAMPLE

Unemployment report in a technology or automobile sector.

EXAMPLE

MLA entry for Joseph Gibaldi.

EXAMPLE

Appendices A, B and C for questionnaires.

Comparison tables

Bibliography versus list of references

Point	List of references	Bibliography
Scope	Only cited works	All consulted works
Mandatory?	Yes, if cited	Complete list for further reading
Order	As per style	Alphabetical

APA versus MLA

Point	APA	MLA
Year position	After author’s name	Towards the end
Used in	Sciences	Humanities / social sciences

Glossary versus index

Point	Glossary	Index
Content	Technical terms with meanings	Topics with page numbers
Use	Many technical terms	Very long reports

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Main body: introduction, discussion, conclusion, recommendation.
- Introduction gives background, authorisation, scope, limitations, methods, definitions and preview.
- Conclusion contains no new information.
- Recommend only when asked and keep it feasible.
- Appendices hold supporting material labelled A, B, C.
- List of references = cited works; bibliography = consulted works.
- APA: year after author; MLA: year at end.
- Bibliography is alphabetical, surname first.
- Glossary and index are alphabetical.
- Index only for extremely long reports.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W8 Q8	p.29	Bibliography vs references	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

The main body has introduction (background, authorisation, scope, limitations, methods, definitions, preview), discussion (analysis and interpretation), conclusion (based on analysis, no new data) and recommendation (only if asked and feasible). The back matter holds appendices, list of references, bibliography, glossary and index. A list of references contains only cited works; a bibliography lists all consulted works. APA and MLA differ in the position of the year.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) No new information should appear in the:

A. Introduction

B. Discussion

C. Conclusion

D. Appendix

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Conclusions rest on analysis.

Q2 (MCQ) Which gives the full list of consulted works?

A. Glossary

B. Index

C. Bibliography

D. Appendix

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** References contain only cited works.

Q3 (MSQ) The introduction may contain:

A. Scope

B. Limitations

C. Definitions of terms

D. Final recommendation

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Recommendation is a separate part.

Q4 (T/F) Recommendations should always be added to a report.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Only if asked.

Q5 (Fill) In APA style the _____ follows the author's name.

> **Answer:** year
> **Why:** In MLA it comes near the end.

Q6 (Short) What is placed in appendices?

> **Answer:** Supporting material such as questionnaires, interview sheets and charts that would interrupt the flow of the text.
> **Why:** Labelled Appendix A, B, C.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the four parts of the main body.
☐ I can list introduction contents.
☐ I know conclusion and recommendation rules.
☐ I can list back matter items.
☐ I can differentiate bibliography and references.

Lecture 38: Report Style: Part I

Week 8 · Course book PDF pages 609–630 (printed pages 608–629)

Learning objectives

- Explain why report language must be familiar, specific and simple.
- Identify and correct clichés, jargon, foreign words, redundancy, circumlocution and unfamiliar abbreviations.
- Replace difficult words and phrasal verbs with simple ones.
- Correct misplaced modifiers and use specific rather than vague words.
- Recall Nathaniel Hawthorne's remark on words.

Important definitions

CLICHÉ

A word or phrase once fresh but now overused and stale (e.g. 'threadbare', 'uphill task', 'writing on the wall', 'leave no stone unturned').

JARGON

Technical language of a profession that non-specialist readers cannot follow.

REDUNDANCY

Using unnecessary words that repeat meaning (basic fundamentals, repeat again, final result, great majority).

CIRCUMLOCUTION

A roundabout, wordy way of saying something simple.

FOREIGN WORDS AND PHRASES

Words from other languages (e.g. subpoena, avant-garde, tête-à-tête) that readers may not know.

MODIFIER

A word (adjective/adverb) that describes another; piled-up or misplaced modifiers confuse.

PHRASAL VERB / IDIOM

Verb plus particle (make out, make up) with changed meaning; avoid in reports.

SYNONYM

A word with a near meaning, used to replace a difficult word.

ABBREVIATION

Shortened form; use only if familiar to readers (HIV is fine; FIG, ATR, CVR may not be).

Core concepts

Why style matters

- A report is written to bring action; action requires understanding.
- Readers have different backgrounds (an engineer and a doctor use different terminologies).
- Technical language is needed for technical subjects, but use words that are at least familiar.
- Report language is not only sentences but also words and paragraphs: choose words, phrases, sentences and paragraphs carefully.
- **Hawthorne:** "Words so innocent and powerless as they are, as standing in a dictionary, how potent for good and evil they become in the hands of one who knows how to combine them."

Be specific and familiar

- Avoid unusual words used for an 'air of intellectuality'.
- Be specific: 'the majority were divided' → '70 per cent were divided'.
- Revise and replace difficult words with simple synonyms.

Difficult word replacements

- ramifications → results; corroborate → verify / prove
- veracity → truth; validation → proof
- apogee → orbit (as given); camaraderie → friendship; dismember → cut; impasse → deadlock/difficulty
- obtuse → dull; synergy → unity/coordination
- antiquated → old; annihilation → destruction; conflagration → fire
- cognizant → aware/know; pedagogue → teacher

Examples: "The ramifications of the experiment should be corroborated" → "The result of the lab experiment should be verified." "The veracity of the scientist's claim requires validation" → "The truth of the claim requires proof."

Modifiers and phrasal verbs

- Avoid double modifiers: "all praises and credits", "new and novel structure" – use one word.
- Avoid phrasal verbs: "could not make out" → "could not understand".
- Misplaced modifier: "Speaking before the large audience, my knees began to knock" → "Speaking before the large audience, I felt my knees knocking."

Clichés

- "The report discusses threadbare the problem…" → "…in detail".
- "uphill task" → "challenge"; "writing on the wall" → "prediction".

- “leave no stone unturned” → “work hard / try my best”; “burning question” → “common issue”; “day in and day out”; “repeat again”.

Foreign words, jargon, redundancy, circumlocution

- **Foreign:** subpoena (court summons), avant-garde → pioneer, tête-à-tête → personal interview.
- **Jargon:** “the spectrum of infection with the human immunodeficiency virus continues to evolve...” → “we are learning more about the range of infection in people with HIV”; “pedagogical pursuits” → “teaching”.
- **Redundancy:** basic fundamentals, repeat again, final result, a great majority.
- **Circumlocution:** “We are cognizant that you are experiencing difficulties during this period of reorganisation” → “We know...”.

Abbreviations and slang

- Use only abbreviations the reader knows; explain unfamiliar ones (FIG = Faculty Initiation Grant; CVR = cockpit voice recorder; ATR).
- Avoid campus slang such as ‘insti’, ‘poly class’, ‘audie’ (auditorium), ‘enthu’.
- Take the medium path: maximum familiar words.

Wrong word choice

Confusing *sensitive* with *sensible* leads to awkward writing; the doctor cannot cure what he cannot diagnose, and a solution needs understanding. Next lecture: sentence structure, readability, active/passive.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Faults of word choice in reports

Fault	Meaning	Example → fix
Cliché	Overused expression	threadbare → in detail
Jargon	Technical terminology	pedagogue → teacher
Foreign word	Non-English word	avant-garde → pioneer
Redundancy	Repeated meaning	basic fundamentals → fundamentals
Circumlocution	Roundabout expression	cognizant → know
Unfamiliar abbreviation	Unknown short form	spell out FIG
Phrasal verb	Multi-word idiom	make out → understand

Theories, principles, models and contributors

POWER OF WORDS — NATHANIEL HAWTHORNE

Words are innocent and powerless in a dictionary but become potent for good and evil in the hands of one who combines them.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

70 per cent instead of ‘majority’.

EXAMPLE

Corroborate → verify.

EXAMPLE

Writing on the wall → prediction.

EXAMPLE

HIV instead of human immunodeficiency virus.

EXAMPLE

‘Audie’ mistaken for an Audi car.

Comparison tables

Difficult versus simple words

Difficult	Simple
ramification	result
corroborate	prove / verify
antiquated	old
annihilation	destruction
conflagration	fire
veracity	truth
camaraderie	friendship
obtuse	dull

Redundant versus correct

Redundant	Correct
basic fundamentals	fundamentals
repeat again	repeat
final result	result
a great majority of people	most people

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Report language must be simple, specific and familiar.
- Cliché = overused expression.
- Jargon = technical language unknown to the reader.
- Redundancy = unnecessary repetition.
- Circumlocution = roundabout expression.
- Use one modifier, not two.
- Avoid phrasal verbs and idioms.
- Avoid unfamiliar abbreviations and slang.
- Hawthorne's quotation on words.
- Be specific with numbers instead of 'majority'.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W7 Q9	p.26	Circumlocution	MCQ
W7 Q13	p.27	Clarity in report language	MSQ
W8 Q5	p.28	Report style: plain words	True/False
W8 Q9	p.29	Redundancy	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Report language should be simple, specific and familiar so that readers of different backgrounds can act on it. Avoid unusual words, clichés, jargon, foreign phrases, redundancy, circumlocution, phrasal verbs, double modifiers, misplaced modifiers and unfamiliar abbreviations. Replace difficult terms with synonyms, give exact figures and revise. As Hawthorne notes, words become powerful in the hands of one who knows how to combine them.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) ‘Basic fundamentals’ is an example of:

A. Cliché

B. Redundancy

C. Jargon

D. Foreign phrase

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Basic and fundamental repeat the meaning.

Q2 (MCQ) A simpler word for ‘corroborate’ is:

A. Verify

B. Complicate

C. Dispute

D. Delay

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Verify or prove.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are clichés?

A. Uphill task

B. Writing on the wall

C. Leave no stone unturned

D. Result

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** ‘Result’ is plain.

Q4 (T/F) Abbreviations may be used freely without explanation.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Only if familiar to readers.

Q5 (Fill) A roundabout way of saying a simple thing is _____.

> **Answer:** circumlocution
> **Why:** E.g. ‘We are cognizant…’.

Q6 (Short) Why should report writers avoid jargon?

> **Answer:** Readers of different backgrounds may not understand technical terms, so the report fails to lead to action.
> **Why:** Use technical but familiar terms like HIV.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define cliché, jargon, redundancy, circumlocution.
☐ I can simplify difficult words.
☐ I can correct misplaced modifiers.
☐ I know abbreviation rules.
☐ I recall Hawthorne’s quote.

Lecture 39: Report Style: Part II

Week 8 · Course book PDF pages 631–650 (printed pages 630–649)

Learning objectives

- Use active and passive voice appropriately in reports.
- Apply sentence-style techniques: subject-verb closeness, emphatic word order, parallel construction, splitting breathless sentences, avoiding noun clusters.
- Build unified, coherent, ordered paragraphs and use transitions.
- Compute the Gunning fog index and interpret it.
- Recall George Orwell's 'windowpane' principle.

Important definitions

ACTIVE VOICE

The subject performs the action; direct, clear, but can sound like an allegation.

PASSIVE VOICE

The subject receives the action (verb in third form); neutral, polite, impersonal, used to avoid blame.

EMPHATIC WORD ORDER

Arranging words so the important item is at the beginning or end of the sentence.

PARALLEL CONSTRUCTION

Using the same grammatical pattern for parts of a sentence.

BREATHLESS SENTENCE

A long sentence with no pause; split it into two or more.

NOUN CLUSTER (NOUN STRING)

A long chain of nouns (e.g. 'current group member meeting dates scheduling package format') that hides meaning; replace with verbs and prepositions.

TRANSITIONS (SIGNPOSTS)

Linking words and phrases that guide readers from one idea to the next.

READABILITY

The ease with which a text can be read and understood.

FOG INDEX

Robert Gunning's formula: 0.4 × (average sentence length + percentage of difficult words); a score below 12 means readable.

TOPIC SENTENCE

The main sentence of a paragraph to which others are related.

Core concepts

Variety as a style principle

- Repeating the same pattern ('I am thankful to…' repeatedly) is monotonous; vary voice, sentence length and order.
- Mix short and long sentences; give paragraphs for 'eye relief'.
- Examples of variety in acknowledgement: 'I am indebted to…', 'I acknowledge…'.

Active versus passive voice

- **Active**: direct and easier ("We do not advise the training division to concentrate its time, money and resources on a new programme").
- **Passive**: "Concentration… is not advisable from our point of view."
- Use passive to neutralise blame: "Since your workers did not pack the tape recorders, they got damaged" (allegation) → "Since the tape recorders were not packed properly…".
- Commands ('Shut the door') can be softened: "You are requested to close the door."
- "You are responsible" → "I think it is your responsibility."
- A complaint is written in active voice; the reply is often in passive.

Sentence style

- Put the **subject first and the verb just after it**; don't let the verb get lost at the end.
- Place important matter in the subject; use **emphatic word order**.
- Revise: "Some aspects of desktop publishing… have powerful control…" → "Today even a low-cost word processor can deliver…".
- Link clauses: "Parts are manufactured in Mexico, which has lower wage rates than the United States."
- Word order example: "He, as a management representative, is aware that he should uphold the authority to fire workers who disobey orders."
- Put the **positive first**: "We feel that by using this system we are missing some patients and therefore losing revenue."

Parallelism and splitting

- Parallel: “This book is good as a college text and even better as a means of enlarging their knowledge.”
- Split breathless sentences: “We are enclosing next month’s event calendar. If interested, kindly inform the concerned organiser.”
- Complex scientific sentences (adrenergic–cholinergic antagonism) become readable when split and using pronouns.

Noun clusters

Kick the noun habit, create the verb habit: “Please revise the schedule package format of group members’ meetings” instead of a string of nouns. Value-orientation example: bring the verb closer (“The concept of value orientation in this sense is thus…”).

Paragraph structure

- Three mantras: **unity, coherence, order**.
- Begin with a topic sentence; other sentences coordinate or subordinate to it using connecting words, repetition and pronouns.
- Develop paragraphs by comparison and contrast, cause and effect, classification, problem–solution.
- Avoid very long paragraphs; paragraph breaks give relief.

Transitions

- **Addition:** moreover, furthermore, besides, finally.
- **Cause / result:** hence, therefore, thus, consequently.
- **Contrast:** however, nonetheless, on the other hand, while.
- **Time:** earlier, now, later, after a while, meanwhile.
- **Repetition / summary:** in short, that is, thus.

Readability and fog index

- Gunning (1950s) fog index = 0.4 × (average sentence length + percentage of difficult words).
- Result **below 12** = readable.
- **Orwell:** style should be unobtrusive – like a windowpane through which information is clearly seen.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Transitions by function

Function	Examples
Addition	moreover, furthermore, besides, finally
Cause/effect	hence, therefore, thus, consequently
Contrast/comparison	however, nonetheless, on the other hand
Time	earlier, now, later, meanwhile
Repetition/summary	in short, that is

Paragraph development methods

Method	Use
Comparison and contrast	Show similarity/difference
Cause and effect	Explain reasons and results
Classification	Group items
Problem–solution	State problem then remedy

Theories, principles, models and contributors

FOG INDEX — ROBERT GUNNING (1950S)

Index = 0.4 × (average sentence length + % of difficult words); below 12 is readable.

UNOBTRUSIVE STYLE — GEORGE ORWELL

Style should be like a windowpane: invisible, letting information be clearly seen.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Tape recorders damaged because not packed (passive to avoid blame).

EXAMPLE

‘Please revise the schedule package format of group members’ meetings.’

EXAMPLE

Mexico wage-rate sentence.

EXAMPLE

Splitting the event-calendar sentence.

Comparison tables

Active versus passive voice in reports

Point	Active	Passive
Verb form	Verb follows subject	Be + past participle
Effect	Direct, forceful, may accuse	Neutral, polite, impersonal
Best use	Clarity, instructions, good news	Avoiding blame, bad news

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Vary voice, sentence length and word order.
- Passive neutralises allegations.
- Subject then verb, close together.
- Positive points come first in comparisons.
- Split breathless sentences.
- Replace noun clusters with verbs.
- Paragraph = unity, coherence, order with topic sentence.
- Transitions are signposts.
- Fog index below 12 = readable.
- Gunning proposed the fog index; Orwell compared style to a windowpane.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W8 Q4	p.28	Report style: active voice	True/False
W8 Q12	p.30	Sentence style in reports	MSQ
W8 Q14	p.30	Transitions and coherence	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Good report style mixes active and passive voice (passive neutralises blame), keeps subject and verb close, uses emphatic word order, parallel construction and a mix of short and long sentences, and splits breathless sentences. Noun clusters should be replaced by verbs. Paragraphs need unity, coherence, order and a topic sentence, linked by transitions. Readability can be measured by Gunning's fog index (0.4 × (average sentence length + % difficult words)); a score below 12 is readable. Style should be unobtrusive, like a windowpane (Orwell).

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) A fog index below which value indicates readable writing?

A. 5

B. 12

C. 20

D. 30

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Below 12.

Q2 (MCQ) Which voice is used to avoid accusing the reader?

A. Active

B. Passive

C. Imperative

D. Subjunctive

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Passive neutralises allegation.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are transitions of contrast?

A. However

B. Nonetheless

C. Therefore

D. On the other hand

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** 'Therefore' shows result.

Q4 (T/F) A long string of nouns makes a sentence clearer.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Replace with verbs.

Q5 (Fill) A sentence that cannot be read in one breath is called a _____ sentence.

> **Answer:** breathless
> **Why:** Split it.

Q6 (Short) State the fog index formula.

> **Answer:** Fog index = 0.4 × (average sentence length + percentage of difficult words); below 12 is readable.
> **Why:** Proposed by Robert Gunning.

Revision checklist

☐ I know when to use active and passive.

☐ I can revise noun clusters.

☐ I can structure a paragraph.

☐ I can list transitions.

☐ I can calculate the fog index.

Lecture 40: Group Communication

Week 8 · Course book PDF pages 651–668 (printed pages 650–667)

Learning objectives

- Define a group and a team and differentiate them.
- List the tasks of groups and types of groups.
- State the advantages and disadvantages of group work, including groupthink and hidden agendas.
- Explain group dynamics: cooperation, loyalty, cohesiveness.
- Describe Tuckman’s stages of group development and the three group roles.

Important definitions

GROUP

A collection of people who work, interact and cooperate to achieve a common goal in a specified time; identity of members is taken individually and they share information and resources.

TEAM

A group of people with a common goal, within a limited time, having collective accountability; slogan: ‘one for all and all for one’.

FORMAL GROUP

A group formally constituted by an organisation.

INFORMAL GROUP

A group formed through personal relations; often works better in problem solving.

VIRTUAL GROUP

A group communicating online (WhatsApp, Facebook).

GROUPTHINK

A poor group decision resulting from majority pressure that ignores individual dissent.

HIDDEN AGENDA

A concealed personal aim of a member that harms group interaction.

GROUP DYNAMICS

Forces that keep a group working: cooperation, loyalty, cohesiveness.

COHESIVENESS

Staying together and committed to the goal despite disagreements.

CONSENSUS

General agreement reached by the group.

Core concepts

Why groups

- Humans form groups; modern tasks (events, reports, products, presentations) cannot be done alone or in short time.
- Example: a college cultural festival (‘Cognizance’) is a group effort; teams for music, lectures etc.
- This lecture itself is a team product (recording, editing, approving, posting).

Group versus team

- Group: common goal within a period; members taken individually.
- Team: a subdivision with its own specific goal and **collective accountability**; shared leadership; joint accountability for performance.
- Both share a common goal, cooperation, identification of skills, leadership and accountability.

Tasks of groups and teams

1. Solve problems.
2. Investigate an opportunity (new product, policy).
3. Write reports.
4. Give oral or group presentations (experts present their parts).
5. Devise, evolve and produce new products (e.g. incubation centres).

Types of groups

- **Formal**, **informal** (often more effective) and **virtual** groups.
- Informal groups help problem solving: members help each other beyond formal roles.

Advantages of groups

- More information and resources.
- Diversity of views and experience.
- Better acceptance of decisions and consensus after weighing pros and cons.
- Better performance.
- Sense of belonging; broadened knowledge.

Disadvantages of groups

- Rigid ideas and ego clashes cause wasted, frustrating time.
- ‘Know-it-all’ delusion; unacceptance of consensus.
- Groups within groups; individual opinions ignored.
- **Groupthink** and poor decisions.

- **Hidden agendas**.
- Difficulty coordinating diverse backgrounds; a ‘messiah’/leader is needed.

Group dynamics

- **Cooperation** – communication clears roadblocks.
- **Loyalty** – willingness to make small sacrifices.
- **Cohesiveness** – staying together despite differences (utensils make noise).

Tuckman’s stages

1. **Forming** – introductions, rapport building; members are new.
2. **Storming** – clash of ideas; beneficial for new ideas.
3. **Norming** – peace; members mellow, accept views, filter.
4. **Performing** – energetic, effective work.
5. **Adjourning** – group dissolves after the task (added later by Tuckman).

Bruce Tuckman, psychologist; initially four stages, adjourning added later.

Group roles

- **Self-oriented roles** – members pursuing self-interest, wanting control or withdrawing.
- **Maintenance roles** – encouraging, harmonising, compromising to keep the group together.
- **Task-facilitating roles** – initiating, giving and seeking information, setting procedures.

Leader and Drucker

A leader coordinates and secures consensus. **Peter Drucker:** “When the ship goes down, you do not call a meeting. The captain gives an order or everybody drowns.” (crisis needs decisive leadership). Members must also consider ethics and personal responsibility. Next lecture: leadership.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Tuckman’s stages of group development

Stage	Characteristic
Forming	Introductions, uncertainty, building rapport
Storming	Conflict of ideas; clashes
Norming	Acceptance, norms, harmony
Performing	Productive teamwork
Adjourning	Task completed; group disbands

Group roles

Role type	Behaviour
Self-oriented	Self-interest, control, withdrawal
Maintenance	Encourage, harmonise, compromise
Task-facilitating	Initiate, give/seek information, set procedure

Theories, principles, models and contributors

STAGES OF GROUP DEVELOPMENT — BRUCE TUCKMAN

Forming, storming, norming, performing and (later) adjourning.

CRISIS LEADERSHIP — PETER DRUCKER

When the ship goes down, you do not call a meeting; the captain gives an order.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

College cultural festival (Cognizance) with music and lecture teams.

EXAMPLE

Incubation centre developing a new product.

EXAMPLE

Task force that is adjourned after completing its work.

EXAMPLE

WhatsApp virtual groups.

Comparison tables

Group versus team

Point	Group	Team
Goal	Common goal	Specific goal within group goal
Accountability	Individual identity	Collective accountability
Motto	Work together	One for all, all for one

Advantages versus disadvantages of groups

Advantages	Disadvantages
More information	Ego clashes, wasted time
Diverse views	Individual views ignored
Better performance	Groupthink, hidden agendas
Sense of belonging	Coordination difficulty

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Tuckman stages: forming, storming, norming, performing, adjourning.
- Team = collective accountability.
- Tasks: solve problems, investigate opportunities, write reports, present, develop products.
- Types of groups: formal, informal, virtual.
- Group dynamics: cooperation, loyalty, cohesiveness.
- Roles: self-oriented, maintenance, task-facilitating.
- Groupthink leads to poor decisions.
- Drucker: the captain gives an order.
- Informal groups can work better than formal ones.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W0 Q1	p.1	Soft skills in teamwork	MCQ
W8 Q3	p.28	When not to hold meetings	True/False
W8 Q7	p.29	Team membership	MCQ
W8 Q10	p.29	Group roles: maintenance	MCQ
W8 Q11	p.29	Group roles: task facilitating	MSQ
W8 Q15	p.30	Group communication	MSQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

A group is a collection of people cooperating for a common goal in a set time; a team is a subdivision with collective accountability. Groups solve problems, investigate opportunities, write reports, give presentations and develop products. They may be formal, informal or virtual. Advantages are more information, diversity, acceptance, performance and belonging; disadvantages include ego clashes, ignoring individuals, groupthink and hidden agendas. Group dynamics: cooperation, loyalty, cohesiveness. Tuckman's stages: forming, storming, norming, performing, adjourning. Roles are self-oriented, maintenance and task-facilitating.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which stage of Tuckman's model involves conflict of ideas?

A. Forming

B. Storming

C. Norming

D. Adjourning

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Storming: clashes of ideas.

Q2 (MCQ) Collective accountability characterises a:

A. Crowd

B. Team

C. Audience

D. Mob

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Team: one for all.

Q3 (MSQ) Group dynamics include:

A. Cooperation

B. Loyalty

C. Cohesiveness

D. Hidden agenda

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Hidden agenda is a drawback.

Q4 (T/F) The fifth stage, adjourning, was added later by Tuckman.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** Initially four stages.

Q5 (Fill) Poor decisions caused by majority pressure are called _____.

> **Answer:** groupthink
> **Why:** Individual views are ignored.

Q6 (Short) List two disadvantages of group work.

> **Answer:** Ego clashes and wasted time; groupthink or individual views being ignored (also hidden agendas).
> **Why:** Groups need a leader.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define group and team.
☐ I know group tasks and types.
☐ I can list advantages and disadvantages.
☐ I know the five Tuckman stages.
☐ I know the three roles.

Week 9: Leadership, Discussion, Meetings and Ethics

1. Lecture 41: Leadership Skills
2. Lecture 42: Group Discussion: Part I
3. Lecture 43: Group Discussion: Part II
4. Lecture 44: Meeting Management
5. Lecture 45: Adaptability and Work Ethics

Lecture 41: Leadership Skills

Week 9 · Course book PDF pages 669–683 (printed pages 668–682)

Learning objectives

- Identify traits and characteristics of a leader.
- Describe leadership styles: autocratic, democratic, laissez-faire, transactional, transformational.
- Explain initiating structure and consideration, and Fiedler's contingency model.
- Describe charismatic and visionary leadership.
- List cultural differences in leadership and the elements of trust.

Important definitions

LEADER

A person from among the group who initiates action, guides members and helps the group reach its goal; not necessarily a manager.

AUTOCRATIC LEADER

Takes decisions on his own ideas, with little interest in members' problems.

DEMOCRATIC LEADER

Considers members' interests, takes suggestions and arrives at a solution acceptable to all.

LAISSEZ-FAIRE LEADER

Gives members full autonomy and does not intervene.

TRANSACTIONAL LEADER

Guides followers towards established goals by clarifying roles and task requirements.

TRANSFORMATIONAL LEADER

Inspires followers to transcend self-interest and brings profound change.

INITIATING STRUCTURE

Leader behaviour that defines tasks, work relationships, goals, standards and deadlines.

CONSIDERATION

Leader behaviour that builds mutual trust, respects ideas and feelings, and cares for members' welfare.

LPC (LEAST PREFERRED CO-WORKER)

Scale in Fiedler's model measuring whether a leader is task-oriented or relationship-oriented.

CHARISMATIC LEADER

Leader with heroic, extraordinary qualities, vision and commitment, an agent of radical change.

VISIONARY LEADERSHIP

Leadership offering a clear, compelling image of an innovative future that taps people's energy and emotions.

Core concepts

Who is a leader

- A leader is 'among us', not from heaven; example of a passenger who organised a solution after a flight was diverted to Bhopal instead of Jabalpur.
- Distinguish a manager from a leader.
- Traits: intelligence, charisma, decisiveness, enthusiasm, strength, bravery, integrity, self-confidence.
- Characteristics shown: **initiative**, desire to lead, honesty, integrity, **subject knowledge**, concern for others.

Styles of leadership

- **Autocratic** – not considered good; ignores problems of members.
- **Democratic** – involves everyone, weighs pros and cons, acceptable solution.
- **Laissez-faire** – autonomy; no interference.
- **Transactional** – assigns tasks and roles.
- **Transformational** – goes beyond role, sees a new tomorrow.

Dimensions of leader behaviour

- **Initiating structure:** assigns tasks, expects standards and deadlines.
- **Consideration:** trust, respect, concern, well-being.
- Leaders **high on both** bring better products and solutions; too much consideration may cause absenteeism.

Fiedler's model

- Fred Fiedler (spelt Fielder in the transcript): effectiveness depends on the match between the leader's style (measured by LPC) and the degree of control and influence the situation gives.
- Leadership style is **fixed**: either task-oriented or relationship-oriented.
- A relationship-oriented leader may neglect the task and cost the organisation.

Charismatic leadership

- Followers attribute heroic qualities; leaders show commitment, vision, confidence; agents of radical change (politics, religion, business).

- Rise above petty self-interest; articulate the vision; participative; pioneers of change; aware of environmental concerns.

Visionary leadership

- Clear and compelling imagery of an innovative future; draws on traditions and connects to actions people can take.
- Taps energy and emotions, creating enthusiasm like for sports.
- Visionary leader **explains the vision**, has no hidden agenda, expresses it through behaviour and action, extends it to different contexts.

Transactional versus transformational

- Transactional: roles and task requirements.
- Transformational: inspires followers to transcend self-interest, instils courage, profound effect.

Cultural differences in leadership

- **Koreans:** paternalistic, mentors.
- **Arabs:** strict; kindness seen as weakness.
- **Japanese:** humble, speak little.
- **Scandinavians and Dutch:** do not praise individuals in public.
- **Americans:** talk of responsibility, rationality, value orientation and hedonism.

Trust: the hallmark of an effective leader

- **Integrity** (honesty, words match action)
- **Competence** (subject knowledge)
- **Consistency**
- **Loyalty** (to organisation and coworkers; represents their case assertively)
- **Openness / candidness**

The leader is the sailor guiding the ship; members are passengers.

Closing quotation

Warren E. Bennis: “Leadership is the capacity to translate vision into reality.” Are leaders born or made? Both – they emerge from among us and are made by their qualities (to be seen in group discussion).

Types, classifications and characteristics

Leadership styles

Style	Feature
Autocratic	Own decisions, rigid
Democratic	Participative
Laissez-faire	Hands-off autonomy
Transactional	Roles, tasks, rewards
Transformational	Inspires beyond self-interest
Charismatic	Heroic, vision, radical change

Elements of trust

Element	Meaning
Integrity	Honesty; word = action
Competence	Knowledge of the subject
Consistency	Same action for same problem
Loyalty	Sacrifice and defending co-workers
Openness	Candid, clear explanation

Theories, principles, models and contributors

CONTINGENCY MODEL — FRED FIEDLER (AS ‘FIELDER’)

Effectiveness depends on matching the leader’s style (task or relationship oriented, measured by LPC) with situational control.

LEADERSHIP DEFINITION — WARREN E. BENNIS

Leadership is the capacity to translate vision into reality.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Passenger organising alternative transport after the Bhopal landing.

EXAMPLE

Korean paternalistic leaders; Arab strictness; Japanese humility.

EXAMPLE

Scandinavian leaders avoid public praise.

Comparison tables

Transactional versus transformational

Point	Transactional	Transformational
Focus	Roles and tasks	Vision and change
Followers	Guided to established goals	Inspired to go beyond self-interest
Effect	Maintains	Profound change

Initiating structure versus consideration

Point	Initiating structure	Consideration
Focus	Task, deadlines	People, trust
Risk if excessive	Neglects members	Absenteeism

Autocratic, democratic and laissez-faire

Style	Decision making	Member involvement
Autocratic	Leader alone	Low
Democratic	Shared	High
Laissez-faire	Members decide	Full autonomy

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- A leader emerges from the group.
- Five styles: autocratic, democratic, laissez-faire, transactional, transformational.
- Initiating structure and consideration are two dimensions.
- Fiedler: leadership style fixed; task or relationship oriented.
- Charismatic leaders have vision and conviction.
- Transformational leader inspires beyond self-interest.
- Trust elements: integrity, competence, consistency, loyalty, openness.
- Bennis: capacity to translate vision into reality.
- Koreans paternalistic; Arabs strict; Japanese humble.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W0 Q5	p.1	Leadership and motivation	True/False
W9 Q1	p.31	Leadership styles	MCQ
W9 Q2	p.31	Visionary leadership	MCQ
W9 Q3	p.31	Charismatic leadership	MCQ
W9 Q8	p.32	Meaning of leadership	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

A leader emerges from the group and shows initiative, integrity, knowledge and concern. Styles are autocratic, democratic, laissez-faire, transactional and transformational. Leader behaviour has two dimensions, initiating structure and consideration, and Fiedler's model links effectiveness to the fit between a fixed task or relationship style and the situation. Charismatic and visionary leaders inspire change; leadership differs across cultures. Trust, built on integrity, competence, consistency, loyalty and openness, is the hallmark. Bennis: leadership is the capacity to translate vision into reality.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which style gives members complete autonomy?

A. Autocratic
B. Democratic
C. Laissez-faire
D. Transactional

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Leader does not intervene.

Q2 (MCQ) 'Leadership is the capacity to translate vision into reality' is by:

A. Drucker
B. Bennis
C. Tuckman
D. Orwell

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Warren E. Bennis.

Q3 (MSQ) Elements of trust include:

A. Integrity

B. Competence

C. Consistency

D. Secrecy

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Openness, not secrecy.

Q4 (T/F) According to Fiedler, a leader's style is fixed.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** Task or relationship oriented.

Q5 (Fill) Scandinavian and Dutch leaders avoid _____ praise of individuals.

> **Answer:** public
> **Why:** It is considered impolite.

Q6 (Short) Differentiate transactional and transformational leaders.

> **Answer:** A transactional leader guides followers to established goals by defining roles and tasks; a transformational leader inspires them to rise above self-interest and brings profound change.
> **Why:** Transformational is one step ahead.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list leader traits.

☐ I know five styles.

☐ I know Fiedler's model.

☐ I can describe charismatic and visionary leaders.

☐ I can list elements of trust.

Lecture 42: Group Discussion: Part I

Week 9 · Course book PDF pages 684–702 (printed pages 683–701)

Learning objectives

- Define group discussion (GD) and explain its importance in selection.
- Differentiate debate and GD.
- Describe GD set-up: seating, size, time, topic announcement.
- Differentiate topic GD and case GD.
- List language, qualities evaluated, individual and group responsibilities, and leadership types in a GD.

Important definitions

DISCUSSION

An exchange of knowledge and experience among people.

GROUP DISCUSSION (GD)

A formal, face-to-face, unstructured, cooperative discussion among participants who exchange views on a topic; a dialogic learning process.

DEBATE

A formal, structured contest with participants speaking for or against a motion.

MOTION

The topic of a debate, supported by the ‘for’ speakers and opposed by the ‘against’ speakers.

TOPIC GD

A GD on an announced topic, often unstructured and announced on the spot.

CASE GD

A GD based on a printed real-life or imaginary case where the group is expected to reach a solution.

DIALOGIC

In the form of a dialogue among many people.

BULLDOZER

A dominating, selfish participant who tries to overpower the group.

INERT PARTICIPANT

A member who does not participate and needs encouragement.

Core concepts

Why GD matters

- Organisations use GD as a criterion to **shortlist/eliminate** candidates when applicants are many and vacancies few, often followed by another test.
- It also helps in crises as a means to find remedies; it has an inbuilt mechanism of correction.
- Evaluates traits: awareness, reasoning, behaviour, initiative, motivation, assertiveness, listening, leadership, teamwork.

Debate versus GD

- Both are formal and face-to-face.
- Debate: **structured**, fixed sides (for/against), topic given in advance (a week or ten days), competitive, emotional, flowery language.
- GD: **unstructured**, flexible (a participant may change stance), topic often announced on the spot, cooperative atmosphere, facts and simple language.

Set-up of a GD

- Seating **circular or semi-circular** so all see each other.
- Usually **7–10** participants.
- Time: 15, 20 or 25 minutes (decided by organisers).
- Topic announced; a few minutes to think; keywords ignite thoughts.
- No rule on who speaks first or in what order; no designated leader.

Topic GD versus case GD

- **Topic GD:** clear topic announced.
- **Case GD:** detailed printed case (real or imaginary); tests analytical, decisive and reasoning skills; aim is a solution; suggestions of ways may be offered.
- Flexibility is the hallmark of both.

Language and phrases

- Simple, concise, appropriate, persuasive and polite; avoid flowery, pompous, obsolete or sesquipedalian words.
- Starting: “Today we have gathered to discuss…”.
- Strong view: “I strongly feel…”, “I am convinced…”, “I am pretty sure…”.
- Neutral: “According to me…”.
- Making a point: “May I make a point about…?”, “I think it is important to consider…”.
- Agreeing: “I fully agree with what Mohan says.”
- Disagreeing politely: “That may be your personal view; my view is…”.
- Returning to the topic: “Could we stick to the topic?”, “I fear we are deviating…”.

Qualities evaluated

- **Awareness**, **reasoning** with facts, **behaviour** (group dynamics matter more than content), **initiative**, **motivation** (encourage the quiet), **assertiveness** (not aggression), **listening**, leadership and team skills.

Responsibilities

- **Individual:** speak, behave well, listen, show interest.
- **Group:** commit to group goals, keep a conducive and amicable atmosphere, resolve conflicts, ensure full participation, keep cohesion; differences should be ideological, not personal.

Leadership in GD

- No designated leader; anyone can lead at any time; tested in conflict or chaos.
- **Driver** – initiates.
- **Amiable** – speaks little, neutral; not acceptable.
- **Democrat** – best; restores order and shares time.
- **Bulldozer** – dominating, selfish; can be cut to size by exposing weak logic.

Body language

Must never be negative; accept opposition graciously through eyes, face and posture; show commitment. “A group swims and sinks together.”

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of GD

Type	Features
Topic GD	Topic announced; unstructured
Case GD	Printed case; aim at solution

Leadership types in GD

Type	Behaviour	Acceptable?
Driver	Starts discussion	Yes
Amiable	Silent, neutral	No
Democrat	Orderly, shares time	Best
Bulldozer	Dominates	No

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Job fair using GD to shortlist.

EXAMPLE

College debates for and against a motion.

EXAMPLE

Phrases like ‘Could we stick to the topic?’.

Comparison tables

Debate versus group discussion

Point	Debate	Group discussion
Structure	Structured, ordered	Unstructured
Sides	For or against fixed	Flexible stance
Topic	Given in advance	Announced on the spot
Tone	Competitive, emotional	Cooperative
Language	Flowery, ornamented	Simple, factual
Purpose	Win the argument	Exchange and reach conclusion

Topic GD versus case GD

Point	Topic GD	Case GD
Input	Announced topic	Printed case
Aim	Discuss views	Reach a solution
Skills tested	Awareness, expression	Analysis, decision making

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- GD is formal, face-to-face, unstructured and cooperative.
- Debate is structured with motion for/against.
- GD seating: circular or semi-circular.
- 7–10 participants; 15–25 minutes.
- Two types: topic GD and case GD.
- No designated leader in GD.
- Leader types: driver, amiable, democrat, bulldozer.
- Group dynamics matter more than content.
- Body language must be positive.
- Participants have individual and group responsibilities.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W8 Q1	p.28	Group discussion etiquette	True/False
W9 Q4	p.31	Definition of group discussion	Fill-in-the-blank
W9 Q5	p.31	Benefits of group discussion	MCQ
W9 Q6	p.32	Group responsibilities	MCQ
W9 Q7	p.32	Role of the leader in discussion	MCQ
W9 Q10	p.32	Evaluation criteria in group discussion	MCQ
W9 Q12	p.33	Purpose of group discussion	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Group discussion is a formal, unstructured, cooperative, dialogic exchange used to shortlist candidates. Unlike a structured, competitive debate with fixed sides, GD allows flexible stances and uses simple, factual, polite language. Held in a circle or semi-circle with 7–10 participants for 15–25 minutes, it may be a topic GD or case GD. Evaluators look for awareness, reasoning, behaviour, initiative, motivation, assertiveness, listening and leadership; participants have individual and group responsibilities. Leaders may be drivers, amiable, democrats or bulldozers.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) GD is best described as:

A. Structured and competitive
B. Unstructured and cooperative
C. One-sided
D. Informal chat

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Cooperative and flexible.

Q2 (MCQ) Which type of leader is best in a GD?

A. Bulldozer
B. Amiable
C. Democrat
D. Dictator

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** A democrat keeps order.

Q3 (MSQ) Differences between debate and GD include:

A. Debate is structured

B. GD allows change of stance

C. Debate topic is given in advance

D. GD uses flowery language

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** GD uses simple language.

Q4 (T/F) A GD has a designated leader chosen beforehand.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Anyone can lead.

Q5 (Fill) A GD is typically seated in a circular or _____ arrangement.

> **Answer:** semi-circular
> **Why:** Everyone must see each other.

Q6 (Short) What is a case GD?

> **Answer:** A GD in which a printed real or imaginary case is given and the group is expected to analyse it and reach a solution.
> **Why:** Tests analytical and decisive skills.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define GD.
☐ I can differentiate debate and GD.
☐ I know topic vs case GD.
☐ I know the qualities evaluated.
☐ I know leader types.

Lecture 43: Group Discussion: Part II

Week 9 · Course book PDF pages 703–718 (printed pages 702–717)

Learning objectives

- Explain the role of an emergent leader and the LEADER acronym used in the lecture.
- Describe what panelists observe in a GD.
- List the dos for preparing and participating in a GD.
- List the don’ts in a GD.
- Recognise types of GD topics and the need for decorum.

Important definitions

EMERGENT LEADER

A leader who is not designated but emerges from the group by taking initiative to bring the discussion back to the main issue.

PANELIST

The evaluator who observes participants’ speech, behaviour and non-verbal conduct, usually noting points.

INERT (SILENT) PARTICIPANT

A member who does not participate; he becomes a liability to the group.

HIGH / LOW PARTICIPATOR

Members who speak often or rarely; panelists note changes in participation.

CHAIRMAN ROLE

Giving judgment; participants must not assume it.

BULLDOZER

A dominating member who creates chaos; can be countered by exposing flaws in his logic.

DECORUM

Proper behaviour in a discussion, free from gender, cultural or ego bias.

Core concepts

Role of leader in GD

- Saves the group from being sidetracked (like a boat in the middle of a river).
- Resolves conflicts, summarises, encourages silent members, keeps participation going.
- Leader types: specific, implied, **emergent**, designated – in GD the leader is **emergent**.
- Influence by constructive participation and rational thoughts; build support among supporters and logically weaken opponents' view.

LEADER acronym (lecture's analysis)

- **L**iberal – not rigid; ensures everyone participates.
- **E**ager and enthusiastic.
- **A**ssertive – without arrogance; influence by constructive ideas.
- **D**emocrat – everyone gets a chance; nobody's sentiment is hurt.
- **E**rudite – subject knowledge.
- **R**ational – no discrimination.

Also: good communication ability. (The lecture lists these traits in running speech; the letter mapping follows the speaker's explanation.)

What panelists observe

- Who started, who speaks more or less, who became silent, who keeps the ball rolling.
- Reactions to others: gesture, posture, pitch and loudness of voice.
- Whether anyone is hurt (religion, ethics) in controversial topics.
- Shifts in participation: support, opposition or attempts to subdue.
- Consistent involvement – not one speech followed by 'golden silence'.

How to prepare / dos

1. Seat yourself **comfortably** (non-verbal behaviour).
2. **Listen to the topic** carefully; keywords ignite thoughts.
3. **Organise thoughts** before speaking; speak complete, grammatical sentences with follow-up points.
4. Speak at the **earliest opportunity** without snatching; be patient.
5. Politely intervene if someone speaks too long: "May I share my piece of mind...".
6. Identify supporters and opponents; augment or counter.
7. Keep track of time; share time fairly.
8. Maintain **eye contact** while speaking and listening.
9. Persuade silent members politely.
10. Use a proper pitch, intonation and articulation; speak at a pace others follow.
11. Define the problem when sidetracked; look at both sides of the coin.

Don'ts in a GD

- Do not be in a hurry to start; never remain silent.
- Do not dominate; **influence** through constructive, rational, factual views.
- Never take the role of a **chairman** or an extreme, judgmental stance.

- Do not argue with opponents or whisper with supporters; no value judgments.
- Do not look at the panelist to impress; do not use slang to shout at silent members.
- Do not move excessively forward or show physical weight.
- Do not put all ideas in one go or speak too fast.
- Do not digress; avoid gender, cultural or ego issues.

GD topics

- **Factual** (e.g. brain drain should be stopped; human cloning should be banned), **abstract**, **fictional**, **controversial** (e.g. no reservation in jobs; transfer of religious places; ‘money makes happy, but too much money makes us unhappy’).
- Take a solid stand based on logic; discuss, do not quarrel; consensus is desirable but not always possible.

Types, classifications and characteristics

GD topics

Type	Example
Factual	Brain drain should be stopped
Factual/policy	Human cloning should be banned
Abstract / fictional	Imaginative or conceptual topic
Controversial	No reservation in jobs; religious places

Dos and don’ts summary

Do	Don’t
Listen to the topic	Dominate
Organise thoughts	Act as chairman
Maintain eye contact	Whisper or argue
Share time	Speak too fast or all at once
Encourage silent members	Look at the panelist

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Boat in the middle of a river without a leader.

EXAMPLE

Crowded bus: creating your own space.

EXAMPLE

Polite phrase: ‘Mr Suraj may be right in a particular situation, but every situation has its own requirements.’

Comparison tables

Influence versus dominate

Point	Influence	Dominate
Method	Constructive, rational, factual ideas	Loudness, weight, interruption
Result	Emerges as leader	Seen as a bulldozer

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- The GD leader is emergent.
- Silent members are a liability to the group.
- Panelists observe both verbal and non-verbal behaviour.
- Listen to the topic carefully; keywords matter.
- Organise thoughts; use complete sentences.
- Never take the role of a chairman.
- Don’t whisper or argue; maintain eye contact.
- Influence, don’t dominate.
- Topics: factual, abstract, fictional, controversial.
- Consensus not always necessary; exchange of views is.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W8 Q1	p.28	Group discussion etiquette	True/False
W9 Q9	p.32	Group discussion do's and don'ts	MCQ
W9 Q10	p.32	Evaluation criteria in group discussion	MCQ
W9 Q14	p.33	Group discussion conclusion	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

In a GD the leader emerges from the group; he is communicative, liberal, eager, democratic, assertive, erudite and rational, saves the group from conflict, summarises and encourages silent members. Panelists observe participation, tone, gestures and fairness. Prepare by sitting comfortably, listening to

the topic, organising thoughts, speaking early but politely, sharing time, maintaining eye contact and encouraging others. Avoid dominating, acting as chairman, extreme stands, arguments, whispering, looking at the panelist, over-speed and digressions. Topics may be factual, abstract, fictional or controversial; a solid, logical stand and decorum are essential.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The kind of leader in a GD is:

A. Designated

B. Hereditary

C. Emergent

D. Elected

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** A leader emerges on his own initiative.

Q2 (MCQ) Which role should a participant NOT take?

A. Encourager

B. Chairman

C. Supporter

D. Listener

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Participants discuss; they do not judge.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are don’ts in a GD?

A. Whispering with supporters

B. Looking at the panelist

C. Maintaining eye contact

D. Speaking too fast

> **Answer:** A, B, D
> **Why:** Eye contact is recommended.

Q4 (T/F) Staying silent in a GD is safe because it avoids mistakes.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Silence makes you a liability.

Q5 (Fill) Instead of dominating, a participant should _____ the group.

> **Answer:** influence
> **Why:** Through constructive ideas.

Q6 Short How should a silent member be handled?

> **Answer:** Politely encourage and persuade him to speak, without shouting or using slang.
> **Why:** The group is judged collectively.

Revision checklist

- ☐ I know the emergent leader’s traits.
- ☐ I know what panelists observe.
- ☐ I can list GD dos.
- ☐ I can list GD don’ts.
- ☐ I know GD topic types.

Lecture 44: Meeting Management

Week 9 · Course book PDF pages 719–731 (printed pages 718–730)

Learning objectives

- Define a meeting and list its functions.
- Identify reasons why meetings fail.
- Plan a meeting by answering why, who, when, where and what.
- Conduct a meeting: start on time, follow the agenda, allow participation, record minutes.
- State participant etiquette and the leader's closing duties.

Important definitions

MEETING

An organised gathering of people for a specific purpose, called to share information, train, solve problems, plan, receive/demonstrate products and make decisions.

AGENDA

A list of items to be discussed, circulated in advance to give members first-hand information.

MINUTES

The official record of what was discussed and decided; unpleasant incidents are not recorded.

VENUE

The place where the meeting is held.

FIASCO

A meaningless or failed meeting with no outcome.

FOLLOW-UP ACTION

Assigning responsibilities and deadlines after the meeting.

Core concepts

Functions of a meeting

1. **Information sharing** in the unit.
2. **Training** of new members and for new practices.
3. **Problem solving** and crisis management, using diverse resources of the group.
4. **Planning** and taking stock of work in progress.

5. **Receiving / demonstrating a new product** (e.g. e-rickshaw) to find lapses.
6. **Decision making** – the overall function of every meeting.

Why meetings fail

- Poor planning – notice of 2–3 hours, no agenda or unprepared members.
- Poor leadership.
- Too many routine meetings; half-hearted, disinterested participation.
- Meetings at very short notice (except emergencies).

Questions before calling a meeting

- **Why** – is a meeting really necessary or is a discussion enough?
- **Who** – only people whose presence matters.
- **When** – check calendars and convenience of key people (by e-mail); avoid evenings after 7 pm; first half preferred by some.
- **Where** – accessible common place; change venues for a series but keep cost low.
- **What** – agenda circulated beforehand.

Arrangements

- Check the venue well in advance: capacity (6–7 to 20 people), electricity, coolers or AC, gadgets, microphones for large groups.
- Pad and pen at each seat; refreshments if possible.
- Agenda well prepared and systematic.

Conducting the meeting

- **Start on time** even if some are late (do not scold latecomers; may say ‘we started without you’).
- **Follow the agenda**; keep the discussion from deviating.
- Allow **full participation**; democratic control; encourage quiet members politely (“Well, Mr X, what is your opinion?”).
- Appoint a **secretary** to record minutes; use official, positive language; do not record unpleasant incidents.
- Be task-centred; finish on time.

Etiquette for participants

- Wait for your turn to speak.
- Switch off cell phones; no satirical language.
- If the meeting overruns because of a domineering person, ask politely: “May I know if the meeting is over?”
- Be an active participant, not a mute spectator.

Closing the meeting

- Summarise the outcomes; identify specifics.
- Assign **responsibilities** and set **deadlines**; decide follow-up.
- Thank the leader/participants; announce that minutes will be circulated.
- Leader resolves conflict neutrally in polite, persuasive language.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Functions of meetings

Function	Purpose
Information sharing	Circulate new information
Training	Induct new employees; introduce practices
Problem solving	Find solutions in crisis
Planning	Plan and review progress
Product demonstration	Test and announce new products
Decision making	Reach a decision

Planning checklist

Question	Consideration
Why?	Clear aim
Who?	Essential people only
When?	Check calendars; daytime
Where?	Accessible, adequate venue
What?	Agenda circulated

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

E-rickshaw as a new product announced internally before launch.

EXAMPLE

Meeting of 6–7 versus 20 people needing different rooms.

EXAMPLE

Latecomer remark: ‘We started without you’.

Comparison tables

Effective versus ineffective meeting

Point	Effective	Ineffective
Notice	Advance with agenda	Hours before
Leadership	Democratic control	Poor leadership
Time	Starts and ends on time	Overruns
Outcome	Decisions and deadlines	No decision

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Meeting = organised gathering for a purpose.
- Overall function of every meeting: decision making.
- Plan with why, who, when, where, what.
- Agenda is circulated in advance.
- Start on time; follow agenda.
- Minutes should not record unpleasant incidents.
- Switch off cell phones.
- Assign responsibilities and deadlines at the end.
- Avoid meetings after 7 pm.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W9 Q13	p.33	Meeting management: agenda	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Meetings are organised gatherings to share information, train, solve problems, plan, demonstrate products and above all make decisions. They fail through poor planning and leadership. Before calling a meeting ask why, who, when, where and what; check calendars, venue and facilities and circulate the agenda. During the meeting start on time, follow the agenda, encourage participation, record official minutes; participants should follow etiquette. Close by summarising, assigning responsibilities and deadlines and promising to circulate minutes.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The primary function of every meeting is:

A. Entertainment

B. Decision making

C. Refreshments

D. Socialising

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Meetings finally must come to decisions.

Q2 (MCQ) What should not be recorded in minutes?

A. Decisions

B. Attendance

C. Unpleasant incidents

D. Action points

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Only official matters.

Q3 (MSQ) Planning questions include:

A. Why

B. Who

C. Where

D. Whom to blame

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Also when and what.

Q4 (T/F) A meeting should wait until all latecomers arrive.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Start on time.

Q5 (Fill) The list of items to be discussed is called the _____.

> **Answer:** agenda
> **Why:** Circulated beforehand.

Q6 (Short) What should a leader do when concluding a meeting?

> **Answer:** Summarise outcomes, assign responsibilities, set deadlines, decide follow-up and announce circulation of minutes.
> **Why:** Ensures action.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list meeting functions.
☐ I know why meetings fail.
☐ I can plan using wh-questions.
☐ I know conduct and etiquette.
☐ I know closing steps.

Lecture 45: Adaptability and Work Ethics

Week 9 · Course book PDF pages 732–749 (printed pages 731–748)

Learning objectives

- Define adaptability and explain why employees must adapt.
- Define ethics and work ethics.
- Explain mutual obligations of employer and employee, including Kant's view that employees are ends, not merely means.
- List employee rights: freedom/non-discrimination, privacy, due process, participation, health and safety, fair wages, speech.
- Identify unethical practices and ways to be ethical.

Important definitions

ADAPTABILITY

The ability of an individual or organisation to change itself or its responses to new circumstances, situations or environments; shows the ability to learn.

ETHICS

A sense of righteousness that tells whether actions are right or wrong.

WORK ETHIC

A set of values based on the moral virtues of hard work and diligence, belief in the moral benefit of work and its ability to enhance character (as quoted from Wikipedia).

CODE OF CONDUCT

Written rules and regulations of an organisation; supported by unwritten personal codes.

MORAL HAZARD

Risk that parties in an employer–employee relationship behave unethically.

PLAGIARISM

Reproducing another person's words or ideas as one's own.

PILFERING

Stealing small things slowly and steadily from the organisation.

MISQUOTING / MISREPRESENTING DATA

Reporting what was not said or distorting data to gain advantage.

PROBATION PERIOD

Initial period to judge an employee's capability.

Core concepts

Why adaptability

- Organisations change practices: paperless offices, electronic pay slips, online tax returns.
- Resisting change makes people rigid, isolated and a barrier to communication; adaptable people learn and improve themselves and the organisation's fitness.
- Change is the law of nature; follow the organisational flow of communication.
- Computer literacy spread because people adapted.

Skills needed to adapt

- **Physical** fitness (a sound mind in a sound body).
- **Mental** and **psychological** preparedness.
- Willingness to work in a **multicultural** setting.
- Learn the organisation's culture and code of conduct; remember that you are its ambassador.

Personal ethics at work

- Commitment, reliability, loyalty to organisation over friends and relatives.
- Keep confidential information secret (finance, banking passwords).
- Regular attendance for pay received.
- Honouring the appointment letter, contract and probation; leaving for a small perk soon after joining is an ethical issue.

Employer–employee relationship

- Based on trust and legal obligations; rights come with duties.
- Organisation provides pay, facilities, environment and self-actualisation.
- The employer has authority to monitor and control, and may invest in the employee.
- **Immanuel Kant:** employees should be treated as **ends, not only means**; occupation gives awareness of one's powers and happiness; 'man feels contented after heavy work'.

Employee rights

- **Right to freedom / non-discrimination** – on gender, colour, faith, age, disability.
- **Right to privacy** – personal data and habits, except where safety demands (e.g. testing a pilot for alcohol); work–life balance (no odd-hour duties for women).
- **Right to due process** – equal criteria for promotion and fair treatment in layoffs with adequate time and compensation.
- **Right to participation and association** – consulted in decisions such as closing a unit.
- **Right to health and safe working conditions** – well-being measures, helmets, yoga, swimming.

- **Right to fair wages** – same pay for same work.
- **Right to freedom of conscience and speech** – but not anti-organisational.

Unethical practices to avoid

- Plagiarism.
- Misusing office resources (phone, property); pilfering.
- Selective misquoting.
- Taking credit for others' work.
- Misrepresenting data; distorting visuals; exaggeration.
- Criticising the organisation or colleagues publicly.
- Conflict of loyalties: personal ethics versus organisational code (e.g. evaluating a loss-making unit that will cause redundancies).

How to be ethical

- Follow written and unwritten codes of conduct.
- Be honest, transparent, sincere, hardworking, an ambassador of the organisation.
- Love your work; speak well of the organisation.
- Protect confidential information.
- Respect all faiths and beliefs in a multicultural workplace.
- Balance rights and duties.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Employee rights

Right	Meaning
Freedom / non-discrimination	Equal opportunity regardless of gender, colour, faith, age, disability
Privacy	Personal data protected except for safety
Due process	Equal criteria for promotion and termination
Participation	Involved in decisions
Health and safety	Safe conditions and well-being
Fair wages	Equal pay for equal work
Speech	Express views without harming organisation

Unethical practices

Practice	Description
Plagiarism	Using others' work as own
Misuse of resources	Using office property/phone personally
Misquoting	Selective or false reporting
Credit stealing	Taking credit for others' work
Data misrepresentation	Distorting facts

Theories, principles, models and contributors

EMPLOYEES AS ENDS — IMMANUEL KANT

Persons must never be treated merely as means but also as ends; work brings awareness of one's powers and contentment.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Paperless office and electronic pay slips.

EXAMPLE

Pilot tested for alcohol.

EXAMPLE

Leaving a job after two months for higher pay.

EXAMPLE

Evaluating a loss-making unit leading to layoffs.

Comparison tables

Adaptable versus rigid employee

Point	Adaptable	Rigid
Attitude to change	Welcomes	Resists
Learning	Continuous	Stagnant
Organisational view	Valued contributor	Sidelined, isolated

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Adaptability = ability to change to new circumstances.
- Ethics = sense of right and wrong.
- Work ethic is based on hard work and diligence.
- Kant: treat employees as ends, not only means.
- Rights come with duties.
- Loyalty to organisation outweighs loyalty to friends in confidentiality.
- Rights listed: freedom, privacy, due process, participation, health, fair wages, speech.
- Unethical: plagiarism, misuse, misquoting, credit stealing.
- Employees are ambassadors of the organisation.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W5 Q3	p.19	Ethical breakdown	Fill-in-the-blank
W9 Q11	p.33	Adaptability	True/False
W9 Q15	p.33	Work ethics	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Adaptability is the ability to change with new circumstances; it helps employees learn and strengthens the organisation. Ethics is the sense of right and wrong; work ethics rests on hard work, diligence, reliability and loyalty. Employer–employee relations are bound by trust and law; Kant argues employees are ends, not merely means. Employees have rights – freedom from discrimination, privacy, due process, participation, safe conditions, fair wages and speech – and duties. Avoid plagiarism, misuse of resources, misquoting, credit stealing and data misrepresentation; follow the code of conduct and act as the organisation's ambassador.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Who said employees should be treated as ends and not merely means?

A. Kant
B. Tuckman
C. Drucker
D. Gunning

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Immanuel Kant.

Q2 (MCQ) Which is an unethical workplace practice?

A. Plagiarism

B. Punctuality

C. Honesty

D. Loyalty

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Plagiarism is intellectual theft.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are employee rights discussed?

A. Privacy

B. Due process

C. Fair wages

D. Right to leak secrets

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Secrets must be protected.

Q4 (T/F) Organisations may test pilots for alcohol despite the right to privacy.

> **Answer:** True
> **Why:** Safety justifies it.

Q5 (Fill) With rights come _____.

> **Answer:** duties
> **Why:** Balance both.

Q6 (Short) Why must employees adapt to change?

> **Answer:** Organisations evolve; adapting lets employees learn, remain useful, avoid isolation and improve the organisation's fitness.
> **Why:** Change is the law of nature.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define adaptability and ethics.

☐ I know employer–employee obligations.

☐ I can list employee rights.

☐ I can list unethical practices.

☐ I recall Kant.

Week 10: Speaking, Presentations and Nervousness

1. Lecture 46: Advanced Speaking Skills
2. Lecture 47: Oral Presentations, Speeches, and Debates
3. Lecture 48: Combating Nervousness
4. Lecture 49: Patterns and Methods of Presentation
5. Lecture 50: Oral Presentation: Planning & Preparation

Lecture 46: Advanced Speaking Skills

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 750–767 (printed pages 749–766)

Learning objectives

- Explain why speaking is a skill and how it differs from writing.
- List the situations where speaking is required.
- State the advantages of speaking over writing.
- Describe the four components of effective speaking: voice, vocabulary, audience, style.
- Recall the quotations by Shakespeare and Benjamin Franklin.

Important definitions

LSRW

Listening, Speaking, Reading, Writing: the four language skills; this lecture covers ‘S’.

SPEAKING SKILL

The ability to perform tasks (convince, inform, report, entertain) by spoken words coupled with non-verbal communication.

CONVERSATION

An art of informal two-way speaking, e.g. breaking the ice with a co-passenger.

SPONTANEITY

Natural, unplanned quality of speech that keeps the audience engaged.

STYLE (IN SPEAKING)

The speaker’s inner voice: animation, enthusiasm and audibility.

AUDIBILITY

Being heard clearly even by the last row.

Core concepts

Why speaking is a skill

- Speaking is natural, but in organisations tasks are communication-based; a professional must master all LSRW skills.
- Individually you must convince, prove, satisfy, report, inform and entertain (as employee, manager or CEO).

- A silent person in a group is seen as uninterested or without content.
- Verbal communication is coupled with **non-verbal** cues.

Situations requiring speaking

- Conversation, meetings, negotiations, group discussions, debates.
- Speeches and presentations; giving or taking interviews.
- Oral presentations; talks with several people for an MOU.

Advantages of speaking over writing

- **Face to face:** immediate feedback and reading the listener's reaction.
- Allows **clarification**, dialogue and persuasion.
- Builds **credibility and rapport**; more energising than reading.
- **Emotion** conveyed through voice (commentary on cricket versus silent TV).
- Clearer, more lucid, explanatory and **spontaneous**; reliable because of expressions.
- **Saves time**; quick response; flexible tone and tenor (anger, sadness, joy, favour, instruction).
- Voice can be modulated (also can be manipulated, as actors do).

Four components of effective speaking

1. **Voice** – God's gift but the way of speaking can be trained (singers train pitch); aim at clarity; avoid too fast (may signal fear) or too slow.
2. **Vocabulary** – enriched over years; must use right words in the right place; words are context-based (e.g. 'recycle' for a computer person versus a pharmacist); use familiar words.
3. **Audience** – know age, background, taste, gender and education; if unknown, imagine a mixed gathering; size affects enthusiasm.
4. **Style** – enthusiasm and animation; audibility to the last row (check microphone); a vibrant start and varied tone, never monotone.

Quotations

- "Half the world is full of people who have nothing to say and keep saying on; the other half has too much to say yet cannot say it."
- **Shakespeare:** men of few words are the best men.
- **Benjamin Franklin:** "Remember not only to say the right thing in the right place, but far more difficult still, to leave unsaid the wrong thing at the tempting moment."
- Every speaker wins or loses in the beginning.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Components of effective speaking

Component	Key idea
Voice	Trainable; clarity; modulation
Vocabulary	Right word, right place; familiar words
Audience	Know and adapt
Style	Enthusiasm, audibility, variety

Speaking situations

Situation	Example
Informal	Conversation
Group	Meeting, GD, debate, negotiation
Formal solo	Speech, presentation
Interview	Giving or taking

Theories, principles, models and contributors

RIGHT WORD, RIGHT TIME — BENJAMIN FRANKLIN

It is more difficult to leave unsaid the wrong thing at the tempting moment than to say the right thing in the right place.

MEN OF FEW WORDS — WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE (AS CITED)

Men of few words are the best men.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Cricket commentary versus a silent television.

EXAMPLE

Breaking the ice with a co-passenger on a train.

EXAMPLE

Word ‘recycle’ in computing versus pharmacy.

EXAMPLE

Speaking to a half-empty versus full class.

Comparison tables

Speaking versus writing

Point	Speaking	Writing
Time	Quick	Slower, can be delayed
Feedback	Immediate	Delayed
Non-verbal cues	Present	Absent
Emotion	Conveyed by voice	Limited
Permanence	Fleeting (unless recorded)	Permanent record

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- LSRW: this lecture is on speaking.
- Four components: voice, vocabulary, audience, style.
- Voice can be trained; the quality itself is a gift.
- Use familiar words.
- Know your audience; imagine a mixed audience if unknown.
- Speakers win or lose at the start.
- Audibility to the last row is essential.
- Speaking can be modulated and even manipulated.
- Franklin quotation on leaving unsaid the wrong thing.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q1	p.34	Speaking skills	MCQ
W10 Q2	p.34	Importance of advanced speaking skills	MCQ
W10 Q3	p.34	Components of effective speaking	MCQ
W10 Q11	p.36	Advanced speaking skills	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Speaking is a skill that complements writing: it is fast, face to face, emotive and spontaneous, builds rapport and credibility, and gives immediate feedback. It is needed in conversation, meetings, negotiations, GDs, debates, speeches, presentations and interviews. Effective speaking rests on four components – voice (trainable), vocabulary (familiar, context-appropriate), audience (know and adapt)

and style (enthusiasm, audibility, variety). Franklin: leaving unsaid the wrong thing at the tempting moment is harder than saying the right thing.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) How many components of effective speaking does the lecture list?

A. Two

B. Three

C. Four

D. Five

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Voice, vocabulary, audience, style.

Q2 (MCQ) The advantage of speaking over writing is:

A. Permanent record

B. Immediate feedback

C. More time to edit

D. Less emotion

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Face-to-face feedback.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are speaking situations?

A. Interview

B. Negotiation

C. Presentation

D. Memo writing

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** A memo is written.

Q4 (T/F) A speaker should use difficult words to impress the audience.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use familiar words.

Q5 (Fill) Every speaker wins or loses in the _____.

> **Answer:** beginning
> **Why:** First impression matters.

Q6 Short How can voice be improved?

> **Answer:** Voice quality is a gift but one can change the way one speaks through consistent training, clarity, modulation and practice, as singers do.
> **Why:** Aim for clarity and variety.

Revision checklist

☐ I can explain why speaking is a skill.
☐ I know speaking situations.
☐ I can list advantages over writing.
☐ I can name four components.
☐ I recall Franklin.

Lecture 47: Oral Presentations, Speeches, and Debates

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 768–783 (printed pages 767–782)

Learning objectives

- Define oral presentation, speech and debate and differentiate them.
- List occasions for oral presentations.
- Explain the role of visual aids and the question–answer session.
- Describe the purposes and features of speeches.
- State how to prepare for and deliver a debate, including rebuttal and courtesy (Roosevelt).

Important definitions

ORAL PRESENTATION

A planned, factual, professional talk to a small, defined audience to inform or persuade, usually with visual aids and a question–answer session leading to a decision.

SPEECH

Formal face-to-face oral communication to an audience for a purpose, relying on voice, vocabulary, gesture and posture, usually without visual aids.

DEBATE

A formal contest of arguments on a motion, with speakers for or against, requiring research, logic and rebuttal.

VISUAL AIDS

Charts, graphs, tables, film clips and live demonstrations used in presentations.

BRIEFING

A short presentation to update a group (press, vendors, senior executives).

REBUTTAL

The time to counter the opponent’s arguments.

ORIENTATION PROGRAMME

A presentation introducing new members to an organisation or course.

Core concepts

Purposes of speaking

All speaking situations aim to **inform**, **persuade** or **entertain**.

Oral presentation

- Given to a **small defined group**; more challenging because they listen to every word.
- Factual and not too emotional; **informative or persuasive**.
- Uses **visual aids** – charts, graphs, tables, film clips, live demo – to satisfy curiosity.
- Leads to a decision (e.g. a paperless office, biometric attendance).
- **Question–answer session**: anticipate questions and prepare answers; convince the audience.

Occasions for presentations

- **Budget presentation** for a department/unit.
- **Briefing**: the press, vendors, senior executives (progress updates).
- **Training and orientation** of new employees, students, teachers.
- **Recruitment** tips by placement officers.
- **Launching a new product** and competing with others.

Speech

- Occasions: degree ceremonies, Bhavan day, farewell, impromptu announcements; may inform, persuade or entertain.
- Fear comes from unfamiliar crowds and lack of preparation.
- Uses voice, vocabulary, style, gesture and posture.
- Difference from presentation: speeches generally have **no visual aids** and the audience is usually larger.

Debate: value and skills

- Builds **argumentative ability** and **critical thinking** (analysis, evaluation, conceptualisation).
- Two sides: for or against the motion; opinion must be backed by logic and data.
- Enriches speaking and arguing skills; topics may be literal, psychological, quotations, etc.

Preparing for a debate

1. **Research** the topic (not only Google) and collect data.
2. Draft the speech with conviction; use arguments supported by facts.
3. **Rehearse** several times with a guide.
4. Listen carefully to the opposition and prepare to counter.
5. Use **note cards** that are legible.
6. Use **rebuttal time** well – it can change the result.

On the day of the debate

- Reach the venue **well in time**; be mentally, physically and psychologically ready.
- Treat opponents with courtesy; greet panelists.
- Use appropriate non-verbal behaviour; polite, harmless language even when contradicting.

- **Roosevelt:** “Courtesy is as much a mark of a gentleman as courage.”

Types, classifications and characteristics

Occasions for oral presentations

Occasion	Audience
Budget presentation	Colleagues, management
Press briefing	Media
Vendor briefing	Vendors
Executive briefing	Senior executives
Training/orientation	New recruits, students, teachers
Product launch	Team, customers

Debate preparation

Step	Detail
Research	Collect facts and data
Draft	Logical arguments
Rehearse	Practise delivery
Listen	Note opposing points
Rebuttal	Counter effectively

Theories, principles, models and contributors

COURTESY AND COURAGE — THEODORE ROOSEVELT (AS CITED)

Courtesy is as much a mark of a gentleman as courage.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Biometric attendance replacing registers.

EXAMPLE

Budget presentation to colleagues.

EXAMPLE

Impromptu announcement of a student’s name on Bhavan day.

EXAMPLE

Rebuttal turning the result.

Comparison tables

Presentation, speech and debate

Point	Oral presentation	Speech	Debate
Audience	Small, defined	Usually larger	Judges and audience
Aim	Inform/persuade; decision	Inform, persuade, entertain	Win by argument
Visual aids	Yes	Usually no	Note cards only
Tone	Factual, less emotional	Occasion-based	Argumentative, logical
Q&A	Yes	Not necessarily	Rebuttal

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Speaking aims to inform, persuade or entertain.
- Oral presentations suit small defined groups and use visual aids.
- Prepare for the Q&A by anticipating questions.
- Briefings: press, vendors, senior executives.
- Speeches normally lack visual aids.
- Debate develops argumentative ability and critical thinking.
- Rebuttal time can decide the winner.
- Reach the debate venue early.
- Roosevelt: courtesy is as much a mark of a gentleman as courage.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q5	p.34	Debate	MCQ
W10 Q6	p.35	Speeches	MCQ
W10 Q12	p.36	Types of presentation	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Speaking serves to inform, persuade or entertain. An oral presentation is a planned, factual talk to a small defined audience, using visual aids and ending with a question–answer session that leads to decisions; occasions include budgets, briefings, training and product launches. A speech is a formal

oral address to a larger audience for an occasion, usually without visual aids. A debate develops argumentative ability and critical thinking and requires research, rehearsal, careful listening, effective rebuttal and courtesy.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) An oral presentation is typically given to:

A. A huge crowd

B. A small defined group

C. A single reader

D. No one

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Small groups listen carefully.

Q2 (MCQ) Rebuttal in a debate means:

A. Opening the motion

B. Countering opponent's arguments

C. Thanking the judge

D. Summarising the topic

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Time to counter points.

Q3 (MSQ) Visual aids used in presentations include:

A. Charts

B. Graphs

C. Film clips

D. Live demonstration

> **Answer:** A, B, C, D
> **Why:** All are aids.

Q4 (T/F) Speeches usually involve visual aids more than presentations.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Presentations use visual aids.

Q5 (Fill) Debates cultivate _____ thinking.

> **Answer:** critical
> **Why:** Analysis and evaluation.

Q6 Short Why prepare for the question–answer session?

> **Answer:** Because the audience must be convinced before a decision; anticipating questions and answers helps persuasion.
> **Why:** Q&A decides acceptance.

Revision checklist

☐ I can distinguish presentation, speech, debate.
☐ I know occasions for presentations.
☐ I can prepare for the Q&A.
☐ I know debate preparation steps.
☐ I recall Roosevelt’s quote.

Lecture 48: Combating Nervousness

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 784–799 (printed pages 783–798)

Learning objectives

- Define nervousness and describe its physical and psychological symptoms.
- Explain why nervousness is natural, universal and useful.
- Recall the views of William James, Sartre, Dale Carnegie and Shakespeare.
- List causes of nervousness and their remedies.
- Apply stress busters during a talk.

Important definitions

NERVOUSNESS

A psychological and physiological state of anxiety/fear about performance, with cognitive, emotional and physical components.

AROUSAL

The keyed-up state caused by adrenaline surge in the body.

ADRENALINE SURGE

Release of adrenaline that speeds the heartbeat and breathing and pumps extra energy.

FIGHT OR FLIGHT

Psychologists' term for the response to threat; the speaker should 'fight' nervousness.

STRESS BUSTERS

Techniques such as deep breathing, pausing and speaking slowly to control nerves.

RAPPORT

Friendly connection built with the audience.

Core concepts

Symptoms

- Butterflies and a sinking feeling in the stomach.
- Dry throat, trembling hands, quivering voice.
- Rapid heartbeat and fast speech; forgetting lines.
- Feeling is mostly internal; the audience rarely notices.

Why people feel nervous

- Fear of not performing well; concern about **image** before strangers.
- Unfamiliar audience, unfamiliar or difficult topic, poor preparation, inexperience.
- Survey cited: 80 per cent of people prefer death to public speaking.
- Common to speakers, musicians, singers, cricketers, swimmers.

Nervousness is natural and useful

- **Natural and universal** – even celebrities and experienced speakers feel it.
- You are **more conscious** because you want to perform better.
- **William James:** survival devices prepare us for an emergency – muscles tense for agility, heartbeat and breathing quicken, glands sharpen senses and give emergency energy.
- It is **energising** and improves the talk; fears pass after the opening.
- Analogy: a new Test batsman's nerves vanish after the first ball; crossing a bridge carefully.
- **Sartre:** people have a choice whether to be cowards.
- **Dale Carnegie:** "I am OK, you are OK." The audience will not attack you; worst case, the talk is not appreciated and you learn.
- **Shakespeare:** "Cowards die many times before their death; the valiant taste of death but once."

Remedies before the talk

- **Prepare well in advance** – the best antidote or panacea.
- **Know the audience** (age, education) and use examples from their field.
- Begin with **familiar topics**; research thoroughly.
- Practise before friends in small groups and take feedback.
- **Record yourself** on a cell phone (audio/video) to review body language, pauses and accent.
- **Check the venue** – acoustics, microphone, seating.
- Treat the audience as friends; see their smiles and whispers as compliments.

Stress busters during the talk

- Face the crowd: stand, **pause** and build rapport before the first word.
- Take a **deep breath**; start with a pause, not a verbal firework.
- Speak **slowly and distinctly**; experienced speakers keep a steady pace (slow and steady wins the race).
- If you forget, **review** the last point; the next thought will come.
- Concentrate on the topic, not on shaking hands; a dais hides trembling.
- Tell yourself: 'bear it, not fear it'.
- Fear is in the mind; practise; learn from failures and imitate good speakers.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Symptoms of nervousness

Type	Symptoms
Physical	Dry throat, trembling, fast heartbeat, butterflies
Voice	Quivering, fast speech
Cognitive	Forgetting, worry about image
Emotional	Anxiety, arousal

Causes and remedies

Cause	Remedy
Poor preparation	Prepare well in advance
Unknown audience	Research audience; treat as friends
Difficult topic	Start with familiar topics
Inexperience	Practise in small groups; record yourself
Venue worries	Check venue in advance
Forgetting	Review and pause

Theories, principles, models and contributors

SURVIVAL DEVICES — WILLIAM JAMES

Nervousness is part of survival: the body prepares for emergency with energy.

I AM OK, YOU ARE OK — DALE CARNEGIE (AS CITED)

Tell yourself you and the audience are fine.

CHOICE TO BE COWARD — JEAN-PAUL SARTRE

People choose whether they are cowards.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

New Test batsman facing bouncers.

EXAMPLE

Crossing a bridge cautiously.

EXAMPLE

Recording a talk on a cell phone.

EXAMPLE

80% prefer death to public speaking.

Comparison tables

Experienced versus inexperienced speaker

Point	Experienced	Inexperienced
Pace	Slow and steady	Fast
Start	Pause, then speak	Rushes
Nerves	Controls them	Overwhelmed

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Nervousness is natural and universal.
- It is energising because of adrenaline.
- 80 per cent prefer death to public speaking (survey cited).
- William James: survival devices.
- Preparation is the best antidote.
- Begin with familiar topics.
- Record yourself on a cell phone.
- Pause and breathe before starting.
- Check the venue in advance.
- Shakespeare: cowards die many times.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q7	p.35	Combating nervousness	MCQ
W10 Q8	p.35	Causes of nervousness	MCQ
W10 Q13	p.36	Anxiety and nervousness	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Nervousness is a natural, universal psychological and physiological response – dry throat, trembling, quivering voice, rapid heartbeat – caused by concern for one's image and unfamiliarity. It is useful because adrenaline gives extra energy (William James). Control it through thorough preparation, knowing the audience, starting with familiar topics, rehearsing and recording yourself, checking the venue, treating the audience as friends, pausing and breathing before speaking, speaking slowly, and reviewing if you forget. Fear is in the mind: bear it, not fear it.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The best antidote to nervousness is:

A. Speaking fast

B. Preparation

C. Avoiding the audience

D. Silence

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Preparation is the panacea.

Q2 (MCQ) Who said survival devices prepare us for an emergency?

A. William James

B. Orwell

C. Tuckman

D. Gunning

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Psychologist William James.

Q3 (MSQ) Stress busters include:

A. Deep breath

B. Starting with a pause

C. Speaking slowly

D. Speaking fast

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Fast speaking signals nervousness.

Q4 (T/F) Nervousness always harms a speaker's performance.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It is energising and natural.

Q5 (Fill) The keyed-up state caused by adrenaline is called _____.

> **Answer:** arousal
> **Why:** A psychological term.

Q6 (Short) What should you do if you forget a point?

> **Answer:** Review what you have said; repeating helps the audience and the next thought comes back.
> **Why:** Nothing disastrous will happen.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the symptoms.
☐ I know nervousness is natural.
☐ I can list causes and remedies.
☐ I know stress busters.
☐ I recall James, Sartre, Carnegie.

Lecture 49: Patterns and Methods of Presentation

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 800–813 (printed pages 799–812)

Learning objectives

- List the 5 Ps of presentations and the three stages of a presentation.
- Describe the five patterns: chronological, causal, problem–solution, spatial, topical.
- Describe the four methods of delivery: manuscript, memorised, impromptu, extemporaneous.
- Evaluate the advantages and limitations of each method.
- Recall the Shakespeare quotations used.

Important definitions

5 PS

Preparation, Planning, Practice, Pattern, Performance.

CHRONOLOGICAL PATTERN

Arranges material in time sequence, e.g. history of civilisation.

CAUSAL PATTERN

Presents causes first and then effects (cause–effect relationship); informative.

PROBLEM–SOLUTION PATTERN

Presents a problem (e.g. deforestation, pollution, global warming) and then offers solutions; persuasive.

SPATIAL PATTERN

Arranged by space or direction, e.g. design of a new product.

TOPICAL PATTERN

Divides information into topics and sub-topics; easiest when others do not fit.

READING FROM MANUSCRIPT

Delivering a written text word for word.

MEMORISED METHOD

Delivering a fully memorised text.

IMPROMPTU METHOD

Unprepared speech given on the spur of the moment.

EXTEMPORANEOUS METHOD

Flexible, prepared with notes/outline/slides, delivered conversationally.

Core concepts

5 Ps and stages

- **5 Ps:** preparation, planning, practice, pattern, performance.
- **Three stages:** pre-presentation, during presentation, post-presentation.
- Preparation is the best antidote to nervousness (fight or flight).

Five patterns of presentation

1. **Chronological** – time sequence, historical events.
2. **Causal** – causes then effects (e.g. causes and effects of nervousness).
3. **Problem–solution** – problem then solution; persuasive.
4. **Spatial** – space or direction, product design.
5. **Topical** – topics and sub-topics; easiest.

Choose according to topic and information.

Reading from manuscript

- **Advantages:** accuracy, suitable for technical or data-heavy subjects, carefully drafted words.
- **Limitations:** no eye contact or rapport; no control over crowd; hard to be spontaneous; strain on eyes; little vocal variety (modulation, pauses); time limit pressure (“Damocles’ sword”); needs a practised reader; audience loses interest.
- Not advisable for beginners.

Memorised method

- Looks fresh and allows eye contact.
- Problems: cannot memorise pauses, shifts in voice or transitions; speed and time control (may finish early); sounds like a robot; **forgetting a part halts the talk**; hard to prepare and sustain.

Impromptu method

- No preparation: on the spot (name announced suddenly).
- Challenging but rewarding; relies on **past reading, experience and observations**.
- Be **brief and to the point**; take a moment, pick a keyword; summarise when ideas run out; resist the temptation to add; silence is better than saying nothing.
- Be mentally prepared always.
- **Shakespeare:** ‘It is best to speak few than to speak more’; ‘There is nothing either good or bad, but thinking makes it so.’

Extemporaneous method

- Prepared flexibly: prepare **more material than needed**; use notes, slides and visual aids; **outline** ready so you can skip.
- Conversational and interactive; gauge the audience's mood and cut or squeeze points.
- Needs expertise.
- A speech may sound conversational but is not a conversation.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Patterns of presentation

Pattern	Basis	Example
Chronological	Time	History of civilisation
Causal	Cause → effect	Nervousness
Problem–solution	Problem → remedy	Deforestation, pollution
Spatial	Space / direction	Product design
Topical	Topics and sub-topics	General information

Methods of delivery

Method	Strength	Weakness
Manuscript	Accurate	No rapport; monotone
Memorised	Fresh, eye contact	Forgetting; robotic
Impromptu	Spontaneous, rewarding	No preparation
Extemporaneous	Flexible, interactive	Needs expertise and outline

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Presentation on deforestation, soil erosion or global warming (problem–solution).

EXAMPLE

Design of a new product (spatial).

EXAMPLE

Name suddenly announced at a function (impromptu).

Comparison tables

Causal versus problem–solution

Point	Causal	Problem–solution
Content	Causes and effects	Problem and remedies
Nature	Informative	Persuasive

Impromptu versus extemporaneous

Point	Impromptu	Extemporaneous
Preparation	None	Prepared with notes/outline
Flexibility	On the spur of the moment	Planned flexibility
Material	Past knowledge	More material than needed

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- 5 Ps: preparation, planning, practice, pattern, performance.
- Three stages: pre, during, post-presentation.
- Five patterns: chronological, causal, problem–solution, spatial, topical.
- Four methods: manuscript, memorised, impromptu, extemporaneous.
- Manuscript reading limits eye contact.
- Memorised talks fail when a part is forgotten.
- Impromptu: be brief.
- Extemporaneous: prepare more than needed; use outline.
- Topical is the easiest pattern.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q14	p.36	Methods of presentation	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Presentations are built on the 5 Ps and go through pre-, during and post-presentation stages. They may follow a chronological, causal, problem–solution, spatial or topical pattern. Delivery methods are reading from manuscript (accurate but lifeless), memorised (fresh but risky), impromptu (unprepared, brief, relies on experience) and extemporaneous (flexible, conversational, with outline and notes). Beginners should avoid reading and memorising; speaking extemporaneously with an outline is most effective.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which pattern arranges content by time sequence?

A. Spatial

B. Topical

C. Chronological

D. Causal

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Time and events.

Q2 (MCQ) Which method uses an outline and prepares more material than required?

A. Manuscript

B. Memorised

C. Impromptu

D. Extemporaneous

> **Answer:** D
> **Why:** Flexible method.

Q3 (MSQ) Limitations of reading from a manuscript include:

A. No rapport

B. Eye strain

C. Little vocal variety

D. Perfect spontaneity

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Spontaneity is lost.

Q4 (T/F) An impromptu speech should be long to impress the audience.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Be brief and to the point.

Q5 (Fill) The pattern that divides information into topics and sub-topics is _____.

> **Answer:** topical
> **Why:** Easiest to use.

Q6 (Short) Why is the memorised method risky?

> **Answer:** Forgetting one phrase can halt the talk; pauses and transitions are hard to memorise; speed is hard to control and delivery sounds robotic.
> **Why:** Not advisable for novices.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the 5 Ps.
☐ I can name five patterns.
☐ I can name four methods.
☐ I know the limits of manuscript and memorised.
☐ I know how to handle impromptu.

Lecture 50: Oral Presentation: Planning & Preparation

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 814–831 (printed pages 813–830)

Learning objectives

- Plan an oral presentation: purpose, topic, audience analysis, research, specific purpose statement.
- Prepare content that is audience-specific and written to be spoken.
- Structure the presentation into introduction, body and conclusion with time proportions.
- Plan visual aids, repetition, signposts and anticipated questions.
- Choose topics through an inventory and brainstorming.

Important definitions

PURPOSE STATEMENT

A specific statement of what the talk aims to do: add knowledge, persuade, inform of trends.

AUDIENCE ANALYSIS

Studying the age, background, education, faith, gender and interests of the listeners.

AUDIENCE-SPECIFIC CONTENT

Content designed to benefit the particular audience.

VERBATIM

Word for word, as in a full manuscript.

INVENTORY OF TOPICS

A personal record of topics and new information kept for future talks.

SIGNPOSTS / TRANSFER STATIONS

Transitions and previews that guide the audience through the talk.

CALL FOR ACTION

A closing appeal in problem–solution talks urging the audience to act.

Core concepts

Planning sequence

1. Know the **purpose**: why, whom and how.

2. Decide the **topic** (given by host or chosen by you).
3. **Analyse the audience**.
4. **Research** and gather information.
5. Formulate a **specific purpose statement**.
6. Prepare **content** and visual aids.
7. Divide into **beginning, middle, end**.
8. Plan for questions and practise.

Choosing the topic

- Pick a topic **familiar to you** (reduces nervousness) but add something new for the audience.
- Keep an **inventory** of topics of interest from school/college days; update it continuously (library, internet).
- **Brainstorm** about the audience's tastes, habits, interests, beliefs.
- Mix the new and the old: familiarity increases receptivity.

Audience analysis

- Many good presentations fail because the speaker did not understand the audience.
- Consider age, background, education, faith, gender, rural/urban, profession; mixed gatherings are common.
- Make the talk beneficial to them.

Preparing the content

- Good content matters more than a good voice.
- Write for the ear: compose word by word (manuscript method) but keep it spoken.
- **Short sentences** that speak; suitable, simple words; avoid jargon, clichés, circumlocution, idioms and phrases for second-language audiences.
- Use **repetition** and summarising (e.g. Martin Luther King's 'I have a dream').
- Insert transitions and signposts; plan places for pauses and shifts.

Visual aids

- Use for technical subjects; pictures aid understanding.
- Decide in advance **where** each aid will appear and mark it in the outline.
- Make aids relevant, specific and accessible; avoid merely catchy ones.

Three parts: beginning, middle, end

- **Introduction** – capture attention (quote, anecdote, story, e.g. Nehru's 'Tryst with destiny'); state purpose; preview main points; build credibility and rapport. About **2 minutes of a 20-minute talk**; do not make it long.
- **Body** – the heart of the matter; limit to **two or three points**, each explained and supported; simple, logical, stepwise.
- **Conclusion** – inference from the body; **restate and recapitulate** so the audience carries something home; call for action in problem–solution talks; signal the end ('to conclude…'); avoid an abrupt or limp ending.

Questions and notes

- Encourage questions; anticipate them and prepare answers.
- Prepare more material than required but be ready to skip.
- Note cards with legible keywords; leave space in the script to look up at the audience.
- Use quotations and references for support; create animation through word choice.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Structure of a presentation

Part	Role	Guidance
Introduction	Capture attention; preview	About 10% of time; quote, anecdote, story
Body	Develop 2–3 points	Logical, supported, simple
Conclusion	Recapitulate; call for action	Natural signal to end; invite questions

Planning checklist

Step	Question to ask
Purpose	Why am I speaking and to whom?
Topic	Is it familiar and useful to them?
Audience	Age, background, education?
Content	Are sentences short and spoken?
Aids	Where will each be used?
Questions	What will they ask?

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Martin Luther King’s repetition ‘I have a dream’.

EXAMPLE

Nehru’s ‘Tryst with destiny’ opening.

EXAMPLE

Presentation on modern cell phones adding special new information.

EXAMPLE

20-minute talk with a 2-minute introduction.

Comparison tables

Good versus poor introduction

Point	Good	Poor
Opening	Quote, anecdote, story	Long, dull background
Length	About 10% of time	Excessively long
Effect	Captures attention, rapport	Loses audience

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Planning starts with purpose, topic and audience.
- Speak on a familiar topic and add new information.
- Maintain an inventory of topics.
- Write short sentences meant to be spoken.
- Repetition helps (Martin Luther King).
- Decide positions of visual aids in the outline.
- Three parts: beginning, body, end.
- Introduction ≈ 2 minutes in a 20-minute talk.
- Restrict body to two or three points.
- Conclusion restates and may call for action.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q9	p.35	Prerequisites of an oral presentation	MCQ
W10 Q10	p.35	Selecting a topic	MCQ
W10 Q15	p.36	Audience analysis	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Plan an oral presentation by fixing the purpose, selecting a familiar yet fresh topic (using an inventory and brainstorming), analysing the audience and researching. Draft audience-specific content in short, simple, spoken sentences with repetition, signposts and planned visual aids. Structure it into a brief attention-grabbing introduction, a body of two or three well-supported points and a conclusion that recapitulates and, if needed, calls for action. Anticipate questions, prepare notes and extra material, and then practise.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) In a 20-minute talk, the introduction should take about:

A. 2 minutes

B. 10 minutes

C. 15 minutes

D. 5 minutes after the body

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Do not make it long.

Q2 (MCQ) How many main points should the body ideally have?

A. Two or three

B. Ten

C. Fifteen

D. As many as possible

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Avoid overload.

Q3 (MSQ) Good ways to open a presentation:

A. Quotation

B. Anecdote

C. Story

D. Apology for being unprepared

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Capture attention.

Q4 (T/F) A speech written to be spoken should use long, complex sentences.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use short sentences that speak.

Q5 (Fill) Keeping an _____ of topics helps in impromptu situations.

> **Answer:** inventory
> **Why:** Update it regularly.

Q6 (Short) What should the conclusion contain?

> **Answer:** An inference from the body, a restatement or recapitulation of main points, a call for action if relevant, and a natural signal that the talk is ending.
> **Why:** Avoid abrupt endings.

Revision checklist

☐ I can plan purpose, topic, audience.
☐ I know how to write for the ear.
☐ I know where to place visual aids.
☐ I can structure the three parts.
☐ I can anticipate questions.

Week 11: Presentations, Speeches and Interviews

1. Lecture 51: Making Effective Presentations
2. Lecture 52: Speeches for Various Occasions
3. Lecture 53: Interviews
4. Lecture 54: Planning and Preparation: Part-1
5. Lecture 55: Planning and Preparation: Part II

Lecture 51: Making Effective Presentations

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 832–851 (printed pages 831–850)

Learning objectives

- List the features of an effective presentation: beginning, voice, body language, humour, examples, ending.
- Explain the role of practice and rehearsal, including timing and self-recording.
- Describe delivery factors: expressiveness, rate, volume, pitch, articulation, appearance.
- Use visual aids, PPT slides and connectives effectively.
- State tips for the delivery day and recall Freud and Confucius.

Important definitions

EFFECTIVE PRESENTATION

A presentation that captivates at the start, is clear in voice and body language, uses humour and familiar examples, integrates aids and ends emphatically.

REHEARSAL (PRACTICE)

Repeated, timed practice of the presentation, ideally recorded and reviewed.

EXPRESSIVENESS

The quality of voice and body in conveying the intended meaning.

RATE

Speed of speaking in words per minute.

PITCH MOVEMENT / INTONATION

Rise and fall of voice to give emphasis and emotion.

CONNECTIVES (SIGNPOSTS)

Transitions, internal previews and internal summaries that show the audience where the speaker is.

LECTERN

A stand for notes that may also hide nervousness.

DESENSITISATION

Telling oneself positive things and visualising success to reduce anxiety.

Core concepts

Effective beginning

- Capture attention: a question, story, anecdote, episode or startling fact; avoid an abrupt start.
- Example: “There is one thing common to all of us…and that is nervousness.”
- Memorise the first lines and any quotation fully, with the name of the author, to avoid embarrassment.

Voice and body language

- **Voice:** clear and articulate; speak slowly enough that words are not eaten; voice can be trained.
- **Body language:** eye contact with all sections of the audience; stand firmly; use space naturally; gestures that match the message; avoid too frequent movement and fidgeting.
- **Freud:** “He who has eyes to see and ears to listen can convince himself that no mortal can keep a secret…betrayal oozes out of him at every pore.”

Humour and examples

- Humour relieves technical subjects (e.g. dentist joke) and sustains attention.
- Use familiar examples suited to the audience (sports, music, movies; for yoga, a mix).

Ending

End **emphatically** with a restatement and signposts (‘before I close…’); summarise main points; do not end abruptly or limply.

Practice and rehearsal

- Confidence cannot be gained in a day; rehearse repeatedly.
- Prepare a final **outline**; do not read word for word.
- **Time** yourself with a clock; cut points if too long; record on a cell phone to review body language, eye contact and voice.
- Be your own critic; give small presentations to friends for honest feedback; use a mirror.

PPT slides

- Use slides as an outline: only essential points, a limited number per slide; no clutter or reading from slides (same as reading from manuscript).
- Animation without ‘music of thought’ is useless.

Delivery factors

- **Expressiveness** of voice and body.
- **Rate:** moderate – the lecture cites 120–130 words per minute versus 180 as too fast.
- **Volume:** audible; adjust to hall, crowd and acoustics; keep a little distance from the microphone.
- **Pitch and intonation:** vary emphasis.
- **Articulation:** clear syllables.

- **Appearance:** formal, presentable dress, haircut, bearing; avoid distracting items (earrings, cell phones).

Visual aids and connectives

- Integrate aids at the relevant point; interpret them; do not stand between the aid and the audience (OHP failure).
- Use pointers properly.
- In speech we use **connectives** instead of punctuation: transitions, internal previews, internal summaries; signposts such as ‘finally’, ‘last but not the least’, ‘before I close’.

Tips

- Prepare thoroughly, practise repeatedly, time yourself.
- Use a lectern if needed; microphone etiquette (no shouting).
- Stress busters: desensitise, visualise success, begin with a pause, speak the first sentence from memory, keep eye contact, slow down.
- Move naturally; ignore smiles and whispers or treat them as appreciation.
- Do not read, do not memorise everything, no long introduction, no ‘verbal bullets’, avoid frowning.
- Keep writing and speaking when using a blackboard.
- Stand with one foot ahead of the other; avoid fidgeting.
- Give handouts after; stay for questions; if you cannot answer, offer to discuss later; end with summary and appreciation.
- **Confucius:** “A superior man is modest in his speech but exceeds in his actions.”

Types, classifications and characteristics

Features of effective delivery

Feature	Guidance
Beginning	Question, story, anecdote, startling fact
Voice	Clear, moderate rate, audible, varied pitch
Body language	Eye contact, natural gestures, firm stance
Humour/examples	Familiar, relevant
Aids	Integrated, interpreted
Ending	Emphatic recapitulation

Connectives

Type	Role
Transitions	Move to the next idea
Internal previews	Announce what comes next
Internal summaries	Recap points so far

Theories, principles, models and contributors

BODY BETRAYS THE SPEAKER — SIGMUND FREUD

The body speaks even when the lips are silent.

MODEST SPEECH, STRONG ACTION — CONFUCIUS

A superior man is modest in his speech but exceeds in his actions.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Speaker forgetting half of his opening quotation.

EXAMPLE

Dentist humour.

EXAMPLE

OHP presenter standing between the transparency and the audience.

EXAMPLE

Self-recording on a cell phone.

Comparison tables

PPT used well versus poorly

Point	Used well	Used poorly
Text	Few key points	Full paragraphs
Speaker	Talks with the audience	Reads from the slides
Result	Engagement	Dull, like reading a manuscript

Slow versus fast speaking

Point	Moderate rate (120–130 wpm)	Very fast (180 wpm)
Clarity	High	Words lost
Audience	Comfortable	Strained
Speaker	Controlled	Runs out of ideas

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Start with a question, story, anecdote or startling fact.
- Memorise opening and closing lines.
- Rate cited: 120–130 words per minute.
- Do not read slides.
- Time yourself and record your practice.
- Dress formally; check appearance.
- Do not stand between aid and audience.
- Use connectives and signposts.
- Freud: the body speaks.
- Confucius: modest in speech, exceed in action.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q4	p.34	Effective oral presentation	MCQ
W10 Q7	p.35	Combating nervousness	MCQ
W11 Q1	p.37	Delivery of presentations	MCQ
W11 Q2	p.37	Evaluating presentations	MCQ
W11 Q11	p.39	Evaluating presentations	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

An effective presentation opens with a captivating hook, uses a clear voice at a moderate rate, appropriate volume and varied pitch, supportive body language and eye contact, humour and familiar examples, well-integrated aids and signposts, and an emphatic ending. Success depends on rehearsal: outline, timing, recording and feedback. Slides should be an outline, not a script. On the day, begin with a pause, stay natural, dress formally, handle questions gracefully and end with a summary. Freud reminds that the body speaks; Confucius that a superior man is modest in speech.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which is a good way to begin a presentation?

A. An abrupt start

B. A startling fact or question

C. A long apology

D. Reading the title slowly

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Capture attention.

Q2 (MCQ) Reading from slides is equivalent to:

A. Extemporaneous speaking

B. Reading from a manuscript

C. Impromptu speaking

D. Debating

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It is dull.

Q3 (MSQ) Aids to practice include:

A. Timing with a clock

B. Recording on a cell phone

C. Using a mirror

D. Never rehearsing

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Rehearsal builds confidence.

Q4 (T/F) A speaker may stand between the visual aid and the audience.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It blocks the view.

Q5 (Fill) Speakers should begin with a _____ rather than rush.

> **Answer:** pause
> **Why:** Stress buster.

Q6 (Short) What are connectives in a talk?

> **Answer:** Transitions, internal previews and internal summaries that signal movement from one idea to the next.
> **Why:** Replace punctuation in speech.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list features of an effective presentation.
☐ I know how to rehearse.
☐ I know delivery factors.
☐ I can use slides properly.
☐ I recall Freud and Confucius.

Lecture 52: Speeches for Various Occasions

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 852–868 (printed pages 851–867)

Learning objectives

- Explain why professionals need to give occasion speeches.
- Differentiate speeches from presentations.
- Stress the importance of the beginning and closing, with the Antony and Frost illustrations.
- Describe the types: welcome, introductory, felicitation, commemorative, farewell, vote of thanks.
- State the do’s of each type.

Important definitions

SPEECH

A formal, subjective, emotion-soaked oral address for a specific occasion, without visual aids, depending on voice and language.

WELCOME SPEECH

A speech welcoming the chief guest and the audience, with accurate facts about the guest.

INTRODUCTORY SPEECH

A speech introducing a guest or speaker to the audience, praising achievements without embarrassment or exaggeration.

FELICITATION SPEECH

A speech honouring and celebrating a person’s achievements or award.

COMMEMORATIVE SPEECH

A speech honouring the memory of a person who is no more, in a sorrowful tone.

FAREWELL SPEECH

A leave-taking speech, in a subdued tone, by the organisation or by the departing person.

VOTE OF THANKS

Closing speech thanking everyone in order of seniority with reasons, briefly and warmly.

Core concepts

Why speeches

- We maintain social and professional relationships; occasions arise at work: welcoming guests, retirements, honours, tributes, farewells.
- Notice may be only a day or two, so always be ready.

Speech versus presentation

- Presentation: technical, complex, objective, with visual aids.
- Speech: emotional, sentimental, subjective, **no visual aids**; the speaker is the visual.
- Language: may be ornate or figurative but must stay **simple** and understandable; style varies by occasion.

Power of opening and closing

- The beginning should generate **intimacy**; the closing leaves a lasting impression (**Longfellow**: great is the art of beginning, but greater the art of ending).
- **Opening illustration:** in Shakespeare's *Julius Caesar* Antony wins over a hostile crowd by a courteous, subtle opening that asks for their attention and gradually reverses their opinion of Caesar as a traitor; 'half the battle is won in the beginning'.
- **Closing illustration:** a convocation address ending with a famous poem's lines about promises to keep and miles to go (Robert Frost) reminds graduates that life is a greater examination.

Welcome speech

- Gather facts about the guest; get the name and achievements exactly right.
- Welcome the chair, dignitaries, the guest **and the audience**; say why the guest is important and how the audience will benefit.
- Example: welcoming a renowned Indian English poet-novelist to a conference of English teachers.

Introductory speech

- Start with salutations and an engaging note; give achievements in short sentences.
- Do not speak too long; no embarrassing or untrue claims.
- Example: introducing Mukesh Ambani – joined Reliance in 1981, chairman in 2002, awards for telecom; end by inviting applause.

Felicitation speech

- Honour achievements; talk about the laurel, award or recognition and its impact.
- Example: felicitating a nominee to the World Bank for work benefiting farmers; use auspicious, respectful language.

Commemorative speech

- Honour the memory of a departed person; talk of loss and contribution.
- Tone is sorrowful; words figurative and suited to the occasion.
- Example: Pandit Nehru's address on the death of Mahatma Gandhi – light gone out, 'Bapu', 'Father of the Nation'.

Farewell speech

- Subdued tone; talk of the person's association and contribution; mention that he will be missed.
- If you are the one leaving: control emotions, thank organisers, be polite, brief and humble; do not exaggerate your contribution.
- No criticism and no excessive praise.

Vote of thanks

- Acknowledge everyone, in order of seniority, with **reasons**; include supporting staff.
- Brief but warm; change the language from the report acknowledgement; a touch of humour is welcome.
- Example: 'I am thankful to Mr X for his valuable contribution...'.

Closing quotation

Buddha: the wise fashion speech with thought, sifting it as grain is sifted through a sieve – speak only filtered, valuable thoughts. Work hopefully and prepare for every speech situation.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of occasion speeches

Type	Purpose	Tone / key point
Welcome	Welcome guest and audience	Respectful; accurate facts
Introductory	Introduce the speaker	Concise; no exaggeration
Felicitation	Honour achievements	Celebratory
Commemorative	Remember the departed	Sorrowful, subdued
Farewell	Bid goodbye	Warm, humble, brief
Vote of thanks	Thank all	Ordered, brief, warm

Theories, principles, models and contributors

ART OF ENDING — HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW (AS CITED)

Great is the art of beginning, but greater the art of ending.

SPEECH AS SIFTED THOUGHT — BUDDHA (AS CITED)

The wise shape speech with thought, sifting it like grain through a sieve.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Antony's funeral speech from Julius Caesar (opening).

EXAMPLE

Convocation address closing with lines from Robert Frost.

EXAMPLE

Nehru’s speech on Gandhi’s death.

EXAMPLE

Welcome to Prof. Shiv Kumar; introduction of Mukesh Ambani; felicitation on World Bank nomination.

Comparison tables

Speech versus presentation

Point	Speech	Presentation
Nature	Emotional, subjective	Technical, objective
Visual aids	None	Yes
Language	Ornate/figurative but simple	Plain, factual
Purpose	Occasion (honour, thanks, welcome)	Inform/persuade

Welcome versus introductory speech

Point	Welcome	Introductory
Addressee	Guest and audience	Audience about the speaker
Content	Gratitude and welcome	Achievements and background

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Six speech types: welcome, introductory, felicitation, commemorative, farewell, vote of thanks.
- Speeches have no visual aids.
- Beginning generates intimacy; closing leaves a lasting impression.
- Welcome speech welcomes both guest and audience.
- Do not exaggerate in introductions or farewells.
- Commemorative speech uses a sorrowful tone.
- Vote of thanks follows seniority and gives reasons.
- Longfellow: art of ending.
- Buddha: speech sifted like grain.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q3	p.37	Vote of thanks	MCQ
W11 Q4	p.37	Welcome speech vs vote of thanks	MCQ
W11 Q12	p.39	Opening and closing a speech	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Professionals must be ready to give speeches on occasions. Unlike presentations, speeches are emotional, subjective and without visual aids, so language, style, and especially the opening and closing matter, as illustrated by Antony's speech and a convocation ending. The six types are welcome, introductory, felicitation, commemorative, farewell and vote of thanks, each with its own tone and conventions: accurate facts, respect, no exaggeration, humility, brevity and warmth. Speak only sifted, valuable thoughts.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which speech honours the memory of a departed person?

A. Welcome
B. Felicitation
C. Commemorative
D. Vote of thanks

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Delivered in a sorrowful tone.

Q2 (MCQ) Visual aids are normally used in:

A. Speeches
B. Oral presentations
C. Farewell speeches
D. Vote of thanks

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Speeches rely on the speaker.

Q3 (MSQ) A vote of thanks should be:

A. In order of seniority

B. Brief

C. With reasons for thanks

D. Critical

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Never critical.

Q4 (T/F) A farewell speech should criticise the departing person.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** No criticism or exaggeration.

Q5 (Fill) A speech's beginning should generate _____.

> **Answer:** intimacy
> **Why:** It connects with the crowd.

Q6 (Short) What should be done in a welcome speech?

> **Answer:** Welcome the chief guest and the audience, state the guest's identity and importance accurately, and explain how the audience will benefit.
> **Why:** Gather accurate facts.

Revision checklist

☐ I can differentiate speech and presentation.

☐ I can list six types.

☐ I know each type's tone.

☐ I know how to open and close.

☐ I recall Longfellow and Buddha.

Lecture 53: Interviews

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 869–884 (printed pages 868–883)

Learning objectives

- Define an interview and explain the origin of the word.
- List the types of interview: informative, persuasive, exit, evaluation, counselling, conflict resolution, disciplinary, termination, job.
- State general skills needed by an interviewee.
- Describe the stages of the recruitment process.
- List attributes recruiters look for.

Important definitions

INTERVIEW

A face-to-face, mostly oral, systematic communication in which an interviewer tests the traits and qualities of an interviewee for a purpose; from French ‘entrevue’ (a sight between), glossed in the lecture as ‘to see the other person’.

INTERVIEWER / INTERVIEWEE

The person taking the interview / the person being interviewed.

INFORMATION-GATHERING INTERVIEW

An interview to collect data, e.g. by phone or Skype when time is short.

PERSUASIVE INTERVIEW

An interview to convince a person, e.g. to close a deal or to correct performance.

EXIT INTERVIEW

An interview with a departing employee to learn problems and get valuable suggestions.

EVALUATION INTERVIEW

A periodic progress review between a senior and a subordinate.

COUNSELLING INTERVIEW

An interview to motivate and boost the morale of employees.

CONFLICT-RESOLUTION INTERVIEW

An interview to resolve conflict between departments or persons.

DISCIPLINARY INTERVIEW

A fact-finding interview by a disciplinary committee after a mistake.

TERMINATION INTERVIEW

An interview before ending an employee's service (may involve a 'golden handshake').

STRESS INTERVIEW

An interview that tests the candidate in a stressful situation with challenging questions.

SCREENING

First stage where applications and CVs are sifted.

Core concepts

Nature of an interview

- Occurs in jobs, admissions, hospitals, hostels and organisations throughout life.
- Orality combined with non-verbal skills.
- **Pauline V. Young:** an interview is a systematic method by which a person enters imaginatively into the inner life of a comparative stranger.
- Nervousness arises because interviewers are strangers.

Types of interviews

1. **Informative** (data collection; telephonic, Skype).
2. **Persuasive** (convincing in deals or to improve performance).
3. **Exit** – leaving employees give honest, constructive inputs; avoid bad-mouthing.
4. **Evaluation** – progress reviews.
5. **Counselling** – morale boosting.
6. **Conflict resolution** between departments.
7. **Disciplinary** – fact finding.
8. **Termination** – final discussion; golden handshake.
9. **Job interview** (selection).

Skills for the interviewee

- **Confidence** – built by understanding the purpose and gathering information.
- Listen carefully to the whole question before answering.
- Anticipate questions; use intelligence for tricky ones (like Yorkers, googlies and bouncers in cricket).
- Use formal language; no informal expressions.

- Know your strengths and weaknesses; present weaknesses so they become merits; avoid over- or underestimating yourself.
- Understand the interviewer's needs and expectations.
- Behave well: every person present is observing.

Importance of preparation

John D. Singleton: "Very often the difference between the person hired and the person rejected is not who is the better candidate, but who is better prepared for the interview." Years of learning are judged in half an hour; careers can be made or lost there.

Stages of recruitment

1. **Screening** of applications and CVs (saleable résumé is essential).
2. **Competency tests** to eliminate candidates.
3. **Psychological tests.**
4. **Group discussion** / case.
5. **Negotiation.**
6. **Stress interview.**
7. **Medical test** (last).

What recruiters look for

- A good person, competent, an asset to the organisation; well informed and well rounded; good personality.
- **Attitude, adaptability, aptitude, behaviour, team spirit and dynamics.**
- Clarity of purpose, thought and expression; decision-making ability.
- Originality and innovative mind; cheerful disposition.
- Find information through newspapers (e.g. Times of India Ascent), Employment News and company websites.

Getting started

Mark Twain: the secret of getting ahead is getting started. Build confidence, revise the lectures on personality and positive thinking, prepare a good résumé to get the call (next lecture).

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of interviews and purposes

Type	Purpose
Information gathering	Collect data quickly
Persuasive	Convince or correct
Exit	Learn from departing employee
Evaluation	Review progress
Counselling	Boost morale
Conflict resolution	Settle disputes
Disciplinary	Find facts on misconduct
Termination	End service
Job	Select candidates

Stages of recruitment

Stage	Purpose
Screening	Sift CVs
Competency test	Test skills
Psychological test	Assess personality
Group discussion	Observe behaviour
Negotiation	Test bargaining
Stress interview	Test under pressure
Medical test	Final fitness check

Theories, principles, models and contributors

INTERVIEW AS SYSTEMATIC METHOD — PAULINE V. YOUNG

An interview is a systematic method by which a person imaginatively enters the inner life of a comparative stranger.

PREPARATION DECIDES SELECTION — JOHN D. SINGLETON

The hired candidate is often the better prepared, not the better.

GETTING AHEAD — MARK TWAIN

The secret of getting ahead is getting started.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Telephonic or Skype interview for data collection.

EXAMPLE

Exit interview of a long-serving employee.

EXAMPLE

Counselling interview after poor performance.

EXAMPLE

Cricket analogy: Yorkers, googlies, bouncers for tricky questions.

Comparison tables

Exit versus termination interview

Point	Exit interview	Termination interview
Initiator	Employee leaving	Employer ending service
Purpose	Feedback and inputs	Final discussion / settlement
Tone	Constructive	Formal, sensitive

Informative versus persuasive interview

Point	Informative	Persuasive
Aim	Collect information	Change opinion/action
Example	Telephonic data collection	Persuading a client or employee

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Interview: face-to-face, mostly oral, systematic.
- Pauline V. Young's definition.
- Types include exit, evaluation, counselling, conflict resolution, disciplinary and termination.
- Develop confidence by gathering information.
- Listen fully before answering.
- Use formal language.
- Stages: screening, competency test, psychological test, GD, negotiation, stress interview, medical.
- Recruiters seek attitude, adaptability, aptitude, team spirit.
- Singleton: preparation decides.
- Twain: get started.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q5	p.37	Types of interviews	MCQ
W11 Q6	p.38	Job interview process	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

An interview is a systematic, mostly oral face-to-face method to test an interviewee's traits; it has many forms: informative, persuasive, exit, evaluation, counselling, conflict resolution, disciplinary, termination and job interviews. Success needs confidence from information, careful listening, anticipation of questions, formal language, awareness of strengths and weaknesses and understanding the interviewer's expectations. Recruitment proceeds through screening, tests, GD, negotiation, stress interview and medical test; recruiters seek attitude, adaptability, aptitude, team spirit and clarity. Preparation (Singleton) and getting started (Twain) matter most.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which interview is held with a departing employee?

A. Exit

B. Persuasive

C. Disciplinary

D. Evaluation

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** To gain constructive inputs.

Q2 (MCQ) Which stage comes last in recruitment?

A. Screening

B. GD

C. Stress interview

D. Medical test

> **Answer:** D
> **Why:** Medical test comes last.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are types of interview?

A. Counselling

B. Conflict resolution

C. Disciplinary

D. Advertisement

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Advertisement is not an interview.

Q4 (T/F) Informal language is acceptable in interviews.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use formal language.

Q5 (Fill) A first stage of recruitment is _____ of applications.

> **Answer:** screening
> **Why:** CVs are sifted.

Q6 (Short) What does a counselling interview aim at?

> **Answer:** To motivate employees and boost their morale after problems or poor performance.
> **Why:** Also used in schools.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define interview.

☐ I know the types.

☐ I know the stages of recruitment.

☐ I know recruiters' expectations.

☐ I recall Young, Singleton, Twain.

Lecture 54: Planning and Preparation: Part-1

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 885–902 (printed pages 884–901)

Learning objectives

- List the preparatory steps before applying for a job.
- Explain self-analysis: who am I, achievements, strengths, weaknesses, values, personality, background, hobbies and career goals.
- Explain why researching the organisation and the job position matters.
- Differentiate intuitive skills from learned skills.
- Describe the interview file and the will to win.

Important definitions

SELF-ANALYSIS

Honest examination of one's qualifications, achievements, strengths, weaknesses, values, personality and goals before choosing a job.

USP (UNIQUE SELLING PRODUCT/PROPOSITION)

The one skill in which a person is most confident, which becomes a personal trademark for which they are called.

INTUITIVE SKILLS

Skills already present within a person, such as adaptability, assertiveness, creativity, resourcefulness and discretion, which can be further developed.

LEARNED SKILLS

Skills acquired through effort, such as computer programming, marketing, interpersonal skills, speaking, organising events, time management, coordination, leadership and writing.

INTERVIEW FILE

An organised file of résumé, certificates, degrees, experience letters, awards, scholarships and newspaper clippings prepared before the interview.

CORPORATE CULTURE

The work culture, language, values and ways of functioning of an organisation.

PANEL INTERVIEW

An interview in which several people judge the candidate together.

WILL TO WIN

The desire to succeed and the urge to reach one's full potential (Confucius, as cited).

Core concepts

Preparatory steps

1. **Analyse yourself** (self-analysis).
2. **Identify your skills.**
3. **Research the organisation.**
4. **Know the job position** (roles, responsibilities, expectations).
5. **Revise subject knowledge** and update skills.
6. Draft the **résumé** and build the interview file.

Choice alone is not the only ingredient in getting a job; qualification, skills and fit matter. Choosing a career in line with one's qualification avoids becoming a misfit.

Know yourself: who am I?

- People either underestimate or overestimate themselves.
- Ask 'Who am I?': think of qualifications, achievements (debates, speeches, sports, best paper award) and strengths.
- Everyone has some quality: speaking, writing, convincing, leadership, initiative, computing (C++, Oracle).
- Match strengths to jobs: good talkers and interviewers suit HR or placement cells.

Planning, goals and values

- Have a plan: e.g. write books, become CEO, head the training and placement cell, general manager or regional head.
- Be clear about goals; review past achievements (papers, patents, books, contribution to the field).
- Prioritise the skill in which you are most confident; it becomes your **USP**.
- Decide what you **value**: money, status, power, position, recognition as a researcher, administrative acumen.
- Values shape the job choice: administrative service for those wanting a group; a laboratory or cabin for researchers.

Personality and behaviour

- Do you work with a group or in isolation? A person who wants to work in isolation is not fit for today's organisations.
- Mental alertness, anticipation and foresight (a visionary).
- Work style: aggressive or democratic; slow but steady; perfectionist or specialist.
- How fast or slow you think.

Background, hobbies and goals

- Background: schools, exposure to the outside world, accomplishments (grades, distinctions, papers).

- Hobbies and interests may be asked, since recruiters want a **well-rounded** person, not merely bookish; workplace requires social relationships and responsibility.
- Career goals must be defined.

Research the organisation

- Visit the company website (e.g. Wipro, Infosys, L&T, Reliance, Reliance Jio): operations, growth rate, history, work culture, language of correspondence, new products.
- Know the corporate culture, faiths and cultures of an MNC workforce and the language used.
- Questions may come from the organisation's recent achievements; be updated.

Know the job

- Understand roles, responsibilities, challenges, special duties, career prospects, enhancement opportunities and promotions.
- You may be asked which task you can do more comfortably; psychologists may create challenging situations to test your response.
- Anticipate beforehand.

Update subject knowledge and skills

- Revise subject knowledge; a master's done long ago needs updating.
- A skilled person never sits idle (e.g. a cobbler, car or bike mechanic).
- Today's organisations need multiple skills; a person who says he will do only one job is a 'gone case'.

Intuitive and learned skills

- **Intuitive (inborn):** adaptability, assertiveness, creativity, resourcefulness, efficiency, leadership, broad-mindedness, discretion, ability to assimilate differing opinions.
- **Learned:** computer/programming skills, marketing and deal making, interpersonal skills, speaking on occasions, organising events/conferences/workshops, training, time management, coordination, administrative and leadership skills, writing for different occasions.

Interview file and will to win

- Develop the interview file well in advance; do not be at 'sixes and sevens' on the day.
- Contents: **résumé that sells**, certificates, degrees, diplomas in proper order, experience certificates, conference/competition/workshop certificates, awards, scholarships, fellowships, newspaper clippings for a quick glance.
- Be confident that the recruiter is waiting for you.
- **Confucius (as cited):** "The will to win, the desire to succeed, the urge to reach your full potential: these are the keys that will unlock the door to personal excellence."
- Winners do things with a difference; those not selected get another chance.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Intuitive versus learned skills

Intuitive skills	Learned skills
Adaptability	Computer programming
Assertiveness	Marketing and deal making
Creativity	Interpersonal and speaking skills
Resourcefulness	Time management
Discretion, broad-mindedness	Coordination, leadership, writing

Self-analysis checklist

Aspect	Question
Identity	Who am I?
Achievements	What have I accomplished?
Strengths and weaknesses	What are my qualities?
Values	Money, status, power or recognition?
Personality	Group or isolation; fast or slow?
Background	Education, exposure, hobbies
Goals	Where do I want to be?

Theories, principles, models and contributors

WILL TO WIN — CONFUCIUS (AS CITED)

The will to win, the desire to succeed and the urge to reach full potential unlock personal excellence.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A graduate in a relevant field switching to an unrelated job becomes a misfit.

EXAMPLE

Applying to Wipro, Infosys, L&T or Reliance Jio: study the website.

EXAMPLE

Someone with strong speaking and convincing ability choosing HR, placement or recruitment cell.

EXAMPLE

Cobbler and mechanic as skilled people who never sit idle.

Comparison tables

Intuitive versus learned skills

Point	Intuitive	Learned
Source	Within the person	Acquired by effort
Examples	Adaptability, creativity, assertiveness	Programming, marketing, writing, time management
Action	Explore and develop	Learn and practise

Underestimating versus overestimating oneself

Point	Underestimating	Overestimating
Result	Missed opportunities	Unrealistic job choices
Remedy	Self-analysis	Self-analysis

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- First preparatory step: analyse yourself.
- Second: identify your skills.
- Research the organisation and the job position.
- Revise subject knowledge.
- Skills are intuitive or learned.
- USP: unique selling product.
- A person working in isolation is unfit for today’s organisations.
- Recruiters prefer well-rounded candidates.
- Interview file contains résumé, certificates, awards and clippings.
- Confucius quoted on the will to win.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q7	p.38	Self-analysis for interviews	MCQ
W11 Q8	p.38	Job analysis	MCQ
W11 Q15	p.39	Interview file	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Preparation for an interview begins long before the call. Analyse yourself honestly (qualifications, achievements, strengths, weaknesses, values, personality, background, hobbies, goals), identify and prioritise your skills to form a USP, and research both the organisation (website, growth, culture, new products) and the job (roles, responsibilities, prospects). Revise subject knowledge and update skills. Skills are intuitive (adaptability, assertiveness, creativity, resourcefulness) or learned (computer, marketing, speaking, time management, leadership, writing). Build an interview file and a saleable résumé, and keep the will to win.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The first preparatory step before applying for a job is:

A. Writing a résumé

B. Self-analysis

C. Medical test

D. Salary negotiation

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Analyse yourself first.

Q2 (MCQ) Which of these is an intuitive skill?

A. Computer programming

B. Adaptability

C. Time management

D. Report writing

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Adaptability is within us; others are learned.

Q3 (MSQ) Which belong in an interview file?

A. Certificates

B. Awards and scholarships

C. Newspaper clippings

D. Other candidates' résumés

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Only your own documents.

Q4 (T/F) A person who prefers working in isolation suits today's organisations well.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Group work is essential.

Q5 (Fill) The skill in which one is most confident becomes one's _____.

> **Answer:** USP
> **Why:** Unique selling product.

Q6 (Short) Why should a candidate research the organisation before an interview?

> **Answer:** Questions may be asked about its growth, culture, products and work environment, and knowing them shows interest and helps present oneself as a fit.
> **Why:** Use the company website.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list preparatory steps.
☐ I can do a self-analysis.
☐ I know intuitive versus learned skills.
☐ I know how to research an organisation and job.
☐ I know the contents of an interview file.

Lecture 55: Planning and Preparation: Part II

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 903–924 (printed pages 902–923)

Learning objectives

- Differentiate résumé and CV with their etymologies.
- State the purpose and requirements of a standard résumé.
- List special skills and personal attributes recruiters want.
- Describe the three formats: chronological, functional, hybrid.
- Explain the parts of a résumé opening: heading, career objective, summary of qualification.
- State do’s and don’ts of résumé writing.

Important definitions

RÉSUMÉ

From French, ‘to summarise’: a document summarising one’s achievements, education, experience and future intentions to create interest in one’s candidature.

CURRICULUM VITAE (CV)

From Latin, ‘the course of life’ / details of qualification: a more detailed document than a résumé; the two terms are often used interchangeably.

CAREER OBJECTIVE

A specific statement of the position sought and the skills to be used, expressing short- and long-term goals.

CHRONOLOGICAL RÉSUMÉ

Lists experience in time order from the latest to the earliest; suits experienced candidates.

FUNCTIONAL (SKILL) RÉSUMÉ

Emphasises skills and abilities; suits entry-level candidates.

HYBRID / COMBINATIONAL RÉSUMÉ

A mix of chronological and functional formats.

ACTION VERBS

Past-tense verbs that ‘speak’, such as accomplished, assisted, demonstrated, identified, investigated, participated, supervised, streamlined.

REFERENCES (REFEREES)

People who can verify one's capability; supplied if asked.

SCANNABLE RÉSUMÉ

A résumé on good-quality paper that can be scanned or sent as an attachment.

Core concepts

Résumé versus CV

- **Résumé** (French): a summary; **CV** (Latin): curriculum vitae, more detailed.
- Used interchangeably; some organisations ask for one, some for the other.
- A résumé accompanies an **application letter**.

Purpose of a résumé

- The first round of selection (elimination) is through the résumé.
- Its purpose is to **kindle interest** in your candidature and win an **interview call**.
- Many candidates fail by being too weighty or poorly framed.

Requirements of a standard résumé

- **Formatted** (no handwritten résumé today) in a systematic manner; many organisations give a proforma, others test your own format.
- **Specific** to the advertised post and its required skills.
- **Error-free** in grammar and spelling.
- Broken into units, with **crisp phrases** and specific words; use **action verbs**.
- Positive image: 'sell' yourself (e.g. academically gifted, leader); relate your best features and relegate weaknesses; do not overestimate yourself.

Contents

- Career goals/objective, education, work experience, activities, honours, rewards, awards, special skills, references.

Special skills

- **Computer proficiency** (paperless office).
- **Foreign-language** proficiency (multicultural workplaces).
- **Writing** ability and interpersonal/human skills.
- **Problem-solving** and **decision-making**.

Personal attributes

- Enthusiasm, initiative, motivation, adaptability, sense of humour, friendliness; also gregarious, self-starter, manager, good speaker/writer, creative, communicative.
- Today's organisations are people organisations.

Education, experience and references

- **Education:** school, college, university, other courses.
- **Experience:** even brief or small experiences count; freshers can cite fests, group projects, reports, responsibilities, with their **role** clearly stated.
- Mention gaps and job changes accurately; longer service helps; be honest if terminated (they may ask).
- **References:** former or present employers, colleagues, professors; **not relatives**; write 'available on request' and give only when asked.

Types of résumé

1. **Chronological** – experienced; latest to earliest; shows work style.
2. **Functional / skill** – entry-level; highlights skills.
3. **Hybrid / combinational** – blend of the two.

Opening of a résumé

- **Heading:** exact name as on certificates (no nickname), permanent and campus address, an active phone number, a frequently checked email, and URL/web page if any.
- **Career objective:** specific, not generalised. Examples: 'To obtain a position as a software engineer allowing me to utilise my knowledge of Oracle and Linux'; 'To obtain a post of marketing support representative where skills in administration and management, program development, public relations and writing can be used'.
- **Summary of qualification:** start with the highest qualification, in order (e.g. B.Tech in computer science with specialisation in networking).

Style and length

- Use active statements and phrases consistently, not a mix of sentences and phrases; begin with action verbs; avoid weak words like 'help'; avoid 'I was in charge of…'.
- **Length:** 1 to 1.5 pages for entry-level candidates; even one page is fine if it shows skills.
- Use good-quality paper; the résumé may be scanned.

Do's and don'ts

- **Do:** mention major activities, job objective, use proper headings, be honest, be specific, update regularly.
- **Don't:** write an autobiography; list every strength (keep something for the interview); mention salary; criticise a previous employer; overestimate yourself.
- Statements in the résumé must match reality.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of résumé

Type	Basis	Best for
Chronological	Time order (latest to earliest)	Experienced candidates
Functional (skill)	Skills and abilities	Entry-level candidates
Hybrid / combinational	Mix of both	Mixed profiles

Sections of a résumé opening

Section	Content
Heading	Name, address, phone, email, URL
Career objective	Specific position and skills to be used
Summary of qualification	Highest qualification first

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Career objective: software engineer using Oracle and Linux.

EXAMPLE

Career objective: marketing support representative using administration, program development, PR and writing.

EXAMPLE

Action verbs: accomplished, assisted, demonstrated, identified, investigated, participated, supervised, streamlined.

EXAMPLE

Freshers citing college fests (techno fests, Cognizance) and group projects.

Comparison tables

Résumé versus CV

Point	Résumé	CV
Origin	French: summary	Latin: course of life
Detail	Brief summary	More detailed
Usage	Often interchangeable	Often interchangeable

Chronological versus functional résumé

Point	Chronological	Functional
Focus	Work history in time order	Skills
Suits	Experienced	Entry-level
Other name	–	Skill résumé

Weak versus strong wording

Weak	Strong
I was in charge of the lab for two years	Supervised the fluid mechanics lab for two years
Helped with...	Assisted / streamlined / demonstrated...

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Résumé is French for summary; CV is Latin.
- Purpose: to get an interview call.
- No handwritten résumés today.
- Résumé must be specific, error-free, formatted.
- Use action verbs in the past tense.
- Three types: chronological, functional (skill), hybrid.
- Length for entry-level: 1 to 1.5 pages.
- Heading: real name, address, phone, email, URL.
- Do not give references unless asked; avoid relatives.
- Do not mention salary or criticise previous employer.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q9	p.38	Purpose of a résumé	MCQ
W11 Q10	p.38	Résumé guidelines	MCQ
W11 Q14	p.39	Résumé length	True/False
W12 Q11	p.42	Résumé: references	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

A résumé (French: summary) or CV (Latin: course of life) is a formatted, specific, error-free document that kindles interest and secures an interview call. It presents career objective, education, experience,

activities, honours, skills (computer, foreign language, writing, problem solving, decision making) and attributes (enthusiasm, initiative, motivation, adaptability, humour). Formats are chronological (experienced), functional/skill (entry-level) and hybrid. Open with heading, a specific career objective and qualifications from highest downward; use action verbs, keep to 1–1.5 pages, give references only on request, and never mention salary, criticise employers or overestimate yourself.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) A functional résumé is also called a:

A. Chronological résumé

B. Skill résumé

C. Hybrid résumé

D. CV

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It highlights skills.

Q2 (MCQ) The word ‘résumé’ comes from:

A. Latin

B. French

C. Greek

D. German

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It means to summarise.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are special skills recruiters look for?

A. Computer proficiency

B. Foreign language

C. Problem solving

D. Salary demand

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Salary should not be mentioned.

Q4 (T/F) References should include relatives who will praise you.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use employers or professors, and only when asked.

Q5 (Fill) The recommended length of a fresher’s résumé is 1 to _____ pages.

> **Answer:** 1.5
> **Why:** Not longer.

Q6 Short What is a career objective?

> **Answer:** A specific statement of the position sought and the skills to be used, expressing the candidate's aims.
> **Why:** Avoid generalised objectives.

Revision checklist

☐ I can differentiate résumé and CV.
☐ I know the three formats.
☐ I can write a heading and career objective.
☐ I can use action verbs.
☐ I know the do's and don'ts.

Week 12: Resume, Interviews, Emotional Intelligence and Grammar

1. Lecture 56: Drafting an Effective Resume
2. Lecture 57: Facing Job Interviews: Part- I
3. Lecture 58: Facing Job Interviews: Part II
4. Lecture 59: Emotional Intelligence and Critical Thinking
5. Lecture 60: Applied Grammar

Lecture 56: Drafting an Effective Resume

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 925–947 (printed pages 924–946)

Learning objectives

- Draft each section of an effective résumé: objective statement, education, additional qualifications, experience, activities and honours, special skills, references.
- Apply action verbs and parallelism in résumé writing.
- Explain what an application (covering) letter is and its three-paragraph structure.
- Use specific, active, unbiased language in the cover letter.
- Analyse a sample entry-level résumé.

Important definitions

OBJECTIVE STATEMENT

A one-to-three-line summary of area of expertise and career interest, placed just after the heading; focused and specific.

COVERING LETTER (APPLICATION LETTER)

A short letter, much like a business or sales letter, whose main purpose is to attract the employer to read the résumé.

PARALLELISM

Using the same grammatical form for items in a list, e.g. each résumé bullet beginning with a past-tense action verb.

PROFESSIONAL REFERENCES

Referees such as professors, project in-charge, heads or employers, as opposed to personal acquaintances.

SCANNABLE LETTER

A letter in which each paragraph begins with a topic sentence so that it can be skimmed or scanned.

ACTION PHRASE

A phrase beginning with a strong verb, e.g. organised a debate, conducted a workshop, represented the college team.

Core concepts

Three parts of a résumé

Like every letter, a résumé has an **opening**, **body** and **close**. Remember: a résumé is only a **passport**; leave something for the interview. Demonstrate what you can do for the company, not what the company can do for you.

Objective statement

- One to three lines, complete and focused; tells recruiters your skills.
- Avoid generalised statements such as ‘a position allowing me to use my knowledge in different areas’.
- Be specific. Examples: ‘a position allowing me to apply my background in engineering and high performance computing to biological problems’; ‘a marketing position with an opportunity for eventual managerial status requiring strong customer contact skills’.

Education

- List in **reverse order**: latest first (master’s, then B.Tech); a graduate starts from graduation.
- Give grade as on the marks sheet: CGPA if the institute uses CGPA, percentage otherwise.

Additional qualifications

- Courses that make you stand out: German or French, programming languages, effective English, business law, ethics.
- **Never mention what you do not have.**
- Write the **course title**, not just a code like HS 001.

Employment experience

- Freshers: internship (e.g. two months), practice school, project in an organisation, brief positions related to the job.
- Use **action verbs**; replace weak words (got, help) by assisted, demonstrated, supervised, coordinated.
- Examples: organised a debate during Cognizance 2017; conducted a workshop; represented the college team in volleyball.
- Mention exact dates and place of internship; everything may be questioned in the interview.

Parallelism in bullets

Begin each bullet with the same form: *oversaw the planning..., assisted in training and development, created a positive..., supervised, coordinated*. Do not mix full sentences with fragments.

Activities and honours

- Volunteering, representing the institute, awards, fellowships and visits abroad carry weight.
- Include only those you can discuss at the interview.

Special skills

- Two foreign languages (German, French) help in MNCs; NSS/social service shows the ‘extra mile’.
- Name software specifically (C++, Oracle); give course duration or dates.

References

- Preferably ‘available upon request’; if compulsory give **professional** references (professor, project in-charge, head, employer) with full address, phone and URL.
- **Inform the referee in advance**, send your résumé, tell about the company.

Application (covering) letter

- Like a business or sales letter; purpose: **attract the employer to read the résumé**.
- Short; **three paragraphs**, no longer than one page.
- Begin with a header giving the addressee’s name and address.
- **Paragraph 1:** get attention (AIDA-like sales technique), mention the source of the advertisement and your suitability. E.g. ‘I believe that my knowledge of public relations and proven communication and leadership skills make me a strong candidate for the position of media relations coordinator…’.
- **Paragraph 2 (body):** support candidacy with experience; **show, do not tell**; refer to the enclosed résumé. E.g. ‘As a banking representative at … I provided quality service while promoting sale of products…’ (must have a grain of truth).
- **Paragraph 3:** emphatic close creating opportunity: ‘I would welcome the opportunity to discuss these and other qualifications with you’; give a working phone number; ask for a personal interview; end with thanks.

Language of the letter

- Active voice; **past tense** for past work, present for present responsibilities; balance past and present.
- Be specific with figures: ‘I initiated a program to attract customers to Pizza Hut which resulted in a 10 percent increase’ instead of ‘I attempted to attract customers’.
- Avoid weak words (tried, helped, attempted), gender-biased words (use chairperson), jargon, clichés, redundancy.
- Proofread; mail with résumé in a proper envelope; address company values (‘your esteemed organisation’).

Sample résumé (Nischay Buddhiraja)

- Objective: ‘Position in sales or marketing with opportunity for advancement and travel.’
- Academic profile with action verbs in past tense: scored 100 percentile, completed B.Tech, obtained, secured.
- Achievements: presented a paper on the Aadhaar card and data security at IIT Delhi and won first prize; submitted a project on Electro Volt at Apogee, BITS Pilani.
- Extracurricular activities; no referees because the format had no space (could write ‘on request’); personal details: date of birth, father’s name, languages, nationality, hobbies.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Résumé sections in order

Section	Key rule
Heading	Real name, contact details
Objective	1–3 specific lines
Education	Latest first; grade as on marks sheet
Additional qualifications	Real courses, with titles
Experience	Action verbs; dates; relevant
Activities and honours	Discussable at interview
Special skills	Named and specific
References	Professional; on request

Three paragraphs of the covering letter

Paragraph	Function
1	Attract attention; source of advertisement; suitability
2	Support with experience; show, don't tell; refer to résumé
3	Emphatic close; request interview; thank

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Objective: apply engineering and high performance computing to biological problems.

EXAMPLE

Verb list: oversaw, assisted, created, demonstrated, supervised, coordinated.

EXAMPLE

Cover letter line: strong candidate for media relations coordinator.

EXAMPLE

I initiated a program to attract customers to Pizza Hut resulting in a 10 percent increase.

EXAMPLE

Sample résumé of Nischay Buddhiraja.

Comparison tables

Generalised versus specific objective

Point	Generalised	Specific
Example	A position using my knowledge in different areas	A position applying engineering and HPC to biological problems
Effect	Lose chance	Shows fit

Weak versus strong statements

Weak	Strong
I attempted to attract customers	I initiated a program that raised sales by 10 percent
Helped	Assisted / coordinated
Chairman	Chairperson

Résumé versus covering letter

Point	Résumé	Covering letter
Length	1–1.5 pages	One page, three paragraphs
Role	Details of qualifications	Attracts the employer to read the résumé
Form	Phrases with action verbs	Business/sales letter

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Objective statement: 1 to 3 lines.
- A résumé is a passport; leave something for the interview.
- Education in reverse chronological order.
- Mention CGPA or percentage as on the marks sheet.
- Write the course name, not the code.
- Never mention what you do not have.
- Use parallelism with action verbs.
- Referees must be informed beforehand.
- Covering letter: three paragraphs, one page.
- Use specific figures; avoid gender-biased words.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W12 Q1	p.40	Career objective in a résumé	MCQ
W12 Q2	p.40	Action phrases in a résumé	MCQ
W12 Q11	p.42	Résumé: references	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

An effective résumé opens with a specific one-to-three-line objective, lists education from latest to earliest with grades as on the marks sheet, names real additional courses, uses parallel action-verb phrases for experience, highlights activities, honours and named special skills, and gives professional references only when needed. The covering letter, a short three-paragraph business/sales letter, attracts the reader in the first paragraph, shows rather than tells in the body, and closes emphatically with a request for an interview. Language should be active, specific, unbiased and error free.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The objective statement should be:

A. Generalised
B. One to three lines and specific
C. A full page
D. Omitted

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Specific and focused.

Q2 (MCQ) In the education section, entries are listed:

A. Oldest first
B. Latest first
C. Alphabetically
D. Randomly

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Reverse chronological.

Q3 (MSQ) The covering letter should be:

A. Within one page

B. Three paragraphs

C. Attractive in the first paragraph

D. A full autobiography

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** It only attracts attention.

Q4 (T/F) Referees need not be informed before their names are given.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Inform them and send your résumé.

Q5 (Fill) Use the course _____, not just the code, in the résumé.

> **Answer:** title
> **Why:** Recruiters cannot decode HS 001.

Q6 (Short) What is parallelism in a résumé?

> **Answer:** Starting list items with the same grammatical form, e.g. past-tense action verbs such as supervised, coordinated, assisted.
> **Why:** Makes bullets consistent.

Revision checklist

☐ I can write a specific objective.
☐ I can list education correctly.
☐ I can use action verbs and parallelism.
☐ I can structure a covering letter.
☐ I can avoid weak and biased language.

Lecture 57: Facing Job Interviews: Part- I

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 948–965 (printed pages 947–964)

Learning objectives

- List the types of interview questions.
- Explain how to be patient, positive and confident before and during an interview.
- Describe the importance of appearance, personality, dress, grooming and bearing.
- State the dress code for men and women.
- Explain the role of voice, pauses, mannerisms and nonverbal cues.

Important definitions

TYPES OF QUESTIONS

Open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical and leading questions.

TACT

The skilful way of combining sentences and responding to questions without offending.

PERSONALITY TEST

An interview stage that judges personality traits and communication beyond subject knowledge.

BEARING

The manner of carrying oneself: facial expression, posture, enthusiasm.

MANNERISMS

Habitual ways of behaving: how one looks, bends, turns, greets and responds.

CIRCUMLOCUTION

Roundabout questioning by interviewers that may puzzle the candidate.

DECORUM

Appropriate, dignified behaviour and dress for a formal occasion.

Core concepts

Facing the call

- An interview call brings delight and fear.

- Success depends on **how well you are prepared**, not on contacts.
- Most interviews are 'decided in our brains' by anticipation; tell yourself you can answer.

Types of questions

Open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical and leading questions (discussed in later lectures).

Patience, positivity, tact

- Panel members may ask in quick succession; the best approach is **patience**.
- Be confident and positive; be aware of likely questions; use **tact** and **intuition**; stay energetic.
- **Control your nerves**; remain committed; do not show frustration by gesture or posture, since everything within is written on the face.

Conduct during questioning

- Half of the battle is won by **nonverbal behaviour**.
- **Let the interviewer lead**; do not answer before the question is complete.
- Pause, stay composed, do not hurry or speak too fast; do not give the impression you know everything.
- Listen throughout; answer as if responding, not imposing.

Bolstering confidence through appearance

- Appearance covers dress, sitting posture, facial emotions, enthusiasm and preparations.
- Appearances can be deceptive and experienced interviewers can detect it; do not beguile; present yourself as you are but positively. Quoted: 'A false face must have a false heart within' (Shakespeare, *Macbeth*).

Vocal characteristics and mannerisms

- Neither too loud nor too fast; balance speed, rate, pitch.
- Mannerisms (how you look at, bend towards or turn from different interviewers) can offend; stay composed.

Personality counts

- Many selections include a **personality test** after the written test.
- **Dale Carnegie:** personality is one of the important attributes for success; a New York department-store employment manager would rather hire a salesgirl who had not finished grade school but had a **lovely smile** than a PhD with a sober smile.
- Employers prefer better communicators with good traits over degrees alone.

Dress and grooming (general)

- Dress to suit the formality of the occasion: not gaudy, flamboyant or too loose; need not be expensive but should be simple, pleasant and clean.
- **Richard Bolles**, *What Color Is My Parachute?*, is cited on dress and career choice.
- Hair: dignified, not trendy or imitating celebrities ('until you become a celebrity, be your own self'); short hair fares better; no long sideburns.
- Face: warm, sincere; clean-shaven preferred, or neatly trimmed; trimmed nails.

- Minimal cologne; minimal or no jewellery (no chains, bands, necklaces, earrings for men; rings kept minimum).

Dress for men

- **Shirt:** good quality, button-down or classic colour, properly washed and ironed.
- **Suit:** navy blue, dark brown or grey; natural-fibre blend; properly tailored, not designer; fresh and clean; two-piece.
- **Tie:** good-quality blend, conservative stripes, simple pattern; **tip should end near the centre of the belt**.
- **Shoes:** black (or brown), polished, not pointed or designer; dark socks.
- Black or blue, **not red**; carry a small briefcase or portfolio.

Dress for women

- Conservative business suit or full dress in natural woven blend and soft colour matching skin and hair.
- Sensible polished pumps, **not high heels**.
- Small purse; minimal nail polish; minimal jewellery: **one set of earrings and no more than one ring on each hand**.

Voice and pronunciation

- Voice is the vehicle of expression: audible, clear, distinct, neither too fast nor too slow.
- Use standard, understandable pronunciation, articulated clearly.
- Use **silence and pauses**; interviewers are observing, not trying to eliminate you.

Tough questioning and mindset

- Interviewers may rotate or twist questions; stay polite, flexible and tactful.
- Each interview, even a failure, has meaning; the door is never closed. ‘You can fare well only when you can dare well.’

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of interview questions

Type
Open
Closed
Probing
Reflective
Loaded
Hypothetical
Leading

Dress code at interviews

Item	Men	Women
Outfit	Two-piece suit in navy, dark brown or grey; button-down shirt	Conservative business suit or full dress in soft colour
Shoes	Black or brown polished; dark socks	Polished pumps; low heel
Accessories	Simple tie ending at belt centre; minimal jewellery	Small purse; one set of earrings; one ring per hand
Grooming	Short hair, trimmed beard or clean-shaven, trimmed nails	Minimal nail polish and fragrance

Theories, principles, models and contributors

PERSONALITY OVER DEGREES — DALE CARNEGIE

Personality is vital to career success; a lovely smile may outweigh a PhD with a sober smile.

DRESS AS INDICATOR — RICHARD BOLLES (CITED)

Dress indicates background and attitude; author of *What Color Is My Parachute?*

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Carnegie’s example of the New York department store employment manager.

EXAMPLE

Interviewer rotates questions to puzzle the candidate.

EXAMPLE

Candidate answers before the question ends and gets into trouble.

EXAMPLE

Candidate with celebrity-style hair or jewellery distracted from the interview.

Comparison tables

Dress for men versus women

Point	Men	Women
Suit	Navy, brown, grey two-piece	Conservative business suit / full dress
Footwear	Black polished shoes	Polished pumps, low heel
Jewellery	Almost none	One set earrings; one ring each hand

Confident versus pretentious behaviour

Point	Confident	Pretentious
Dress	Simple, clean, formal	Gaudy, flamboyant, designer
Answering	Pauses, listens, tactful	Interrupts, rushes, shows off
Self-image	Presents self as is	Beguiles

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Preparation is the best way to face an interview.
- Question types: open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical, leading.
- Let the interviewer lead; do not answer before the question ends.
- Half the battle is won by nonverbal behaviour.
- Carnegie’s smile example.
- Men: navy blue, dark brown or grey suit; black polished shoes.
- Tie tip near the centre of the belt.
- Women: low-heeled polished pumps; minimal jewellery.
- Use pauses and clear, audible voice.
- Failure in one interview is not the end.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W12 Q3	p.40	Confidence in interviews	MCQ
W12 Q4	p.40	Vocal characteristics in interviews	MCQ
W12 Q12	p.42	Paralanguage in interviews	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Facing an interview calls for preparation, patience, positivity and nerve control. Let the interviewer lead, listen fully, pause before answering and use tact. Appearance, personality, dress, grooming, voice and mannerisms all communicate; Carnegie stresses that personality (even a lovely smile) can outweigh degrees. Men should wear a well-tailored navy, brown or grey suit, button-down shirt, simple tie ending at the belt centre and polished black shoes; women a conservative business suit or full dress, low-heeled pumps and minimal jewellery. Speak clearly with controlled rate, use pauses, remain polite with tricky questions, and remember that every interview is a learning experience.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Who gave the example of the salesgirl with a lovely smile?

A. Dale Carnegie

B. Richard Bolles

C. Freud

D. Confucius

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Used to stress personality.

Q2 (MCQ) The tip of the tie should end near the:

A. Collar

B. Centre of the belt

C. Knee

D. Pocket

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Standard grooming guidance.

Q3 (MSQ) Question types include:

A. Probing

B. Leading

C. Hypothetical

D. Photographic

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Photographic is not a type.

Q4 (T/F) A candidate should start answering before the interviewer completes the question.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Let the interviewer lead.

Q5 (Fill) Half of the battle in an interview is won by _____ behaviour.

> **Answer:** nonverbal
> **Why:** Appearance and gestures count.

Q6 (Short) State the jewellery advice for women at interviews.

> **Answer:** Keep jewellery minimal: one set of earrings and no more than one ring on each hand.
> **Why:** Avoid distraction.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list types of questions.
☐ I know how to stay patient and positive.
☐ I know the dress code for men and women.
☐ I know voice and nonverbal tips.
☐ I recall the Carnegie example.

Lecture 58: Facing Job Interviews: Part II

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 966–989 (printed pages 965–988)

Learning objectives

- Define and exemplify the seven question types: open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical, leading.
- Answer common interview questions about self, experience, strengths, weaknesses, money and ethics.
- Handle inappropriate personal questions tactfully.
- List what to do before, during and after the interview.
- Recall Charles Dickens' closing quotation.

Important definitions

OPEN QUESTION

A question inviting a free, varied, elaborate answer, usually asked at the start to make the candidate comfortable (e.g. Tell us briefly about yourself).

CLOSED QUESTION

A question with limited answers such as yes/no or a date (e.g. When did you complete your B.Tech?); often followed by a follow-up needing justification.

PROBING QUESTION

A question that tests the candidate's opinion, bias and attitude (e.g. Should students be allowed to take part in politics, including state and central politics?).

REFLECTIVE QUESTION

A question that mirrors the candidate's statement or view to test rationale, logic and forward thinking (e.g. Am I right in thinking you are against opening many IITs and IIMs?).

LOADED QUESTION

A question in which the interviewer's own bias or assumption is built in (e.g. Your GPA after first semester has been too low; how do you justify that?).

HYPOTHETICAL QUESTION

A question that places the candidate in an imagined unforeseen situation to test decision making (e.g. What would you do if disgruntled employees wanted to damage company property?).

LEADING QUESTION

A question that suggests the answer the interviewer expects (e.g. Don't you think our company is the best in reputation?).

TEETOTALER

A person who does not drink alcohol.

Core concepts

Why know question types

- Interviews include **general questions**, not only subject questions: integrity, honesty, sincerity, resourcefulness, initiative, leadership, communication.
- The interview is a **discourse** in which meaning is negotiated; a wrong hire hurts the organisation for years.
- Boards include subject experts and psychologists; **how** you answer matters as much as what.
- Interviews last about 10–20 minutes.

Open questions

- Asked at the beginning to create a comfortable atmosphere.
- Examples: Tell us briefly about yourself; What is your area of expertise? How did you come to know about this job? What prompted you to apply? Why do you consider yourself suitable?
- Answering is an **art**: indicate your qualities and experience briefly.

Closed questions

- Answer limited to yes/no or exact facts: When did you complete graduation? Where did you receive first professional training? Do you know data processing? Do you have an advanced degree in electronics?
- A follow-up such as 'What is the relevance of electronics today?' requires **justification**.

Probing questions

- Test opinion, bias, attitude: 'I believe students should be allowed to take part in politics. Should this include state and central politics?'
- Give a reasoned opinion (e.g. politics develops leadership traits).

Reflective questions

- Test rationale and forward thinking: 'Am I rightly thinking you are against opening many IITs and IIMs?'; 'So you want public sector companies to be totally privatised?'
- Answers may differ (like the **blind men and the elephant**) but must be justified.

Loaded questions

- The interviewer's bias is embedded: 'Your GPA is too low—how do you justify that?'; 'Should places of religious disputes be converted into public parks?'
- Responsibility for the reaction lies with the candidate; respond logically and calmly.

Hypothetical questions

- Test decisions in unforeseen crises: ‘What if disgruntled employees want to damage company property?’; ‘How would you handle employees misusing company assets?’
- Answer: first dialogue to understand the problem, then take action if needed; prevent others from being instigated.

Leading questions

- Suggest the expected answer: ‘Don’t you think our company is the best in reputation?’; ‘Should the company be free to retrench people in a market tumble?’
- Agree tactfully where harmless; where ethics is involved, respond ethically (e.g. call a meeting, share the burden, avoid retrenchment).

Experience and accomplishment questions

- **Why should we hire you when others have more experience?** – state your qualities and fit.
- **You change jobs frequently?** – give a positive, non-blaming reason; do not criticise a boss.
- **Team or alone?** – prefer teams: save time, build relationships, better solutions.
- **Where do you see yourself after 5 years?** – be modest; do not say ‘in your position’.
- **Boss dissatisfied with your work?** – modest, receptive.
- **Foreign assignment?** – be affirmative.
- **Co-worker supplying false data?** – verify quietly from various sources.

Strengths, weaknesses, personal and money questions

- **Strength:** state it affirmatively. **Weakness:** present it so it becomes a merit (e.g. perfectionism).
- **Alcohol:** be honest (‘I am a teetotaler’ or ‘occasionally, not habituated’).
- **What if you are not selected?** – hopeful, affirmative; learn from mistakes for the next interview.
- **Salary:** do not disclose; refer to the advertised structure and your qualification.
- **Importance of money?** – important, but not the only need; belonging matters.
- Also hobbies, extracurriculars, general awareness (new products, nuclear policy, demonetisation), ethics (misuse of assets).

Inappropriate personal questions

- Examples: divorced/separated? own house? maiden name? religious preference?
- Do not overreact; answer rationally and positively: ‘I believe in humanity’; ‘I have lived in organisation accommodation and will own a house in due course’.

Before the interview

- Select a comfortable, sober, clean, ironed dress; do not buy a new outfit obsessively.
- Polished formal shoes; testimonials in order.
- Read newspapers weeks ahead; anticipate current and general topics.

On the day

- Reach before time; read the morning newspaper.
- **Talk to other candidates** to ease nervousness; think positively and recall joyful memories.
- Enter as if you belong; greet all; **sit only when permitted**; thank them.

- Maintain **eye contact** with the questioner.
- Do not accept an offer until all interviews are over, but never say no outright (e.g. lower position: 'first let me get selected').

After the interview

- Do not turn back to look at the members; close the door gently; thank all and leave with a confident impression.
- Quote: **Charles Dickens** – 'Whatever I have tried to do in my life, I have tried to do well...I have always been thoroughly in earnest.' Honesty is the best policy.
- Interviews are continuous; 'Prepare well, do well, perform well, and succeed well.'

Types, classifications and characteristics

Seven types of interview questions

Type	Purpose	Example
Open	Create comfort; elaborate answers	Tell us about yourself
Closed	Fact or yes/no	When did you complete B.Tech?
Probing	Test opinion and attitude	Should students join politics?
Reflective	Test reasoning and foresight	Are you against many IITs and IIMs?
Loaded	Embedded bias	Your GPA is low—why?
Hypothetical	Test decision in unforeseen situations	What if employees damage property?
Leading	Suggest expected answer	Isn't our company the best?

Sample question and recommended approach

Question	Approach
Weakness?	Present it as a merit (perfectionism)
Salary expectation?	Refer to the advertised structure
Where in 5 years?	Modest; work hard and grow
What if not selected?	Hopeful; learn and improve
Foreign assignment?	Affirmative
Religion?	Humanity above all

Theories, principles, models and contributors

HONEST EFFORT — CHARLES DICKENS (AS CITED)

'Whatever I have tried to do in my life, I have tried to do well...I have always been thoroughly in earnest.'

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Blind men and the elephant for different answers to reflective questions.

EXAMPLE

Disgruntled employees damaging company property (hypothetical).

EXAMPLE

Market tumble and retrenchment (leading, ethical).

EXAMPLE

Weakness presented as perfectionism.

EXAMPLE

Asked about religion: ‘I believe in humanity’.

Comparison tables

Open versus closed questions

Point	Open	Closed
Answer	Elaborate, varied	Limited (yes/no, date)
Timing	Beginning of interview	Fact checking, followed by follow-up
Example	Tell us about yourself	Do you have a degree in electronics?

Probing versus reflective questions

Point	Probing	Reflective
Tests	Opinion, bias, attitude	Rationale, logic, forward thinking
Form	Statement of belief + ‘do you think...’	‘Am I right in thinking you...?’

Loaded versus leading questions

Point	Loaded	Leading
Feature	Contains the interviewer’s bias or fault-finding	Suggests the expected answer
Response	Justify calmly	Agree tactfully or answer ethically

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Seven types: open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical, leading.
- First question is usually ‘Tell us briefly about yourself’.
- Closed questions are often followed by justification questions.
- Hypothetical questions test decision making in crises.
- Do not disclose salary; do not criticise past employers.
- Present weakness as a merit.
- Sit only when permitted; maintain eye contact.
- Do not accept an offer until all interviews are over, but never say no.
- Close the door gently.
- Dickens quoted at the close.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q13	p.39	What recruiters look for	True/False
W12 Q5	p.40	Types of interview questions	MCQ
W12 Q6	p.41	Types of interview questions	MCQ
W12 Q13	p.42	Common interview questions	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Interviews use seven kinds of questions: open (comfort-building), closed (facts), probing (opinions), reflective (reasoning), loaded (embedded bias), hypothetical (crisis decisions) and leading (suggesting answers). Answers should be logical, honest, affirmative and justified: present weaknesses as merits, avoid disclosing salary or criticising employers, remain modest about the future, show team spirit and ethics, and handle personal questions calmly. Before the interview prepare dress, documents and current awareness; on the day arrive early, talk to other candidates, enter confidently, sit when asked, maintain eye contact and leave gracefully, closing the door gently.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) 'Your GPA after the first semester was too low; how do you justify that?' is a:

A. Open question

B. Loaded question

C. Closed question

D. Hypothetical question

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It embeds the interviewer's bias.

Q2 (MCQ) Which question tests decision making in an unforeseen situation?

A. Closed

B. Probing

C. Hypothetical

D. Leading

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Imagined crisis scenarios.

Q3 (MSQ) Good practices on the interview day include:

A. Reaching early

B. Sitting only when permitted

C. Maintaining eye contact

D. Slamming the door when leaving

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Close the door gently.

Q4 (T/F) A candidate should name a desired salary at the first chance.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Refer to the advertised structure.

Q5 (Fill) 'Tell us briefly about yourself' is typically an _____ question.

> **Answer:** open
> **Why:** It creates a comfortable atmosphere.

Q6 (Short) How should you answer a question about your weakness?

> **Answer:** Present it so that it becomes a merit, e.g. being a perfectionist who works hard to bring perfection to the task.
> **Why:** Stay affirmative.

Revision checklist

☐ I can name and exemplify seven question types.
☐ I can answer weakness and salary questions.
☐ I can handle personal questions.
☐ I know before/during/after tips.
☐ I recall the Dickens quote.

Lecture 59: Emotional Intelligence and Critical Thinking

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 990–1005 (printed pages 989–1004)

Learning objectives

- Define emotional intelligence (EI) and critical thinking.
- Differentiate EQ and IQ.
- List the components of emotional intelligence: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills.
- Distinguish personal and social competencies.
- List the components of critical thinking and the social skills of influence, conflict management, leadership, change catalyst, building bonds, collaboration.

Important definitions

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE (EI)

The capacity for recognising our own feelings and those of others, for motivating ourselves and for managing emotions well in ourselves and in our relationships (popularised by Daniel Goleman in *Working with Emotional Intelligence*; the lecture names him ‘Richard Goleman’).

IQ (INTELLIGENCE QUOTIENT)

A measure of mental ability or intelligence, related to academic abilities.

EQ (EMOTIONAL QUOTIENT)

A measure of emotional intelligence: awareness and management of emotions in oneself and others.

CRITICAL THINKING

A mode of thinking about any content or subject in which the thinker improves the quality of thinking by skilfully taking charge of the structures inherent in thinking and imposing intellectual standards upon them.

SELF-AWARENESS

Awareness of one’s emotions, accurate self-assessment and self-confidence.

SELF-REGULATION

Controlling emotions; includes trustworthiness, conscientiousness, adaptability and innovation.

EMPATHY

Understanding others' emotions and putting oneself in their position.

SOCIAL SKILLS

Influence, communication, conflict management, leadership, change catalyst, building bonds, collaboration and team capabilities.

CHANGE CATALYST

A person who initiates and brings change in the organisation.

ACHIEVEMENT DRIVE

A personal competency of striving to do something new and excellent.

Core concepts

Why emotions matter at work

- Everyone has emotions; compromises and control are needed at the workplace.
- If driven by emotions, tasks are not completed; progress stalls.
- Intelligence alone may not give correct decisions; groups use meetings and consensus.
- Example clip: two managers argue over a conference room ('conference rooms go to the highest ranked manager'), anger outbursts spoil the meeting.

Emotional intelligence

- Ability to recognise, motivate and manage feelings in self and others; popularised by Goleman.
- Balance between **IQ and EI** is needed for success.
- Observation cited: women on average are more aware of their emotions, show more empathy and are more adept interpersonally.

EQ versus IQ

- IQ relates to academic ability and mental ability; helps in getting a job.
- EQ relates to emotions and relationships; helps to **succeed**; a true leader relies more on EQ without ignoring IQ.
- Self-analysis is the first step in EI.

Components of EI (personal competence)

1. **Self-awareness:** emotional awareness, accurate self-assessment, **self-confidence** (a 'can do' attitude; preparation plus self-belief).
2. **Self-regulation:** self-control, **trustworthiness** (words match actions), **conscientiousness** (right versus wrong, ethics), **adaptability** (flexibility), **innovation**. Emotions cannot be left at home; nerves are controlled by telling oneself everything is in order.
3. **Motivation:** achievement drive, commitment, **initiative**, optimism, determination. Example: Swachh Bharat Abhiyan began with one person's drive.

Social competence

1. **Empathy / social awareness:** understand others' emotions, develop others, **service orientation**, awareness of diversity (cultures, faiths) and organisational politics; 'brotherly feeling' not a 'big brother'.
2. **Social skills: influence** (fairness, no bias, smooth communication), **communication** (Descartes quoted: 'Thanks to language man became man'), **conflict management** (listening), **leadership** (listen to grievances), **change catalyst**, **building bonds**, **collaboration and cooperation**, **team capabilities**.

Critical thinking components

- **Imagination:** anticipate what may happen in a meeting; keen observation; creative listening.
- **Asking relevant questions** at the right time; detect fallacies.
- **Not being judgmental**; hurried judgment is frightening.
- Test the validity of points before discarding irrelevant ones.
- **Learning from experience**; learn, unlearn; self-assessment and self-learning.
- **Examine relationships** between people as well as statements.
- **Neutrality** is the hallmark of a leader; assimilate everyone's views.

Quotations and closing messages

- Shakespeare: 'What a piece of work is man' – immense potential (even travel to Mars).
- Robert Frost: 'Two roads diverged in a wood, and I took the one less traveled by' – be extraordinary; the wood stands for uncertainty.
- 'Difference of opinion is good, but let there be **deference** for difference of opinion'; be **different, not indifferent**.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Components of emotional intelligence

Domain	Elements
Self-awareness	Emotional awareness, self-assessment, self-confidence
Self-regulation	Self-control, trustworthiness, conscientiousness, adaptability, innovation
Motivation	Achievement drive, commitment, initiative, optimism
Empathy	Understanding others, developing others, service orientation, diversity, political awareness
Social skills	Influence, communication, conflict management, leadership, change catalyst, bonds, collaboration, team skills

Personal versus social competence

Type	Components
Personal competence	Self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation
Social competence	Empathy, social skills

Theories, principles, models and contributors

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE — DANIEL GOLEMAN (NAMED 'RICHARD GOLEMAN' IN THE LECTURE)

Book: *Working with Emotional Intelligence*. EI is the capacity to recognise our feelings and those of others, to motivate ourselves and to manage emotions in ourselves and relationships.

LANGUAGE MAKES MAN — DESCARTES (AS CITED)

'Thanks to language man became man.'

MAN'S POTENTIAL — SHAKESPEARE (AS CITED)

'What a piece of work is man.'

THE ROAD LESS TRAVELLED — ROBERT FROST

'Two roads diverged in a wood, and I took the one less traveled by.'

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Conference room dispute between two managers.

EXAMPLE

Swachh Bharat Abhiyan as achievement drive and initiative.

EXAMPLE

Forgetting words and fretting on stage as failure of self-regulation.

EXAMPLE

A manager arriving early so that everyone becomes punctual (change catalyst).

Comparison tables

IQ versus EQ

Point	IQ	EQ
Relates to	Mental/academic ability	Emotions and relationships
Helps in	Getting a job	Succeeding and leading
Tests	IQ tests	EQ tests

Self-awareness versus self-regulation

Point	Self-awareness	Self-regulation
Focus	Knowing one's emotions and strengths	Controlling and channelling emotions
Includes	Emotional awareness, self-assessment, self-confidence	Self-control, trustworthiness, conscientiousness, adaptability, innovation

Different versus indifferent

Different	Indifferent
Innovative and respectful of differences	Uncaring; bad

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- EI popularised by Goleman's *Working with Emotional Intelligence*.
- IQ gets the job; EQ ensures success.
- Five EI components: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills.
- Self-analysis is the first step in EI.
- Critical thinking improves thinking quality by imposing intellectual standards.
- Do not be judgmental; ask relevant questions.
- Neutrality is the hallmark of a leader.
- Change catalyst, collaboration and team capabilities are social skills.
- Frost's road less travelled.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W0 Q3	p.1	Emotional intelligence	MCQ
W12 Q7	p.41	Emotional intelligence	MCQ
W12 Q8	p.41	Critical thinking	MCQ
W12 Q14	p.42	Social skills (emotional intelligence)	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Emotional intelligence is the capacity to recognise, motivate and manage emotions in oneself and others; it complements IQ, with IQ helping one get a job and EQ helping one succeed and lead. Its personal competencies are self-awareness (emotional awareness, self-assessment, self-confidence), self-regulation (self-control, trustworthiness, conscientiousness, adaptability, innovation) and motivation (achievement drive, initiative, commitment, optimism); its social competencies are empathy (understanding and developing others, service orientation, diversity and political awareness) and social

skills (influence, communication, conflict management, leadership, change catalysing, bonds, collaboration, teamwork). Critical thinking adds imagination, relevant questioning, non-judgmental observation, learning and unlearning, awareness of relationships and neutrality. Respect differences: be different, not indifferent.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which book popularised the term emotional intelligence in the workplace?

A. Working with Emotional Intelligence

B. What Color Is My Parachute

C. How to Win Friends

D. The Road Not Taken

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** By Daniel Goleman.

Q2 (MCQ) Which is a component of self-regulation?

A. Trustworthiness

B. Service orientation

C. Influence

D. Collaboration

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Others belong to social competence.

Q3 (MSQ) Social skills include:

A. Influence

B. Conflict management

C. Change catalyst

D. Self-confidence

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Self-confidence is part of self-awareness.

Q4 (T/F) A critical thinker should reach quick judgments about people.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Hurried judgments are frightening.

Q5 (Fill) A leader's hallmark is _____.

> **Answer:** neutrality
> **Why:** Assimilate everyone's views.

Q6 Short Differentiate IQ and EQ.

> **Answer:** IQ measures mental or academic ability and helps in getting a job; EQ measures awareness and management of emotions in oneself and others and helps one succeed and lead.
> **Why:** Balance both.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define EI and critical thinking.
☐ I can list the five EI components.
☐ I can contrast IQ and EQ.
☐ I can list critical-thinking components.
☐ I recall Frost and Shakespeare quotes.

Lecture 60: Applied Grammar

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 1006–1026 (printed pages 1005–1025)

Learning objectives

- Apply rules of plural nouns, nouns ending in s, and always-plural nouns.
- Use capitalisation of titles, designations, departments and organisations correctly.
- Use apostrophes for possession correctly.
- Apply subject–verb agreement rules (none of, either/or, neither/nor, each of, indefinite pronouns, a great deal of).
- Use articles, question tags, prepositions and voice correctly; avoid commonly confused words.

Important definitions

GRAMMAR

Rules of a language and notions of correctness in its use.

CONCORD (AGREEMENT)

The verb must agree with its subject in number and person.

APPOSITIVE

A noun phrase (such as a name) placed beside another noun to identify it, e.g. only one professor, Jonathan Reeves.

APOSTROPHE

A mark showing possession or relationship, e.g. women’s, girls’ hostel; not used in yours.

INDEFINITE PRONOUN

A pronoun without specific reference: anybody, nobody, each, either, every, everyone; takes a singular verb.

QUESTION TAG

A short question added to a statement to seek confirmation, e.g. people are happy, aren’t they?

ACTIVE VOICE

The subject performs the action; verb follows the subject; greater impact.

PASSIVE VOICE

The subject receives the action; order changes; less impact.

DEFINITE ARTICLE

'the': used for specific things, rivers, mountains, great books, newspapers, and for classes (the rich, the wise).

Core concepts

Why applied grammar

- Grammar means rules and notions of correctness.
- Even good speakers err in writing because of overuse, advertisements and digital media.
- The lecture sensitises learners to shaky areas; it does not teach all grammar.

Sample incorrect sentences

- I congratulate you **for** your success (should be **on**).
- My student is **a** SDO (should be **an** S.D.O).
- Where is your **particular**? (particulars).
- Diabetes **kill** people (kills).
- The secretary and principal **are** on leave (concord/article issue depending on meaning).
- The man who is clad in jeans **are** my neighbour (is).

Nouns always plural

- **police** (the police **are** coming), **clothes** (Where are my clothes?).
- Tools and instruments in pairs: **binoculars, scissors, spectacles, glasses, scales**.
- Garments: **breeches, pants, jeans, pyjamas, trousers**.
- **Children** is already plural (not 'childrens'); old plural *brethren*.

Nouns ending in s that are singular

- **news** (no news is good news), **politics**, **mathematics, physics, astrophysics**, diseases **diabetes, mumps**.
- Politics is an interesting game; Diabetes kills people silently.

Capitalisation

- Capitalise titles before names: **Professor Mishra**, Doctor, surname.
- Government posts as titles: Prime Minister, President, Vice Chairman.
- Designation after the name is in small letters: Mr Pratyush Pant, **director** of Anshul Enterprises.
- Do **not** capitalise when a title is followed by an appositive: only one professor, Jonathan Reeves, objected.
- When a title replaces a name in a sentence, small letters: the director and the deputy director; capital only in an address (The Director, IIT Roorkee).
- Do not capitalise with possessive pronouns: my supervisor, your brother, his guide.

- Names of departments, units, cells: Educational Technology Cell; Dell's Quality Control Unit; the firm's Personnel Department; Nokia's Corporate Social Responsibility unit.

Apostrophe

- Shows ownership/relationship: one's own, one year's time, two years' time, women's associations, girls' hostel, judges' verdict, students' views.
- Never in **yours, hers, its, ours, theirs** ('yours faithfully', not 'your's').
- Names ending in s: both **James' book** and **James's book**; **Keats' / Keats's poetry** are correct.

Subject–verb agreement

- Verb agrees with its subject in number and person; trace the true subject in long sentences.
- **None of** + plural: usually plural (none of these managers have submitted...); singular when meaning 'not one' (none of them has come).
- Singular subjects joined by **either...or / neither...nor**: singular verb (either the works manager or the shift in-charge has to take the responsibility).
- If subjects differ in number/person, the verb agrees with the **nearest** subject: either he or I **am** to blame; neither the doctor nor the nurses **were** seen.
- **Each of, either of, neither of**: third-person singular (each of these policies has its own limitations).
- **A great deal of / a good deal of**: verb agrees with the object of 'of' (a great deal of money has been spent).
- **Most of the students feel...**: agrees with the noun after 'of'.
- **Indefinite pronouns** (anybody, nobody, each, either, every, everyone): singular verb (each of the employees has to follow norms; everyone was recommended).

Articles

- Choose **a/an** by **sound**, not spelling: **an** S.D.O, **an** apple, **a** university professor, **a** superintendent.
- **The** for specifics and for: rivers and mountains (the Ganges, the Yamuna), great books (The Mahabharata, The Ramayana, The Bible, The Geeta, The Vedas), newspapers (The Times of India, The Telegraph, The Hindu), classes (the rich, the wise; Dr Johnson: 'Let me smile with the wise and feed with the rich').

Question tags

- Positive statement → negative tag: people are happy, aren't they?
- Negative statement → positive tag: you do not like me, do you?
- Exception: **I am teaching well, aren't I?**
- Use the same auxiliary: you have not enjoyed this course, have you?

Prepositions

- **senior, junior, superior, inferior** take **to**, not than (Mr Rathore is senior to me).
- **Since** for a point of time (since 2007); **for** for a period (for four years; for the last three days).
- **Beside** = by the side of; **besides** = in addition to.
- absorbed **in**; Roorkee lies **between** Meerut and Haridwar (two objects); beware **of**; comply **with**; confident **of**.

Voice and transformation

- Active: verb follows subject; stronger impact. Passive: changed order; less impact (use for politeness or unknown doer).
- Examples: 'You are requested to submit the report' (passive) vs 'Please submit your report' (active); 'We expect good news' vs 'Good news is expected'; 'The streets are swept every day'.
- Meaning transformations: 'too…to' is negative (the hall is too small to accommodate thirty guests = so small that it cannot); an interrogative can carry negative meaning (Can a leopard change its skin? = it cannot); comparison (The aeroplane flies faster than birds = birds do not fly as fast as aeroplanes).

Confusing words

- **affect** (verb: influence) / **effect** (noun: result).
- **formal / formerly** (earlier).
- **loose** (not tight) / **lose** (fail to keep).
- **stationary** (still) / **stationery** (paper and writing material).
- **later** (afterwards) / **latter** (second of two).
- **compliment** (praise) / **complement** (complete); complimentary copy (free).
- **desert** / **dessert** (sweet).
- **elicit** (draw out) / **illicit** (illegal).

Course conclusion

- The course covered communication in many phases: telephone, oral, written; personality; barriers; letters, reports, data; interviews, group discussion; leadership; speeches; balancing emotion and intellect.
- 'All is well that ends well.' Grammar is a sea; one is only a drop in it.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Singular nouns ending in s

Category	Examples
Information/politics	news, politics
Subjects	mathematics, physics, astrophysics, economics
Diseases	diabetes, mumps

Always-plural nouns

Category	Examples
Group	police, clothes, children
Instruments	binoculars, scissors, spectacles, glasses, scales
Garments	breeches, pants, jeans, pyjamas, trousers

Agreement rules

Subject pattern	Verb
Either…or / neither…nor (both singular)	Singular
Subjects differing in number	Agrees with nearest subject
Each of / either of / neither of	Singular
Indefinite pronoun (everyone, nobody…)	Singular
A great deal of / most of + noun	Agrees with the noun after ‘of’
None of + plural	Usually plural; singular for ‘not one’

Theories, principles, models and contributors

WISE AND RICH AS CLASSES — DR SAMUEL JOHNSON (AS CITED)

‘Let me smile with the wise and feed with the rich’: ‘the’ + adjective denotes a class.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

The police are coming.

EXAMPLE

Diabetes kills people silently.

EXAMPLE

Either he or I am to blame.

EXAMPLE

Neither the doctor nor the nurses were seen at the accident site.

EXAMPLE

Each of these policies has its own limitations.

EXAMPLE

I am teaching well, aren’t I?

EXAMPLE

Mr Rathore is senior to me.

EXAMPLE

Besides teaching, I write books.

EXAMPLE

Life is not a desert; life is full of desserts.

Comparison tables

Since versus for

Point	Since	For
Indicates	Point of time	Period of time
Example	since 2007	for four years

Beside versus besides

Point	Beside	Besides
Meaning	By the side of	In addition to
Example	Sitting beside the driver	Besides teaching I write books

Active versus passive voice

Point	Active	Passive
Impact	Stronger	Weaker
Order	Subject–verb–object	Object–verb–doer
Example	We expect good news	Good news is expected

Commonly confused pairs

Word 1	Word 2
affect (verb)	effect (noun)
loose (not tight)	lose (misplace)
stationary (still)	stationery (paper)
compliment (praise)	complement (complete)
elicit (draw out)	illicit (illegal)

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Police, clothes, scissors, trousers are plural.
- News, politics, mathematics, diabetes are singular.
- Children is already plural.
- Never write your's or yours'.
- James' or James's both acceptable.
- Either/or: singular verb for singular subjects; nearest-subject rule otherwise.
- Each of takes a singular verb.
- Articles depend on sound: an S.D.O, a university.
- Tag for 'I am' is 'aren't I?'
- Senior, junior, superior, inferior take 'to'.
- Since = point of time; for = period.
- Too...to has negative meaning.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W12 Q9	p.41	Applied grammar: indefinite pronouns	MCQ
W12 Q10	p.41	Applied grammar: passive voice	MCQ
W12 Q15	p.42	Applied grammar: subject-verb agreement	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Applied grammar focuses on common trouble spots: always-plural nouns (police, clothes, scissors, trousers), singular nouns ending in s (news, politics, mathematics, diabetes), capitalisation rules for titles, designations and department names, apostrophes for possession (never in yours), subject–verb agreement (none of, either/or, neither/nor, each of, indefinite pronouns, a great deal of), articles chosen by sound, question tags (including 'aren't I?'), prepositions (senior to, since/for, beside/besides, between), voice and transformation, and confusing words (affect/effect, loose/lose, stationary/stationery, later/latter, compliment/complement, desert/dessert, elicit/illicit). The course closes with a message that balanced emotion and intellect, careful communication and constant learning lead to success.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which sentence is correct?

A. Diabetes kill people

B. Diabetes kills people

C. Diabetes are killing people

D. Diabetes have killed people

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Diabetes is singular.

Q2 (MCQ) Choose the correct tag: 'I am teaching well, _____'

A. amn't I?

B. aren't I?

C. isn't I?

D. don't I?

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Exception to the rule.

Q3 (MSQ) Which nouns are always plural?

A. Scissors

B. Trousers

C. Police

D. News

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** News is singular.

Q4 (T/F) 'Mr Rathore is senior than me' is correct.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use 'senior to'.

Q5 (Fill) Either he or I _____ to blame.

> **Answer:** am
> **Why:** Verb agrees with the nearest subject.

Q6 (Short) Differentiate 'since' and 'for'.

> **Answer:** 'Since' marks a specific point of time (since 2007); 'for' marks a period of time (for four years).
> **Why:** Used with perfect continuous tenses.

Revision checklist

☐ I know always-plural and singular-s nouns.
☐ I can capitalise titles correctly.
☐ I can use apostrophes properly.
☐ I can apply agreement rules.
☐ I can choose articles, tags, prepositions.
☐ I can avoid confusing word pairs.